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Ques : What is the projected growth rate for the Indian economy in FY25 according to Deloitte?

- (a) 6.5-6.8%
- (b) 5.5-5.8%
- (c) 4.5-4.8%
- (d) 7.5-7.8%
- (e) 8.5-8.8%

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- According to Deloitte, the Indian economy is expected to grow at 6.5-6.8 percent this fiscal year and slightly higher at 6.7-7.3 percent in FY2026, boosted by domestic consumption.
- According to Deloitte India Economist Rumki Majumdar, growth in the first half of fiscal year 2025 was slower than expected due to election concerns and disruptions in business caused by excessive rainfall and geopolitical events, which weighed on domestic demand and exports.
- However, India continues to demonstrate resilience in some areas that are worth mentioning, such as consumer patterns, service growth, the increasing role of high-value manufacturing in exports, and the capital market.

Updated GDP List :

- Deloitte – 6.5% – 6.8% (FY24), 6.7% – 7.3% (FY26)
- India Ratings – 6.4% (FY24), 6.6% (FY26)
- ADB – 6.5% (FY24), 7%(FY25)
- S&P – 6.8% (FY25), 6.9% (FY26)
- RBI –6.6% (FY24)
- Morgan Stanley – 6.3% (FY25)
- Moody Ratings – 2% (CY24)
- IMF – 7% (FY25), 6.5% (FY26)
- World Bank – 7% (FY25)





Ques : Federation of Cold Storage Associations of India (FCAOI) signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with which bank to enhance agricultural infrastructure ?

- (a) South Indian Bank
- (b) Axis Bank
- (c) Indian Bank
- (d) Punjab National Bank
- (e) Karur Vyasya Bank

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Punjab National Bank (PNB) and Federation of Cold Storage Associations of India (FCAOI) have signed an MoU to improve agricultural infrastructure and cold chain development in India.
- The partnership advances innovation, improves agricultural infrastructure, and provides farmers and agribusinesses with efficient storage and cold chain solutions.

About Punjab National Bank :

- Established : 19 May 1894
- HQ : New Delhi
- MD & CEO : Atul Kumar Goel
- Tagline : The Name You Can Bank Upon

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Ques : What is the name of the framework for which the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has constituted a committee to develop ethical and responsible use of Artificial Intelligence in the financial sector?

- (a) Ethical AI Framework (EAF)
- (b) Responsible AI in Banking (RAIB)
- (c) Framework for Responsible and Ethical Enablement of Artificial Intelligence (FREE-AI)
- (d) Artificial Intelligence Governance Framework (AIGF)
- (e) AI in Finance Framework (AIF)

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has set up a committee to create a Framework for Responsible and Ethical Enabling of Artificial Intelligence (FREE-AI) in the Financial Sector.
- Pushpak Bhattacharyya, Professor, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, IIT Bombay, will serve as the committee's head.
- According to the RBI, the committee's goal is to develop a governance framework to promote ethical AI use in India's financial industry.
- The Committee will assess the current level of AI adoption in financial services, both globally and in India, review regulatory and supervisory approaches to AI with a focus on the financial sector globally, identify potential risks associated with AI, if any, and recommend an evaluation, mitigation, and monitoring framework, as well as compliance requirements for financial institutions such as banks, NBFCs, FinTechs, PSOs, and so on.
- The Committee will submit its report within six months after its initial meeting.





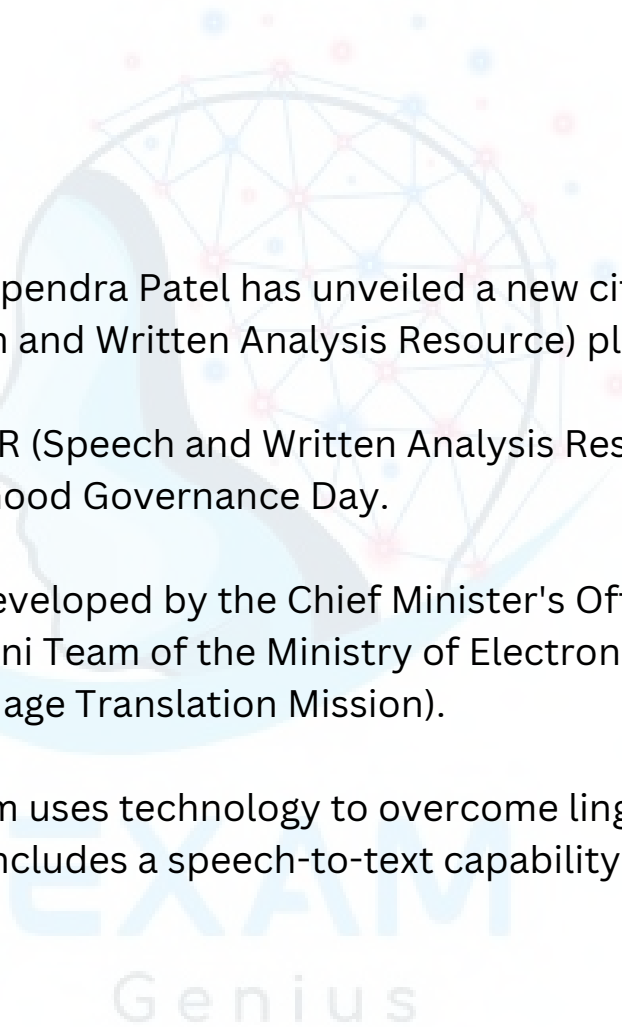
Ques : Which state launched a new citizen-centric initiative called the SWAR (Speech and Written Analysis Resource) platform ?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) Madhya Pradesh

Answer : Option B

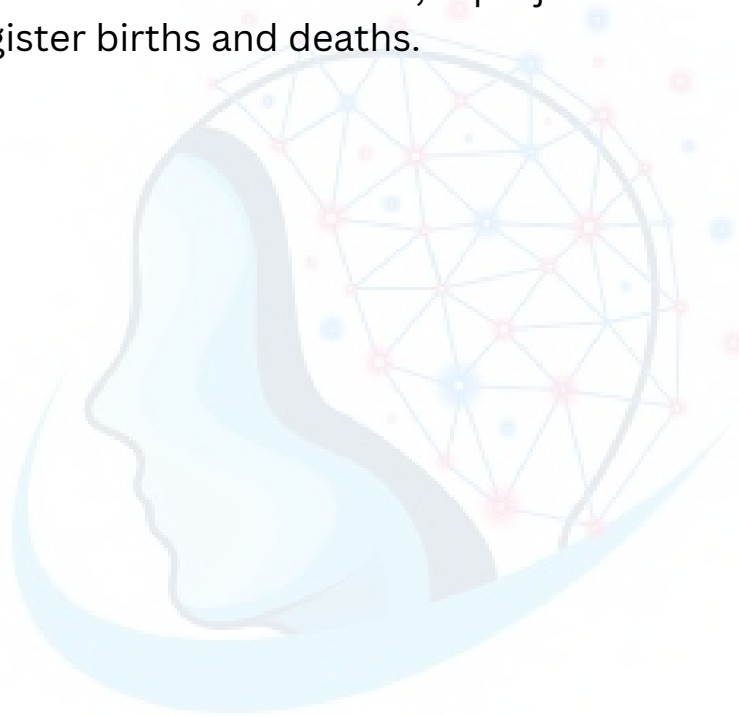
Explanation :

- Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel has unveiled a new citizen-centric project known as the SWAR (Speech and Written Analysis Resource) platform.
- On December 25, the SWAR (Speech and Written Analysis Resource) platform was launched to coincide with Good Governance Day.
- The SWAR platform was developed by the Chief Minister's Office (CMO) in partnership with the Bhashini Team of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (National Language Translation Mission).
- This revolutionary platform uses technology to overcome linguistic obstacles. The Gujarat CMO website now includes a speech-to-text capability.





- Shri C.R. Paatil, the Hon'ble Minister of Jal Shakti, digitally launched the "Bhu-Neer" platform during the India Water Week 2024 closing ceremony.
- The Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports has started a statewide campaign to improve the battle against doping in sports, encouraging athletes, coaches, and the entire sporting community to use the National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA) India's 'Know Your Medicine (KYM)' app
- The Civil Registration System (CRS) smartphone app, developed by India's Registrar General and Census Commissioner, is projected to dramatically cut the time necessary to register births and deaths.



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Ques : Who has been appointed as the Director of the National Testing Agency (NTA)?

- (a) Ramesh Pokhriyal
- (b) Subhas Sarkar
- (c) Sandip Kumar Mishra
- (d) Amit Khare
- (e) Anil Sahasrabudhe

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Sandip Kumar Mishra has been appointed as the Director of the National Testing Agency (NTA) for 5 years.
- The NTA is responsible for conducting various national-level entrance examinations in India, ensuring transparency and fairness in the examination process.
- He Replaced Pradeep Singh Kharola.
- Mishra's leadership is expected to strengthen the agency's operations.
- Archana Shukla, Amit Kumar, and Shivani Appointed as Joint directors of NTA for 4 years.
- National Testing Agency (NTA) is established in 2017 and headquarter is in New Delhi.





Recent Appointment in different departments :

- K N Renuka Pujar : first transgender guest lecturer at a Karnataka institution
- Dr. Sandip Shah : Chairperson of the National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL)
- Abhijit Majumder : Chief financial officer (CFO) of Oil India
- Arunish Chawla : Revenue Secretary
- Suman Berry : Chairman of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM)
- Unsoo Kim : Managing Director (MD) of Hyundai Motor India for 3 years
- Pradeep Chugh : Company secretary of Hyundai Motor India
- Sriram Krishnan : Senior White House Policy Advisor on Artificial Intelligence
- Rupam Roy : General Secretary (GS) of All India State Bank Officers' Federation (AISBOF)
- Arun Kumar Bishoyi : President of All India State Bank Officers' Federation (AISBOF)
- Retired Supreme Court Justice V. Ramasubramanian : Chairperson of the National Human Rights Commission
- Madan B Lokur : chairperson of the United Nations Internal Justice Council (IJC)
- Raj Kumar Chaudhary : Additional charge of CMD for the government-owned hydropower company SJVN Limited (Replaced Sushil Sharma)
- Dr. Jagath Wickramaratne : Speaker of Sri Lanka's 10th Parliament (Replaced Asoka Ranwala)
- Malaysian coach Tan Kim Her : India's Doubles Badminton Coach for the 2026 Asian Games and 2028 Olympics
- Preeti Lobana : Country Manager and Vice President in India by Google
- Carl Hopkinson : Mumbai Indians' new fielding coach for the IPL 2025
- Economic Affairs Secretary Ajay Seth : Additional charge of Revenue Secretary (Replaced Sanjay Malhotra)
- Rahul Narwekar : 15th Maharashtra Legislative Assembly Speaker
- Rabindra Nath Mahato : Speaker of the 6th Jharkhand Legislative Assembly





Ques : Who, a global auto industry icon and former chairman of Suzuki Motor Corporation, passed away at the age of 94?

- (a) Akio Toyoda
- (b) Osamu Suzuki
- (c) Soichiro Honda
- (d) Eiji Toyoda
- (e) Shoichiro Toyoda

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Osamu Suzuki, the former chairman of Suzuki Motor Corporation and an icon in the worldwide car industry, died at the age of 94.
- The former chairman of the Japanese brand, who headed the company for nearly four decades, has reportedly died of cancer. Suzuki stepped down as the brand's chairman in 2021, at the age of 91.
- Osamu Suzuki joined Suzuki Motor in 1958 and became president in 1978, while serving as chairman from 2000 onward.
- With 28 years in the chair and two terms as president of the brand, he became the longest-serving leader of the global carmaker.

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Ques : Which state Launches AI Task Force to promote Technological Growth ?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) Madhya Pradesh

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- During the 11th Chintan Shibir in Somnath, Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel launched the Artificial Intelligence (AI) Task Force to position the state as a pioneer in technology-driven government and socio-economic growth.
- The AI Task Force, directed by the Principal Secretary of Gujarat's Department of Science and Technology, has a one-year tenure with annual progress evaluations.
- The group consists of 10 members, including directors from IIT Gandhinagar and IIT Vadodara in Gujarat, as well as senior experts from India AI Mission, National Informatics Centre (NIC), and Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC).

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Ques : Which country Universities Set to Establish Campuses at GIFT City, Gujarat ?

- (a) Spain
- (b) China
- (c) USA
- (d) France
- (e) UK

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Two UK universities, Queen's University Belfast and Coventry University, have applied to open international campuses in Gujarat's GIFT City, following the lead of Australian institutions.
- Queen's University Belfast, a top-ranked UK institution, is the third foreign university accepted for GIFT City.
- Coventry University, with over 13,000 international students from 160 countries, is preparing to join the GIFT City educational environment.
- The institution, famed for its global campuses, will open a "India Hub" in Delhi in 2024.

About United Kingdom :

- Capital : London
- Currency : Pound sterling
- PM : Keir Starmer

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Ques : Which company launched the advertising campaign "First the fan will come, then electricity will come" to promote its renewable energy initiatives?

- (a) Tata Power
- (b) Adani Group
- (c) Reliance Industries
- (d) NTPC Limited
- (e) Suzlon Energy

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Adani Group has launched a new advertising campaign dubbed "First the fan, then the electricity" to promote its renewable energy initiatives.
- The program is part of the Adani Group's overall commitment to renewable energy. Its renewable energy division, Adani Green Energy, aspires to build 50 GW of renewable energy capacity by 2030. This includes the huge Khavda Renewable Energy Park in Gujarat.
- Khavda, which covers 538 square kilometers—five times the size of Paris—is destined to become one of the world's largest renewable energy projects.
- The park will have a total capacity of 30 GW, with the first phase of 250 MW wind energy now online. The group's track record includes the 648 MW Kamuthi Solar Plant in Tamil Nadu, which was completed in 2016.
- At the time, it was the world's largest single-site solar energy plant. These initiatives demonstrate the Adani Group's leadership in promoting India's sustainable energy aspirations.
- Director of Adani Airport Holdings Ltd is Jeet Adani .





Ques : Which country will host the World Audio Visual Entertainment Summit (WAVES) for the first time in 2025?

- (a) United States
- (b) China
- (c) India
- (d) Japan
- (e) Russia

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- India will host the World Audio Visual Entertainment Summit (WAVES) for the first time in 2025.
- The WAVES Summit is set to act as a global forum for India's creative talent, encouraging collaborations and highlighting the country's potential as a hub for world-class content development.
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Ques : Joe Biden signed a law on Christmas Eve?

- (a) Golden Eagle
- (b) Bald Eagle
- (c) Peregrine Falcon
- (d) American Robin
- (e) Red-tailed Hawk

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The bald eagle is now the official national bird of the United States, according to a statute signed by President Joe Biden on Christmas Eve that recognizes the white-headed and yellow-beaked bird of prey.
- The bird has served as a national emblem in the United States for many years, appearing on the Great Seal of the United States, which is used on US papers, since 1782.
- Benjamin Franklin, a founding father, opposed to the species being picked to represent the country, calling it a "bird of bad moral character".
- According to the US Department of Veteran Affairs, bald eagles, like other eagles around the world, have long been regarded as emblems of strength, courage, independence, and immortality. The bald eagle, unlike other eagles, was native only to North America.
- Minnesota lawmakers spearheaded the legislation that designated the bald eagle as the national bird. The bald eagle is also protected by the National Emblem Act of 1940, which makes it unlawful to sell or hunt the bird.





Ques : Which state celebrated the annual Kagyad Dance festival ?

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Sikkim
- (c) Assam
- (d) Arunachal Pradesh
- (e) Meghalaya

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Sikkim held its annual Kagyad Dance event at Gangtok's Tsuklakhang Palace in accordance with tradition.
- Enacted on the 28th and 29th days of the 10th month of the Tibetan Lunar Calendar (early December), it is a bustling cultural festival that attracts both locals and international tourists seeking spiritual guidance.
- The event finishes with the traditional burning of effigies, which symbolizes the triumph of good over evil.

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Recent News Headlines Related to Festivals & Fairs :

- Ladakhi Losar : Celebrated in Ladakh to mark the New Year according to the Tibetan calendar .
- Viraasat Sari Festival 2024 : 3rd Edition Hosted by Ministry of Textiles at Handloom Haat, Janpath, New Delhi .
- Eaglenest Bird Festival : Arunachal Pradesh in Kellong and Thongre village, West Kameng District .
- International Gita Mahotsav : Kurukshetra, Haryana .
- Asthalakshmi Mahotsav : New Delhi, It will focus on India's eight north-eastern states .
- Cherry Blossom Festival : Shillong, Meghalaya .
- Hornbill Festival : Nagaland .
- Bodoland Mohotsav : celebration of the Bodo language in Delhi (theme is 'Peace and Harmony for Prosperous Bharat') .
- Jauljibi Mela : Pithoragarh, Uttarakhand .
- Igas Bagwal (also known as Budhi Diwali or Harbodhni Ekadashi) : Uttarakhand
- Bali Padyami festival (Bali Pratipada) : Karnataka
- Ningol Chakkouba : Meitei community in Manipur
- 20th Divya Kala Mela : goal is to help Divyang craftsmen market and promote their products
- 8th Bhartiya Kala Mahotsav : President Droupadi Murmu has inaugurated in Secunderabad, Telangana. focuses on the North-Eastern states.
- Jivitputrika or Jitiya Vrat : Hindu festival celebrated by mothers in northern and eastern India, including Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand, and Nepal.
- Naga King Chilli festival : Seiyhama village in Nagaland celebrated 3rd edition belongs to the genus Capsicum





Ques : Who, a revered figure in Malayalam literature and cinema, passed away at the age of 91?

- (a) Kamala Surayya
- (b) O. V. Vijayan
- (c) Thakazhi Sivasankara Pillai
- (d) Vaikom Muhammad Basheer
- (e) M. T. Vasudevan Nair

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Madath Thekkepat Vasudevan Nair, also known as M T Vasudevan Nair, was 91 years old when he died.
- Madath Thekkepat Vasudevan Nair was born into a Nair family in Kudallur village, Palakkad district, Kerala, in 1934.
- MT's literary achievements earned him India's highest literary honour, the Jnanpith Award, in 1995, as well as numerous other accolades such as the Kendra Sahitya Akademi Award, Kerala Sahitya Akademi Award, Vayalar Award, Vallathol Award, Ezhuthachan Award, Mathrubhumi Literary Award, and O N V Literary Award.
- M T received India's third-highest civilian decoration, the Padma Bhushan, in 2005.

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Ques : International Cello Day is annually celebrated on which day ?

- (a) 26 December
- (b) 27 December
- (c) 28 December
- (d) 29 December
- (e) 30 December

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- International Cello Day is an annual event celebrated on December 29 in several countries throughout the world.
- The day commemorates the life and contributions of the great cellist Pablo Casals, who was born on this day.
- Casals is regarded as one of the finest cellists of all time, and he is credited with establishing the cello as a significant solo instrument in classical music.

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Important days :

- 4 December : International Day of Banks (Theme 2024: Empowering Sustainable Development through Finance)
- 4 December : International Cheetah Day
- 4 December : Indian Navy Day 2024 (Theme 2024 Strength and Capability through Innovation and Indigenization)
- 5 December : World Soil Day (Theme 2024: Soil is Life)
- 5 December : International Volunteer Day (Theme 2024: Volunteer Now for Our Future)
- 6 December : Mahaparinirvan Diwas
- 7 December : Armed Forces Flag Day
- 7 December : International Civil Aviation Day (Theme 2024: Safe Skies. Sustainable Future: Together for the Next 80 Years)
- 9 December : International Anti-Corruption Day (Theme 2024: Uniting with Youth Against Corruption to Shape Tomorrow's Integrity)
- 9 December : International Day of Commemoration and Dignity of the Victims of Genocide
- 10 December : World Human Rights Day (Theme 2024: Our Rights, Our Future)
- 11 December : International Mountain Day (Theme 2024 - Mountain solutions for a sustainable future: innovation, adaptation, and youth)
- 11 December : United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund (UNICEF) Day
- 12 December : International Day of Neutrality
- 12 December : International Universal Health Coverage (UHC) Day
- 13 December : National Horse Day
- 14 December : National Energy Conservation Day (Theme 2024: Powering Sustainability: Every Watt Counts)
- 16 December : Vijay Diwas 2024 (Commemorates India's decisive victory over Pakistan in the 1971 Indo-Pak War)
- 18 December : International Migrants Day (Theme 2024: Recognizing the contributions of migrants and protecting their rights)
- 18 December : Minorities Rights Day
- 18 December : World Arabic Language Day (Theme 2024: Arabic Language and AI: Driving Innovation While Preserving Cultural Heritage)





- 19 December : Goa Liberation Day
- 20 December : International Human Solidarity Day (Theme 2024: Promote friendship and collaboration)
- 21 December : World Meditation Day (Theme 2024: Inner Peace, Global Harmony)
- 21 December : World Basketball Day
- 22 December : National Mathematics Day 2024 (Theme 2024 Mathematics: The Bridge to Innovation and Progress)
- 23 December : Kisan Diwas, also known as National Farmer's Day (Theme 2024: Empowering 'Annadatas' for a Prosperous Nation)
- 24 December : National Consumer Rights Day
- 25 December : Good Governance Day
- 26 December : Boxing Day
- 26 December : Veer Bal Divas A Day of Valor And Righteousness
- 27 December : International Day of Epidemic Preparedness

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IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Punjab's Vijayveer Sidhu defeated fellow Olympian Gurpreet Singh of the Army Marksmanship Unit to win his first men's 25m rapid-fire pistol (RFP) title at the 67th National Shooting Championship Competitions (NSCC) for pistol events.

West Bengal(WB) Government and United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) signed an MOU To enhance the treatment of children affected by NonCommunicable Diseases (NCD), including juvenile diabetes.

Lakshya Sen from India secured third place at the King Cup International Badminton Open by defeating French player Alex Lanier in straight games.

Nvidia has recently announced the launch of its Jetson Orin Nano Super Generative AI supercomputer. With a price-tag of \$249, this new model is significantly more affordable compared to its predecessor, which was priced at \$499.

Uttar Pradesh and Manipur governments signed an MOU To implement the 'Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat' program in Lucknow, UP. Manipur is the third state to sign a MoU with Uttar Pradesh (UP) under the Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat programme after Arunachal Pradesh (AR) and Meghalaya.

'Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat' Program is Launched on 31st October 2015 under Nodal Ministry, Ministry of Education. It is Launched during 140th birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, India's first Deputy PM and Home Minister.

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Ques : Which country's regulatory authority has granted approval for Doha Insurance Group (DIG) to establish a reinsurance branch in India?

- (a) RBI
- (b) SEBI
- (c) World Bank
- (d) Qatar Central Bank
- (e) Dubai Financial Market

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region's top insurance and reinsurance provider, Doha Insurance Group (DIG), has revealed plans to build a reinsurance branch in India as part of its expansion.
- The Qatar Central Bank has given the insurer permission to open a branch in Gujarat International Financial Technology City (GIFT City). The "Gift City" international insurance office category will apply to the new branch's operations.
- Building on the achievements of its regional centers, which have greatly increased the group's revenues and fortified its insurance portfolio, this calculated move is a component of DIG's larger expansion strategy.

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Ques : Shriram Finance established in which year ?

- (a) 1979
- (b) 1956
- (c) 1998
- (d) 1999
- (e) 2002

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- To strengthen its green finance initiatives, the Shriram Group's flagship company, Shriram Finance Limited, established a special business unit called "Shriram Green Finance."
- Within the next three to four years, Shriram Green Finance's main objective is to reach an Asset Under Management (AUM) of Rs 5,000 crore.
- The company's initial focus will be on expanding its EV portfolio in areas such as Maharashtra, Kerala, the National Capital Region (NCR), and Karnataka.

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Ques : Which edition of Exercise Surya Kiran 2024 Held at Saljhandi, Nepal ?

- (a) 12th
- (b) 13th
- (c) 15th
- (d) 17th
- (e) 18th

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Indian and Nepalese Army contingents are taking part in the 18th round of Exercise Surya Kiran.
- A battalion from the 11th Gorkha Rifles is in charge of the 334-person Indian Army contingent.
- The Srijung Battalion will represent the Nepal Army contingent.
- Saljhandi, Nepal, will host the exercise from December 31, 2024, to January 13, 2025.

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Recent News Headlines Related to Defence Exercise :

- Exercise Sahayog–Hop Tac 2nd Edition Held at off the coast of Kochi, Kerala between India & Vietnam (Coast guard).
- Exercise Desert Knight 2025 Held at Arabian Sea between India, France, and the UAE (Air force). From India Sukhoi-30MKI, Jaguars, IL-78 mid-air refuellers, and AEW&C (Airborne Early Warning and Control) systems participate in Exercise.
- The Eastern Naval Command will host the bilateral naval exercise SLINEX 2024 (Sri Lanka-India Exercise) at Visakhapatnam from December 17 to 20, 24.
- India and Cambodia's first joint tabletop exercise, dubbed 'CINBAX,' began at the Foreign Training Node in Pune, Maharashtra
- On December 2, 2024, India and Malaysia began the bilateral Joint Military Exercise "Harimau Shakti" at the Bentong camp in Pahang district, Malaysia
- The Indian Coast Guard (ICG) held the 11th National Maritime Search and Rescue Exercise (SAREX-2024) off the Kochi coast.
- The 13th edition of Joint Military Exercise AGNI WARRIOR (XAW-2024), a bilateral exercise between the Indian Army and the Singapore Armed Forces, ended at Field Firing Ranges in Devlali (Maharashtra).
- The 11th edition of the Indian Coast Guard's National Maritime Search and Rescue Exercise and Workshop (SAREX-24) starts in Kochi, Kerala.
- The Indian Army successfully completed the Multilateral Annual Joint Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR) Exercise 'Sanyukt Vimochan 2024', which took place in Ahmedabad and Porbandar, Gujarat
- India Launches First Space Defense Exercise Antariksha Abhyas – 2024 To simulate and address threats to and from space-based assets, integrating space capabilities into military operations
- Exercise AUSTRALIND 3rd Edition Held at Foreign Training Node, Pune, Maharashtra between India & Australia (Army)
- The Indian Army, Indian Air Force, and Indian Navy will launch a command-level tri-service theatre exercise called 'Poorvi Prahar' along the India-China border.
- The fifth edition of the Vietnam-Indian Bilateral Army Exercise "VINBAX 2024" began in Ambala. The drill will take place from November 4 to 23 in Ambala and Chandimandir.





Ques : Youth Co:Lab Launched in india in which year ?

- (a) 2015
- (b) 2017
- (c) 2019
- (d) 2020
- (e) 2021

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The 7th edition of the 'Youth Co:Lab National Innovation Challenge for 2024-2025' has been launched by the Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), NITI Aayog, the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), and the Citi Foundation.
- The 2024-2025 iteration will be implemented in conjunction with the Bangalore (Karnataka)-based AssisTech Foundation (ATF).
- The competition encourages young founders (18-32 years) to produce significant ideas that address real-world difficulties, with a focus on disability inclusion.
- The initiative intends to help 30-35 early-stage entrepreneurs through a springboard program, offering seed money to the top performers to scale their impact.

About Youth Co:Lab :

- Launched in : 2017
- Launched by : UNDP and Citi Foundation, Youth Co:Lab
- Launched in India : 2019
- Launched by : UNDP and Citi Foundation, Youth Co:Lab with AIM, NITI Aayog
- Aim : To drive Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) through leadership, innovation, and entrepreneurship





About Atal Innovation Mission (AIM) :

- Launched in : 2016
- Launched by : NITI Aayog
- Objective : To promote innovation and entrepreneurship

About NITI Aayog :

- Established : 1 January 2015
- HQ : New Delhi
- Chairman : Narendra Modi
- CEO : B V R Subrahmanyam

Ques : What was the primary focus of the 45th edition of PRAGATI chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi ?

- (a) Reviewing international trade agreements
- (b) Discussing defense modernization
- (c) Reviewing key infrastructure and development projects
- (d) Addressing climate change policies
- (e) Announcing new education reforms

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi chaired the 45th edition of PRAGATI, an interactive platform aimed at ensuring Pro-Active Governance and Timely Implementation of various development and infrastructure projects across India.
- PRAGATI enables the review and resolution of bottlenecks in critical government initiatives to enhance public service delivery.





- During the meeting, PM Modi reviewed eight significant projects Costs More than Rs 1 lakh crore.
- Six metro projects of Urban Transport, One project of Road Connectivity and One project of Thermal Power.

About PRAGATI Platform :

- Launched on : March 25, 2015
- Developed By : PMO team with the National Informatics Center (NIC)
- Aim : Addresses public grievances and monitors key government projects

Ques : Which state defeated Chandigarh 34-31 to clinch their maiden Senior National Men's Handball Championship title ?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) Telangana

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Kerala won the Senior National Men's Handball Championship for the first time, defeating Chandigarh 34-31. The event final was held in Changanassery, Kerala.
- Kerala made it to the final for the first time, defeating Services in the semi-finals, and Chandigarh defeated Indian Railways to win their position.
- Kerala's Devendar was crowned Best Player of the Championship, while Rahul was awarded Best Goalkeeper.
- Sujith was recognized as the finest left-wing player.





- At the Mangaung Oval in Bloemfontein, South Africa, England's Nat Sciver-Brunt and Maia Bouchier broke records in women's cricket.
- The Indian men's team achieved fifth place in Men's World Team Squash Championships.
- Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami unveiled the logo, theme music, and mascot for the upcoming 38th National Games in Dehradun.

Ques : Which state government has decided to increase the maximum limit of Death-cum-Retirement Gratuity for state government employees by 25 percent ?

- (a) West Bengal
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Haryana
- (e) Maharashtra

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Haryana government has agreed to enhance the maximum amount of Death-cum-Retirement Gratuity for state government employees by 25%.
- This enhancement will take effect on January 1, 2025, increasing the gratuity from Rs 20 lakh to Rs 25 lakh.
- The Cabinet also approved a 25% increase in the maximum death-cum-retirement gratuity for state judicial officers.
- These decisions are intended to provide increased financial stability to state government employees and their families, as well as judicial authorities.

About Haryana :

- Capital – Chandigarh
- Chief Minister – Nayab Singh Saini
- Governor – Bandaru Dattatreya



Ques : Which cricket legend has been appointed as the brand ambassador for Kissht, India's leading digital lending platform?

- (a) Rohit Sharma
- (b) Virat Kohli
- (c) MS Dhoni
- (d) Ravindra Jadeja
- (e) Sachin Tendulkar

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Sachin Tendulkar, the iconic cricketer known as the "God of Cricket," has been appointed as the brand ambassador for Kissht, a leading digital lending platform operated by OnEMI Technology Solutions Private Limited.
- His association is expected to enhance Kissht's brand image and connect with a broader audience.

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Recent Headlines Related to Brand Ambassador :

- Salman Khan : Inaugural Kho Kho World Cup
- Indian Chess Prodigy D Gukesh : RBL Bank Limited
- Indian cricketer Rohit Sharma : ixigo's Trains app
- Mahendra Singh Dhoni : Eurogrip Tyres
- Mary Kom : Brand ambassador for the "Assam Rifles Half-Marathon (ARHM) 2024" in Shillong
- Rashmika Mandanna : DRA, a Chennai-based real estate developer
- Pankaj Tripathi : Festival ambassador for the Arunachal Rang Mahotsav 2024
- Abhishek Bachchan : Ramraj Cotton, a prominent traditional and ethnic wear brand
- Bollywood actor Jackie Shroff : All Living Things Environmental Film Festival (ALT EFF)
- Harbhajan Singh and Sania Mirza : Sports Ambassador by Dubai Sports Council
- Mahendra Singh Dhoni : Jharkhand Assembly Election
- Pankaj Tripathi : brand ambassador of Madhya Pradesh Tourism Department
- Sonu Sood : Brand Ambassador and Honorary Tourism Advisor for Thailand
- Rashmika Mandanna : Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre
- Manu Bhaker : Golden Bullet, a tools company
- Rahul Dravid : Shriram Finance Ltd
- Manu Bhaker : Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW)
- Sharath Kamal : first Indian ambassador for the International Table Tennis Federation (ITTF) Foundation
- Alia Bhatt : French cosmetics company L'Oreal Paris
- Salman Khan : GRM Basmati Rice
- Shikhar Dhawan : MotoGP
- Aditya Roy Kapur : Bisleri Limonata
- PV Sindhu : Greenday's 'Better Nutrition' brand



Ques : Consider the following statements About newly-formed interim Asian body for boxing :

- (a) The interim Asian body was established by the World Boxing organization.
- (b) Ajay Singh has been appointed as the Board Member.
- (c) Lovlina Borgohain is one of the members of the Athletes' Commission in this body.

Which of the following statement is/are true ?

- (a) Only a
- (b) Only b
- (c) Both a and b
- (d) Both a and c
- (e) All a, b and c

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- The Athletes' Commission now includes Tokyo Olympic medallist Lovlina Borgohain, while the newly formed interim Asian body, which was created by the breakaway organization World Boxing, will comprise six officials from the Boxing Federation of India (BFI), including president Ajay Singh.
- With the BFI holding seven important positions, including Singh's appointment as a board member, India will be pivotal in determining the direction of Asian boxing in the future.
- Borgohain will speak for sportsmen in Asian and international boxing. Treasurer Digvijay Singh and Secretary General Hemanta Kumar Kalita, two important BFI officials, will serve on the Finance and Audit Committee and the Olympic Commission, respectively.
- One of the three members of the Athletes' Commission, Borgohain, emphasized the value of the platform in promoting improved facilities, equitable chances, and support networks for athletes throughout Asia.



- Dr. Karanjeet Singh will join the Medical Commission, and BFI executives D P Bhatt and Narender Kumar Nirwan will serve on the Constitution and Sports & Competition Commissions, respectively.

Ques : Which Indian airport recently became the country's first Zero-Waste Airport?

- (a) Kempegowda International Airport, Bengaluru
- (b) Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, Mumbai
- (c) Indira Gandhi International Airport, Delhi
- (d) Devi Ahilyabai Holkar Airport, Indore
- (e) Rajiv Gandhi International Airport, Hyderabad

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Devi Ahilyabai Holkar Airport in Indore has been officially declared India's first Zero-Waste Airport.
- Inauguration of 3,000 square feet (sq.ft) material recovery facility at the airport by Union Minister Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu, Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA). This facility is based on the concept of 4R i.e. Reduce, Reuse, Recycle, and Restore.
- The airport achieved this milestone by implementing sustainable waste management practices, recycling, and minimizing waste generation, setting a benchmark for environmental responsibility in the aviation sector.





Recent News Headlines Related to First in India and World :

- Uttarakhand has recently inaugurated its first wine production unit in Kotdwar, which is part of the government's new excise policy aimed at promoting wine tourism
- The Punjab Chief Minister, Bhagwant Singh Mann, approved the Punjab State (Development and Promotion of Sports) Act, 2024, making it the first state in the country to do so.
- Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ) Mundra welcomed CMA CGM Fort Diamant, the first LNG-powered container vessel to berth at the port's Container Terminal-CT4.
- Uttar Pradesh is the first state to connect its procurement process with the Centre's Govt e-Marketplace (GeM), replacing its traditional tendering system
- Masali, a village in Gujarat's Banaskantha district, has become India's first 'solar village' near the border, a key milestone in the country's renewable energy efforts.
- Uttarakhand, often known as "Devbhoomi," will be the first Indian state to enact a specific Yoga Policy, aiming to make the state a global yoga destination.
- The first Ganges River Dolphin (Platanista Gangetica) has been tagged in Assam, marking a historic moment in animal conservation.
- NLC India Limited (NLCIL) and Uttar Pradesh Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Limited (UPRVUNL) partners to commence commercial operations of its 1st supercritical power plant '1980 Mega Watt (MW) Ghatampur Thermal Power Plant' (GTPP) in Uttar Pradesh.
- Dr. Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology, unveiled Kisan Kavach, India's first indigenous anti-pesticide bodysuit
- The New Delhi Indira Gandhi International (IGI) Airport has become the first airport in India to connect 150 destinations.





Ques : Which organization awarded with the 'Great Place to Work' certification for January 2025 to January 2026?

- (a) BHEL
- (b) SAIL
- (c) RINL
- (d) BPCL
- (e) HPCL

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Great Place to Work Institute in India has granted Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL) the esteemed "Great Place to Work" certification for January 2025–2026.
- After been certified for December 2023 to December 2024, this is SAIL's second straight certification.
- The company's creative HR initiatives, such as the Work Other than Workplace (WoW) program, flexible scheduling for city-based employees, self-paced learning via LinkedIn Learning Hub and E-Pathshala, high-end IT and digital training with NASSCOM, etc., are highlighted by this consecutive worldwide recognition.
- These programs are designed to increase output, get workers ready for new technology, and help them reach their maximum potential.
- Through a stringent review process, the Great Place to Work Institute is a global organization that honors employers who are delivering exceptional employee experiences. After the Institute performed a thorough survey based on direct input from SAIL employees, SAIL obtained the certification.





Ques : Which Indian Cricketer Accepts Prestigious Melbourne Cricket Club (MCC) Membership ?

- (a) Rohit Sharma
- (b) Virat Kohli
- (c) MS Dhoni
- (d) Ravindra Jadeja
- (e) Sachin Tendulkar

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- The Melbourne Cricket Club (MCC), which manages the renowned Melbourne Cricket Ground (MCG), has announced that legendary Indian batsman Sachin Tendulkar has accepted an Honorary Cricket Membership.
- This award honors Tendulkar's outstanding achievements to cricket during his 24-year international career.
- The Melbourne Cricket Club was founded on November 15, 1983, by Fred Powlett, Robert Russell, George B. Smyth, and brothers Alfred and Charles Mundy.
- Tendulkar holds the record for the most runs at MCG, with 449 from five Tests at an average of 44.90 and a strike rate of 58.69, including a hundred and three fifties.
- In 2012, Tendulkar received the Order of Australia, one of the country's highest honors.

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Ques : Who has become the youngest female to scale the highest peaks on all seven continents?

- (a) Malavath Purna
- (b) Kaamya Karthikeyan
- (c) Arunima Sinha
- (d) Bachendri Pal
- (e) Tashi Malik

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The remarkable accomplishment of becoming the youngest female to climb the highest peaks on all seven continents was accomplished by Kaamya Karthikeyan, a Class 12 student at Navy Children's School in Mumbai.
- Together with her father, Commander S. Karthikeyan, Kaamya climbed Mount Vinson in Antarctica to complete the Seven Summits Challenge at the age of 17.
- She climbed Mt. Kilimanjaro in Africa, Mt. Elbrus in Europe, Mt. Kosciuszko in Australia, Mt. Aconcagua in South America, Mt. Denali in North America, Mt. Everest in Asia, and Mt. Vinson in Antarctica.
- Kaamya's love of adventure was demonstrated when she ascended Mount Everest at the age of 16.

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IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Tiger Shroff Appointed as Brand ambassador for the inaugural Kho Kho World Cup

The US released a revised edition of Form I-129, the petition for a nonimmigrant worker, in alignment with the newly announced H-1B and H-2 modernisation final rules

Google has introduced 2 experimental upgrades to its Gemini Artificial Intelligence (AI) suite “Gemini-Exp-1206 and Gemini 2.0 Flash”.

India recorded its highest ever coal production of 997.826 million tonnes (MT) in the financial year 2023-24 which represents an 11.71 per cent increase in comparison to the corresponding figure of 893.191 MT in the year 2022-23.

Elephant and Tourism Festival 18th Edition Held at Baghmara Intermediate Community Forest near the renowned Chitwan National Park, Sauraha, Chitwan, Nepal.

Uttar Pradesh and Japan’s Yamanashi Prefecture signs MOU to improve economic and cultural cooperation between UP and Yamanashi, representing a growing partnership between the two nations.

The 39th President of the United States, Jimmy Carter, died in his hometown of Plains, Georgia, at the age of 100. Carter won the Nobel Peace Prize in 2002 and later received recognition for his international peace initiatives, despite serving only one time as president.





Ques : Rajat Verma has been appointed as the new CEO of which Bank?

- (a) DBS Bank India
- (b) Axis Bank
- (c) Yes Bank
- (d) HDFC Bank
- (e) ICICI Bank

Answer : option A

Explanation :

- DBS Group of Singapore has chosen Rajat Verma as CEO of DBS Bank India, succeeding Surojit Shome.
- Verma had been nominated and was awaiting clearance from the Reserve Bank of India, which is required for all bank CEO appointments.
- Verma, the current head of DBS Bank India's institutional banking group, was appointed effective March 1, following RBI approval.
- In his new post, he will be a member of DBS' group management committee, Southeast Asia's largest bank.

About Development Bank of Singapore (DBS) Bank :

- Founded – 1968
- Headquarters – Singapore
- Chairman – Peter Seah
- CEO – Piyush Gupta
- DBS Bank India' CEO- Rajat Verma (replace Surojit Shome)
- CEO – Tan Su Shan (effect from March 2025)

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Recent Appointment in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- Amitava Chatterjee : Managing director (MD) and CEO J&K Bank
- Alok Aggarwal : Managing Director and CEO of Brookfield India Real Estate Trust
- R Subramaniakumar : MD & CEO of RBL Bank
- Ram Mohan Rao Amara : Managing Director of State Bank of India (SBI)
- George Heber Joseph : Chief investment officer (CIO) of the newly- incorporated joint venture firm Jio BlackRock Asset Management Company (AMC)
- Manish Jain : Executive Director of YES Bank
- R Ramaseshan : Part-time Chairman' (independent director) of Jana Small Finance Bank (JSFB) Limited (Replaced Subhash Khuntia)
- Bhavesh Jain : Managing Director and CEO of TransUnion CIBIL
- Sanjay Malhotra : 26th Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for three years
- Vaibhav Chaturvedi : ex-officio member of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI)
- Vijay Chandok : MD & CEO of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) (Replaced Padmaja Chunduru)
- Masato Kanda : 11th president of the Asian Development Bank (ADB)
- Nand Kishore : Managing Director and CEO of SBI Funds Management
- Binod Kumar : Managing Director of Chennai-based Indian Bank
- Rahul Bhawe : Managing Director (MD) and CEO of Industrial Finance Corporation of India (IFCI Ltd)
- Rishi Chhabra : country manager for India at Visa

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Ques : What is the new deadline for implementing the transaction volume cap on UPI apps as per NPCI?

- (a) December 31, 2024
- (b) December 31, 2025
- (c) December 31, 2026
- (d) December 31, 2027
- (e) December 31, 2028

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has extended the deadline for implementing transaction volume cap on Unified Payments Interface (UPI) apps by two years till December 31, 2026. This is the second time that the NPCI has extended this deadline.
- The industry giants PhonePe and Google Pay, who handle the majority of UPI transactions in the nation, are anticipated to receive much-needed relief from the most recent development. According to NPCI data, the two handled roughly 47.8% and 37.02 % of UPI transaction volumes in November, respectively.
- The deadline for current third-party application providers (TPAPs) to comply was extended by an additional two years by the apex payments authority after "considering various factors."
- Up 32.2% from 117.58 billion transactions in calendar year 2023 (CY23), UPI recorded 155.44 billion transactions as of November this year. The December 2024 numbers have not yet been released.
- In November 2020, the NPCI first suggested a 30% cap on the number of transactions that UPI apps may handle. The current players were given two years to comply with the volume cap.





Ques : The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has approved the reappointment of Anup Kumar Sinha as the Non-Executive Chairman of which Bank ?

- (a) ICICI Bank
- (b) Axis Bank
- (c) IndusInd Bank
- (d) HDFC Bank
- (e) Bandhan Bank

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Anup Kumar Sinha's reappointment as Bandhan Bank's non-executive chairman has been authorized by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).
- The former head of Heritage Business School (or "HBS") was Dr. Anup Kumar Sinha. He has also been a member of the NABARD Board.
- Dr. Sinha has taught at the Indian Institute of Management Calcutta (often known as "IIMC") and Presidency College. He spent twenty-five years as an economics professor at IIMC.
- He was IIMC's Dean from 2003 to 2006 in addition to serving three terms on the Board of Governors.

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Ques : Reserve Bank of India (RBI) will Closed which type of Bank Accounts to Be Starting January 1, 2025 ?

- (a) Dormant Accounts
- (b) Inactive Accounts
- (c) Zero Balance Accounts
- (d) Both a and b
- (e) All a, b and c

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

• The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) plans to increase the effectiveness, security, and transparency of the financial system by rendering three different kinds of bank accounts inactive by January 1, 2025.

Types of Accounts Becoming Non-Operative :

- Dormant Accounts : Accounts that have not had any transactions for two years
- Inactive Accounts : Accounts with no activity for a fixed period, often one year
- Zero Balance Accounts : Accounts with no money deposited for a long time and a zero balance

EXAM
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Ques : What is the projected GDP growth rate for India in FY25, according to the RBI report?

- (a) 6.4%
- (b) 6.6%
- (c) 7.2%
- (d) 7.4%
- (e) 7.8%

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- According to the RBI, the Indian economy is showing resilience and stability, and the GDP is expected to grow by 6.6% in 2024–2025 thanks to a rebound in rural consumption, an increase in government spending and investment, and robust services exports.
- The Reserve Bank has published the Financial Stability Report (FSR) for December 2024, which includes the Sub-Committee of the Financial Stability and Development Council's (FSDC) collective assessment of the threats to financial stability and the resilience of the Indian financial system.
- Sufficient capital and liquidity buffers, excellent profitability, and a decline in non-performing assets have all contributed to the stability of scheduled commercial banks (SCBs). The gross non-performing asset (GNPA) ratio has dropped to a multi-year low, while return on equity (RoE) and return on assets (RoA) are at decadal highs.

Genius





Ques : Who was awarded Bahrain's 'Medal of Efficiency' (First Class) by King Hamad bin Isa Al Khalifa?

- (a) Yusuf Ali M.A
- (b) Dr. Ravi Pillai
- (c) Mukesh Ambani
- (d) Sunil Bharti Mittal
- (e) Azim Premji

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Dr. Ravi Pillai, a prominent Indian businessman and the founder and chairman of the Dubai-based RP Group of Companies, was awarded Bahrain's prestigious 'Medal of Efficiency' (First Class) by King Hamad bin Isa Al Khalifa.
- This honor recognizes his contributions to Bahrain's economic development and his philanthropic initiatives.
- He was the 1st foreign national to receive this distinguished honor
- In 2010, he was awarded 'Padma Shri' (India 4th highest civilian honour) for his distinguished service
- In 2015, Arabian Business ranked him as the 4th most powerful Indian in the Middle East

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Recent News Headlines Related to Awards & Winners :

- "Great Place to Work" certification for January 2025–2026 : Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL)
- SKOCH Award : Maharashtra government's initiative 'Shasan Aplya Dari' ('Government at Your Doorstep')
- 34th Vyas Samman for 2024 : Hindi writer Suryabala for Her novel "Kaun Des Ko Vasi: Venu Ki Diary" which was published in 2018
- Prestigious "Gold Award" in the State Energy Conservation Award 2024 : RINL, the corporate entity of the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant
- Royal honors 'knighthood' and 'damehood' by King Charles III : Oscar award winning filmmaker Christopher Nolan and his wife, Emma Thomas
- Pandit Swapan Chaudhuri : Rashtriya Tansen Samman 2023
- Sanand Nyas Sanstha from Indore : Raja Mansingh Tomar Samman 2023
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi : Kuwait's highest civilian honour, the Order of Mubarak Al Kabeer
- Mrs. India USA 2024 : Caitlin Sandra Neil, a 19-year-old Indian-American teenager born in Chennai, India
- Miss Teen India USA 2024 : Sanskriti Sharma from Illinois
- 14th PSE Excellence Awards in 3 Category : "Corporate Governance" and "Corporate Social Responsibility & Sustainability" and "Operational Performance Excellence" : Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA)
- Public Relations Society of India (PRSI) National Awards 2024 (in 8 category) : Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL)
- US Navy's prestigious Distinguished Public Service Award : Tom Cruise
- External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar : Sri Chandrasekarendra Saraswathi National Eminence Award for Public Leadership by the South Indian Education Society (SIES)
- Biocon Group Chairperson Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw : Jamsetji Tata Award by the Indian Society for Quality (ISQ)
- Best FIFA Men's Player : Vinícius Junior of Spain and Real Madrid football club of Spain





Ques : Who has been appointed as the new Director General of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)?

- (a) Kuldiep Singh
- (b) Subodh Jaiswal
- (c) Praveen Sood
- (d) Vitul Kumar
- (e) Sanjay Arora

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Vitul Kumar, a senior IPS official, has been named as Director General of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF). He replaced Anish Dayal Singh.
- Kumar, a 1993 batch IPS officer from the Uttar Pradesh cadre, is currently the CRPF's Special Director General.
- Kumar's service has been acknowledged with numerous awards, including the President's Police Medal (PPM) on January 26, 2021 and the Police Medal (PM) on August 15, 2009.
- He also earned the Director General's Commendation Disc in Silver on January 26, 2016 and Gold on January 26, 2018.

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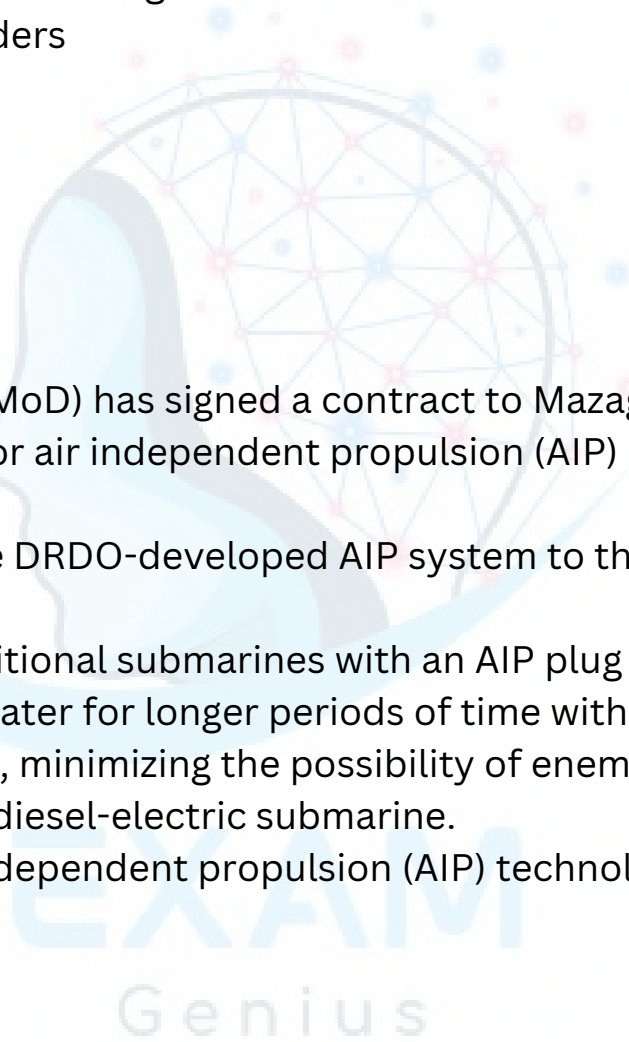
Ques : The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has signed a contract with which company for DRDO-made Air Independent Propulsion (AIP) system worth nearly Rs 1,990 crore?

- (a) Cochin Shipyard Limited
- (b) Hindustan Shipyard
- (c) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (d) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders
- (e) None of these

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has signed a contract to Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL) in Mumbai for air independent propulsion (AIP) plugs valued roughly Rs 1,990 crore.
- The plugs will connect the DRDO-developed AIP system to the Kalvari-class submarines.
- An AIP is attached to traditional submarines with an AIP plug to allow the submarines to stay underwater for longer periods of time without having to come up to the ocean surface for air, minimizing the possibility of enemy discovery. AIP works as a 'force multiplier' for a diesel-electric submarine.
- DRDO is developing air independent propulsion (AIP) technology on its own.





Recent News Headlines related to Defence

- India marked a significant milestone in its self-reliance by delivering two warships to the Indian Navy: the destroyer Surat and the frigate Nilgiri.
- China successfully launched four Earth-observation radar satellites called 'PIESAT-2' using a Long March-2D rocket from the Taiyuan Satellite Launch Center in Shanxi Province.
- Space entrepreneurs in Japan and India had agreed to collaborate on a study of utilizing laser-equipped spacecraft to remove garbage from orbit, as an experimental answer to the increasingly pressing problem of orbital congestion.
- China's space program reached a milestone when two of its astronauts performed a nine-hour spacewalk. Shenzhou-19 crew members Cai Xuzhe and Song Lingdong completed a nine-hour extravehicular exercise (EVA), breaking a 22-year-old US record
- Defence PSU BEML Limited has secured Rs.136 crore contract to supply indigenously designed High Mobility Vehicles (HMs) 8x8.
- Starting in 2025, India's Aditya L1 and the European Space Agency's (ESA) Proba-3 missions will collaborate to further solar research.
- INS Tushil, a Russian-built guided missile frigate, was commissioned into the Indian Navy in Kaliningrad, Russia, in front of Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Chief of Naval Staff Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi, and other senior officials.
- Adani Defence has delivered the second Drishti-10 Starliner surveillance drone to the Indian Navy, improving the country's marine capability.
- The Ministry of Defence has inked a contract with M/s Cochin Shipyard Limited for the Short Refit and Dry Docking (SRDD) of INS Vikramaditya at a total cost of Rs. 1207.5 crore
- India and the United Kingdom have signed a Statement of Intent (Sol) to cooperate on the design and development of Electric Propulsion Systems for the Indian Navy.
- MOI-TD (My Orbital Infrastructure – Technology Demonstrator), India's first AI laboratory in space Made by Hyderabad-based space tech company TakeMe2Space (TM2Space). Launch Vehicle is ISRO'S PSLV C60 rocket.





Ques : What is the key achievement of the India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (Ind-Aus ECTA) after completing two years?

- (a) Establishing a defense partnership
- (b) Advancing trade ties and creating opportunities for MSMEs and employment
- (c) Enhancing technological cooperation
- (d) Promoting cultural exchanges
- (e) Launching a joint space exploration program

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The India-Australia Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (Ind-Aus ECTA) has completed two years of outstanding performance, promoting reciprocal growth and demonstrating the complementarity of both economies.
- The India-Australia ECTA has greatly advanced trade connections, opening up new prospects for MSMEs, businesses, and jobs in both countries while strengthening the foundation of their economic collaboration.
- Entering its third year, the Government of India is committed to maintaining this momentum through enhanced collaboration and new initiatives to drive mutual prosperity and achieve the Hon'ble Prime Minister's goal of India becoming a developed country by 2047.
- Since its signing, bilateral merchandise trade has more than doubled, increasing from USD 12.2 billion in 2020-21 to USD 26 billion in 2022-23. Total trade, however, moderated in 2023-24 to USD 24 billion, with India's exports to Australia increasing by 14%. The current fiscal year continues to show good momentum.





Ques : Karnataka Gov declared which day as Computer Operators' Day ?

- (a) 26 December
- (b) 27 December
- (c) 28 December
- (d) 29 December
- (e) 30 December

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Karnataka government established Computer Operators' Day on December 26 to commemorate the birth anniversary of Charles Babbage, an English mathematician and inventor of the digital computer.
- The Rural Development & Panchayat Raj Department (RDPR) of Karnataka observed this.
- The first-ever Computer Operators' Day was held on December 26, 2024.

About Karnataka :

- Capital : Bangalore
- Cm : Siddaramaiah
- Governor : Thawar Chand Gehlot

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Ques : Who has been appointed as the new Secretary General of the Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM)?

- (a) Dilip Chenoy
- (b) Uday Shankar
- (c) Manish Singhal
- (d) Chandrajit Banerjee
- (e) Praveen Mittal

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Manish Singhal has taken over as Secretary General of the Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM), the country's premier business chamber.
- Singhal follows Deepak Sood, who left after a five-year tenure to pursue other interests.
- Singhal, an industry expert with more than 35 years of experience in Chamber and Corporate India, previously served as Deputy Secretary General of The Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI).
- He has also worked for several Indian multinational corporations, including Tata Motors, Eicher (Volvo), Tata Auto Comp Systems, Moser Baer India, and BEML, to name a few.

About Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM) :

- ASSOCHAM is a non-governmental trade association and advocacy group. This organization represents the interests of trade and commerce in India.
- Established -1920
- Headquarters – New Delhi
- Secretary General – Manish Singhal (replace Deepak Sood)
- ASSOCHAM has more than 200 chambers and trade organizations across India. It has more than 450,000 members.





Ques : Which country is set to construct its largest nuclear plant for electricity generation after receiving approval from its atomic energy regulatory agency?

- (a) China
- (b) Pakistan
- (c) Bangladesh
- (d) Malaysia
- (e) None of these

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Pakistan's atomic energy regulatory agency has approved the construction of the country's largest nuclear reactor for electricity generating.
- The Pakistan Nuclear Regulatory Authority (PNRA) approved the construction of Chashma Nuclear Power Plant Unit 5 (C-5), the world's largest nuclear power plant with a capacity of 1200 MWe.
- C-5 is a Chinese Hualong-designed advanced third-generation pressurised water reactor with active and passive safety features such as double-shell containment and a reactor-filtered ventilation system. It has a lifespan of sixty years.
- This is Pakistan's third nuclear power facility using this architecture. Two other plants, Karachi Nuclear Power Plants units 2 and 3, are already operational and supplying power to the national grid.
- The National Economic Council's executive committee has already approved the C-5, which would cost USD 3.7 billion to build.
- Pakistan's installed nuclear energy capacity is around 3,530 MW, accounting for around 27% of total electricity generation in the national system.





Ques : Who has taken charge as the chief of the Indian Air Force's Western Air Command?

- (a) Air Marshal Raghunath Nambiar
- (b) Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra
- (c) Air Marshal Sandeep Singh
- (d) Air Marshal Balabhadra Radha Krishna
- (e) Air Marshal Vivek Ram Chaudhari

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra takes over as chief of the Indian Air Force's Western Air Command, which is responsible for airspace security in the sensitive Ladakh sector and other portions of north India.
- Air Marshal Mishra, a fighter combat leader and experimental test pilot, has over 3000 hours of flying experience, according to the IAF.
- He follows Air Marshal Pankaj Mohan Sinha, who retired after more than 39 years of meritorious service.
- Air Marshal Mishra was commissioned into the Indian Air Force (IAF) as a fighter pilot on December 6, 1986.

Ques : Global Family Day is observed annually on which day ?

- (a) 28 December
- (b) 29 December
- (c) 31 December
- (d) 1 January
- (e) 2 January

Answer : Option D



Explanation :

- Every year on January 1, Global Family Day is marked to promote peace, solidarity, and a sense of common humanity around the world.
- Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation
- The day evolved from the United Nations Millennium Celebration in 2000, highlighting the importance of global solidarity and building a sense of family among people all around the world.

Important days :

- 5 December : World Soil Day (Theme 2024: Soil is Life)
- 5 December : International Volunteer Day (Theme 2024: Volunteer Now for Our Future)
- 6 December : Mahaparinirvan Diwas
- 7 December : Armed Forces Flag Day
- 7 December : International Civil Aviation Day (Theme 2024: Safe Skies. Sustainable Future: Together for the Next 80 Years)
- 9 December : International Anti-Corruption Day (Theme 2024: Uniting with Youth Against Corruption to Shape Tomorrow's Integrity)
- 9 December : International Day of Commemoration and Dignity of the Victims of Genocide
- 10 December : World Human Rights Day (Theme 2024: Our Rights, Our Future)
- 11 December : International Mountain Day (Theme 2024 - Mountain solutions for a sustainable future: innovation, adaptation, and youth)
- 11 December : United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund (UNICEF) Day
- 12 December : International Day of Neutrality
- 12 December : International Universal Health Coverage (UHC) Day
- 13 December : National Horse Day
- 14 December : National Energy Conservation Day (Theme 2024: Powering Sustainability: Every Watt Counts)
- 16 December : Vijay Diwas 2024 (Commemorates India's decisive victory over Pakistan in the 1971 Indo-Pak War)
- 18 December : International Migrants Day (Theme 2024: Recognizing the contributions of migrants and protecting their rights)





- 18 December : Minorities Rights Day
- 18 December : World Arabic Language Day (Theme 2024: Arabic Language and AI: Driving Innovation While Preserving Cultural Heritage)
- 19 December : Goa Liberation Day
- 20 December : International Human Solidarity Day (Theme 2024: Promote friendship and collaboration)
- 21 December : World Meditation Day (Theme 2024: Inner Peace, Global Harmony)
- 21 December : World Basketball Day
- 22 December : National Mathematics Day 2024 (Theme 2024 Mathematics: The Bridge to Innovation and Progress)
- 23 December : Kisan Diwas, also known as National Farmer's Day (Theme 2024: Empowering 'Annadatas' for a Prosperous Nation)
- 24 December : National Consumer Rights Day
- 25 December : Good Governance Day
- 26 December : Boxing Day
- 26 December : Veer Bal Divas A Day of Valor And Righteousness
- 27 December : International Day of Epidemic Preparedness
- 29 December : International Cello Day

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IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

The 20th anniversary of the 2004 tsunami was observed across the coastal districts of Nagapattinam, Mayiladuthurai, and Karaikal in Tamil Nadu

The UAE's General Civil Aviation Authority (GCAA) introduced the first digital platform in the region for implementing CORSIA, a framework designed to reduce international aviation emissions through carbon offset mechanisms

Mizoram government entered into a Memorandum of Agreement (MoA) with its partner banks – State Bank of India (SBI), Mizoram Rural Bank (MRB), and Mizoram Cooperative Apex Bank Limited (MCAB) for the disbursement of loans under the Bana Kaih(handholding) Scheme

Hemanth Muddappa, known as the "Drag King," achieved a remarkable triple crown victory in the final round of the MMSC FMSCI Indian National Motorcycle Drag Racing Championship held at the Madras International Circuit (MIC)

Puducherry led the nation with 53.03% women electors in the 2024 Lok Sabha Elections, making it the state/UT with the highest percentage of women electors.

China introduced the CR450, the world's fastest high-speed train, capable of reaching speeds of 450 kmph.

India's defence exports have surged to a record Rs 21,000 crore, a significant increase from Rs 2,000 crore a decade ago.





Ques : What is the name of the initiative launched by YES Bank and FICCI FLO to promote women entrepreneurs?

- (a) YES Women's Empowerment
- (b) YES Power to Women
- (c) YES PowherUp
- (d) Women Entrepreneurship Drive
- (e) EmpowerHer

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- YES Bank Limited & Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry(FICCI) Ladies Organisation (FLO) Launched 'YES PowherUp'
- Its aim is to empower women entrepreneur in promoting their businesses.
- It will offer comprehensive funding solutions like: waiving of 50% processing fee for members of FICCI FLO.
- Beneficiaries will be able to trade maximum Rs 1.5 crore at zero brokerage for 60 days with YES securities

About YES Bank :

- Established : 2004
- HQ : Mumbai, Maharashtra
- MD & CEO : Prashant Kumar
- Chairman : Rama Subramaniam Gandhi
- Tagline : Experience our Expertise

About FICCI Ladies Organisation :

- Established : 1983
- HQ : New Delhi
- President : Joyshree Das Verma





Recent Facilities Launched in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has established the ICICI Prudential Rural Opportunities Fund, an open-ended equity strategy focused on rural and adjacent themes. It starts on January 9, 2025 and ends on January 25, 2025.
- ICICI Prudential Life Insurance has introduced a first-of-its-kind health insurance that covers women's critical illnesses and procedures.
- Shriram Finance Limited, a financial services company, has developed a new vertical to manage all of its green finance commitments.
- Poonawalla Fincorp, a non-banking finance company under Cyrus Poonawalla Group, has implemented AI in HR operations to reduce risks and increase hiring accuracy.
- LazyPay, a leading digital financial services provider by PayU, has launched 'LazyPay EMI' in partnership with its partner lender, PayU Finance. Consumers can finance purchases between Rs. 5,000 to Rs. 1 lakh with flexible repayment options ranging from 3 to 12 months
- BOBCARD LIMITED has launched the TIARA Credit Card, a premium credit card specifically developed for women.
- Golden Jubilee (GJF) Scholarship Scheme 2024 Launched by Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)
- IDFC FIRST Bank Limited has created a holographic digital avatar of brand ambassador Amitabh Bachchan using AI technology.
- The Federal Bank sponsored an initiative named "Kaliyum Karyavum" to teach life skills to schoolchildren using traditional art forms.
- Paytm launched Unified Payment Interface(UPI) Lite Auto Top-Up which was designed to streamline small, frequent transactions for users, making everyday payments quick and hassle free.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the 'Bima Sakhi Yojana' in Panipat to increase financial literacy and insurance awareness among women. This initiative by the LIC aims to empower women aged 18 to 70 who have completed Class X.
- Esteem Savings Account Launched by Federal Bank Limited for Senior Citizens
- BharatPe, a fintech business, has created a fraud protection package called 'Shield' to provide coverage against digital fraud, including fraudulent Unified Payments Interface (UPI) transactions.





Ques : What is the GST collection in December ?

- (a) Rs.1.57 lakh crore
- (b) Rs.1.67 lakh crore
- (c) Rs.1.77 lakh crore
- (d) Rs.1.87 lakh crore
- (e) Rs.1.97 lakh crore

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- In December 2024, India's GST collection growth decreased to 7.3% YoY, resulting in gross income of Rs.1.77 lakh crore, compared to Rs.1.65 lakh crore in December 2023.
- GST income have continuously exceeded Rs.1.7 lakh crore for ten consecutive months, with the December quarter averaging Rs.1.82 lakh crore, representing an 8.3% increase year on year.

Collection of GST in December 2024 :

- Gross GST Revenue : Rs 1,76,857 lakh Crore
- Central GST : Rs 32,836 crore
- State GST : Rs 40,499 crore
- Integrated GST : Rs 47,783 crore (including Rs 18,310 crore collected on imports)
- Cess : Rs 11,471 crore (including Rs 1,258 crore collected on imports)

GST Collection of Previous Months :

- November 2024 : 1,82,269 Crore
- October 2024 : 1,87,346 Crore
- September 2024 : 1.73 lakh crore
- August 2024 : 1.75 lakh crore
- June 2024 : 1.74 lakh crore





Ques : Consider the following statement About proposed lookup facility for NEFT and RTGS :

- (a) Member banks are required to implement the facility by January 1, 2025.
- (b) The facility will allow users to verify the beneficiary's name before initiating a transaction.
- (c) NPCI will develop the facility and onboard all banks.

Which of the following statement is/are True ?

- (a) Only a
- (b) Only b
- (c) Both a and b
- (d) Both a and c
- (e) Both b and c

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- To combat fraud, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) proposed adding a lookup tool for beneficiary accounts to the Real-Time Gross Settlement (RTGS) and National Electronic Funds Transfer (NEFT) systems.
- Users will be able to read and verify the beneficiary's name before making a transaction, similar to the existing capability on India's real-time payment systems, Unified Payments Interface (UPI) and Immediate Payments Service (IMPS).
- Currently, remitters cannot see the beneficiary's name before making a NEFT or RTGS transfer. The RBI has directed that member banks in these systems implement the capability by April 1, 2025. Customers will be able to use this functionality for free.
- The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has been tasked with establishing the capability and ensuring that all banks enable the function.





- Based on the account number and IFSC given by the remitter, the feature will retrieve the beneficiary's account name from the bank's core banking solution.
- Remitters will be able to use the facility via internet and mobile banking, as well as at bank branches for in-person transactions. Beneficiary banks will have to display the account name to the remitter.
- As part of the procedure, both the remitting and recipient banks must maintain data relating to the lookup queries and responses. However, the NPCI, which is in charge of building the service, will not be able to maintain any data relating to the lookup queries.

Recent News Headlines Related to RBI

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has set up a committee to create a Framework for Responsible and Ethical Enabling of Artificial Intelligence (FREE-AI) in the Financial Sector.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) allows holders of full-KYC prepaid payment instruments (PPIs) including digital wallets, gift cards, and metro rail cards to make and receive UPI payments using third-party apps like Google Pay and PhonePe.
- In October 2024, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) sold \$9.2 billion, its highest monthly sale in almost two years (since September 2022, when \$10.3 billion was sold).
- Banks have asked the RBI to extend the deadline for compliance with new lending standards that prohibit overlapping activity between banks and their group businesses.
- RBI lifted business restrictions on two entities of the Edelweiss Group, ECL Finance Limited and Edelweiss Asset Reconstruction Company Limited (Edelweiss ARC).
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) cancelled Zavron Finance Private Limited's Certificate of Registration (CoR) under Section 45-IA (6) of the RBI Act, 1934.
- In-Solutions Global (ISG) has received full authorisation from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) as a payment aggregator under the Payment and Settlement Systems framework
- RBI has announced Introduction of the Secured Overnight Rupee Rate (SORR) , a benchmark based on the secured money markets
- The RBI increased the interest rate limit for NRI FCNR (B) deposits for a limited period.





- The Reserve Bank of India's Innovation Hub (RBIH), Bengaluru has launched MuleHunter.AI is a cutting-edge program that detects and flags mule bank accounts implicated in criminal financial activity, including money laundering.
- The RBI has increased the collateral-free lending limit for agricultural producers from Rs.1.66 lakh to Rs.2 lakh per borrower, providing significant relief to small and marginal farmers.
- The Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority (WDRA) is lobbying the RBI for preferential treatment of Electronic Negotiable Warehouse Receipts (eNWRs).

Ques : Who released the “Report on Trend and Progress of Banking in India 2023-24,” ?

- (a) RBI
- (b) SEBI
- (c) NABARD
- (d) SBI
- (e) IMF

Answer : Option A
Explanation :

- The RBI's "Report on Trend and Progress of Banking in India 2023-24" provides a detailed study of the banking sector's performance for fiscal year 2023-24.
- In 2023-24, banks' profitability increased for the sixth year in a row, with a return on assets (RoA) of 1.4% and a return on equity (RoE) of 14.6%.
- Asset Quality of Banks : The gross non-performing assets (NPAs) ratio of Indian banks has fallen to a 12-year low of 2.5% as of September 2024, the lowest since 2012.
- Projections for NPAs : The gross bad loan ratio could rise to 3% by March 2026 under a baseline scenario. In high-risk scenarios, it could reach up to 5.3%.
- Profitability Growth : SCBs have demonstrated consistent profitability, with a RoA of 1.4% and RoE of 14.6% in 2023-24
- Strong Capital Adequacy : The Capital-to-Risk-Weighted Assets Ratio (CRAR) of Indian banks stood at 16.8% as of September 2024, significantly higher than the regulatory minimum of 9%.



- Credit Growth and Economic Outlook : The Indian banking sector has witnessed a significant 19% increase in credit growth during 2023-24, reflecting positive economic growth and robust demand for loans
- GNPA ratio of NBFCs : Dropped to 3.4 percent at end-September 2024
- Consolidated balance sheet of the scheduled commercial banks, excluding RRBs : Increased by 15.5 percent during 2023-24, as compared with 12.2 percent during 2022-23
- Net profit : Increased by 32.8 percent to Rs 3,49,603 crore during the last fiscal

Ques : What is the unique feature of the Undergraduate Minor Programme in Quantum Technologies announced recently in India?

- (a) It is the first UG program fully funded by private institutions
- (b) It is India's first UG Minor Programme in Quantum Technologies
- (c) It focuses exclusively on theoretical physics
- (d) It is mandatory for all engineering students
- (e) It offers dual degrees in Quantum Computing and Artificial Intelligence

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE) and the National Quantum Mission (NQM) have jointly launched India's first Undergraduate (UG) Minor Programme in Quantum Technologies, which will begin in the upcoming academic session.
- This effort for engineering students in their third or fourth semester intends to develop a qualified workforce in quantum computing and related sectors, in line with India's National Quantum Mission goals.
- Students can select 18 credits from over 30 courses, allowing flexibility and customisation based on institutional resources.





Ques : Who has recently been appointed as the CEO of the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI)?

- (a) Sanjay Malhotra
- (b) Bhuvnesh Kumar
- (c) Amit Agrawal
- (d) Arvind Kumar
- (e) Rajesh Verma

Answer : option B

Explanation :

- Bhuvnesh Kumar, an IAS official, became the CEO of India's Unique Identification Authority (UIDAI).
- Mr. Kumar, a 1995 batch Uttar Pradesh cadre officer, is now employed as an additional secretary at the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MEITY), where he will remain following this assignment.
- Mr. Kumar succeeds Amit Agrawal, a 1993 batch IAS official from the Chhattisgarh cadre who was also MEITY's additional secretary before his June 2023 appointment.
- In a bureaucratic restructuring, Mr Agrawal was appointed Secretary of the Department of Pharmaceuticals within the Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers.

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Recent Appointment in different departments :

- Manish Singhal : Secretary General of the Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM)
- Sachin Tendulkar : Melbourne Cricket Club (MCC) Membership
- Sandip Kumar Mishra : Director of the National Testing Agency (NTA)
- K N Renuka Pujar : first transgender guest lecturer at a Karnataka institution
- Dr. Sandip Shah : Chairperson of the National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL)
- Abhijit Majumder : Chief financial officer (CFO) of Oil India
- Arunish Chawla : Revenue Secretary
- Suman Berry : Chairman of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM)
- Unsoo Kim : Managing Director (MD) of Hyundai Motor India for 3 years
- Pradeep Chugh : Company secretary of Hyundai Motor India
- Sriram Krishnan : Senior White House Policy Advisor on Artificial Intelligence
- Rupam Roy : General Secretary (GS) of All India State Bank Officers' Federation (AISBOF)
- Arun Kumar Bishoyi : President of All India State Bank Officers' Federation (AISBOF)
- Retired Supreme Court Justice V. Ramasubramanian : Chairperson of the National Human Rights Commission
- Madan B Lokur : chairperson of the United Nations Internal Justice Council (IJC)
- Raj Kumar Chaudhary : Additional charge of CMD for the government-owned hydropower company SJVN Limited (Replaced Sushil Sharma)
- Dr. Jagath Wickramaratne : Speaker of Sri Lanka's 10th Parliament (Replaced Asoka Ranwala)
- Malaysian coach Tan Kim Her : India's Doubles Badminton Coach for the 2026 Asian Games and 2028 Olympics
- Preeti Lobana : Country Manager and Vice President in India by Google
- Carl Hopkinson : Mumbai Indians' new fielding coach for the IPL 2025





Ques : Who successfully launched the Space Docking Experiment (SpaDeX) mission ?

- (a) ISRO
- (b) DRDO
- (c) NASA
- (d) HAL
- (e) None of these

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has successfully launched the Space Docking Experiment (SpaDeX) mission.
- ISRO's PSLV-C60 rocket, carrying two spacecraft for space docking demonstrations, launched from Sriharikota's Satish Dhawan Space Centre.
- PSLV-C60 successfully launched two satellites, SDX01 (the Chaser) and SDX02 (the Target), into low Earth orbit shortly after launch.
- The two spacecraft will now be headed towards space docking within the next ten days. SpaDeX seeks to demonstrate advanced in-space docking technology, which is critical for future missions such as lunar excursions and the Bharatiya Antariksh Station (BAS).
- The SpaDeX mission is a significant step in increasing India's orbital docking capability. The successful completion of this mission would strengthen ISRO's capabilities to execute complicated operations in space and create the framework for future interplanetary missions.





Ques : PM CARES Fund created in which year ?

- (a) 2014
- (b) 2016
- (c) 2018
- (d) 2020
- (e) 2021

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The PM CARES Fund, established in March 2020 to address the COVID-19 problem, received just Rs 912 crore in donations in fiscal year 2022-23, a considerable decrease from Rs 7,184 crore in 2020-21.
- Voluntary contributions totaled Rs 909.64 crore, while international donations were only Rs 2.57 crore.
- In 2020-21, the PM CARES Fund got its highest-ever voluntary contributions of Rs 7,184 crore due to popular support during the COVID-19 situation.
- Foreign contributions also increased to Rs 495 crore. However, as the pandemic intensity dropped, voluntary donations decreased to Rs 1,938 crore in 2021-22 and Rs 912 crore in 2022-23.
- The "PM Cares for Children" initiative received a huge allocation of Rs 346 crore to support children who lost both parents or guardians due to COVID-19.
- Nearly Rs 92 crore was spent on purchasing oxygen concentrators to support the pandemic's medical response.

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Ques : Which team won the 78th edition of the Santosh Trophy by defeating Kerala in the final?

- (a) West Bengal
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Haryana
- (e) Maharashtra

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- West Bengal, the most successful team in the Santosh Trophy's history, added to its trophy collection by defeating Kerala in the final of the 78th edition. This was the Bengal team's 33rd Santosh Trophy.
- The final of the 78th Santosh Trophy 2024-25 was held at the GMC Balayogi Stadium in Hyderabad, Telangana.
- Santosh Trophy is a prominent domestic state-level football tournament for men in India, organized by the All India Football Federation.
- The final in Hyderabad was West Bengal's 47th appearance in the Santosh Trophy, while Kerala was making its 16th.

Winners :

- Winners – West Bengal (Santosh Trophy & a cash prize of Rs 5 Lakhs).
- Runners Up – Kerala (Kamla Gupta Trophy, & a cash prize of Rs 3 lakhs).
- Tulsidas Balaram Player of the Final Match – Robi Hansda of West Bengal.
- Peter Thangaraj Player of the Championship – Robi Hansda of West Bengal.

About the Santosh Trophy :

- The Santosh Trophy is a state-level men's event founded by the Indian Football Federation in 1941 and presently handled by the All India Football Federation (AIFF).
- The Santosh Trophy is a competition between Indian states, Union Territories, Services (Army, Navy, and Air Force), and Railways.
- Bengal won the first tournament in 1941-42, defeating Delhi. West Bengal is the tournament's most successful team, having won 33 titles.





Ques : Which state government has launched a 15 day reading campaign amongst students?

- (a) West Bengal
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Haryana
- (e) Maharashtra

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- The Maharashtra government has announced a 15-day "reading campaign among students" beginning January 1, 2025.
- The plan was announced by Maharashtra's Minister for Higher and Technical Education, Chandrakant Patil.
- The Maharashtra government's Higher and Technical Education Department will organize a 15-day reading campaign. It will be conducted annually from January 1 to 15.
- The Maharashtra government's 15-day reading campaign aims to target college and university students.

Ques : Where has the Indian Army recently unveiled a grand statue of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj ?

- (a) Siachen Glacier
- (b) Galwan Valley, Ladakh
- (c) Tawang, Arunachal Pradesh
- (d) Leh, Ladakh
- (e) Pangong Tso, Ladakh

Answer : Option E



Explanation :

- The Indian Army recently inaugurated a statue of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj at Pangong Tso in Ladakh, near the India-China border.
- The Fire and Fury Corps installed a statue to honor the great Maratha monarch known for his courage and insight.
- The statue was unveiled by Lt Gen Hitesh Bhalla, General Officer Commanding of the 14 Corps (also known as the Fire and Fury Corps).
- The statue, placed at 14,300 feet, represents India's commitment to border security, especially in a location with tensions like the 2020 stalemate at Pangong Tso.

Recent Headlines Related to Inauguration :

- Two UK universities, Queen's University Belfast and Coventry University, have applied to open international campuses in Gujarat's GIFT City, following the lead of Australian institutions.
- During a function in Khajuraho, Madhya Pradesh, Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the groundwork for the Ken-Betwa National River Linking Project, inaugurated the Omkareshwar Floating Solar Project.
- Union Minister Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu of the Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) inaugurated the centenary celebration logo for Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose International Airport (NSCBI Airport) in Kolkata, West Bengal (WB), to commemorate its 100-year service.
- GSI Geoscience Museum Inaugurated by Vice President Shri Jagdeep Dhankhar at Victoria Market Building in Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi will formally inaugurate Mahakumbh-2025 and launch over 600 projects worth Rs.7,000 crore, undertaken and completed ahead of the mega once-in-12-years fair.
- Delhi chief minister Atishi inaugurated an underground shooting range at the National Cadet Corps (NCC) Bhawan in Rohini
- External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar inaugurated the new Chancery of the Indian Embassy in Rome, emphasizing the deep historical ties between India and Italy.
- Symbiosis International University's first international campus Inaugurated by External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar and UAE Minister Sheikh Nahyan bin Mubarak Al Nahyan at Dubai Knowledge Park .





- Bengaluru marked a milestone with the inauguration of its first digital population clock at the Institute for Social and Economic Change (ISEC). The project was jointly taken up by ISEC, and the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW).
- India's celebrated badminton star and Olympic medallist, PV Sindhu, laid the foundation stone for the PV Sindhu Centre for Badminton and Sports Excellence in Chinna Gadili village on the outskirts of Visakhapatnam.
- External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar inaugurated the new Consulate General of India in Brisbane, emphasizing that it will help to deepen India's ties with the Queensland state, promote trade, and serve the diaspora
- PM Modi inaugurated airports at Rewa (Madhya Pradesh), Ambikapur (Chhattisgarh), and Saharanpur (Uttar Pradesh) through the UDAN scheme. The government recently extended the Udan plan for another ten years
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi and visiting Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez jointly opened the Tata Advanced Systems Ltd (TASL) Tata Aircraft Complex in Vadodara, Gujarat.

Ques : Where was India's first glass bridge over sea inaugurated?

- (a) Bengaluru
- (b) New Delhi
- (c) Chennai
- (d) Greater Noida
- (e) Gurugram

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Kanyakumari, Tamil Nadu's famed tourist resort, has added another pearl to its crown. India's first glass bridge across the sea was inaugurated.
- Tamil Nadu Chief Minister MK Stalin unveiled the traditional glass bridge that joins the 133-foot-tall Saint Tiruvalluvar statue to the Vivekananda Rock Memorial.
- The bridge would allow travelers to take a leisurely walk between the locations while gazing into the choppy water below.
- The 77-meter bridge, built at a cost of 37 crores, was launched as part of the state government's silver anniversary celebrations for the Tiruvalluvar statue, which has been dubbed the Wisdom statue.





Ques : The Income Tax Department has extended the deadline for the Vivad Se Vishwas Scheme 2024. What is the new deadline ?

- (a) 31 January 2025
- (b) 31 February 2025
- (c) 31 March 2025
- (d) 31 April 2025
- (e) 31 May 2025

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Income Tax Department has extended the deadline for the Vivad Se Vishwas Scheme 2024, offering taxpayers another chance to resolve disputes at lower tax rates.
- The new date of January 31, 2025, provides much-needed respite to those currently studying the concept. Initially scheduled for December 31, 2024, the extension avoids a 10% additional tax, resulting in a speedier settlement procedure.
- The Vivad Se Vishwas Scheme, proposed in Budget 2024, enables taxpayers to resolve pending disputes by paying a reduced amount of contested tax plus predetermined percentages.
- Applications received by January 31, 2025 will be subject to the lower rates listed in column (3) of the scheme's table. However, beginning February 1, 2025, applications will be subject to a 10% higher tax rate.
- The Vivad Se Vishwas Scheme makes dispute settlement easier by allowing taxpayers to settle issues with lower financial liability. Applications filed by January 31, 2025 will be charged at the rates shown in column (3) of the scheme's table.
- For example, new appellants must pay 100% of the challenged tax and 25% of the disputed penalty or interest if they file before the deadline. However, on February 1, 2025, these rates will increase to 110% and 30%, respectively.





Recent News Headlines Related to Schemes

- The Haryana government has agreed to enhance the maximum amount of Death-cum-Retirement Gratuity for state government employees by 25%.
- Government of India(Gol) sanctioned Rs. 4388 crore under the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahabhiyan (PM-KUSUM) Scheme to solarize agriculture for states across India.
- Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) chief Arvind Kejriwal has launched a new scholarship programme aimed at Dalit students in Delhi. The scheme, named the Dr Ambedkar Samman Scholarship, will cover all expenses for Dalit students wishing to pursue higher education abroad.
- Delhi Chief Minister Atishi has introduced the Mukhyamantri Mahila Samman Yojana, which would pay a monthly stipend of Rs 1,000 to women residents with annual household incomes of up to Rs 3 lakh
- Gujarat, Maharashtra, and Uttar Pradesh have emerged as the top three states for rooftop solar installations under the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana plan. It is launched on February 15, 2024.
- West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee has launched the "Banglar Bari" initiative, which aims to provide housing for the state's rural poor.
- Yuva Shuddhi Abhiyan Launched by Karnataka Governor Thaawarchand Gehlot to raise awareness about the dangers of drug abuse among youth.
- The Chief Minister introduced 'Him Bhog Atta,' which is prepared from maize harvested by farmers in Uttarakhand using natural agricultural practices.
- The Indira Gandhi Sukh Shiksha Yojna aims to prevent child exploitation and assist vulnerable children of widows, poor mothers, divorced women, and disabled parent
- The Chief Minister handed over keys to 16 electric taxi owners as part of the Rajiv Gandhi Self-Employment Start-up Scheme 2023
- The Government of India's main effort for people with disabilities (PwDs), Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan or Accessible India Campaign (AIC), has been successfully implemented for 9 years.
- The Empowered Programme Committee has approved 7 startup proposals under the GREAT scheme. The Government is providing a maximum fund support of Rs 50 lakhs per startup.





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Myanmar shares a 1,643 km long unfenced border with the Indian states of Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Manipur, and Mizoram.

The National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (NaBFID) has invested Rs 745 crore in long-term bonds issued by NDR InvIT.

NDR InvIT is an Infrastructure Investment Trust managed by NDR InvIT Managers and sponsored by NDR Warehousing Private Limited.

Between 2017 and 2024, the country's groundwater recharge increased by 15 billion cubic meters while extraction decreased by 3 billion cubic meters.

The Dynamic Ground Water Resource Assessment Report was released by the Union Minister for Jal Shakti CR Patil in New Delhi on 31st December 2024.

The Ministry of Consumer Affairs has partnered with messaging platform Gupshup to introduce a web-based AI virtual assistant, Jagriti, to simplify the process of filing consumer complaints.

Amit Aggarwal has been appointed as the Secretary, of the Department of Pharmaceuticals, Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers, Government of India.

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Ques : Which organization has partnered with Vivifi Finance to launch a pilot project for providing unsecured loans to gig workers?

- (a) National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)
- (b) Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)
- (c) Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH)
- (d) Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
- (e) Indian Banks' Association (IBA)

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH) has teamed with Vivifi Finance to start a pilot operation offering unsecured loans to gig workers.
- The experiment intends to create a digital platform for lending to cab drivers like Ola and Uber, food delivery providers like Swiggy and Zomato, and gig workers.
- Currently, 36 lenders, including banks and NBFCs, use over 50 data services including authentication, land records from 6 states, satellite data, property searches, dairy insights, and document verification.
- The RBIH created the Public Tech Platform for Frictionless Credit to provide a digital solution for agriculture loans.

About the Reserve Bank Innovation Hub :

- Established : 2021
- HQ : Bengaluru, Karnataka
- CEO : Rajesh Bansal

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Ques : Who has been appointed as the Chief Executive Officer of ITI Asset Management (ITI AML)?

- (a) Rajesh Bhatia
- (b) Suresh Kumar
- (c) Jatinder Pal Singh
- (d) Anil Jain
- (e) Rohit Sharma

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- ITI Asset Management (ITI AML) has appointed Jatinder Pal Singh as CEO, succeeding Hitesh Thakkar, who had been acting CEO.
- Singh has over 25 years of experience in the mutual funds industry and previously worked at Mahindra Manulife Investment Management.
- His leadership is expected to guide the company in expanding its portfolio and strengthening its position in the asset management industry.
- ITI Mutual Fund Established in 2018 and headquartered in Mumbai.

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Recent Appointment in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- Rajat Verma : CEO of DBS Bank India (succeeding Surojit Shome)
- Anup Kumar Sinha : Reappointment as Bandhan Bank's non-executive chairman
- Amitava Chatterjee : Managing director (MD) and CEO J&K Bank
- Alok Aggarwal : Managing Director and CEO of Brookfield India Real Estate Trust
- R Subramaniakumar : MD & CEO of RBL Bank
- Ram Mohan Rao Amara : Managing Director of State Bank of India (SBI)
- George Heber Joseph : Chief investment officer (CIO) of the newly- incorporated joint venture firm Jio BlackRock Asset Management Company (AMC)
- Manish Jain : Executive Director of YES Bank
- R Ramaseshan : Part-time Chairman' (independent director) of Jana Small Finance Bank (JSFB) Limited (Replaced Subhash Khuntia)
- Bhavesh Jain : Managing Director and CEO of TransUnion CIBIL
- Sanjay Malhotra : 26th Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for three years
- Vaibhav Chaturvedi : ex-officio member of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI)
- Vijay Chandok : MD & CEO of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) (Replaced Padmaja Chunduru)
- Masato Kanda : 11th president of the Asian Development Bank (ADB)
- Nand Kishore : Managing Director and CEO of SBI Funds Management
- Binod Kumar : Managing Director of Chennai-based Indian Bank.

Ques: What was the total value of UPI transactions in December 2024?

- (a) Rs 23.25 trillion
- (b) Rs 20.25 trillion
- (c) Rs 21.75 trillion
- (d) Rs 23 trillion
- (e) Rs 22 trillion

Answer : Option A



Explanation :

- Unified Payments Interface (UPI) transactions increased by 8% month on month to 16.73 billion in December, the greatest number for the digital system since its launch in April 2016.
- The value also rose by 8% to Rs 23.25 trillion, up from Rs 21.55 trillion in November.
- According to figures from the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), the volume of transactions climbed by 46% to around 172 billion in 2024, up from 118 billion in 2023.
- In terms of value, transactions climbed by 35% to roughly Rs 247 trillion for the year, compared to Rs 183 trillion in 2023.
- Compared to November, the number of daily transactions climbed from 516 million to 540 million in December.
- This resulted in an increase in daily value to Rs 74,990 crore from Rs 71,840 crore in November.
- The volume and value in December increased by 39% and 28%, respectively, compared to December 2023.

Ques : Which bank has introduced a TAB-based end-to-end digital onboarding process for Non-Resident Indians (NRIs) ?

- (a) Canara Bank
- (b) State Bank of India
- (c) HDFC Bank
- (d) UCO Bank
- (e) Axis Bank

Answer : Option B

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Explanation :

- State Bank of India (SBI) has introduced a TAB-based digital onboarding procedure for Non-Resident Indians (NRIs) to make it easier to open NRE and NRO accounts.
- The new program is currently available at all SBI branches in India and select foreign offices. By utilizing digital tools, the bank hopes to improve the efficiency and convenience of the account opening procedure.
- The digital onboarding procedure reduces the need for physical documentation, allowing for faster account openings at branches and during customer visits via digital document verification.
- This streamlined approach is intended to make the procedure more efficient and comfortable for NRIs.
- Indian financial institutions offer an NRI bank account, which is a bespoke banking solution for Indian residents or Persons of Indian Origin (PIOs) residing overseas.
- These accounts provide a variety of banking services to help NRIs manage their financial affairs, investments, and transactions within India.
- NRE Account are Non-Resident External account for managing income earned outside India
- NRO Account are Non-Resident Ordinary account for income earned in India .

Recent News Headlines Related to SBI :

- SBI is seeking a ¥30 billion (\$197 million) credit facility, contributing to a record level of yen loans raised by Asian borrowers outside Japan in 2024.
- SBI Mutual Fund has established the SBI Quant Fund, an open-ended equity program with a quant-based investment strategy.
- The State Bank of India (SBI), India's largest lender, has launched a statewide awareness campaign to promote the necessity of activating inactive accounts.
- SBI has raised Rs.50,000 crore through domestic bonds in FY25. Bond issuances totaled Rs.30,000 crore for long-term bonds, Rs.15,000 crore for tier 2 bonds, and Rs.5000 crore for AT1
- State Bank of India (SBI), India's largest lender, has introduced a low-cost customized vehicle loan for Uber fleet partners.
- The State Bank of India (SBI), India's largest lender, has successfully raised \$500 million through five-year bonds from international investors .





- SBI, India's largest public sector bank, has joined with Jagriti Yatra 2024, an 8,000-kilometer, 15-day entrepreneurial adventure through India's Tier 2 and Tier 3 districts.
- SBI is aiming to secure a \$1.25 billion five-year loan, which would be the largest dollar-denominated loan from India's financial sector in 2024.
- During the India Entrepreneurs Forum (IEF), the South African CEOs of the State Bank of India (SBI) and India Exim Bank emphasized their efforts to bridge the trade finance gap for firms in Africa.
- SBI intends to issue Rs.5,000 crore in the domestic debt capital market via non-convertible, perpetual, subordinated, unsecured Basel III-compliant Additional Tier I (AT-I) notes.
- The State Bank of India (SBI) will offer the Mauritius government with a Rs 487.60 crore line of credit to finance a water project.
- The State Bank of India (SBI) plans to increase the quick loan scheme's threshold from Rs 5 crore to improve credit availability for the MSME sector.
- The State Bank of India (SBI) has extended the Amrit Kalash and Amrit Vrishti fixed deposit schemes till March 31, 2025.
- The State Bank of India (SBI) chaired a committee to promote co-lending agreements between commercial banks and non-banking financial enterprises. The committee proposed abolishing the 18% Goods and Services Tax (GST) on co-lending-related operations.
- State Bank of India (SBI) has filed a petition under Section 7 of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016, against KM Toll Road Private Limited, a wholly owned subsidiary of Reliance Infrastructure, before the National Company Law Tribunal, Mumbai, for a claim amount of Rs.233.44 crore (including interest).

Ques : Which microfinance company has applied for a small finance bank (SFB) license under the 'on tap' licensing guidelines?

- (a) Ujjivan Small Finance Bank
- (b) Bandhan Bank
- (c) Janalakshmi Financial Services
- (d) Equitas Small Finance Bank
- (e) VFS Capital

Answer : Option E





Explanation :

- VFS Capital, a microfinance organization, has sought for a small finance bank (SFB) licence under the private sector's 'on tap' licensing standards.
- During the quarter ending December 31, 2024, the Reserve Bank of India received one application from VFS Capital Limited under the rules for 'on tap' licensing of small finance banks in the private sector, dated December 5, 2019.
- VFS Capital, formerly known as Village Financial Services Private and headquartered in West Bengal, was established in 1994 as a non-deposit non-banking financial company-microfinance organization.
- It began microfinance activity in 2006 and was registered with the RBI as an NBFC-MFI in September 2013.
- VFS makes loans to individual female members, primarily from rural areas, through joint liability groups (JLGs) of five members each. VFS Capital makes all disbursements digitally.

Ques : National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) partners with which company to Empower Delivery Partners with Financial Literacy ?

- (a) Amazon
- (b) Flipkart
- (c) Google
- (d) Messho
- (e) Swiggy

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Swiggy Limited & National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) Partners to provide financial literacy to its delivery partners.
- This initiative aims to educate them about personal finance, savings, and investment options to help them achieve financial stability and security.
- The main Aim to introduce a financial literacy program designed specifically for Swiggy's delivery partners, with a strong focus on empowering women in the workforce
- Swiggy Limited aims to have 1 lakh women delivery partners by 2030.

About National Stock Exchange :

- **Established : 1992** • **HQ : Mumbai** • **Chairperson : Ashishkumar Chauhan**



Ques : Which year has India declared as the 'Year of Reforms' in the defence sector?

- (a) 2024
- (b) 2025
- (c) 2026
- (d) 2027
- (e) 2030

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- India has designated 2025 to be the 'year of changes' in the defence sector, promising "unprecedented" progress in strengthening India's security and sovereignty in the face of 21st-century challenges.
- The 'Year of Reforms' will mark a watershed moment in the armed forces' modernisation journey.
- The reforms seek to establish integrated theater commands, improve cooperation between the three services, and turn the military into a technologically advanced, combat-ready force.

Ques : Where did Blinkit first launch its 10-minute ambulance service?

- (a) Bengaluru
- (b) New Delhi
- (c) Chennai
- (d) Greater Noida
- (e) Gurugram

Answer : Option E



Explanation :

- Blinkit, a quick-commerce business, has launched a 10-minute ambulance service in Gurugram. Blinkit intends to expand the service to additional cities in India during the next two years.
- The ambulances would be equipped with medical supplies such as oxygen cylinders, AEDs (Automated External Defibrillators), stretchers, monitors, suction machines, emergency medications, and injections. The ambulance will include a paramedic, a helper, and a certified driver.
- While the first five ambulances will immediately hit the roads of Gurugram, more people will be able to order a Basic Life Support (BLS) ambulance through the Blinkit app.
- Blinkit's ambulance service would carry a flat Rs 2,000 fee.
- Albinder Dhinds is the CEO of Blinkit.

Ques : Who released the book 'Jammu Kashmir & Ladakh Through the Ages: A Visual Narrative of Continuities and Linkages'?

- (a) Anurag Thakur
- (b) Piyush Goyal
- (c) Narendra Modi
- (d) Dharmendra Pradhan
- (e) Amit Shah

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Amit Shah, Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation, released the book 'Jammu Kashmir & Ladakh Through the Ages: A Visual Narrative of Continuities and Linkages' in New Delhi.
- The book's editor is Professor Raghuvendra Tanwar, the Chairman of the Indian Council of Historical Research (ICHR).
- The book provides an insightful visual depiction of the historical and cultural linkages of Jammu, Kashmir, and Ladakh.





Recent News Headlines Related to Books :

- In Pursuit of Democracy : Najma Heptulla
- The Nehru Development Model : Arvind Panagariya
- Living with Birds : Asad Rahamani
- BRING IT ON: The Incredible Story of My Life : Dr. Deepa Malik
- New Bharat – Modi's Vision and Development 2019-2024 : Ravi Prashar and Released by Union Minister of Culture and Tourism Gajendra Singh Shekhawat
- 3 Books - Hindu Rashtra Hai Kya , The Fight for the Republic and Reflections on Culture, Media, and Science : Published by Safdar Hashmi Memorial Trust (SAHMAT) based in New Delhi and Tulika Books
- Tipu Sultan-The Saga of the Mysore Interregnum : Vikram Sampath
- Loh Purush Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Ka Jeevanvrit : Rakesh Kumar Sharma
- "Why the Heck Not?" - a blueprint for success from the man behind DLF : KP Singh and Aparna Jain
- Beyond the Higgs Boson: The W Boson : Manik Kotwal
- My Beloved Life tells the story of Jadunath : Amitava Kumar
- Ratan Tata: A Life : Thomas Mathew
- Why Bharat Matters : External Affairs Minister Dr S. Jaishankar
- 'Maa-Mother' : Dr. Davendra Kumar Dhodawat
- Modialogue: Conversations for a Viksit Bharat : Dr. Ashwin Fernandes, Executive Director of the United Kingdom (UK)-based QS World ranking
- Speaking with Nature: The Origins of Indian Environmentalism : Ramachandra Guha
- Bharatvakya : Pravin Vitthal Tarde
- Friends – India's Closest Strategic Partners : Prof. Sreeram Chaulia
- Mountain Mammals of the World : M.K. Ranjitsinh
- War : Veteran investigative journalist Bob Woodward





Ques : Which state becomes 5th state to provide 100% piped water supply to rural household ?

- (a) Punjab
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Haryana
- (e) Maharashtra

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Punjab Water Supply and Sanitation Minister Hardip Singh Mundian announced that the state has become the fifth in the country to offer 100% piped water to rural communities.
- This was done under the central government's 'Har Ghar Jal' initiative.
- To address water quality and availability, 15 large canal water projects encompassing 1706 villages are undertaken at a cost of Rs. 2174 crore.
- The following states and union territories have 100% tap water supply : Telangana, Mizoram, Himachal Pradesh, and Gujarat.

About Punjab :

- Capital : Chandigarh
- CM : Bhagwant Mann
- Governor : Gulab Chand Kataria





Ques : What is the total outlay approved by the Union Cabinet for the continuation of the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) and the Restructured Weather Based Crop Insurance Scheme (RWBCIS) until 2025-26?

- (a) Rs.42,415.71 Crore
- (b) Rs.52,500.71 Crore
- (c) Rs.69,515.71 Crore
- (d) Rs.73,415.71 Crore
- (e) Rs.80,165.71 Crore

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Union Cabinet, led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the extension of the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana and Restructured Weather Based Crop Insurance Scheme until 2025-26, with a total budget of Rs.69,515.71 crore from 2021-22 to 2025-26.
- The Union Cabinet has approved the creation of the Fund for Innovation and Technology (FIAT) with a capital of Rs.824.77 Crore to enhance transparency and claim calculation and settlement in the scheme's execution.
- The fund will support technological efforts such as Yield Estimation System using Technology (YESTECH), Weather Information and Network Data Systems (WINDS), and research and development.
- YES-TECH: Uses remote sensing technology to estimate yield accurately; it has now been deployed in nine key states, including Madhya Pradesh, which will use 100% technology-based estimating in 2023-24.
- WINDS: Plans to build up Automatic meteorological Stations (AWS) and Automatic Rain Gauges (ARGs) to collect hyper-local meteorological data. The system is being implemented in nine states, including Uttar Pradesh and Karnataka, with a funding ratio of 90:10 between the central and state governments.





About Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) :

- Launched : 2016
- Implementing Agency : Department of Agriculture, Cooperation & Farmers Welfare, Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
- Aim : To provide financial support to farmers suffering crop loss/damage arising out of natural calamities.
- Payment of premium : Maximum of 2 percent of the total premium of the insured amount for Kharif crops, 1.5 percent for rabi food crops and oilseeds as well as 5 percent for commercial/horticultural crops

Recent News Headlines Related to Schemes

- The Income Tax Department has extended the deadline for the Vivad Se Vishwas Scheme 2024, offering taxpayers another chance to resolve disputes at lower tax rates. The extended new date is January 31, 2025.
- The Haryana government has agreed to enhance the maximum amount of Death-cum-Retirement Gratuity for state government employees by 25%.
- Government of India(GoI) sanctioned Rs. 4388 crore under the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahabhiyan (PM-KUSUM) Scheme to solarize agriculture for states across India.
- Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) chief Arvind Kejriwal has launched a new scholarship programme aimed at Dalit students in Delhi. The scheme, named the Dr Ambedkar Samman Scholarship, will cover all expenses for Dalit students wishing to pursue higher education abroad.
- Delhi Chief Minister Atishi has introduced the Mukhyamantri Mahila Samman Yojana, which would pay a monthly stipend of Rs 1,000 to women residents with annual household incomes of up to Rs 3 lakh .
- Gujarat, Maharashtra, and Uttar Pradesh have emerged as the top three states for rooftop solar installations under the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana plan. It is launched on February 15, 2024.





- West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee has launched the "Banglar Bari" initiative, which aims to provide housing for the state's rural poor.
- Yuva Shuddhi Abhiyan Launched by Karnataka Governor Thaawarchand Gehlot to raise awareness about the dangers of drug abuse among youth.
- The Chief Minister introduced 'Him Bhog Atta,' which is prepared from maize harvested by farmers in Uttarakhand using natural agricultural practices.
- The Indira Gandhi Sukh Shiksha Yojna aims to prevent child exploitation and assist vulnerable children of widows, poor mothers, divorced women, and disabled parent .
- The Chief Minister handed over keys to 16 electric taxi owners as part of the Rajiv Gandhi Self-Employment Start-up Scheme 2023 .
- The Government of India's main effort for people with disabilities (PwDs), Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan or Accessible India Campaign (AIC), has been successfully implemented for 9 years.
- The Empowered Programme Committee has approved 7 startup proposals under the GREAT scheme. The Government is providing a maximum fund support of Rs 50 lakhs per startup.
- The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) predicts that by March 2025, rooftop solar installations under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSGMBY) will exceed 10 lakh .
- Rythu Bharosa Scheme Launched by Telangana government, led by Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy To provide annual subsidies of Rs.15,000 per farmer as part of Congress' six guarantees. The government has cleared Rs.7,625 crore in crop loan arrears for Kharif 2023, affirming its commitment to farmers' welfare.
- The government's Ayushman Bharat-Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB-PMJAY) has improved the health and wellbeing of senior folks significantly. Approximately 14 lakh Ayushmann Vay Vandana cards have been distributed to older adults aged 70 and above through the scheme.





Ques : India's coffee exports have reached a remarkable milestone, achieving a record _ between April and November of FY24 .

- (a) \$1.04 billion
- (b) \$1.14 billion
- (c) \$2.10 billion
- (d) \$3.15 billion
- (e) \$2.25 billion

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- India's coffee exports reached a record \$1.14 billion from April to November of FY24, a 29% rise over the same period last year.
- The expansion of Robusta coffee has been driven by global demand and supply chain issues in countries such as Brazil and Vietnam.
- Total exports in 2023-24 increased by 12.22% to \$1.28 billion.
- Major export markets include Italy, Russia, the UAE, Germany, and Turkey.
- Brazil is the Largest coffee grower and Rank of India as coffee grower is 8th.
- Coffee produces by India are Arabica and Robusta (72% of India's production). India is the 5th largest Robusta producer globally (Vietnam is largest).

Top 3 coffee producing states of India :

1. Karnataka with 71%
2. Kerala with 20%
3. Tamil Nadu with 5%





Ques : Which institution has partnered with the Union Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare to enhance the agricultural extension system?

- (a) IIT Guwahati
- (b) IIT Delhi
- (c) IIT Madras
- (d) IIT Indore
- (e) IIT Roorkee

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Indian Institute of Technology, Madras, has worked with the Union Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare on a project to increase the efficiency and efficacy of the agricultural extension system through digitization.
- Vistaar (Virtually Integrated System To Access Agricultural Resources) is a prototype project that will utilize the institute's expertise.
- The Centre for Research on Startups and Risk Financing and the business it incubated, YNOS Venture Engine, have compiled extensive data on the Indian startup environment.
- The institute and the agriculture ministry have signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) to supplement the Vistaar platform with information about agricultural startups and related sectors.
- This will make farmers and others in the agricultural and allied industries more aware of startups' skills and opportunities.





Recent News Headlines Related to IITs

- IIT Madras has completed a 410-meter Hyperloop test track, marking a big step forward in India's pursuit of futuristic transportation solutions.
- Hyundai Motor Group has partnered with three IITs to build a joint research system in the domains of batteries and electrification, involving a USD 7 million investment over five years.
- IIT Guwahati will host the 10th India International Science Festival (IISF) 2024 from November 30 to December 3.
- Samsung R&D Institute, Noida (SRI-Noida) has signed a MOU with the famed Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay).
- IIT Madras and ISRO Collaborate to create a Centre of Excellence focused on research in 'Fluid and Thermal Sciences'. ISRO will provide seed funding of Rs 1.84 Crore to establish this center.
- The IIT Madras aims to establish a worldwide flagship center in Dubai to promote research, innovation, and entrepreneurship.
- IIT Delhi and the International Energy Agency (IEA) have signed a Memorandum of Understanding on clean energy transition.
- IIT Indore has developed a new technology for early detection of breast cancer that is specifically geared to assist women in rural and remote places.
- IIT Delhi and the Indian Air Force's Headquarters Maintenance (HQ) Command in Nagpur have signed a MOU to collaborate on the development of novel technologies for aviation textiles, with an emphasis on parachutes and other safety equipment.
- US Government Partner with IIT Madras Research Park in Chennai to work in 4 broad areas namely, Solar energy (SE), Green Hydrogen (GH), Electric Vehicles (EVs), and Batteries, and Green Buildings (GBs).
- The National Health Authority (NHA) and IIT Kanpur inked an MoU in the presence of Union Health Secretary Apurva Chandra.
- The establishment of an Advanced Drone Excellence Center at the IIT Bhubaneswar Research and Entrepreneurship Park is the result of an agreement between IIT Bhubaneswar and IG Drones.
- Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IIT Madras) has partnered with IDBI Bank to launch a cybersecurity Lab to develop and deploy security solutions in crucial sectors such as healthcare, fintech and aerospace, among others.
- The Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT), signed an agreement with the Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee (IIT Roorkee) and Indian Institute of Technology, Mandi (IIT Mandi). Goal for the development of 'Cell-Free' 6G Access Points. Both the IITs are collaborating to develop this technology.





Ques : Which country introduced a new tourist tax, replacing the earlier resort fee from January 1, 2025 ?

- (a) United States
- (b) China
- (c) India
- (d) Japan
- (e) Russia

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- On January 1, 2025, Russia implemented a new tourist tax, replacing the previous resort charge.
- Amendments to the Russian Tax Code aim to strengthen regional tourism infrastructure.
- The staged proposal will charge tourists 1% of their hotel expenditures, increasing to 3% by 2027.
- To create a baseline contribution, a daily price of 100 rubles (0.9 US dollars) has been set.

About Russia :

- Capital : Moscow
- Currency : Russian Ruble
- President : Vladimir Putin





Ques : Which team won their first-ever Pro Kabaddi League (PKL) title?

- (a) Patna Pirates
- (b) Jaipur Pink Panthers
- (c) Bengaluru Bulls
- (d) Haryana Steelers
- (e) U Mumba

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Haryana Steelers reached a historic milestone by winning their first Pro Kabaddi League (PKL) title.
- In a thrilling final at the Shree Shiv Chhatrapati Sports Complex in Pune, the Steelers overcame the Patna Pirates by 32-23.
- Top scorer : Devank Dalal (301) Patna Pirates
- Most tackle points : Mohammadreza Chiyaneh (82) Haryana Steelers
- Most successful raid : Devank Dalal (226) Patna Pirates
- Most successful tackle : Mohammadreza Chiyaneh (78) Haryana Steelers

About Pro Kabaddi League :

- Started : 2014
- Tournament format : Double round-robin league and playoffs
- 2024 edition : 11th
- Number of teams : 12
- Most successful : Patna Pirates (3 titles)
- 2023 winner : Puneri Paltan
- 2024 Champion : Haryana Steelers (1st title)
- 2024 Runner-up : Patna Pirates





Ques : World Introvert Day celebrated on which day ?

- (a) 1 January
- (b) 2 January
- (c) 3 January
- (d) 4 January
- (e) 5 January

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- World Introvert Day is observed on January 2 to recognize and honor introverts' distinct features, stressing their strengths and contributions to society.
- The day raises awareness about common misconceptions regarding introversion and encourages acceptance of various personality types.
- Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world.
- World Introvert Day was first recognized in 2011, and has since grown in popularity as a way to highlight the qualities and accomplishments of the wallflower community.
- In contrast to extroverts, they recharge by spending time alone and prefer serious one-on-one conversations to huge social gatherings.

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Ques: International Mind-Body Wellness Day celebrated on which day ?

- (a) 1 January
- (b) 2 January
- (c) 3 January
- (d) 4 January
- (e) 5 January

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Every year on January 3rd, we celebrate International Mind-Body Wellness Day.
- This day emphasizes the need of striking a balance between mental, emotional, and physical well-being.
- This global campaign encourages people to prioritize their mental and physical health by using practices that promote growth and wellness.

EXAM
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IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) & boAt Signs MoU to nurture DPIIT-recognized startups, particularly in the Direct-to-Consumer (D2C) and manufacturing sectors.

Switzerland is implementing a series of significant changes starting January 1, 2025. The ban applies to burqas, niqabs, and other face coverings, with violations punishable by a fine of up to CHF 1,000 (\$1,143)

Yoon Suk Yeol Resigned as South Korean President. The impeachment bill passed with 192 votes, exceeding the 151-vote threshold for cabinet members but below the 200 votes needed for a president.

People's Liberation Army Navy (PLAN) officially launched its latest amphibious assault ship (AAS) from Shanghai, named 'Sichuan' after a province in southwestern China.

Romania and Bulgaria have officially become the full member of the European Union's (EU) Schengen area at the stroke of midnight on 1 January 2025.

12 students and 2 teachers from Dyal Singh Public School in Karnal, Haryana has been awarded with International Astronomical Search Collaboration (IASC) by National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) for their discovery of a Main-Belt Asteroid (MBA) TD40 found using data from pan-STARRS telescope.

Genius





Ques : Which state signed an MOU with State Bank of India (SBI) and Union Bank of India (UBI) to offer insurance benefits to state government employees ?

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Sikkim
- (c) Assam
- (d) Arunachal Pradesh
- (e) Meghalaya

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Assam government has inked a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with SBI and UBI to provide insurance coverage to state government employees.
- The agreements aim to offer zero-premium insurance coverage and other advantages to approximately 4 lakh permanent state government employees.
- Term Life Insurance : A minimum coverage of Rs.10 lakh for natural death, which includes death due to illness or accidents
- Permanent Total Disability insurance Coverage of up to Rs.1 crore
- Permanent Partial Disability insurance Coverage of up to Rs.80 lakh
- Accidental Death Insurance A minimum coverage of Rs.1 crore
- Air Accidental Insurance Minimum coverage of Rs.2 crore for deaths caused by air crashes

About Assam :

- Capital : Dispur
- CM : Himanta Biswa Sarma
- Governor : Lakshman Acharya

About State Bank of India (SBI) :

- Established : 01 July 1955
- HQ : Mumbai, Maharashtra
- Chairman : Challa Sreenivasulu Setty



About Union Bank of India :

- Established : 1919
- HQ : Mumbai
- MD & CEO : A. Manimekhalai
- Tagline : Good People to Bank with

Recently signed banking agreements

- The Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH) has teamed with Vivifi Finance to start a pilot operation offering unsecured loans to gig workers.
- Mizoram government entered into a Memorandum of Agreement (MoA) with its partner banks – State Bank of India (SBI), Mizoram Rural Bank (MRB), and Mizoram Cooperative Apex Bank Limited (MCAB) for the disbursement of loans under the Bana Kaih (handholding) Scheme.
- Punjab National Bank (PNB) and Federation of Cold Storage Associations of India (FCAOI) have signed an MoU to improve agricultural infrastructure and cold chain development in India
- Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) partnered with Bank of Bhutan, Bhutan's largest commercial bank, to modernize its digital core and improve customer experience.
- Magma HDI General Insurance has partnered with IndoStar Capital Finance Limited (ICFL), a prominent NBFC to enhance the availability of motor, health, and commercial insurance solutions for customers.
- M2P Fintech has partnered with the State Bank of India (SBI) to provide smooth and safe payment experiences.
- Tata Power Renewable Energy, a unit of Tata Power, has partnered with Canara Bank to offer cheap financing for rooftop solar installations.
- The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) has signed an MoU with HDFC Bank, India's largest private sector bank by assets, to provide entrepreneurs with world-class banking and financial services.
- Aditya Birla Housing Finance (ABHFL) has partnered with the National Housing Bank (NHB) to further the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana's (PMAY) mission of 'Housing for All'.
- Times Internet, in cooperation with ICICI Bank, has launched the Times Black ICICI Bank Credit Card, an ultra-premium offering designed for high-net-worth individuals (HNIs) and wealthy clients.
- Federal Bank has partnered with Ecofy, India's first green-only non-banking financial company (NBFC) backed by Eversource Capital, to offer innovative financing options for MSMEs investing in commercial rooftop solar installations.



Ques : Which bank Enhances Digital Rupee App with Accessibility Features ?

- (a) Karnataka Bank
- (b) Central Bank of India
- (c) Indian Overseas Bank
- (d) Union Bank of India
- (e) Punjab & Sind Bank

Answer: Option D

Explanation :

- Union Bank of India has improved digital accessibility by introducing additional features to its Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) app, often known as the Digital Rupee (e₹).
- Union Bank is the first Public Sector Bank (PSB) to deliver such inclusive capabilities, paving the path for increased financial inclusion and innovation.
- The Digital Rupee, issued and regulated by the Reserve Bank of India, is a digital version of fiat currency that allows for wallet-based transactions, interoperability with UPI QR codes, auto-load capabilities, and real-time settlements.
- Union Bank's new accessibility features aim to empower people with diverse abilities, particularly those who are visually impaired, by improving the user experience.

About Union Bank of India :

- Established : 1919
- HQ : Mumbai
- MD & CEO : A. Manimekhalai
- Tagline : Good People to Bank with





Ques : What are the Interest rate on Saving deposits for Jan-March 2025 ?

- (a) 3%
- (b) 3.25%
- (c) 3.75%
- (d) 4%
- (e) 4.25%

Answer : option D

Explanation :

- The Centre has chosen to keep the returns payable on modest savings plans unchanged for the January to March 2025 quarter, making it the fourth quarter in a row that these rates have not changed.
- The interest rates on minor savings schemes such as the Public Provident Fund (PPF) and National Savings Certificate (NSC) are reset quarterly using a formula based on the returns on government assets with similar maturities.
- Since 2016, the Union Ministry of Finance has revised interest rates on modest savings schemes on a quarterly basis.

Interest rates for Jan-March 2025 :

- Savings Deposit- 4%
- 1-Year Post Office Time Deposits- 6.9%
- 2-Year Post Office Time Deposits- 7.0%
- 3-Year Post Office Time Deposits- 7.1%
- 5-Year Post Office Time Deposits- 7.5 %
- 5-Year Recurring Deposits- 6.7%
- Senior Citizens Savings Scheme- 8.2%
- Sukanya Samriddhi Account- 8.2%
- Monthly Income Account- 7.4%
- National Saving Certificates (NSC)- 7.7%
- Kisan Vikas Patra- 7.5% (will mature in 115 months)
- Public Provident Fund- 7.1%





Ques : What is the name of the transaction banking platform launched by Federal Bank?

- (a) FinnAxia
- (b) FedOne
- (c) SmartBank
- (d) FedPay
- (e) E-Banking

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Federal Bank, one of India's leading private sector banks, has unveiled FedOne, a new transaction banking platform built on Nucleus Software's FinnAxia technology.
- The implementation, which was completed following a 10-month partnership, intends to improve the bank's corporate banking offerings.
- Federal Bank, a renowned private sector bank in India, has launched FedOne™, powered by Nucleus Software's FinnAxia® transaction banking platform, marking a critical milestone in its digital transformation path.
- FedOne™ aims to transform corporate banking by streamlining processes and leveraging sophisticated technology to help Federal Bank capitalize on new business possibilities and provide great value.

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Recent Facilities Launched in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- YES Bank Limited & Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry(FICCI) Ladies Organisation (FLO) Launched 'YES PowherUp' to empower women entrepreneur in promoting their businesses .
- ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has established the ICICI Prudential Rural Opportunities Fund, an open-ended equity strategy focused on rural and adjacent themes. It starts on January 9, 2025 and ends on January 25, 2025.
- ICICI Prudential Life Insurance has introduced a first-of-its-kind health insurance that covers women's critical illnesses and procedures.
- Shriram Finance Limited, a financial services company, has developed a new vertical to manage all of its green finance commitments.
- Poonawalla Fincorp, a non-banking finance company under Cyrus Poonawalla Group, has implemented AI in HR operations to reduce risks and increase hiring accuracy.
- LazyPay, a leading digital financial services provider by PayU, has launched 'LazyPay EMI' in partnership with its partner lender, PayU Finance. Consumers can finance purchases between Rs. 5,000 to Rs. 1 lakh with flexible repayment options ranging from 3 to 12 months .
- BOBCARD LIMITED has launched the TIARA Credit Card, a premium credit card specifically developed for women.
- Golden Jubilee (GJF) Scholarship Scheme 2024 Launched by Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) .
- IDFC FIRST Bank Limited has created a holographic digital avatar of brand ambassador Amitabh Bachchan using AI technology.
- The Federal Bank sponsored an initiative named "Kaliyum Karyavum" to teach life skills to schoolchildren using traditional art forms.
- Paytm launched Unified Payment Interface(UPI) Lite Auto Top-Up which was designed to streamline small, frequent transactions for users, making everyday payments quick and hassle free.





Ques : The Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) has provided guidance on the GST treatment of which type of transactions?

- (a) Real estate transactions
- (b) Vouchers
- (c) Cross-border transactions
- (d) Capital goods
- (e) Input tax credit adjustments

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) shed light on the GST approach of voucher-based transactions. According to the CBIC, vouchers are classified into two sorts.
- The first group includes Reserve Bank of India-approved prepaid instruments such as gift cards and digital wallets. These vouchers are treated as 'money' under the GST structure, thus transactions using them are not categorized as the supply of goods or services.
- The second group includes non-prepaid vouchers, which are not classified as prepaid instruments. These vouchers function as claims for certain goods or services and are classified as 'actionable claims'. These transactions, like their prepaid counterparts, do not count as a supply of goods or services for GST purposes.
- The CBIC stated that, regardless of the form of voucher, transactions involving vouchers will not be considered the supply of goods or services. However, the items or services that can be redeemed with these vouchers may still be liable to GST.
- Regarding unused vouchers, when vouchers go unused after their expiry date, known as breakage, the money from these unredeemed vouchers is not taxable under GST.





Ques : Who has been appointed as the chief of the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)?

- (a) Faiz Ahmed Kidwai
- (b) Rajiv Bansal
- (c) Sanjeev Kumar
- (d) Arun Kumar
- (e) Ajay Kumar Bhalla

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Faiz Ahmed Kidwai, a senior IAS officer, has been named chief of the Directorate General of Civil Aviation.
- The Madhya Pradesh cadre Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer from the 1996 batch is now the Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare's Additional Secretary.
- Senior bureaucrat Akash Tripathi has been named Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Power.
- Kamal Kishore Soan, who was previously Additional Secretary in the Labour Ministry, will now serve as Additional Secretary and Mission Director of the Jal Jeevan Mission, which is part of the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation.
- Shubha Thakur, Additional Secretary in the Department of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare, has been appointed to the Inter State Council Secretariat of the Home Ministry.





Ques : How much aid has the Government of India announced for the quake-hit nation of Vanuatu?

- (a) \$5 lakh
- (b) \$10 lakh
- (c) \$15 lakh
- (d) \$20 lakh
- (e) \$25 lakh

Answer: Option A

Explanation :

- The Indian government has provided a \$5 lakh help package for Vanuatu, a tiny Pacific Ocean country devastated by the earthquake. The funding will be utilized to help with relief, rehabilitation, and reconstruction operations in the country.
- Vanuatu, a South Pacific Ocean island nation, was rocked by successive earthquakes on December 17 and 22, 2024.
- On December 17, the country experienced its first earthquake of 7.3 magnitude, killing around 14 people and injuring over 200 others. To deal with the dead and devastation caused by the earthquake, the government ordered a dawn-to-dusk curfew across the country.
- On December 22, 2024, a second earthquake of magnitude 6.1 rocked the country, sparking widespread panic.
- The successive earthquakes caused severe damage to various business and residential buildings, as well as embassies and a hospital, which collapsed due to the powerful earthquake.



Ques : Who among the following has not been selected for the 2024 Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award?

- (a) Harmanpreet Singh
- (b) Vantika Agrawal
- (c) Praveen Kumar
- (d) Manu Bhaker
- (e) Gukesh D

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Union Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports has released the names of the 2024 National Sports Award recipients.
- President Droupadi Murmu will present the awards at a ceremony on January 17, 2025, at the Rashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi.
- The National Sports Awards include the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award, the Arjuna Award, the Dronacharya Award, the Maulana Abul Kalam Azad Trophy, and the Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puruskar.
- Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna is the country's highest sporting honor. It was previously known as the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award until being renamed in 2021 to the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award.

Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award 2024 :

- Shri Gukesh D : Chess
- Shri Harmanpreet Singh : Hockey
- Shri Praveen Kumar : Para-Athletics
- Ms. Manu Bhaker : Shooting

Arjuna Awards (Lifetime) for Outstanding Performance in Sports 2024

- Shri Sucha Singh : Athletics
- Shri Murlikant Rajaram Petkar : Para-Swimming



Dronacharya Award for Outstanding Coaches in Sports and Games 2024 :

Regular Category :

- Shri Subhash Rana : Para-Shooting
- Ms. Deepali Deshpande : Shooting
- Shri Sandeep Sangwan : Hockey

Lifetime Category :

- Shri S Muralidharan : Badminton
- Shri Armando Agnelo Colaco : Football

Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar :

- Physical Education Foundation of India

Maulana Abul Kalam Azad (MAKA) Trophy 2024 :

- Overall Winner University : Chandigarh University
- 1st Runner Up University : Lovely Professional University
- 2nd Runner Up University : Guru Nanak Dev University, Amritsar

Arjuna Awards for Outstanding Performance in Sports 2024 : 32 PLAYERS

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Recent News Headlines Related to Awards & Winners :

- Bahrain's prestigious 'Medal of Efficiency' (First Class) by King Hamad bin Isa Al Khalifa : Dr. Ravi Pillai
- "Great Place to Work" certification for January 2025–2026 : Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL)
- SKOCH Award : Maharashtra government's initiative 'Shasan Aplya Dari' ('Government at Your Doorstep')
- 34th Vyas Samman for 2024 : Hindi writer Suryabala for Her novel "Kaun Des Ko Vasi: Venu Ki Diary" which was published in 2018
- Prestigious "Gold Award" in the State Energy Conservation Award 2024 : RINL, the corporate entity of the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant
- Royal honors 'kighthood' and 'damehood' by King Charles III : Oscar award winning filmmaker Christopher Nolan and his wife, Emma Thomas
- Pandit Swapan Chaudhuri : Rashtriya Tansen Samman 2023
- Sanand Nyas Sanstha from Indore : Raja Mansingh Tomar Samman 2023
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi : Kuwait's highest civilian honour, the Order of Mubarak Al Kabeer
- Mrs. India USA 2024 : Caitlin Sandra Neil, a 19-year-old Indian-American teenager born in Chennai, India
- Miss Teen India USA 2024 : Sanskriti Sharma from Illinois
- 14th PSE Excellence Awards in 3 Category : "Corporate Governance" and "Corporate Social Responsibility & Sustainability" and "Operational Performance Excellence" : Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA)
- Public Relations Society of India (PRSI) National Awards 2024 (in 8 category) : Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL)
- US Navy's prestigious Distinguished Public Service Award : Tom Cruise
- External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar : Sri Chandrasekarendra Saraswathi National Eminence Award for Public Leadership by the South Indian Education Society (SIES)
- Biocon Group Chairperson Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw : Jamsetji Tata Award by the Indian Society for Quality (ISQ)
- Best FIFA Men's Player : Vinícius Junior of Spain and Real Madrid football club of Spain
- Best FIFA Women's Player : Aitana Bonmatí of Spain and Barcelona football club of Spain
- Best FIFA Women's Coach : Emma Hayes, coach of the United States women's team
- Best FIFA Men's Goalkeeper : Emiliano Martínez of Argentina and English club Aston Villa
- Good Design Award Australia 2024 : Air India Limited, India's leading airline based in New Delhi



Ques : Who has been appointed as the Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of the Food Corporation of India (FCI)?

- (a) Faiz Ahmed Kidwai
- (b) Anil Kumar Gupta
- (c) Ashutosh Agnihotri
- (d) Arun Kumar
- (e) Ajay Kumar Bhalla

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Ashutosh Agnihotri, an IAS officer now serving as Additional Secretary in the Department of Home, Ministry of Home Affairs, has been appointed Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of the Food Corporation of India (FCI).
- Agnihotri, a 1999-batch IAS officer from the Assam-Meghalaya cadre, brings extensive administrative experience and skills to administrative tasks.
- The Food Corporation of India, founded in 1965, plays an important role in the country's food security by acquiring, storing, and distributing critical food grains through the Public Distribution System.
- The organization also helps farmers by assuring minimum support prices and storing buffer stockpiles to keep market prices stable.

About Food Corporation of India :

- Founded- 14 January 1965
- Headquarters- New Delhi
- Founder- Government of India
- CMD – Ashutosh Agnihotri
- Owner- Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution, GoI





Ques : The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the extension of One-time Special Package on Di-Ammonium Phosphate (DAP). It belongs to which Department ?

- (a) Department of Higher Education
- (b) Department of Official Language
- (c) Department of Fertilizers
- (d) Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
- (e) Department of Consumer Affairs

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the Department of Fertilizers' proposal to extend the One-time Special Package on Di-Ammonium Phosphate (DAP) beyond the NBS subsidy of Rs 3,500 per MT for the period from January 1, 2025 until further orders to ensure farmers' sustainable availability of DAP at affordable prices.
- The tentative budgetary required for the above would be up to Rs. 3,850 crore. The P&K fertilizer subsidy is administered by the NBS Scheme as of April 1, 2010.
- Continuing to prioritize farmers' welfare, the government has provided significant relief to farmers by keeping the price of Di-Ammonium Phosphate (DAP) fertilizer steady.
- In July 2024, the Cabinet approved a one-time Special Package on DAP beyond the NBS subsidy at Rs 3,500 per MT from 01.04.2024 to 31.12.2024, with an estimated financial cost of Rs 2,625 crore.
- The Cabinet authorized the extension of the Special Package on DAP at its meeting today (1.1.2025), with an estimated financial impact of up to Rs. 3850 crore.





Ques : Whom did Jyoti Sharma succeed as the CEO of Nasscom Foundation?

- (a) Nandan Nilekani
- (b) Arundhati Bhattacharya
- (c) Nidhi Bhasin
- (d) Falguni Nayar
- (e) Shikha Sharma

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Nasscom Foundation has named Jyoti Sharma as its new Chief Executive Officer (CEO), following Nidhi Bhasin.
- Sharma has over 20 years of experience delivering social impact by directing program development, resource mobilization, and stakeholder engagement.
- The Nasscom Foundation, founded in 2001, is a non-profit organisation that represents the Indian technology industry.

Ques : On which day 67th Foundation Day of DRDO is celebrated ?

- (a) 1 January 2025
- (b) 2 January 2025
- (c) 3 January 2025
- (d) 4 January 2025
- (e) 5 January 2025

Answer : Option B





Explanation :

- On January 2, 2025, the Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO) celebrated its 67th Foundation Day.
- Since its establishment in 1958, DRDO has expanded to 52 laboratories and 5 DRDO Young Scientist Laboratories (DYSLs), covering a wide range of defense technologies.
- Raksha Mantri emphasized the importance of DRDO in achieving the 'Year of Reforms' goals

Ques : World Braille Day celebrated on which day ?

- (a) 1 January
- (b) 2 January
- (c) 3 January
- (d) 4 January
- (e) 5 January

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Every year on January 4th, we celebrate World Braille Day.
- The goal is to create awareness about the value of Braille as a communication tool for the blind and partially sighted.
- In 2018, the United Nations General Assembly declared January 4 as World Braille Day in honor of Louis Braille, the visionary who developed the braille system.
- The originator of the braille code, Louis Braille, was born on January 4, 1809, in Coupvray, France. Braille was three years old when he hurt his eye with a sharp tool while playing in his father's shop. Even with the finest care, the infection in one eye quickly spread to the other, leaving him entirely blind.



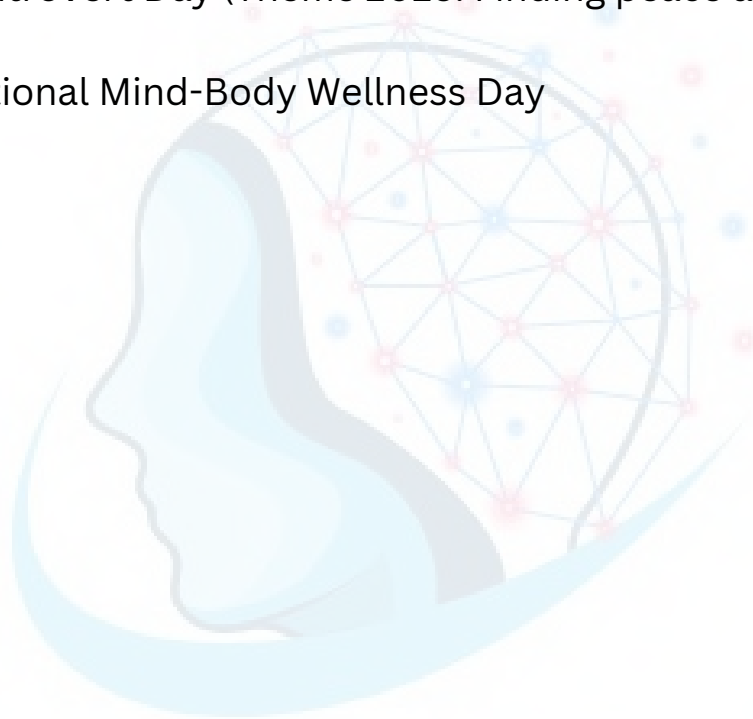
Important days :

- 9 December : International Anti-Corruption Day (Theme 2024: Uniting with Youth Against Corruption to Shape Tomorrow's Integrity)
- 9 December : International Day of Commemoration and Dignity of the Victims of Genocide
- 10 December : World Human Rights Day (Theme 2024: Our Rights, Our Future)
- 11 December : International Mountain Day (Theme 2024 - Mountain solutions for a sustainable future: innovation, adaptation, and youth)
- 11 December : United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund (UNICEF) Day
- 12 December : International Day of Neutrality
- 12 December : International Universal Health Coverage (UHC) Day
- 13 December : National Horse Day
- 14 December : National Energy Conservation Day (Theme 2024: Powering Sustainability: Every Watt Counts)
- 16 December : Vijay Diwas 2024 (Commemorates India's decisive victory over Pakistan in the 1971 Indo-Pak War)
- 18 December : International Migrants Day (Theme 2024: Recognizing the contributions of migrants and protecting their rights)
- 18 December : Minorities Rights Day
- 18 December : World Arabic Language Day (Theme 2024: Arabic Language and AI: Driving Innovation While Preserving Cultural Heritage)
- 19 December : Goa Liberation Day
- 20 December : International Human Solidarity Day (Theme 2024: Promote friendship and collaboration)
- 21 December : World Meditation Day (Theme 2024: Inner Peace, Global Harmony)
- 21 December : World Basketball Day
- 22 December : National Mathematics Day 2024 (Theme 2024 Mathematics: The Bridge to Innovation and Progress)
- 23 December : Kisan Diwas, also known as National Farmer's Day (Theme 2024: Empowering 'Annadata's' for a Prosperous Nation)
- 24 December : National Consumer Rights Day
- 25 December : Good Governance Day





- 26 December : Boxing Day
- 26 December : Computer Operators' Day
- 26 December : Veer Bal Divas A Day of Valor And Righteousness
- 27 December : International Day of Epidemic Preparedness
- 29 December : International Cello Day
- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day



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IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

A Book “Chhaunk: On Food, Economics and Society (Juggernaut)” Authored by Nobel Prize laureate Abhijit Vinayak Banerjee and Cheyenne Olivier is Released at Apeejay Kolkata Literary Festival (AKLF).

As of December 31, 2024, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced that 98.12% of the ₹2,000 denomination banknotes have been returned to the banking system, with ₹6,691 crore still held by the public.

Gangadhar National Award for Poetry 2023 has been given to Odia poet Prativa Satpathy by Sambalpur University on Occasion of Sambalpur University's 58th foundation day on January 5, 2025.

Gangadhar National Award for Poetry Established in 1989. It recognizes excellence in the field of poetry and is named after the eminent Odia poet Gangadhar Meher. A citation, shawl, and a cash prize of Rs.1,00,000 given to the winner.

Sanjiv Ranjan Appointed as Secretary General of the Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA) Secretariat in Ebene, Mauritius for 3 Years. Replaced Salman Al-Farisi of Indonesia.

IDBI Bank has approved the issuance of Long-Term Bonds to finance Infrastructure and Affordable Housing projects, raising up to Rs.10,000 crore. Bond issuance will take place in tranches, with Rs.5,000 crore expected by March 31, 2025, and the remaining amount over FY 2025–26.

Mission MAUSAM Approved in September 2024. It is Led by Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) with the Aim to make India “Weather Ready” and “Climate Smart”, complying with the international standards by 2026. It has an Outlay of Rs 2,000 crore for 2 years.





Ques : Who has approved the voluntary merger of The National Co-operative Bank Ltd., Bangalore (Karnataka) with Cosmos Co-operative Bank Limited (Maharashtra)?

- (a) NABARD
- (b) RBI
- (c) EPFO
- (d) SEBI
- (e) NPCI

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Reserve Bank of India has approved a voluntary merger between The National Co-operative Bank Ltd., Bangalore (Karnataka) and Cosmos Co-operative Bank Limited (Maharashtra).
- The Scheme of Amalgamation has been approved in accordance with the powers granted under Sub-Section (4) of Section 44A read with Section 56 of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949. The Scheme will take effect on January 6, 2025.
- Beginning January 6, 2025, the branches of The National Co-operative Bank Ltd. in Bangalore (Karnataka) will be operated by Cosmos Co-operative Bank Limited (Maharashtra).
- National Cooperative Bank Ltd. has 13 branches. 12 in Bangalore and one in Mysore.
- Cosmos Bank was formed in the fiscal year ending March 2024 by the merger of Mumbai-based Maratha Sahakari Bank (with 7 branches) and Sahebrao Deshmukh Sahakari Bank (with 11 branches).





Recent News Headlines Related to RBI

- As of December 31, 2024, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced that 98.12% of the Rs.2,000 denomination banknotes have been returned to the banking system, with Rs.6,691 crore still held by the public.
- To combat fraud, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) proposed adding a lookup tool for beneficiary accounts to the Real-Time Gross Settlement (RTGS) and National Electronic Funds Transfer (NEFT) systems.
- The RBI's "Report on Trend and Progress of Banking in India 2023-24" provides a detailed study of the banking sector's performance for fiscal year 2023-24.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has set up a committee to create a Framework for Responsible and Ethical Enabling of Artificial Intelligence (FREE-AI) in the Financial Sector.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) allows holders of full-KYC prepaid payment instruments (PPIs) including digital wallets, gift cards, and metro rail cards to make and receive UPI payments using third-party apps like Google Pay and PhonePe.
- In October 2024, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) sold \$9.2 billion, its highest monthly sale in almost two years (since September 2022, when \$10.3 billion was sold).
- Banks have asked the RBI to extend the deadline for compliance with new lending standards that prohibit overlapping activity between banks and their group businesses.
- RBI lifted business restrictions on two entities of the Edelweiss Group, ECL Finance Limited and Edelweiss Asset Reconstruction Company Limited (Edelweiss ARC).
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) cancelled Zavron Finance Private Limited's Certificate of Registration (CoR) under Section 45-IA (6) of the RBI Act, 1934.
- In-Solutions Global (ISG) has received full authorisation from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) as a payment aggregator under the Payment and Settlement Systems framework
- RBI has announced Introduction of the Secured Overnight Rupee Rate (SORR) , a benchmark based on the secured money markets
- The RBI increased the interest rate limit for NRI FCNR (B) deposits for a limited period.





Ques : Which bank has launched the deposit schemes "Har Ghar Lakhpati" and "Patrons"?

- (a) Canara Bank
- (b) State Bank of India
- (c) HDFC Bank
- (d) UCO Bank
- (e) Axis Bank

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The State Bank of India (SBI) has launched two new deposit plans for its customers. The two new deposit schemes are Har Ghar Lakhpati and SBI Patrons.
- 'Har Ghar Lakhpati' is a pre-calculated recurring deposit system that enables clients to accumulate Rs 1 lakh or multiples thereof.
- The new program makes it easier for customers to plan and save for their financial goals. This product is also offered to minors, which promotes early financial planning and saving practices.
- SBI has also launched 'SBI Patrons,' a program for select senior citizens. This is a specialist fixed deposit arrangement designed for senior citizens aged 80 and up.
- SBI has established additional deposit programs that provide greater FD rates to its clients. For example, the SBI We-care deposit scheme offers senior adults a 7.50% interest rate for tenors ranging from 5 to fewer than 10 years.
- Similarly, the SBI 444 days FD program (Amrit Vrishti) offers a 7.75% interest rate to older folks. The plan is accessible until March 31, 2025.
- SBI Amrit Kalash, a 400-day FD scheme, gives older citizens an interest rate of 7.60%. The plan is also accessible until March 31, 2025.





Ques : What is the current rural poverty ratio in India as per the SBI report for FY 2023-24?

- (a) 3.25%
- (b) 4.25%
- (c) 4.86%
- (d) 4.75%
- (e) 5.5%

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- According to an SBI Research analysis, India's rural poverty ratio has dropped dramatically to 4.86 percent in the fiscal year 2023-24 from 25.7 percent in 2011-12, while urban poverty has reduced to 4.09 percent from 4.6 percent during the same period.
- At the aggregate level, we predict India's poverty rates could presently be in the range of 4% to 4.5 percent, with nearly no extreme poverty.
- The dramatic drop in the rural poverty ratio is due to increased consumption growth in the lowest 0-5 percent decile, with significant government support.
- According to the 2023-24 fractile distribution, the sample share of poverty in rural areas is 4.86 percent, whereas 4.09 percent in urban areas in FY24. This is also much lower than the FY23 predictions for rural poverty (7.2%) and urban poverty (4.6%).
- The difference between rural and urban monthly per capita consumption expenditure (MPCE) is now at 69.7 per cent, a rapid decline from 88.2 per cent in 2009-10.





Ques : Punjab & Sind Bank will launch an instant loan scheme for the MSME sector. What is the maximum loan amount under the instant loan scheme for the MSME sector by Punjab & Sind Bank?

- (a) Rs 5 lakh
- (b) Rs 10 lakh
- (c) Rs 15 lakh
- (d) Rs 20 lakh
- (e) Rs 25 lakh

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Punjab & Sind Bank, a state-owned bank, will launch a quick loan scheme for the MSME sector of up to Rs 25 lakh this month as part of its initiative to expand lending through its digital platform.
- As part of its revolutionary goal, the bank has already implemented digital house loan and auto loan schemes that provide in-principle approval for an application within 15 minutes.
- The path from loan application to sanction for both segments, PSB e-Apna Ghar and PSB e-Apna Vahan (introduced last month), is based on Straight Through Process (STP) and a pre-defined Business Rule Engine (BRE).
- This automated system eliminates manual intervention during the processing and sanctioning stages, increasing speed, efficiency, and client satisfaction.





Ques : What is the Rank of India in Global Aging Index ?

- (a) 120
- (b) 121
- (c) 122
- (d) 123
- (e) 124

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Global Aging Index Published by National University of Singapore (NUS) & Columbia University.
- The Domains to check are well-being (25%), productivity and engagement (20%), equity (18%), cohesion (17%) and security (20%).
- India ranks 123rd out of 143 countries (95.4% of the world's population) in addressing the concerns of aging.
- Switzerland leads with a score of 82.3, followed by Norway and Denmark in second and third place, respectively.
- According to the analysis, the global population over 65 is projected to quadruple from 703 million in 2019 to 1.5 billion by 2050.

Ranking of different countries :

- 1 Switzerland
- 2 Norway
- 3 Denmark
- 4 Sweden
- 5 Iceland
- 86th Bangladesh
- 94th Sri Lanka
- 102nd Nepal
- 118th Pakistan
- 123rd India
- 143 Rwanda

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Ques : Which is the first state to link forest ecosystem with Green GDP ?

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Jammu and Kashmir
- (c) Nagaland
- (d) Bihar
- (e) Chhattisgarh

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- In a first, Chhattisgarh state has devised an innovative concept that combines forest ecosystem services with Green Gross Domestic Product (Green GDP).
- The action plan aims to promote economic development while protecting the environment for future generations.
- With 44% of its territory covered in forests, Chhattisgarh's natural resources are crucial for the livelihoods of millions.

About Chhattisgarh :

- Capital : Raipur
- CM : Vishnu Deo Sai
- Governor : Ramen Deka

EXAM
Genius





Ques : What is the name of the flagship initiative launched by the Mira Bhayandar Municipal Corporation (MBMC) to empower women entrepreneurs?

- (a) Sakhi Yojana
- (b) Women Entrepreneurs Program
- (c) Faral Sakhi
- (d) Mahila Udyog
- (e) Nari Shakti Initiative

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Mira Bhayandar Municipal Corporation (MBMC) has developed a flagship initiative named 'Faral Sakhi' to encourage women entrepreneurs in the city of Mira Bhayandar, Maharashtra.
- MBMC cooperated with the Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP) of NITI Aayog to formally launch 'Faral Sakhi' as part of WEP's Award to Reward initiative.
- WEP, which began as an aggregator platform at NITI Aayog in 2018, will shift to a public-private partnership in 2022.
- The 'Faral Sakhi' program intends to provide permanent employment possibilities for women by including them in the preparation and marketing of traditional holiday delicacies ('Faral').
- MBMC established a central kitchen where women from self-help groups (SHGs) may professionally prepare these refreshments.
- 25 women from Mira Bhayandar will be chosen for technical training in business operations. This workshop, led by the Centre for Education, Governance, and Public Policy (CEGP Foundation), will provide participants with the skills and information they need to start sustainable businesses and contribute to the local economy.



Ques : First phase of the ‘One Nation, One Subscription (ONOS)’ launched by which ministry ?

- (a) Union Ministry of Home Affairs
- (b) Union Ministry of Education
- (c) Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways
- (d) Union Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
- (e) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- First phase of the ‘One Nation, One Subscription (ONOS)’ Launched by Ministry of Education(MoE).
- This is Coordinated by INFLIBNET (Information and Library Network), an InterUniversity Centre based in Ahmedabad, Gujarat.
- An Outlay of Rs 6,000 crore released for three years, from 1st January 2025 to 31st December 2027.
- Its aim is to provide access to world-class scholarly articles and journals for government-run Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) and Central Government (CG) Research and Development (R&D) centers across India.
- It will provide access to over 13,000 journals for more than 6,300 government academic and R&D institutes including central and state-govt universities and colleges.
- The subscription fees for journals from 30 publishers under ONOS Phase I will be centrally managed by INFLIBNET.





Ques : When was India's 4th Biennial Update Report (BUR-4) submitted to the UNFCCC?

- (a) 1st January 2025
- (b) 15th December 2024
- (c) 25th November 2024
- (d) 30th December 2024
- (e) 31st December 2024

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- India's fourth Biennial Update Report (BUR-4) to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) was submitted on December 30, 2024. The BUR-4 updates the Third National Communication (TNC) and includes the National Greenhouse Gas (GHG) Inventory for 2020.
- The report also includes information on India's national circumstances, mitigation initiatives, and an analysis of restrictions, gaps, and related funding, technology, and capacity-building requirements.

India's achievements in respect of the NDC targets :

- By October 2024, non-fossil sources accounted for 46.52% of installed energy generation capacity. The total installed capacity of renewable power, including large hydropower, is 203.22 GW.
- The cumulative installed capacity (excluding large hydro projects) has increased by 4.5 times from 35 GW in March 2014 to 156.25 GW.
- India has gradually been decoupling economic growth from GHG emissions. From 2005 to 2020, India reduced its GDP emissions intensity by 36%.
- India's forest and tree cover has continually increased, and it now accounts for 25.17% of the country's total geographical area. From 2005 to 2021, an additional carbon sink of 2.29 billion tons of CO₂ equivalent was created.





Ques : Who inaugurated the Grameen Bharat Mahotsav in New Delhi ?

- (a) Anurag Thakur
- (b) Piyush Goyal
- (c) Narendra Modi
- (d) Dharmendra Pradhan
- (e) Amit Shah

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the Grameen Bharat Mahotsav in New Delhi. The Grameen Bharat Mahotsav will be held in New Delhi from January 4 to 9, 2025.
- The Grameen Bharat Mahotsav brings together government, rural economic, and industry leaders to debate ways and tactics for creating a prosperous and self-sufficient rural India.
- The Department of Financial Services, the Union Ministry of Finance, and the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD) together organized the Grameen Bharat Mahotsav.
- The theme for the Grameen Bharat Mahotsav is "Building a Resilient Rural India for a Viksit Bharat 2024". The Grameen Bharat Mahotsav's motto is "गांव बढ़े, तो देश बढ़े" (If villages flourish, the country grows).



Ques : Who won the Padmapani Lifetime Achievement Award recently?

- (a) Shyam Benegal
- (b) Sai Paranjpye
- (c) Mira Nair
- (d) Zoya Akhtar
- (e) Vishal Bhardwaj

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Sai Paranjpye, a legendary Indian cinema director and writer, was honored with the prestigious Padmapani Lifetime Achievement Award for her contributions to both Indian cinema and Marathi literature.
- Award given at Upcoming 10th edition of Ajanta-Ellora International Film Festival (AIFF) 2025 in Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar.
- A Padmapani memento, a letter of honour, and a monetary reward of Rs 2 lakh will given to her.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Who launched the revamped 'Baanknet' portal?

- (a) Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman
- (b) RBI Governor Shaktikanta Das
- (c) Financial Services Secretary M Nagaraju
- (d) Economic Affairs Secretary Ajay Seth
- (e) Revenue Secretary Sanjay Malhotra

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- M Nagaraju, the Financial Services Secretary, has unveiled the revised 'Baanknet' portal for e-auctioning items like as commercial buildings, industrial land, stores, automobiles, and agricultural and non-agricultural property.
- This portal compiles data on e-auction properties from all Public Sector Banks (PSBs) and provides a one-stop shop for buyers and investors to explore a diverse choice of assets.
- Gathering all of these facts in one place streamlines the process of locating and participating in property e-auctions, allowing buyers and investors to spot attractive opportunities more easily.

EXAM
Genius





Recent News Headlines Related to launched Apps/portals

- Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel has unveiled a new citizen-centric project known as the SWAR (Speech and Written Analysis Resource) platform.
- On the occasion of 'Good Governance Day', which commemorates the birth anniversary of former Prime Minister Shri Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh unveiled the Rashtraparv Website and Mobile App on December 25, 2024.
- On National Consumers Day 2024, the Department of Consumer Affairs will make the "Jago Grahak Jago App" and "Jagriti App" available to the public .
- Gujarat's Chief Minister, Bhupendra Patel, launched the 'Prakrutik Krushi Portal (Natural Agriculture Portal)' to encourage organic farming .
- “Amrit Gyaan Kosh” Portal Launched by Union Minister of State(MoS), Dr. Jitendra Singh, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions to build a comprehensive knowledge base by curating best practices from across India, with a focus on aligning these practices with 15 of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) .
- Pralhad Joshi, Minister of Food and Consumer Affairs, has presented 'Anna Chakra', a game-changing supply chain optimization tool for the Public Distribution System .
- Indian Railways has launched the 'Sanraksha' smartphone application, which is an innovative move toward boosting passenger safety and security.
- The Department of Justice is launching a year-long statewide campaign called 'Hamara Samvidhan Hamara Samman' to commemorate India's 75th year as a Republic and the adoption of its Constitution.





Ques : Who was K S Manilal, who recently passed away in Thrissur ?

- (a) historian
- (b) botanist
- (c) physician
- (d) zoologist
- (e) geologist

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- K S Manilal, a renowned botanist who translated the Latin book 'Hortus Malabaricus', a significant 17th-century botanical compendium about Kerala's medicinal plants, into English and Malayalam, died in Thrissur. He was 86.
- Manilal was also the head of Calicut University's Department of Botany.
- He won the E K Janaki Ammal Taxonomy Award (2003) as well as the Netherlands Government's highest civilian distinction, the Officer of the Order of Orange-Nassau, bestowed by Her Majesty Queen Beatrix of the Netherlands.
- In 2020, India awarded him the Padma Shri.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which city will be the headquarters of the newly proposed 69th Railway Division of Indian Railways?

- (a) Pathankot
- (b) Amritsar
- (c) Srinagar
- (d) Jammu
- (e) Firozpur

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Railway Ministry will reorganize the Firozpur division to form a new division with headquarters in Jammu under the Northern Railway Zone.
- The proposed Jammu division will be divided into five sections: Pathankot-Jammu-Udhampur (currently martyr Captain Tushar Mahajan), Srinagar-Baramulla, Bhogpur Sirwal-Pathankot, Batala (excluding)-Pathankot, and Pathankot-Joginder Nagar.
- The Indian Railways now has 68 divisions, and when the notification is published, Jammu will become the 69th.
- India has the world's fourth largest rail network, after the United States, China, and Russia.
- The Jammu Division will be under the Northern Railway Zone. It will be formed by reorganising the existing Firozpur division and it will manage the 742.1 km network.





Ques : National Bird Day is celebrated every year on which day ?

- (a) 4 January
- (b) 5 January
- (c) 6 January
- (d) 7 January
- (e) 8 January

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Every year on January 5, we celebrate National Bird Day.
- The day is observed every year to promote awareness about the importance of birds and their habitats. The day also emphasizes the ecological value of birds and the need to protect them.
- Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future.
- National Bird Day was founded in 2002 by the Avian Welfare Coalition. The day not only raises awareness about the grave concerns of bird extinction and habitat loss, but it also encourages individuals and organizations to participate in efforts to conserve bird populations.





Ques : World Day of War Orphans celebrated on which Day ?

- (a) 4 January
- (b) 5 January
- (c) 6 January
- (d) 7 January
- (e) 8 January

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The World Day of War Orphans is observed yearly on January 6.
- The day draws awareness to the condition of children who have become orphans as a result of wars and conflicts, highlighting their need for care, protection, and assistance.
- The day promotes international efforts to offer education, healthcare, and secure settings for children afflicted by war.
- SOS Enfants en Détresses, a French NGO, launched World Day of War Orphans. The day focuses on the lives of children affected by war and seeks to improve their future.

EXAM
Genius





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

The Committee Chaired by Professor Ramesh Chand, a member of NITI Aayog to revise the base year of the Wholesale Price Index (WPI) from 2011-12 to 2022-23. The last revision of the WPI occurred in 2015, updating the base year from 2004-05 to 2011-12.

Schengen area Created in 1985 with the Composition of 29 members (25 of the 27 EU member states as well as Switzerland, Norway, Iceland and Liechtenstein).

Pakistan began its two-year tenure as a non-permanent member of the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) on January 1. The new members join the five veto-wielding permanent members the United States, Russia, China, United Kingdom and France and the five countries elected as non-permanent members last year Algeria, Guyana, South Korea, Sierra Leone and Slovenia.

Cosmea Financial Holdings (CFH) Private Limited, led by Sam Ghosh, was granted approval by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) to sponsor a Mutual Fund (MF). CFH plans to invest Rs 200 crore (USD 23.3 million) in its Asset Management Company (AMC).

The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) has partnered with Stride Ventures, a venture debt firm, to catalyse the growth of Indian startups and widen their global footprint.

HDFC Bank, India's largest private sector lender, has received the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) approval to acquire up to a 9.5% stake in Kotak Mahindra Bank, AU Small Finance Bank, and Capital Small Finance Bank.

Devajit Saikia has been appointed as the Chief Secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI). While, Prabhtej Singh Bhatia was appointed as treasurer of BCCI.





Ques : Which company has launched the “Digit Glow Term Life Insurance” plan?

- (a) Bajaj Allianz General Insurance
- (b) ICICI Prudential Life Insurance
- (c) Kotak Mahindra Life Insurance
- (d) Go Digit Life Insurance
- (e) Magma HDI General Insurance

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Go Digit-Life Insurance Limited (Digit-Life), a major new-age digital insurer, has introduced its first individual pure-term life insurance policy, "Digit Glow Term Life Insurance."
- Designed to meet the changing demands of India's self-employed population, the plan aims to make insurance more accessible to approximately 300 million* self-employed individuals, including gig workers, small company owners, and professionals.
- Digit Glow Term Life Insurance tackles the unique issues that self-employed people experience, including as variable income and a lack of formal income verification, by utilizing technology-enabled underwriting methods and alternative credit standards.
- The plan provides comprehensive coverage ranging from Rs.2.25 lakh to Rs.1 crore, making it accessible to persons with lesser incomes.
- Sabyasachi Sarkar is the MD and CEO of Go Digit Life Insurance.





Recent Facilities Launched in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- Punjab & Sind Bank, a state-owned bank, will launch a quick loan scheme for the MSME sector of up to Rs 25 lakh this month as part of its initiative to expand lending through its digital platform.
- Union Bank of India has improved digital accessibility by introducing additional features to its Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) app, often known as the Digital Rupee (₹).
- Federal Bank, one of India's leading private sector banks, has unveiled FedOne, a new transaction banking platform built on Nucleus Software's FinnAxia technology
- YES Bank Limited & Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI) Ladies Organisation (FLO) Launched 'YES PowherUp' to empower women entrepreneur in promoting their businesses
- ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has established the ICICI Prudential Rural Opportunities Fund, an open-ended equity strategy focused on rural and adjacent themes. It starts on January 9, 2025 and ends on January 25, 2025.
- ICICI Prudential Life Insurance has introduced a first-of-its-kind health insurance that covers women's critical illnesses and procedures.
- Shriram Finance Limited, a financial services company, has developed a new vertical to manage all of its green finance commitments.
- Poonawalla Fincorp, a non-banking finance company under Cyrus Poonawalla Group, has implemented AI in HR operations to reduce risks and increase hiring accuracy.
- LazyPay, a leading digital financial services provider by PayU, has launched 'LazyPay EMI' in partnership with its partner lender, PayU Finance. Consumers can finance purchases between Rs. 5,000 to Rs. 1 lakh with flexible repayment options ranging from 3 to 12 months
- BOBCARD LIMITED has launched the TIARA Credit Card, a premium credit card specifically developed for women.
- Golden Jubilee (GJF) Scholarship Scheme 2024 Launched by Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)
- IDFC FIRST Bank Limited has created a holographic digital avatar of brand ambassador Amitabh Bachchan using AI technology.





Ques : Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) established in which year ?

- (a) 1952
- (b) 1958
- (c) 1999
- (d) 1985
- (e) 1949

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The EPFO has successfully deployed the Centralized Pension Payments System (CPPS) throughout all regional offices in India, resulting in substantial advancements in pension disbursement.
- This scheme allows over 68 lakh pensioners to obtain their pensions from any bank location countrywide.
- Pensioners can withdraw their pension from any bank branch in India, removing the requirement for transfers between branches.

About EPFO :

- Established : 4 March 1952
- HQ : New Delhi
- CPFC : Ramesh Krishnamurthi

EXAM
Genius





Ques : IndiaBonds.com, a SEBI-registered Stock Broker (Debt Segment) and licensed Online Bond website Provider (OBPP), now offers Digital Fixed Deposits (FDs) on its website. What is the maximum interest rate available on fixed deposit investments made through IndiaBonds.com?

- (a) 5.5%
- (b) 6.5%
- (c) 7.4%
- (d) 8.4%
- (e) 9.4%

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- IndiaBonds.com, a SEBI-registered Stock Broker (Debt Segment) and licensed Online Bond website Provider (OBPP), now offers Digital Fixed Deposits (FDs) on its website.
- This move improves accessibility and convenience for individual investors by providing a streamlined solution for managing bonds and fixed deposits simultaneously under one roof.
- Fixed deposit investors can earn up to 9.4% interest with an integrated portfolio dashboard that efficiently manages cash flows, returns, and allocations.
- The website also provides adjustable payout options, minimal minimum investment requirements, and the ability to manage all fixed-income investments in one spot. Additional fixed deposit partnerships are likely to increase its offerings in the following weeks.





Ques : Who recently assumed command of the Base Repair Depot (BRD) at Tughlakabad?

- (a) Air Commodore Rishi Seth
- (b) Air Commodore Debakinandan Sahu
- (c) Air Commodore Arvind Kumar
- (d) Air Vice Marshal Rajeev Gupta
- (e) Wing Commander Anil Sharma

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Air Commodore Debakinandan Sahu took leadership of the Base Repair Depot (BRD) in Tughlakabad, following Air Commodore Rishi Seth.
- Air Commodore Sahu was commissioned into the Indian Air Force's Aeronautical Engineering division on May 30, 1994, and brings an impressive career spanning three decades to his current position.
- He is a graduate of the Air Force Technical College (AFTC), Defence Services Staff College (DSSC), and Secunderabad's College of Air Warfare, and is well-known for his extensive knowledge of aviation systems and Guided Weapon Missile technologies.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Who inaugurates Delhi-Meerut Namo Bharat RRTS line worth Rs 4,600 crore ?

- (a) Anurag Thakur
- (b) Piyush Goyal
- (c) Narendra Modi
- (d) Dharmendra Pradhan
- (e) Amit Shah

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi has inaugurated the 13-kilometer extension of the Delhi-Ghaziabad-Meerut Namo Bharat route.
- With this launch, Delhi will receive its first Namo Bharat link. The corridor, worth Rs 4.600 crore, will have several stations, including significant ones in Delhi, Ghaziabad, and Meerut.
- Notable stations include Sarai Kale Khan, Anand Vihar, Sahibabad, and Meerut South.
- The corridor will feature India's fastest rapid transit trains, known as Namo Bharat, which can travel at speeds of up to 160 km/h. These trains are intended to cut the travel time between Delhi and Meerut to around an hour.
- The ticket from New Ashok Nagar Station to Meerut South is Rs 150 for a regular coach and Rs 225 for a premium coach.





Ques : Who launched the BHARATPOL portal developed by the Central Bureau of Investigation in New Delhi ?

- (a) Anurag Thakur
- (b) Piyush Goyal
- (c) Narendra Modi
- (d) Dharmendra Pradhan
- (e) Amit Shah

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurated the BHARATPOL platform, designed by the Central Bureau of Investigation, in New Delhi.
- The BHARATPOL platform will make it easier to process all requests for international assistance through INTERPOL, including the issue of Red Notices and other color-coded INTERPOL notices.
- The CBI built the BHARATPOL portal. It would provide Indian investigation agencies a new competitive advantage by expanding their global reach in order to achieve the Modi government's aim of a secure Bharat for everyone.
- The BHARATPOL platform will greatly benefit Indian law enforcement organizations by allowing real-time information sharing and faster access to international police support.
- Mr Shah also gave police medals to 35 CBI officers who had received the President's Police Medal for Distinguished Service and the Union Home Minister's Medal for Excellence in Investigation.





Recent News Headlines Related to launched Apps/portals

- M Nagaraju, the Financial Services Secretary, has unveiled the revised 'Baanknet' portal for e-auctioning items like as commercial buildings, industrial land, stores, automobiles, and agricultural and non-agricultural property.
- Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel has unveiled a new citizen-centric project known as the SWAR (Speech and Written Analysis Resource) platform.
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- “Amrit Gyaan Kosh” Portal Launched by Union Minister of State(MoS), Dr. Jitendra Singh, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions to build a comprehensive knowledge base by curating best practices from across India, with a focus on aligning these practices with 15 of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)
- Pralhad Joshi, Minister of Food and Consumer Affairs, has presented 'Anna Chakra', a game-changing supply chain optimization tool for the Public Distribution System
- Indian Railways has launched the 'Sanraksha' smartphone application, which is an innovative move toward boosting passenger safety and security.
- The Department of Justice is launching a year-long statewide campaign called 'Hamara Samvidhan Hamara Samman' to commemorate India's 75th year as a Republic and the adoption of its Constitution.
- Union Minister for Commerce and Industry, Piyush Goyal, has launched the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) Ease of Doing Business (EoDB) and Regulatory Affairs Portal in a bid to enhance transparency and facilitate feedback on India's business environment





Ques : Consider the following Statement About Pravasi Bharatiya Divas Convention 2025 :

- (a) The 18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD Convention 2025), will be held at New Delhi.
- (b) The theme of this three-day convention is “The Diaspora’s Contribution to a Viksit Bharat”.
- (c) Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the PBD Convention.

Which of the following Statement is/are True ?

- (a) Only a
- (b) Both a and b
- (c) Both b and c
- (d) Only b
- (e) Only c

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The 18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD Convention 2025) will be place in Bhubaneswar, Odisha, beginning January 8th.
- The theme of this three-day convention is "The Diaspora's Contribution to a Viksit Bharat".
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi will open the PBD Convention. The Chief Guest, Christine Carla Kangaloo, President of the Republic of Trinidad and Tobago, will deliver a virtual address.
- The Pravasi Bharatiya Express will operate as part of the Ministry of External Affairs' Pravasi Teertha Darshan Yojana.
- President Droupadi Murmu will preside over the Valedictory Session of the 18th PBD Convention on January 10th.
- Meanwhile, the Youth Pravasi Bharatiya Divas will be conducted on January 8, 2025, in collaboration with the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.



Ques : Who won the Men's 10-meter Air Pistol finals at the 67th National Shooting Championship 2024?

- (a) Saurabh Chaudhary
- (b) Abhishek Verma
- (c) Varun Tomar
- (d) Divyansh Singh Panwar
- (e) Anish Bhanwala

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Varun Tomar of the Indian Army has won the Men's 10-meter Air Pistol finals of the 67th National Shooting Championship 2024, which took place at Dr Karni Singh Shooting Range in New Delhi.
- Varun's teammate Pradhyumn Singh won silver, and Rajasthan's Aakash Bhardwaj took bronze.
- Varun Tomar also won the Men's Junior 10-meter Air Pistol event, while his teammate Pradhyumn Singh took bronze. Meanwhile, Nikhil from Uttar Pradesh won the silver medal.
- Furthermore, in the Men's Youth 10-meter Air Pistol event, Chirag Sharma of Uttar Pradesh won gold, his colleague Dev Pratap got silver, and Mayank Choudhary of Rajasthan earned bronze.





Recent News headlines related to Sports

- Haryana Steelers reached a historic milestone by winning their first Pro Kabaddi League (PKL) title. In a thrilling final at the Shree Shiv Chhatrapati Sports Complex in Pune, the Steelers overcame the Patna Pirates by 32-23.
- West Bengal, the most successful team in the Santosh Trophy's history, added to its trophy collection by defeating Kerala in the final of the 78th edition. This was the Bengal team's 33rd Santosh Trophy.
- Hemanth Muddappa, known as the "Drag King," achieved a remarkable triple crown victory in the final round of the MMSC FMSCI Indian National Motorcycle Drag Racing Championship held at the Madras International Circuit (MIC).
- Kerala won the Senior National Men's Handball Championship for the first time, defeating Chandigarh 34-31. The event final was held in Changanassery, Kerala.
- Punjab's Vijayveer Sidhu defeated fellow Olympian Gurpreet Singh of the Army Marksmanship Unit to win his first men's 25m rapid-fire pistol (RFP) title at the 67th National Shooting Championship Competitions (NSCC) for pistol events
- Lakshya Sen from India secured third place at the King Cup International Badminton Open by defeating French player Alex Lanier in straight games
- Karnataka's M. Raghu and Haryana's Devika Sihag won the men's and women's singles titles, respectively, at the 86th Senior National Badminton Championships 2024.
- Koneru Humpy, an Indian Grandmaster, won his second World Rapid Chess Championship, this time in New York. Koneru Humpy, 37, won the title by defeating Irene Sukandar with black pieces in the final round.
- Indian lifter Martina Devi clinched a silver medal in the women's junior +87kg category at the Asian Junior Weightlifting Championships.
- Bihar will host the Women's Kabaddi World Cup in March 2025 at Rajgir Sports Academy's indoor venue.
- The young Indian weightlifters ended the Asian Youth and Junior Weightlifting Championships 2024 with a respectable 33 medals, including 7 gold, 16 silver, and 10 bronze
- India won the inaugural Women's U-19 Asia Cup at Kuala Lumpur's Bayuemas Oval, defeating Bangladesh by 41 runs in the final.





Ques : Rishi Dhawan has announced his retirement recently. He is related to which sport?

- (a) Cricket
- (b) Football
- (c) Shooting
- (d) Badminton
- (e) tennis

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Rishi Dhawan, an allrounder, has declared his retirement from Indian limited overs cricket. Dhawan's announcement came following the final day of the Vijay Hazare Trophy's group stage phase, in which Himachal Pradesh failed to advance.
- However, Dhawan's retirement announcement on his social media handle particularly mentions limited overs cricket, implying that he will be ready to play for Himachal for the remainder of the Ranji season.
- The 34-year-old has represented India four times at the international level, with all four appearances coming in 2016. He has previously played for the Mumbai Indians, Punjab Kings, and Kolkata Knight Riders in the IPL, but went unsold in the most recent auctions.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : How many individuals were honored with the Presidential Medal of Freedom in this ceremony?

- (a) 12
- (b) 15
- (c) 17
- (d) 19
- (e) 22

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Lionel Messi, captain of Argentina's men's football team, was one of 19 individuals recognized with the Presidential Medal of Freedom during a ceremony at the White House.
- Messi became the first male football player to win the award, following Megan Rapinoe's win in 2022.
- The honor was given to 19 remarkable individuals by American President Joe Biden, whose time as 46th President ended on January 19, 2024.

The following individuals will be awarded the Presidential Medal of Freedom :

- Ashton Baldwin Carter (posthumous) : served as the 25th Secretary of Defense and devoted his career to making the nation safer for all.
- Michael J. Fox : actor who has won five Emmy Awards, four Golden Globe Awards, two Screen Actors Guild Awards, and a Grammy Award.
- Jose Andres : A renowned Spanish-American culinary innovator who popularized tapas in the United States.
- Tim Gill : visionary entrepreneur whose work has advanced LGBTQI rights and equality.
- Bono : frontman for legendary rock band U2 and a pioneering activist against AIDS and poverty.
- Hillary Rodha Clinton : made history many times over decades in public service, including as the first First Lady elected to the United States Senate.



- Jane Goodall : world-renowned ethologist and conservationist whose research transformed our understanding of primates and human evolution
- Ralph Lauren : fashion designer who redefined the fashion industry with a lifestyle brand that embodies timeless elegance and American tradition
- Fannie Lou Hamer (posthumous) : transformed the struggle for racial justice in America
- Robert Francis Kennedy (posthumous) : remembered as an Attorney General who fiercely combatted racial segregation, and as a United States Senator who sought to address poverty and inequality in the country.
- Lionel Messi : most decorated player in the history of professional soccer.
- Earvin “Magic” Johnson : legendary retired basketball player who led the Los Angeles Lakers to five championships.
- George W. Romney (posthumous) : businessman who served as the chairman and president of American Motors Corporation.
- Denzel Washington : an actor, director, and producer who has won two Academy Awards, a Tony Award, two Golden Globes, and the 2016 Cecil B. DeMille Lifetime Achievement Award.
- William Sanford Nye : inspired and influenced generations of American students as “Bill Nye the Science Guy.”
- George Soros : an investor, philanthropist, and founder of the Open Society Foundations.
- David M. Rubenstein : co-founder and co-chairman of The Carlyle Group, where he built one of the most successful global investment firms.
- George Stevens, Jr. : an award-winning writer, director, author, and playwright.
- Anna Wintour : a renowned fashion icon who has led Vogue as editor-in-chief since 1988.

Genius





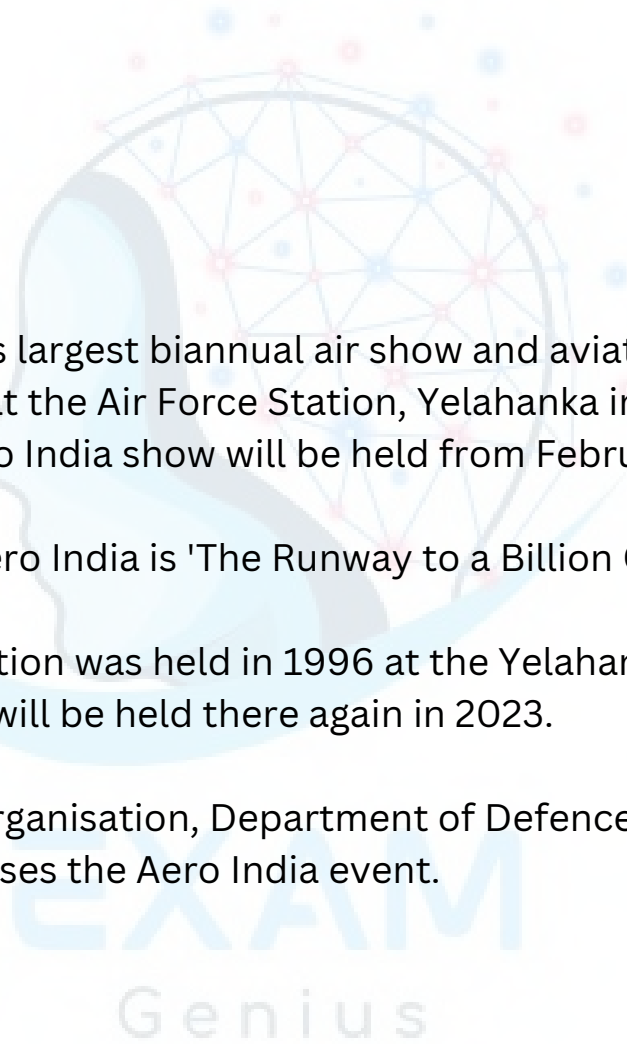
Ques : The latest edition of Asia's largest biannual air show and aviation exhibition, Aero India 2025, will take place in which city ?

- (a) Bengaluru
- (b) New Delhi
- (c) Chennai
- (d) Greater Noida
- (e) Gurugram

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The latest edition of Asia's largest biannual air show and aviation exhibition, Aero India 2025, will take place at the Air Force Station, Yelahanka in Bengaluru, Karnataka. The 15th edition of the Aero India show will be held from February 10 to 14, 2025.
- The theme for the 15th Aero India is 'The Runway to a Billion Opportunities'.
- The first Aero India exhibition was held in 1996 at the Yelahanka Air Force Station base, and the 14th edition will be held there again in 2023.
- The Defence Exhibition Organisation, Department of Defence Production, Union Ministry of Defence, organises the Aero India event.





Ques : India's first coastal and wader bird census held in which state ?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) Madhya Pradesh

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Gujarat government will conduct the country's first census of coastal and wader birds in the Marine National Park and Sanctuary in Jamnagar.
- The Bird Conservation Society of Gujarat and the state forest department will collaborate to organize the census.
- The Marine National Park and Marine Sanctuary in Gujarat is India's first recognized marine national park, covering 170 km of shoreline and 42 islands between Okha and Navlakhi.
- It is located in the districts of Devbhoomi Dwarka, Jamnagar, and Morbi.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Rajiv Ranjan Singh, Union Minister of Animal Husbandry and Fisheries, has opened the country's first organic fisheries cluster in which state ?

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh
- (b) Sikkim
- (c) Himachal Pradesh
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) Uttarakhand

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Rajiv Ranjan Singh, Union Minister of Animal Husbandry and Fisheries, has opened the country's first organic fisheries cluster in Sikkim.
- The organic fish cluster in Sikkim's Soreng District would increase farmer income while also promoting aquaculture sustainability.
- The project intends to sell organic fish that are free of antibiotics, chemicals, and pesticides in environmentally conscious markets around the world.
- Singh inaugurated 50 critical projects worth Rs.50 crore under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY), including all northeastern states except Arunachal Pradesh and Mizoram, in Guwahati.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Dr Rajagopala Chidambaram passed away at the age of 88. He joined Bhabha Atomic Research Centre in which year ?

- (a) 1950
- (b) 1988
- (c) 1954
- (d) 1962
- (e) 1960

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Dr. Rajagopala Chidambaram, the Chairman of the Atomic Energy Commission and the Principal Scientific Adviser to the Government of India when India conducted the critical Pokhran-II nuclear tests, died at the age of 88.
- Chidambaram joined the Bhabha Atomic Research Centre in 1962.
- Chidambaram was born in Chennai in 1936 to C Rajagopal Aiyar, a Controller of Defence Accounts, and Ananthalakshmi.
- He graduated first at Madras University with a B.Sc (Honours). He later joined the Indian Institute of Science in Bengaluru in 1956, earning his master's degree in a year and his PhD in 1961.
- Though Chidambaram's name is mainly linked with Pokhran-II (India's second nuclear testing, in May 1998), he did play a significant role in the 1974 Pokhran-I, for which he received the Padma Shri award in 1975 and the Padma Vibhushan in 1999.





Ques : Earth's Rotation Day is observed every year on which day ?

- (a) 4 January
- (b) 5 January
- (c) 6 January
- (d) 7 January
- (e) 8 January

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Earth's Rotation Day is held every year on January 8.
- The day raises awareness of the Earth's 24-hour rotational period, which is the foundation for the idea of time and the division of hours, minutes, and seconds.
- The Earth's Rotation Day commemorates the anniversary of French physicist Leon Foucault's 1851 confirmation that the Earth rotates around its axis. The day also commemorates Foucault's initial public demonstration in Paris.
- The Earth's diameter is 12,714 kilometers (7,900 miles) from the North to the South Poles and 12,756 kilometers (12,756 miles) along the equator (7,926 miles).
- 70% of the Earth's surface is covered in water. Only 3% of that is freshwater, whereas 97% is salty.

Genius





Important days :

- 13 December : National Horse Day
- 14 December : National Energy Conservation Day (Theme 2024: Powering Sustainability: Every Watt Counts)
- 16 December : Vijay Diwas 2024 (Commemorates India's decisive victory over Pakistan in the 1971 Indo-Pak War)
- 18 December : International Migrants Day (Theme 2024: Recognizing the contributions of migrants and protecting their rights)
- 18 December : Minorities Rights Day
- 18 December : World Arabic Language Day (Theme 2024: Arabic Language and AI: Driving Innovation While Preserving Cultural Heritage)
- 19 December : Goa Liberation Day
- 20 December : International Human Solidarity Day (Theme 2024: Promote friendship and collaboration)
- 21 December : World Meditation Day (Theme 2024: Inner Peace, Global Harmony)
- 21 December : World Basketball Day
- 22 December : National Mathematics Day 2024 (Theme 2024 Mathematics: The Bridge to Innovation and Progress)
- 23 December : Kisan Diwas, also known as National Farmer's Day (Theme 2024: Empowering 'Annadatas' for a Prosperous Nation)
- 24 December : National Consumer Rights Day
- 25 December : Good Governance Day
- 26 December : Boxing Day
- 26 December : Computer Operators' Day
- 26 December : Veer Bal Divas A Day of Valor And Righteousness
- 27 December : International Day of Epidemic Preparedness
- 29 December : International Cello Day
- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 2 January : 67th Foundation Day of Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day
- 4 January : World Braille Day
- 5 January : National Bird Day (Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future)
- 6 January : World Day of War Orphans





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Costas Simitis, former Prime Minister of Greece and the architect of the country's joining the common European currency, the euro, has died at age 88. Mr. Simitis, a co-founder of the Socialist PASOK party in 1974.

Mike Johnson, a Republican from Louisiana Appointed as Speaker of the U.S. House of Representatives

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) lifted business restrictions on Arohan Financial Services Limited, a microfinance institution situated in Kolkata (West Bengal), after the lender implemented remedial steps and committed to fair loan pricing.

Farmers in Telangana will receive Rs.12,000 per acre annually under the Rythu Bharosa scheme, as the State government has increased the cash benefit under the scheme by Rs.2,000.

Uttarakhand government and Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) signed an MOU to promote tourism in the border areas of the state.

A Japanese woman who was the world's oldest person according to Guinness World Records has died. Tomiko Itooka was 116 and died at a care home in Ashiya in the Hyogo Prefecture, according to elderly policies official Yoshitsugu Nagata.

The plan aims to expand heli-services to border areas near popular tourist locations including Adi Kailash, Om Parvat, and Timmarsain Mahadev.





Ques : Who has been appointed as the Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of TATA AIG General Insurance Company?

- (a) Rajesh Bansal
- (b) Sanjay Gupta
- (c) Amit Ganorkar
- (d) Ramesh Kumar
- (e) Piyush Tiwari

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Amit Ganorkar Appointed as Managing Director(MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of TATA AIG General Insurance Company. He Replaced Neelesh Garg.
- TATA AIG General Insurance Company operates in the general insurance sector, offering a range of non-life insurance products.
- TATA AIG General Insurance is a joint venture between the TATA Group and American International Group (AIG), combining domestic and global expertise.
- TATA AIG General Insurance Established in 2001 and Headquarter is in Mumbai.

EXAM
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Recent Appointment in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- Jatinder Pal Singh : CEO of ITI Asset Management (ITI AML) (succeeding Hitesh Thakkar)
- Rajat Verma : CEO of DBS Bank India (succeeding Surojit Shome)
- Anup Kumar Sinha : Reappointment as Bandhan Bank's non-executive chairman
- Amitava Chatterjee : Managing director (MD) and CEO J&K Bank
- Alok Aggarwal : Managing Director and CEO of Brookfield India Real Estate Trust
- R Subramaniakumar : MD & CEO of RBL Bank
- Ram Mohan Rao Amara : Managing Director of State Bank of India (SBI)
- George Heber Joseph : Chief investment officer (CIO) of the newly- incorporated joint venture firm Jio BlackRock Asset Management Company (AMC)
- Manish Jain : Executive Director of YES Bank
- R Ramaseshan : Part-time Chairman' (independent director) of Jana Small Finance Bank (JSFB) Limited (Replaced Subhash Khuntia)
- Bhavesh Jain : Managing Director and CEO of TransUnion CIBIL
- Sanjay Malhotra : 26th Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for three years
- Vaibhav Chaturvedi : ex-officio member of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI)
- Vijay Chandok : MD & CEO of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) (Replaced Padmaja Chunduru)
- Masato Kanda : 11th president of the Asian Development Bank (ADB)
- Nand Kishore : Managing Director and CEO of SBI Funds Management

EXAM
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Ques : What is the projected GDP growth rate for India in the fiscal year 2024-25 as per the first advance estimates?

- (a) 5.6%
- (b) 5.8%
- (c) 6%
- (d) 6.4%
- (e) 7.2%

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) is expected to expand at 6.4% in fiscal year 2024-25, a four-year low and a substantial decrease from the 8.2% growth achieved in FY24, according to the government's initial advance forecasts.
- The prognosis is lower than the latest Reserve Bank estimate of 6.6 percent for the current fiscal year, which ends March 2025.
- The NSO released its first advance estimates of national income for 2024-25, stating that "real GDP has been estimated to grow by 6.4 percent in FY2024-25 as compared to the growth rate of 8.2 percent in the Provisional Estimate (PE) of GDP for FY2023-24". The report also showed that real Gross Value Added (GVA) is predicted to increase by 6.4% in FY25, down from 7.2% in FY24. In contrast, nominal GVA is expected to expand at 9.3% in FY25, slightly higher than 8.5% in the previous fiscal year.





Ques : Bajaj Broking, the broking arm of Bajaj Finance Ltd., has partnered with which Bank to introduce a comprehensive 3-in-1 account solution ?

- (a) South Indian Bank
- (b) Axis Bank
- (c) Tamilnad Mercantile Bank
- (d) Punjab National Bank
- (e) Karur Vyasya Bank

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Bajaj brokerage, the brokerage arm of Bajaj Finance Ltd., has teamed up with Tamilnad Mercantile Bank (TMB) to launch a comprehensive 3-in-1 account solution that combines banking, broking, and investing services on a single platform.
- The agreement intends to provide Tamilnad Mercantile Bank customers with a seamless online trading experience using Bajaj Broking's platform.
- As part of its expansion strategy, Bajaj Broking is increasing its physical presence throughout India. The company intends to expand its branch network to more than 50 locations by March 2025, with an emphasis on metro cities as well as Tier 2 and Tier 3 markets.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Nitin Gadkari, Union Minister of traffic Transport and Highways, has announced a new plan that will provide cashless treatment to traffic accident victims. What is the maximum financial help provided by the new cashless treatment system for road accident victims?

- (a) Rs 1.5 lakh
- (b) Rs 2 lakh
- (c) Rs 2.5 lakh
- (d) Rs 3 lakh
- (e) Rs 3.5 lakh

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Nitin Gadkari, Union Minister of traffic Transport and Highways, has announced a new plan that will provide cashless treatment to traffic accident victims.
- Once the police are notified within 24 hours of the accident, the policy will immediately cover the victim's treatment costs for 7 days, up to a maximum of Rs 1.5 lakh.
- If a person is killed in a hit-and-run accident, his or her immediate family would receive Rs 2 lakh.
- Gadkari also emphasized road safety as a primary issue. In 2024, 1.8 lakh people died in traffic accidents across India. Approximately 30,000 people died as a result of not wearing helmets.
- Another alarming figure is that 66% of fatal accident victims were aged 18 to 34. Additionally, improper access and exit points near schools and colleges resulted in the deaths of 10,000 children.





Ques : Which state has launched the 'Atlas of Indian Wolf Habitats ' ?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) Madhya Pradesh

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Gujarat is prioritizing biodiversity protection, with a focus on the Indian wolf.
- The state has unveiled the 'Atlas of Indian Wolf Habitats,' led by Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel and Forest Minister Mulubhai Bera.
- This atlas identifies ideal locations for wolves in 13 districts.
- The Atlas was created by the GEER Foundation in partnership with the Gujarat Forest Department.

Ques : India signed MOU with which country on Non-Basmati White Rice Trade ?

- (a) Indonesia
- (b) Sweden
- (c) Bhutan
- (d) Mauritius
- (e) Dubai

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Union Cabinet has approved the Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) agreed between the Union Ministry of Cooperation and Indonesia's Ministry of Trade.



- The clearance was provided during a Union Cabinet meeting in New Delhi chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
- India will provide Indonesia with one million metric tonnes of non-basmati white rice per year at the current international pricing.
- The MoU will be valid for four years and automatically extended for another four years. The National Cooperative Exports Limited will supply rice to Indonesia.
- In 2023-24, bilateral commerce between the two countries totaled US\$29.4 billion. India's exports to Indonesia were \$5.99 billion, while its imports totaled \$23.4 billion.
- Indonesia is India's eighth-largest trading partner, and India is the second-largest importer of Indonesian coal and crude palm oil.
- To control rice prices in India, the government has banned the export of non-basmati white rice from July 20, 2023. The Indian government lifted the restriction on non-basmati rice exports in September 2024, but only at a minimum export price of \$490 per tonne.

About National Cooperative Exports Limited (NCEL) :

- Established : in 2023 as a Multi-state Cooperative Society under the Multi-State Cooperative Society Act, of 2002
- Headquarters : New Delhi
- Managing Director : Unupom Kausik
- Function : is an umbrella organization for exports by the cooperative sector of the country.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Who has inaugurated the Gandhi Darshan Art Gallery at Rajghat in New Delhi?

- (a) Draupadi Murmu
- (b) Narendra Modi
- (c) Om Birla
- (d) S Jaishankar
- (e) None of the above

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Om Birla, Lok Sabha Speaker, launched the Gandhi Darshan Art Gallery at Rajghat in New Delhi.
- More than 80 artists have exhibited their work in the gallery, portraying the Father of the Nation, Mahatma Gandhi, in a distinctive and modern manner.
- Darshan Art Gallery will educate today's youngsters about Gandhian principles.
- The event was organized by the Ministry of Culture, Lalit Kala Academy, and Gandhi Smriti and Darshan Samiti.

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Recent Headlines Related to Inauguration :

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi has inaugurated the 13-kilometer extension of the Delhi-Ghaziabad-Meerut Namu Bharat route. The corridor, worth Rs 4.600 crore.
- Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurated the BHARATPOL platform, designed by the Central Bureau of Investigation, in New Delhi. The BHARATPOL platform will make it easier to process all requests for international assistance through INTERPOL.
- The Indian Army recently inaugurated a statue of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj at Pangong Tso in Ladakh, near the India-China border.
- Two UK universities, Queen's University Belfast and Coventry University, have applied to open international campuses in Gujarat's GIFT City, following the lead of Australian institutions.
- During a function in Khajuraho, Madhya Pradesh, Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the groundwork for the Ken-Betwa National River Linking Project, inaugurated the Omkareshwar Floating Solar Project.
- Union Minister Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu of the Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) inaugurated the centenary celebration logo for Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose International Airport (NSCBI Airport) in Kolkata, West Bengal (WB), to commemorate its 100-year service.
- GSI Geoscience Museum Inaugurated by Vice President Shri Jagdeep Dhankhar at Victoria Market Building in Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi will formally inaugurate Mahakumbh-2025 and launch over 600 projects worth Rs.7,000 crore, undertaken and completed ahead of the mega once-in-12-years fair.
- Delhi chief minister Atishi inaugurated an underground shooting range at the National Cadet Corps (NCC) Bhawan in Rohini .
- External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar inaugurated the new Chancery of the Indian Embassy in Rome, emphasizing the deep historical ties between India and Italy.
- Symbiosis International University's first international campus Inaugurated by External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar and UAE Minister Sheikh Nahyan bin Mubarak Al Nahyan at Dubai Knowledge Park





Ques : Prabowo Subianto has formally accepted New Delhi's invitation to be the chief guest at the 2025 Republic Day parade. He is the President of which country ?

- (a) Indonesia
- (b) Sweden
- (c) Bhutan
- (d) Mauritius
- (e) Dubai

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto has formally accepted New Delhi's invitation to be the chief guest at the 2025 Republic Day parade.
- Subianto's selection as the first visitor of Prime Minister Modi's third term demonstrates the importance India places on bilateral relations with Indonesia and its Act East policy. The visit is designed to strengthen both sides' strategic cooperation and defense connections.
- President Sukarno of Indonesia, a crucial friend of Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru during the golden years of the non-aligned movement, was India's first Republic Day visitor.
- India and Indonesia have had strong cultural and commercial ties for over two thousand years, with Hindu, Buddhist, and Muslim traditions extending from India to Indonesia. The legends of the Ramayana and Mahabharata have had a significant impact on Indonesian traditional art and theater.

About Indonesia :

- Capital – Jakarta
- Currency – Rupiah
- Official language – Indonesian
- President – Prabowo Subianto





Ques : Which state has installed the ‘SSI Mantra (Multi-Arm Novel Tele Robotic Assistance) surgical robot’ ?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) Madhya Pradesh

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Noble Hospitals and Research Centre in Pune, Maharashtra has installed the first made-in-India surgical robot, the SSI Mantra (Multi-Arm Novel Tele Robotic Assistance).
- SS Innovations International Inc, an Indian med-tech start-up, created cutting-edge technology that has been authorized by the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) in New Delhi.
- The Rajiv Gandhi Cancer Institute and Research Centre (RGCI) in New Delhi deployed the first Indian-made surgical robot system, which has successfully completed 26 procedures.
- It was later set up in Hyderabad, Telangana and Raipur, Chhattisgarh.





Ques : Which organization approved 'Nadi Tarangini' for use as a medical device?

- (a) Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR)
- (b) World Health Organization (WHO)
- (c) Central Drugs Standard Control Organization (CDSCO)
- (d) Ministry of AYUSH
- (e) National Accreditation Board for Hospitals (NABH)

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- 'Nadi Tarangini', an indigenously designed pulse diagnostic instrument, has been India's first Ayurvedic medical device to be approved for use by the Central Drugs Standard Control Organization CDSCO, a national regulator for the cosmetics, pharmaceutical, and medical device sectors in India.
- Padma Bhushan's brainchild Prof. J. B. Joshi, Chancellor of the famous Institute of Chemical Technology (Formerly UDCT) and President of Marathi Vidnyan Parishad the device built by Dr. Aniruddha Joshi after over 6 years of hard research at IIT Bombay.
- "Nadi Tarangini is an innovative AI-powered pulse testing instrument that aims to speed up traditional Ayurvedic procedures. It combines extremely sensitive sensors with cutting-edge algorithms. It gives exact pulse measurements to provide detailed health information.
- This innovative instrument assists practitioners in analyzing 22 Ayurvedic indicators, including Tridosha balance (Vata, Pitta, Kapha), stress levels, digestive health, and overall well-being of the individual.





Ques : PLI scheme for Specialty Steel, termed as PLI Scheme 1.1 Launched by which ministry ?

- (a) Union Ministry of Home Affairs
- (b) Union Ministry of Education
- (c) Union Ministry of Steel and Heavy Industries
- (d) Union Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
- (e) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- PLI scheme for Specialty Steel, termed as PLI Scheme 1.1 Launched by Union Minister of Steel and Heavy Industries, Shri H. D. Kumaraswamy at Vigyan Bhavan New Delhi.
- It is launched for the Period of FY 2025-26 to FY 2029-30.
- Its aim is to encourage domestic production of specialty steel and lower imports by drawing in capital investments. The Investment is of Rs 6,322 crore.
- It covers Five product categories in line with the existing PLI Scheme, namely Coated / Plated Steel Products, High Strength / Wear resistant Steel, Specialty Rails, Alloy Steel Products & Steel wires and Electrical Steel.
- As of November 2024, companies have already invested Rs 18,300 crore and generated over 8,660 in employment



Recent News Headlines Related to Schemes

- The Mira Bhayandar Municipal Corporation (MBMC) has developed a flagship initiative named 'Faral Sakhi' to encourage women entrepreneurs in the city of Mira Bhayandar, Maharashtra.
- The Union Cabinet, led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the extension of the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana and Restructured Weather Based Crop Insurance Scheme until 2025-26, with a total budget of Rs.69,515.71 crore from 2021-22 to 2025-26.
- The Income Tax Department has extended the deadline for the Vivad Se Vishwas Scheme 2024, offering taxpayers another chance to resolve disputes at lower tax rates. The extended new date is January 31, 2025.
- The Haryana government has agreed to enhance the maximum amount of Death-cum-Retirement Gratuity for state government employees by 25%.
- Government of India (GoI) sanctioned Rs. 4388 crore under the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahabhiyan (PM-KUSUM) Scheme to solarize agriculture for states across India.
- Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) chief Arvind Kejriwal has launched a new scholarship programme aimed at Dalit students in Delhi. The scheme, named the Dr Ambedkar Samman Scholarship, will cover all expenses for Dalit students wishing to pursue higher education abroad.
- Delhi Chief Minister Atishi has introduced the Mukhyamantri Mahila Samman Yojana, which would pay a monthly stipend of Rs 1,000 to women residents with annual household incomes of up to Rs 3 lakh
- Gujarat, Maharashtra, and Uttar Pradesh have emerged as the top three states for rooftop solar installations under the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana plan. It is launched on February 15, 2024.
- West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee has launched the "Banglar Bari" initiative, which aims to provide housing for the state's rural poor.
- Yuva Shuddhi Abhiyan Launched by Karnataka Governor Thawarchand Gehlot to raise awareness about the dangers of drug abuse among youth.





Ques : What is the Rank of India in Threat Landscape Report 2024 Published by CloudSEK ?

- (a) 1st
- (b) 2nd
- (c) 3rd
- (d) 4th
- (e) 5th

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- ThreatLandscape Report 2024 Published by CloudSEK
- In 2024, India was the second most targeted country for cyberattacks, with 95 companies experiencing data breaches.
- Cyber attackers mostly targeted the finance and banking industries, resulting in 20 victims. The government recorded 13 events, followed by telecoms with 12.
- The healthcare, pharmaceutical, and education industries saw substantial threats, with 10 and 9 casualties, respectively.

Ranking of top 5 Countries :

- 1 United States
- 2 India
- 3 Israel
- 4 Thailand
- 5 Brazil

EXAM
Genius





India's Rankings in Different Indices

- Global Aging Index Published by National University of Singapore (NUS) & Columbia University : India (123rd), Switzerland (top)
- Hurun India Top 200 Self-Made Entrepreneurs of the Millennia 2024 Published by Hurun India & IDFC FIRST Private Banking : Kaivalya Vohra (Zepto) (Youngest), Ashok Soota (Happiest Minds Technologies) (Oldest)
- Travel and Tourism Development Index (TTDI) 2024 Published by World Economic Forum (WEF) : India (39th), United States (Top)
- 2025 QS Sustainability Rankings Published by QS Rankings : IIT Delhi (171), University of Toronto (Canada) (top)
- SBTi commitments by Indian companies Published by ICRA ESG Ratings Limited : India (6th), United Kingdom (UK) (top)
- "world's worst airlines" in the 2024 AirHelp Score survey : IndiGo (103rd), Brussels Airlines (top)
- Interdisciplinary Science Rankings (ISR) 2025 Published by Times Higher Education (THE) : Anna University in Chennai (Tamil Nadu, TN) (42nd), Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) (USA) (top)
- 2024 Network Readiness Index (NRI) Published by Portulans Institute and Saïd Business School : India (49th), United States of America (top)
- Sustainable Trade Index 2024 Published by Hinrich Foundation and IMD : India (23rd), New Zealand (top)
- Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) 2025 : India (10th), Denmark (last)
- Brand Finance's Global City Index Published by Brand Finance : London (top), New Delhi (77), Mumbai (78)
- WJP Rule of Law Index 2024 Published by World Justice Project (WJP) : India (79th), Denmark (top)
- World Intellectual Property Indicators Report 2024 : India (6th), China (top)
- EdelGive-Hurun India Philanthropy List 2024 : Shiv Nadar & Family (top)
- AI Preparedness Index (API) Published by IMF : India (72nd), Singapore (top)
- Henley Passport Index 2024 : India (83rd), Singapore (top)
- Global Nature Conservation Index for 2024 : India (176th), Luxembourg (top)



Ques : Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) established in which year ?

- (a) 1947
- (b) 1942
- (c) 1956
- (d) 1958
- (e) 1962

Answer : option B

Explanation :

- Dr. Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology, revealed that the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) has created technology to synthesize Paracetamol in-house.
- Dr. Jitendra Singh declared this during the 40th Foundation Day of the Department of Scientific and Industrial Research (DSIR) in New Delhi.
- Satya Deeptha Pharmaceuticals Ltd, based in Karnataka, would manufacture inexpensive paracetamol domestically.

About Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) :

- Established : 1942
- HQ : New Delhi
- Director General : N. Kalaiselvi





Ques : Who has been elected as the new President of the Athletics Federation of India (AFI)?

- (a) Milkha Singh
- (b) PT Usha
- (c) Bahadur Singh Sagoo
- (d) Neeraj Chopra
- (e) Abhinav Bindra

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Bahadur Singh Sagoo, an Asian Games gold winner, has been elected as the next President of the Athletics Federation of India (AFI).
- The Asian Games shot put medalist succeeded the outgoing president, Adille Sumariwalla, at the federation's Annual General Assembly Meeting in Chandigarh.
- With Sagoo's appointment, Sumariwalla's more than ten-year reign as AFI president comes to an end. The 67-year-old had been AFI president since 2012.
- Sagoo, a one-time Asian medalist and two-time national champion, won the gold medal in the shot put at the 2002 Busan Asian Games. He also competed at the 2000 and 2004 Olympics. His best attempt of 20.40m occurred in 2004 in Koncha-Zaspa, Kyiv.
- Meanwhile, Sandeep Mehta, who previously served as senior joint secretary, was elected secretary of the body during the AGM.





Recent Appointment in different departments :

- Mike Johnson, a Republican from Louisiana : Speaker of the U.S. House of Representatives
- Devajit Saikia : Chief Secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)
- Prabhtej Singh Bhatia : Treasurer of BCCI
- Sanjiv Ranjan : Secretary General of the Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA) Secretariat in Ebene, Mauritius (Replaced Salman Al-Farisi of Indonesia)
- Senior bureaucrat Akash Tripathi : Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Power
- Ashutosh Agnihotri : Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of the Food Corporation of India (FCI)
- Jyoti Sharma : Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Nasscom Foundation
- Kamal Kishore Soan : Additional Secretary and Mission Director of the Jal Jeevan Mission, which is part of the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation
- Shubha Thakur : Inter State Council Secretariat of the Home Ministry
- Faiz Ahmed Kidwai : chief of the Directorate General of Civil Aviation
- Amit Aggarwal : Secretary, of the Department of Pharmaceuticals, Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers
- Manish Singhal : Secretary General of the Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM) (replace Deepak Sood)
- Sachin Tendulkar : Melbourne Cricket Club (MCC) Membership
- Sandip Kumar Mishra : Director of the National Testing Agency (NTA)
- K N Renuka Pujar : first transgender guest lecturer at a Karnataka institution
- Dr. Sandip Shah : Chairperson of the National Accreditation Board for Testing and Calibration Laboratories (NABL)
- Abhijit Majumder : Chief financial officer (CFO) of Oil India
- Arunish Chawla : Revenue Secretary





Ques : In January 2024, the e-Shram portal has been upgraded in how many languages?

- (a) 12
- (b) 18
- (c) 15
- (d) 20
- (e) 22

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- The e-Shram portal has been improved and will now be available in all 22 scheduled languages, allowing unorganized laborers from all parts of the country to use it and benefit from government services.
- The previous version only supported English, Hindi, Kannada, and Marathi.
- Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya, Union Minister of Labour and Employment, has launched the multilingual e-Shram portal, which aims to be a 'One-Stop-Solution' website for all unorganised registered workers to take advantage of various government schemes designed to support their welfare, livelihood, and well-being.
- MEITY's Bhashini project has been used to enhance the e-Shram portal with 22 languages. The portal is now accepting registrations from building and other construction workers (BoCW), as well as gig and platform workers.





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND) and the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) have signed a MoU for sharing of intelligence and information to check money laundering.

Suzuki Motor Corporation has decided to acquire 26 per cent stake in NDDB Mirda Ltd, a bio-gas venture of National Dairy Development Board (NDDB), as part of its plans to use Compressed Bio-Gas (CBG) for longevity and performance of vehicles.

Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND) & the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) signed MOU For sharing of intelligence and information to check money laundering

The National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC) has teamed with pollster Axis My India to help bridge India's skills gaps and satisfy the predicted demand for millions of jobs in developed economies over the next five years.

Justin Trudeau Resigned as Canada's Prime Minister & Leader of his Liberal Party of Canada. He came to power in 2015 after 10 years of Conservative Party rule.

The Central Government has approved the establishment of a memorial dedicated to former President Pranab Mukherjee in the Rashtriya Smriti complex, situated in the Rajghat area of New Delhi. Pranab Mukherjee, who served as the 13th President of India from 2012 to 2017, had a political career spanning five decades.

Genius





Ques : Who has been appointed as the Deputy Managing Director and Group Chief Risk Officer of the State Bank of India (SBI)?

- (a) Rajnish Kumar
- (b) Arundhati Bhattacharya
- (c) Baldev Prakash
- (d) Dinesh Khara
- (e) P K Gupta

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- State Bank of India has named Baldev Prakash as deputy managing director and group chief risk officer.
- Prakash previously served as managing director and chief executive officer of Jammu and Kashmir Bank on a three-year deputation, which concluded in December.
- Shiva Om Dikshit has been assigned a new role as deputy managing director, operations-channel management

EXAM
Genius





Recent Appointment in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- Amit Ganorkar : Managing Director(MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of TATA AIG General Insurance Company (Replaced Neelesh Garg)
- Jatinder Pal Singh : CEO of ITI Asset Management (ITI AML) (succeeding Hitesh Thakkar)
- Rajat Verma : CEO of DBS Bank India (succeeding Surojit Shome)
- Anup Kumar Sinha : Reappointment as Bandhan Bank's non-executive chairman
- Amitava Chatterjee : Managing director (MD) and CEO J&K Bank
- Alok Aggarwal : Managing Director and CEO of Brookfield India Real Estate Trust
- R Subramaniakumar : MD & CEO of RBL Bank
- Ram Mohan Rao Amara : Managing Director of State Bank of India (SBI)
- George Heber Joseph : Chief investment officer (CIO) of the newly- incorporated joint venture firm Jio BlackRock Asset Management Company (AMC)
- Manish Jain : Executive Director of YES Bank
- R Ramaseshan : Part-time Chairman' (independent director) of Jana Small Finance Bank (JSFB) Limited (Replaced Subhash Khuntia)
- Bhavesh Jain : Managing Director and CEO of TransUnion CIBIL
- Sanjay Malhotra : 26th Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for three years
- Vaibhav Chaturvedi : ex-officio member of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI)
- Vijay Chandok : MD & CEO of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) (Replaced Padmaja Chunduru)
- Masato Kanda : 11th president of the Asian Development Bank (ADB)
- Nand Kishore : Managing Director and CEO of SBI Funds Management

Genius





Ques : Export-Import Bank of India established in which year ?

- (a) 1982
- (b) 1985
- (c) 1989
- (d) 1995
- (e) 1998

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Export-Import Bank of India (EXIM Bank) successfully raised \$1 billion (Rs. 8,570 crore) in overseas bond issuance at competitive rates, a notable achievement for Indian issuers in global capital markets.
- The offering was priced at US Treasury rates plus 1%, with a negative new issue concession of 0.05%.
- The bond issue had global interest, with 50% coming from Asia, 32% from Europe, the Middle East, and Africa, and 18% from the US.

About Export-Import Bank of India :

- Established : 1982
- HQ : Mumbai, Maharashtra
- CMD : Harsha Bangari

Ques : What was the theme of the 3rd edition of the Reserve Bank of India's Global Hackathon?

- (a) Financial Inclusion and Literacy
- (b) Zero Financial Frauds and Being Divyang Friendly
- (c) Digital Banking Transformation
- (d) AI and Blockchain Innovations
- (e) Enhancing Rural Banking Services

Answer : Option B

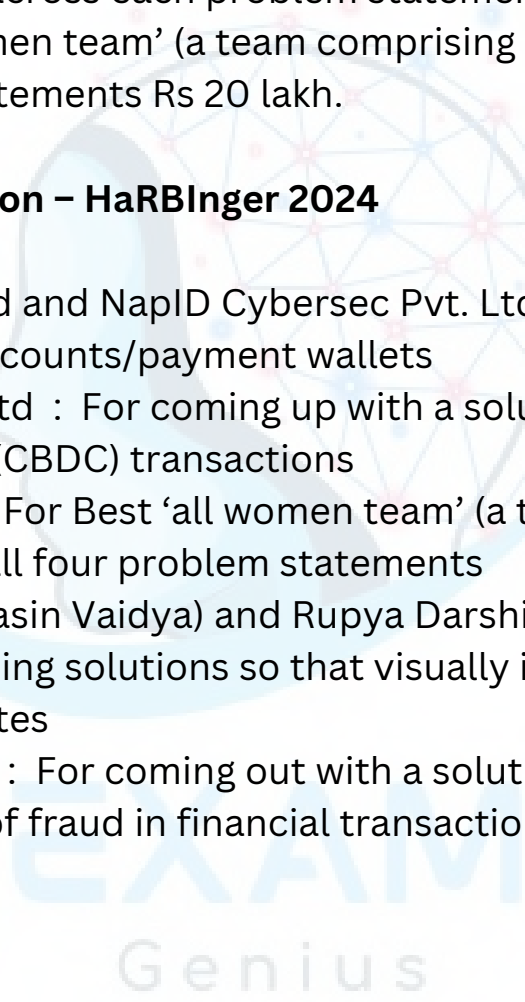


Explanation :

- The Reserve Bank announced the winners of its 3rd Global Hackathon, themed 'Zero Financial Frauds' and 'Being Divyang Friendly'.
- The hackathon got 534 submissions, 39 of which came from teams outside India, including the United States, UK, Hong Kong, Singapore, Brazil, and Morocco.
- Five winners were chosen for solving a set of problem statements.
- Prize money for Winners across each problem statement is Rs 40 lakh.
- Prize money Best 'all-women team' (a team comprising only women members), across all four problem statements Rs 20 lakh.

Winners of Global Hackathon – HaRBInger 2024

- Epifi Technologies Pvt. Ltd and NapID Cybersec Pvt. Ltd : For bringing in solutions to identifying mule bank accounts/payment wallets
- Xaults Technologies Pvt Ltd : For coming up with a solution ensuring transaction anonymity in token-based (CBDC) transactions
- VisAst (Krimisha Deore) : For Best 'all women team' (a team comprising of only women members), across all four problem statements
- H Vision India Pvt. Ltd. (Hasin Vaidya) and Rupya Darshini (Parthiban R., Jebaraj V. and Gobika S.) : For providing solutions so that visually impaired people can accurately identify banknotes
- FPL Technologies Pvt Ltd : For coming out with a solution for real time prediction, detection and prevention of fraud in financial transactions which called 'OneRadar'





Ques : Who maintains the Floating Rate Savings Bonds (Taxable) FRSB interest rate at 8.05% from January 1 to June 30, 2025 ?

- (a) NABARD
- (b) RBI
- (c) EPFO
- (d) SEBI
- (e) NPCI

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The RBI has declared that the interest rate for RBI Floating Rate Savings Bonds (Taxable) FRSB 2020 (T) will stay at 8.05% from January 1 to June 30, 2025.
- The rate will be 7.70% for the National Savings Certificate (NSC) with an additional 0.35% margin.
- RBI FRSB interest is taxable and cannot be deducted. TDS applies if annual interest exceeds Rs.10,000.
- Bonds need a minimum investment of Rs.1,000, with further investments in multiples of Rs.1,000 and no maximum limit. The bonds cannot serve as security for loans.
- The RBI FRSB has a seven-year lock-in period and does not permit early withdrawals, save for senior citizens.

Ques : Who is set to become the next chairman of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) on January 14, 2025?

- (a) Dr. K Sivan
- (b) Dr. V Narayanan
- (c) Dr. A S Kiran Kumar
- (d) Dr. Sivanathan
- (e) Dr. M Annadurai

Answer : Option B



Explanation :

- Dr. V Narayanan, a famous scientist of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), is expected to succeed S. Somanath as chairman on January 14, 2025.
- He is currently the Director of the Liquid Propulsion Systems Centre (LPSC), where he has made significant contributions to India's space ambitions for nearly four decades.
- Dr. Narayanan joined ISRO in 1984 and has held several key positions during his career. His knowledge in rocket and spacecraft propulsion has proven useful on a number of important projects.
- Somanath became Secretary of the Department of Space on January 14, 2022, for a three-year term.
- Narayanan's specialty is in rocket and spacecraft propulsion. He served as the Project Director for the GSLV Mk III vehicle's C25 cryogenic project. Under his supervision, the team successfully produced the C25 Stage, which is an important component of the GSLV Mk III.
- He received his M.Tech in Cryogenic Engineering with First Rank from IIT-Kharagpur in 1989 and began working at the Liquid Propulsion Systems Centre's Cryogenic Propulsion division.

About Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO) :

- Founded – 15 August 1969
- Headquarters – Bangalore, Karnataka
- Founder / 1st Chairman – Vikram Sarabhai
- 10th Chairman – V Narayanan (replace S. Somanath)





Ques : Which edition of Ammunition- Cum TorpedoCum Missile (ACTCM) Barge conducted by Indian Navy ?

- (a) 4th
- (b) 5th
- (c) 7th
- (d) 8th
- (e) 10th

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Indian Navy inducted its eighth ACTCM barge, LSAM 22 (Yard 132), during a ceremony at the Naval Dockyard in Mumbai.
- The ceremony was attended by Commodore Vinay Venkataram, Officer-in-Charge, Fleet Maintenance Unit (Mumbai), as the principal guest.
- On March 5, 2021, a contract was signed with M/s Suryadipta Projects Pvt. Ltd., a Thane-based MSME shipyard, to construct and deliver eleven ACTCM Barges.
- The MSME shipyard has obtained a contract to build and deliver 4 Sullage Barges for the Navy.

Ques : Who has been appointed as the Secretary of the Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance?

- (a) Ajay Seth
- (b) Tuhin Kanta Pandey
- (c) Rajiv Kumar
- (d) Tarun Bajaj
- (e) Sanjay Malhotra

Answer : Option B





Explanation :

- The Cabinet Appointments Committee (ACC) has accepted Tuhin Kanta Pandey's appointment as Secretary, Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance.
- He now serves as Secretary of the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM). Meanwhile, Pandey will continue to serve as the Finance Secretary.
- In a parallel move, Arunish Chawla, who is currently Secretary of Revenue in the Ministry of Finance, has been appointed Secretary of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM), succeeding Tuhin Kanta Pandey.
- Chawla has also been appointed Secretary of the Department of Public Enterprises in the Ministry of Finance, as well as Secretary of Culture.

Ques : What percentage of the budgetary allocation was utilized by Indian Railways for capital expenditure in FY25?

- (a) 45%
- (b) 55%
- (c) 60%
- (d) 76%
- (e) 84%

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- In FY25, Indian Railways exceeded Rs.2 lakh crore in capital expenditure (capex), making up 76% of its budget.
- The Union Budget for FY25 allocates Rs.2.65 lakh crore to Indian Railways, with a Gross Budgetary Support (GBS) of Rs.2.52 lakh crore.
- By December 2024, Indian Railways spent over Rs.2 lakh crore, including Rs.1.91 lakh crore from the GBS, Rs.824 crore from external resources, and Rs.8,733 crore from extra-budgetary sources.





Ques : Inauguration of the Adivasi Mela 2025, ahead of the Pravasi Bharatiya Divas(PBD) program, at the Exhibition Grounds in which state ?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) Telangana

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Mohan Charan Majhi, Chief Minister of Odisha, opened the Adivasi Mela 2025 at the Exhibition Grounds in Bhubaneswar, ahead of the Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD) event.
- During the ceremony, the Shahid Madho Singh Haath Kharcha Scheme was established with a budget of Rs 156 crore to support tribal students. Additionally, nine tribal talents and ten tribal farmers were recognized for their remarkable accomplishments.
- Shaheed Madho Singh, a freedom fighter and tribal landowner from the Ghansa area of Bargarh district, Odisha
- Its aims is to reduce dropout rates and increase students' interest in education
- Tribal students who pass Class 8 and join Class 9 or 10 will receive a one-time incentive of Rs.5,000 per year Students and enrolling in Class 11 will also be eligible for this benefit
- It is Implemented for Current academic year 2024-2025
- Scheduled Tribe(ST) students whose annual family income does not exceed Rs 2,50,000 are eligible for the scheme.





Ques : Which country Joins BRICS as 10th Full Member ?

- (a) Indonesia
- (b) Sweden
- (c) Bhutan
- (d) Mauritius
- (e) Dubai

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Indonesia, the world's fourth-most populous nation, has joined the BRICS (Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa) alliance as the tenth full member, as announced by Brazil, the BRICS chair for 2025.
- The participation of Indonesia corresponds with Brazil's presidency theme, "Enhancing Global South Cooperation for a More Inclusive and Sustainable Governance."
- In 2024, BRICS expanded to include Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and the UAE.

About Brics :

- Established : 2006
- HQ : Shanghai
- Members : Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates and Indonesia

Ques : As the year 2025 brought upon the world the 'Generation Beta', India got its first baby of this generation on New Year's Day, January 1 in which state ?

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Mizoram
- (c) Assam
- (d) Manipur
- (e) Meghalaya

Answer : Option B



Explanation :

- On New Year's Day, January 1, 2025, India welcomed its first 'Generation Beta' baby in Aizawl, Mizoram
- The infant, Frankie Remruatdika Zadeng, is India's first kid from Generation Beta.
- Frankie's birth is significant since he belongs to Generation Beta, which refers to youngsters born between 2025 and 2039.
- Australian futurist Mark McCrindle coined the term "Generation Beta" to refer to the demographic group following Generation Alpha (2010-2024).

All the Generation Names and Years :

- The Greatest Generation : 1901–1927
- The Silent Generation : 1928–1945
- Baby Boom Generation : 1946–1964
- Generation X : 1965–1980
- Millennial Generation (Gen Y) : 1981–1996
- Generation Z (iGen) : 1997–2010
- Generation Alpha : 2010–2024
- Generation Beta : 2025–2039

EXAM
Genius





Recent News Headlines Related to First in India and World :

- Noble Hospitals and Research Centre in Pune, Maharashtra has installed the first made-in-India surgical robot, the SSI Mantra (Multi-Arm Novel Tele Robotic Assistance).
- 'Nadi Tarangini', an indigenously designed pulse diagnostic instrument, has been India's first Ayurvedic medical device to be approved for use by the Central Drugs Standard Control Organization (CDSCO).
- The Gujarat government will conduct the country's first census of coastal and wader birds in the Marine National Park and Sanctuary in Jamnagar.
- In a first, Chhattisgarh state has devised an innovative concept that combines forest ecosystem services with Green Gross Domestic Product (Green GDP).
- Kanyakumari, Tamil Nadu's famed tourist resort, has added another pearl to its crown. India's first glass bridge across the sea was inaugurated.
- Devi Ahilyabai Holkar Airport in Indore has been officially declared India's first Zero-Waste Airport.
- Uttarakhand has recently inaugurated its first wine production unit in Kotdwar, which is part of the government's new excise policy aimed at promoting wine tourism.
- The Punjab Chief Minister, Bhagwant Singh Mann, approved the Punjab State (Development and Promotion of Sports) Act, 2024, making it the first state in the country to do so.
- Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone (APSEZ) Mundra welcomed CMA CGM Fort Diamant, the first LNG-powered container vessel to berth at the port's Container Terminal-CT4.
- Uttar Pradesh is the first state to connect its procurement process with the Centre's Govt e-Marketplace (GeM), replacing its traditional tendering system.
- Masali, a village in Gujarat's Banaskantha district, has become India's first 'solar village' near the border, a key milestone in the country's renewable energy efforts.
- Uttarakhand, often known as "Devbhoomi," will be the first Indian state to enact a specific Yoga Policy, aiming to make the state a global yoga destination.





Ques : In which city was the British Junior Open 2024 held?

- (a) London
- (b) Manchester
- (c) Edinburgh
- (d) Glasgow
- (e) Birmingham

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- In squash, India's Anahat Singh won the Under 17 Girl's Singles title at the British Junior Open in Birmingham, England.
- In the summit showdown, India's 16-year-old top seed defeated Egypt's Malika El Karaksy 3-2.
- Anahat won her third British Junior Open championship, having previously won in the Under-11 division in 2019 and the Under-15 category in 2023.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Martin Guptill announced his retirement from international cricket at the age of 38. He is from which country?

- (a) England
- (b) New Zealand
- (c) Australia
- (d) South Africa
- (e) Ireland

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Martin Guptill, a New Zealand cricketer, has announced his retirement from international cricket at the age of 38.
- During his 14-year career, he scored over 14 thousand runs in 367 matches and smashed 23 international hundreds.
- He played 198 ODIs, 122 T20Is, and 47 Tests, making his debut against the West Indies in 2009.
- Guptill has the record for the highest individual score in an ODI World Cup. In the 2015 World Cup, he scored 237 not out from 163 balls.
- Guptill will continue to play T20 franchise cricket across the world in the near future.

EXAM
Genius





Recently Retired Players :

- Rishi Dhawan : Retirement from Indian limited overs cricket
- Ravichandran Ashwin (Indian) : International cricket
- Imad Wasim (Pakistan) : International cricket
- Siddarth Kaul (Indian) : cricket
- Emma McKeon (Australia): professional swimming
- Rafael Nadal (Spain) : professional tennis
- Tim Southee (New Zealand) : international cricket
- Mohammad Nabi (Afghanistan) : Retire from ODI Cricket
- Wriddhiman Saha (India) : retired from all cricket formats
- Rani Rampal : Retirement from Hockey
- Wicketkeeper-Batter Matthew Wade : Retires from International Cricket
- Andres Iniesta (Spain) : Retirement from professional football
- Rafael Nadal (from Spain) : Retirement from professional tennis
- Dipa Karmakar : Retirement from gymnastics
- Dwayne Bravo : All forms of cricket
- Luis Suarez (Uruguay) : National football team
- Moeen Ali (England) : Retirement from international cricket
- Shannon Gabriel (West Indies) : Retirement from international cricket
- Dawid Malan (England) : Retirement from international cricket
- Shikhar Dhawan (India) : All forms of cricket
- Ilkay Gundogan (Germany) : International football
- Ashwini Ponnappa : Badminton
- Rohan Bopanna (India) : international tennis
- PR Sreejesh (India) : international hockey

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Agnes Keleti was the world's oldest living Olympic gold medalist in which sport?

- (a) Tennis
- (b) Gymnastic
- (c) Badminton
- (d) Wushu
- (e) Archery

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Agnes Keleti, the oldest remaining Olympic gold medalist and Holocaust survivor, passed away at the age of 103.
- Keleti, a five-time Olympic champion from Hungary, earned her first gold medal at the age of 31 in Helsinki in 1952, followed by four more in Melbourne in 1956, making her the oldest female gymnast to win gold.
- Keleti is the second-most successful Hungarian athlete of all time, with 10 Olympic medals, five of which are gold.

EXAM
Genius





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA) has achieved 'Excellent' rating for the performance MoU signed with the Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (MNRE) for the financial year 2023-24, with a score of 98.24.

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) lifted the supervisory restrictions imposed on two non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) – Asirvad Micro Finance Limited and DMI Finance Private Limited.

Bank of Baroda enhanced its "Employee Assistance Program" (EAP) to prioritise the emotional, mental, and psychological well-being of its over 75,000 employees and their families. Partnering with Truworth Wellness, the Bank has introduced an upgraded version of the EAP, reinforcing its commitment to a supportive work environment.

The Gujarat government has approved the bifurcation of Banaskantha district to form a new administrative unit named Vav-Tharad district, with its headquarters in Tharad town. This decision will increase the number of districts in Gujarat to 34.

Banaskantha, which has 14 talukas, is the second-largest district in Gujarat by area and currently houses the highest number of talukas in the state. Vav-Tharad district will encompass eight talukas.

Edelweiss Financial Services Limited (EFSL) has announced the public issue of Secured Redeemable Non-Convertible Debentures (NCDs) with a total issue size of up to Rs. 2,000 million. The offering includes a base issue of Rs. 1,000 million and a green shoe option to retain an additional Rs. 1,000 million.





Ques : Mirae Asset Investment Managers (India) Pvt. Ltd. has launched a new fund named Mirae Asset Smallcap Fund. Which of the following statements about the fund is correct?

- (a) It is an open-ended equity scheme focusing on smallcap stocks
- (b) It primarily invests in large-cap stocks to ensure stability
- (c) The fund exclusively focuses on midcap stocks
- (d) It is a closed-ended debt scheme targeting short-term investments
- (e) It aims to invest in both smallcap and cryptocurrency markets

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Mirae Asset Investment Managers (India) Pvt. Ltd. has established the Mirae Asset Smallcap Fund, an open-ended equity plan that focuses primarily on smallcap stocks.
- Senior Fund Manager Varun Goel will manage the fund, which will be benchmarked against the Nifty smallcap 250 Total Return Index (TRI).
- The New Fund Offer (NFO) is open for subscription on January 10 and expires on January 24, with a minimum initial investment of Rs 5,000. Regular trading will begin on February 3, with further investments allowed in multiples of Rs 1.
- The fund's strategy includes investing at least 65 percent of its portfolio in smallcap firms, with the option of allocating up to 35 percent to mid and largecap stocks. It will focus on quality stocks with long-term high profits growth, solid capital efficiency, and good corporate governance.





Ques : ICICI Lombard General Insurance has partnered with __ to offer insurance cover for people travelling to the Maha Kumbh Mela.

- (a) Paytm
- (b) Cashfree
- (c) PhonePe
- (d) Google Pay
- (e) Razorpay

Answer : option C

Explanation :

- PhonePe has partnered with ICICI Lombard General Insurance to provide insurance coverage for travelers visiting the Maha Kumbh Mela.
- The insurance plan will be available from January 13, 2024 to February 25, 2025 in two forms.
- This economical insurance package is offered in two options: Rs 59 per traveler for train or bus, and Rs 99 for domestic flights.
- Maximum sum insured is Rs 1 lakh.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Microfinance Institutions Network established in which year ?

- (a) 2003
- (b) 2005
- (c) 2009
- (d) 2010
- (e) 2011

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Microfinance Institutions Network (MFIN), a self-regulatory organization (SRO) for the microfinance sector, has announced a three-month delay in adopting a new rule that limits the number of lenders per borrower to three, down from four, to mitigate risks.
- The regulation's implementation date has been pushed out to April 1, 2025, from its original January 1, 2025 deadline.
- On January 1, 2025, further regulations were implemented, including a loan cap of Rs.2 lakh per borrower and a ban on lending to delinquent consumers.
- Members were directed to stop making loans to consumers with overdue amounts over ₹3,000 and waiting for more than 60 days.

Ques : What is the revised GDP growth forecast for India by SBI for FY25?

- (a) 6.1%
- (b) 6.2%
- (c) 6.3%
- (d) 6.4%
- (e) 6.5%

Answer : Option C



Explanation :

- The National Statistical Office (NSO) had predicted that India's GDP will expand by 6.4 percent in the fiscal year 2024–2025 (FY25), however the State Bank of India (SBI) has lowered its estimate to 6.3%.
- SBI's modification reflects concerns about a slowdown in lending and manufacturing, as well as the impact of a big base effect from the previous year.
- According to NSO data, agriculture and related activities are expected to rise by 3.8% in FY25, up from 1.4% in FY24, owing to strong policy measures and public infrastructure development.

Updated GDP List :

- SBI – 6.3% (FY25)
- NSO – 6.4% (FY25)
- RBI – 6.6% (FY24)
- Deloitte – 6.5% – 6.8% (FY24), 6.7% – 7.3% (FY26)
- India Ratings – 6.4% (FY24), 6.6% (FY26)
- ADB – 6.5% (FY24), 7% (FY25)
- S&P – 6.8% (FY25), 6.9% (FY26)
- RBI – 6.6% (FY24)
- Morgan Stanley – 6.3% (FY25)

Ques : Which state has launched the 'Bima Sakhi Yojana' recently ?

- (a) Himachal Pradesh
- (b) Maharashtra
- (c) Goa
- (d) Punjab
- (e) Gujarat

Answer : Option C



Explanation :

- Pramod Sawant, the Chief Minister of Goa, has started the 'Bima Sakhi Yojana' in the state with the goal of providing "insurance for all".
- Goa became the second state, after Haryana, to start Prime Minister Narendra Modi's flagship plan.
- According to the central government's homepage, the Bima Sakhi Yojana project of Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) is intended to empower women aged 18 to 70 who have completed Class X.
- After training, individuals can work as LIC agents, and graduates like Bima Sakhis can be considered for LIC development officer positions.
- Bima Sakhis will be trained and paid a monthly stipend of Rs 7,000 in the first year, Rs 6,000 in the second, and Rs 5,000 in the third year.
- Overall, these Bima Sakhis would receive Rs 2.16 lakh over the course of three years.
- The special scheme intends to improve life insurance coverage at the grassroots level, in addition to empowering women.

Ques : According to a United Nations report, by what percentage is the Indian economy expected to expand in 2025?

- (a) 6.4%
- (b) 6.6%
- (c) 6.8%
- (d) 7%
- (e) 7.2%

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- According to a United Nations estimate, the Indian economy is expected to grow by 6.6% in 2025, driven mostly by strong private consumption and investment.
- According to the United Nations' World Economic Situation and Prospects 2025, the near-term outlook for South Asia is expected to remain robust, with growth projected at 5.7% in 2025 and 6.0% in 2026, "driven by strong performance in India as well as economic recovery in a few other economies," including Bhutan, Nepal, and Sri Lanka.
- The Indian economy increased by 6.8% in 2024 and is expected to grow by 6.6% in 2025. The Indian economy is expected to return to 6.8% growth by 2026.



Ques : Study in India (SII) portal Launched in which year ?

- (a) 2016
- (b) 2018
- (c) 2019
- (d) 2021
- (e) 2022

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has developed two new specialized visa categories, the 'e-student visa' and the 'e-student-x visa', to let overseas students pursue higher education at Indian schools.
- Eligible overseas students registered on the Study in India (SII) portal can apply for the e-student visa. The e-student-x visa is for dependents of e-student visa holders.
- The e-student visa is for foreign citizens participating in full-time formal programs at India-recognized institutions, including UG, PG, and PhD.
- Valid for up to five years depending on course duration, with extensions available in India.

About the Study in India (SII) portal :

- Launched : 2018
- Aim : to streamline the admission process for international students pursuing higher education in India
- Scholarship : The SII Scholarship, valued at USD 3,200, is awarded to students who excel in the PRAGATII Exam





Ques : What is the Rank of India in Henley Passport Index 2025 Published by Henley ?

- (a) 78th
- (b) 80th
- (c) 82nd
- (d) 84th
- (e) 85th

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Henley Passport Index 2025 Published by Henley
- According to the Henley Passport Index 2025, India's position has decreased from 80th to 85th among the world's most powerful passports.
- The Indian passport provides visa-free or visa-on-arrival access to 57 places.
- Singapore and Japan have secured the top two positions.

Ranking of top 5 and last countries :

- 1 Singapore (195 destinations)
- 2 Japan (193 destinations)
- 3 Finland, France, Germany, Italy, South Korea, Spain (192 destinations)
- 4 Austria, Denmark, Ireland, Luxembourg, Netherlands, Norway, Sweden (191 destinations)
- 5 Belgium, New Zealand, Portugal, Switzerland, United Kingdom (190 destinations)
- 60 China (85 destinations)
- 85 India (57 destinations)
- 90 Bhutan (50 destinations)
- 96 Sri Lanka (44 destinations)
- 101 Nepal (39 destinations)
- 103 Pakistan (33 destinations)
- 106 Afghanistan (26 destinations)





India's Rankings in Different Indices

- ThreatLandscape Report 2024 Published by CloudSEK : India (2nd), United States (top)
- Global Aging Index Published by National University of Singapore (NUS) & Columbia University : India (123rd), Switzerland (top)
- Hurun India Top 200 Self-Made Entrepreneurs of the Millennia 2024 Published by Hurun India & IDFC FIRST Private Banking : Kaivalya Vohra (Zepto) (Youngest), Ashok Soota (Happiest Minds Technologies) (Oldest)
- Travel and Tourism Development Index (TTDI) 2024 Published by World Economic Forum (WEF) : India (39th), United States (Top)
- 2025 QS Sustainability Rankings Published by QS Rankings : IIT Delhi (171), University of Toronto (Canada) (top)
- SBTi commitments by Indian companies Published by ICRA ESG Ratings Limited : India (6th), United Kingdom (UK) (top)
- "world's worst airlines" in the 2024 AirHelp Score survey : IndiGo (103rd), Brussels Airlines (top)
- Interdisciplinary Science Rankings (ISR) 2025 Published by Times Higher Education (THE) : Anna University in Chennai (Tamil Nadu, TN) (42nd), Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) (USA) (top)
- 2024 Network Readiness Index (NRI) Published by Portulans Institute and Saïd Business School : India (49th), United States of America (top)
- Sustainable Trade Index 2024 Published by Hinrich Foundation and IMD : India (23rd), New Zealand (top)
- Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) 2025 : India (10th), Denmark (last)
- Brand Finance's Global City Index Published by Brand Finance : London (top), New Delhi (77), Mumbai (78)
- WJP Rule of Law Index 2024 Published by World Justice Project (WJP) : India (79th), Denmark (top)
- World Intellectual Property Indicators Report 2024 : India (6th), China (top)
- EdelGive-Hurun India Philanthropy List 2024 : Shiv Nadar & Family (top)
- AI Preparedness Index (API) Published by IMF : India (72nd), Singapore (top)
- Henley Passport Index 2024 : India (83rd), Singapore (top)
- Global Nature Conservation Index for 2024 : India (176th), Luxembourg (top)
- 2024 100 Most Powerful Women (MPW) in Business 27th Edition Published by Fortune : Mary Barra, CEO of General Motors (USA) (top)



Ques : Which IIT has successfully commissioned Asia's largest shallow wave basin at its Discovery campus in Thaiyur ?

- (a) IIT Guwahati
- (b) IIT Delhi
- (c) IIT Madras
- (d) IIT Indore
- (e) IIT Roorkee

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- IIT-Madras has successfully commissioned Asia's largest shallow wave basin at its Discovery campus at Thaiyur.
- Collaborators: National Technology Centre for Ports, Waterways, and Coasts (NTCPWC), Ministry of Shipping.
- The research facility aims to handle complex coastal engineering challenges and contribute significantly to marine science and engineering.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which wars did Havaladar (retd) Baldev Singh participate in?

- (a) Four wars against Pakistan
- (b) Two wars against Pakistan and one against China
- (c) Three wars against Pakistan and one peacekeeping mission
- (d) One war against Pakistan and the Kargil conflict
- (e) Only one war during the 1965 India-Pakistan conflict

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Veteran soldier Havaladar (retd) Baldev Singh, who fought four wars against Pakistan, died at his home in Jammu and Kashmir's Rajouri district. He was 93.
- Singh, born on September 27, 1931, in Naunihal village, was just 16 years old when he volunteered to join the Bal Sena Force, led by Brigadier Usman, Commander of the 50 Para Brigade, during the battles of Naushera and Jhangar in 1947-48.
- In honor of their valor, then-Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru presented the Bal Sainiks with gramophones, watches, and the opportunity to join the Army.
- Singh joined the Army on November 14, 1950, and served it with dedication and courage for nearly three decades. He served in several wars, including the 1961, 1962, and 1965 India-Pakistan wars.

Genius





Ques : Which state has launched the first phase of its flagship education evaluation programme, Gunotsav 2025 ?

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Mizoram
- (c) Assam
- (d) Manipur
- (e) Meghalaya

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Assam government has inaugurated the first phase of its flagship education evaluation initiative, Gunotsav 2025.
- This effort aims to examine education quality and enhance learning outcomes for 14.11 lakh pupils in the state.
- The "Ensuring Quality Education" program will be implemented in three phases across several schools and districts.

Phases of Gunotsav :

- Phase 1 January 6-9, 2025 (11 districts)
- Phase 2 January 17-22, 2025 (14 districts)
- Phase 3 February 5-8, 2025 (10 districts)

About Assam :

- Capital : Dispur
- CM : Himanta Biswa Sarma
- Governor : Lakshman Acharya





Ques : What is the name of the initiative launched by NITI Aayog's Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP) in collaboration with New Shop?

- (a) EmpowHER Biz – Sapno Ki Udaan
- (b) Women on the Rise
- (c) Empower Women Entrepreneurs
- (d) Sapne Saakar – Women in Business
- (e) Entrepreneurial Growth for Women

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- NITI Aayog's Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP) has developed EmpowHER Biz - Sapno Ki Udaan in collaboration with New Shop, India's largest 24/7 convenience shop chain, as part of its Award to Reward (ATR) program.
- This initiative seeks to empower female entrepreneurs by providing them with the knowledge and resources they need to succeed in the organized retail industry.
- EmpowHER Biz will provide mentorship and thorough training to ambitious female entrepreneurs, covering retail management, digital tools, financial literacy, and business development.
- Under the program, fifty volunteers aged 18 to 35 will be chosen through an online application procedure based on predetermined criteria. The top twenty of these competitors will earn a 100% remission of New Shop franchise fees.
- The initiative is being offered for women in Delhi-NCR, Punjab, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Madhya Pradesh, and Gujarat.
- WEP, which began as an aggregator platform at NITI Aayog in 2018, will shift to a public-private partnership in 2022.





Ques : India and which country have announced a strategic partnership aimed at co-producing sonobuoys for Undersea Domain Awareness (UDA) within the Indian Navy ?

- (a) Spain
- (b) China
- (c) USA
- (d) France
- (e) UK

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- India and the US have partnered to co-produce US sonobuoys for the Indian Navy's underwater domain awareness (UDA).
- Ultra Marine (UM), a US-based leader in underwater combat technology, and Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL) will collaborate to build sonobuoys.
- Sonobuoys are vital for detecting submarines in the ocean and enhancing maritime security.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : The AWBI operates under the Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying, which is a part of which larger Ministry?

- (a) Union Ministry of Home Affairs
- (b) Union Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying
- (c) Union Ministry of Power
- (d) Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- (e) Union Ministry of Heavy Industries

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Animal Welfare Board of India (AWBI), a statutory agency under the Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying of the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry, and Dairying, has signed a MOU with NALSAR University of Law in Hyderabad.
- The MoU established a strategic cooperation to provide high-quality, professional legal training to civil society individuals who aid District Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals (SPCAs) and State Animal Welfare Boards in their efforts to help animals.
- The training will be conducted in batches, with a maximum of 25 participants each session, and will last at least three days. Upon satisfactory completion of training, AWBI will offer Honorary Animal Welfare Representative (HAWR) credentials based on NALSAR assessments.

Genius





Ques : World Hindi Day celebrated every year on which day ?

- (a) 9 January
- (b) 10 January
- (c) 11 January
- (d) 12 January
- (e) 13 January

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Every year on January 10, World Hindi Day, also known as 'Vishwa Hindi Diwas', is observed to promote Hindi as one of the world's most frequently spoken languages, alongside English and Mandarin.
- Theme 2025: A Global Voice of Unity and Cultural Pride.
- On September 14, 1949, the Constituent Assembly of India designated Hindi written in the Devanagari script as the official language of the Republic of India.
- While Hindi became one of India's official languages, the Indian Constitution does not designate a language as the national language.
- Hindi, along with 21 other languages, has official status. The decision underlined the importance of respecting India's multilingual history.





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

John Mahama has been sworn in for a second term as Ghana's president at a ceremony in the capital Accra. Mahama takes over from outgoing President Nana Akufo-Addo, who served two terms in power.

Ajit Doval, the country's national security adviser, and Raja Dato Nushirwan Bin Zainal Abidin, the director general of the National Security Council of Malaysia in New Delhi, co-chaired the first India-Malaysia Security Dialogue, wherein the two countries decided to strengthen their cooperation in the areas of cyber security, maritime security, defense industry, and counterterrorism and deradicalization.

KredX, India's largest supply chain finance platform, has secured the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) final approval to commercially launch its Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) platform under the brand name DTX (Domestic Trade Exchange).

Coal India Limited (CIL) and Indian Rare Earths Limited (IREL) Partner to collaborate on the development of critical minerals. Coal India Limited (CIL) Established in 1975 and headquarter is in Kolkata, West Bengal.

NRI or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is observed every year on 9 January to mark the contribution of the overseas Indian community towards the development of India.

National Commission for Women (NCW), in collaboration with the Lok Sabha Secretariat and the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, inaugurated 'Panchayat Se Parliament 2.0' at the Central Hall of Samvidhan Sadan. This initiative commemorates the 150th birth anniversary of Bhagwan Birsa Munda, a revered tribal leader and freedom fighter.





Ques : Who Introduced New 15-Day Credit Reporting Rule Effective from January 1, 2025 ?

- (a) NABARD
- (b) RBI
- (c) EPFO
- (d) SEBI
- (e) NPCI

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has implemented new credit reporting rules. Lenders are now required to update credit bureau information every 15 days, rather than monthly. This directive went into force on January 1, 2025.
- Under the previous monthly reporting method, late payments or defaults could take up to 40 days to appear on a borrower's credit report. The new 15-day reporting cycle will keep credit histories up to current.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which organisation has partnered with IIMA Ventures to launch Swanari TechSprint 3.0, a programme aimed at fostering women-centric fintech startups in India ?

- (a) National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)
- (b) Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)
- (c) Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH)
- (d) Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
- (e) Indian Banks' Association (IBA)

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Reserve Bank Innovation Hub and IIMA Ventures have launched Swanari TechSprint 3.0, a program targeted at fostering women-centric financial firms in India.
- The curriculum allows fintech innovators to conceptualize, create, and scale solutions that target women's specific financial needs.
- The initiative seeks applications from businesses developing gender-inclusive financial solutions, particularly those with a proven MVP/Product, in the pre-Seed to pre-Series A fundraising stage, or those have already generated revenue or traction.

Ques : What is the name of the new insurance plan introduced by RenewBuy?

- (a) RenewBuy Life Care Plan
- (b) RenewBuy Smart Term Plan
- (c) RenewBuy Secure Policy
- (d) RenewBuy Comprehensive Insurance
- (e) RenewBuy Term Shield

Answer : Option B



Explanation :

- RenewBuy, an online insurance company, has launched the RenewBuy Smart Term Plan under its RB Proprietary line.
- The strategy seeks to simplify term insurance for Indian consumers by tackling typical issues such as complexity, affordability, and policy duration.
- The Smart Term Plan is specifically designed for working professionals and small company owners. It addresses issues such as determining appropriate coverage and controlling long-term premiums.
- In its initial phase, RenewBuy collaborated with LIC, ICICI Prudential, and Digit Life to reach a large client base, particularly in underdeveloped Tier 2-3 areas.
- The plan provides choices including "10 Years Pay," which allows policyholders to pay premiums over 10 years for coverage up to Rs.1 crore till age 80 or beyond.

EXAM
Genius





Recent Facilities Launched in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- Mirae Asset Investment Managers (India) Pvt. Ltd. has established the Mirae Asset Smallcap Fund, an open-ended equity plan that focuses primarily on smallcap stocks.
- Go Digit-Life Insurance Limited (Digit-Life), a major new-age digital insurer, has introduced its first individual pure-term life insurance policy, "Digit Glow Term Life Insurance."
- IndiaBonds.com, a SEBI-registered Stock Broker (Debt Segment) and licensed Online Bond website Provider (OBPP), now offers Digital Fixed Deposits (FDs) on its website.
- Punjab & Sind Bank, a state-owned bank, will launch a quick loan scheme for the MSME sector of up to Rs 25 lakh this month as part of its initiative to expand lending through its digital platform.
- Union Bank of India has improved digital accessibility by introducing additional features to its Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) app, often known as the Digital Rupee (e₹).
- Federal Bank, one of India's leading private sector banks, has unveiled FedOne, a new transaction banking platform built on Nucleus Software's FinnAxia technology
- YES Bank Limited & Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry(FICCI) Ladies Organisation (FLO) Launched 'YES PowherUp' to empower women entrepreneur in promoting their businesses
- ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has established the ICICI Prudential Rural Opportunities Fund, an open-ended equity strategy focused on rural and adjacent themes. It starts on January 9, 2025 and ends on January 25, 2025.
- ICICI Prudential Life Insurance has introduced a first-of-its-kind health insurance that covers women's critical illnesses and procedures.
- Shriram Finance Limited, a financial services company, has developed a new vertical to manage all of its green finance commitments.
- Poonawalla Fincorp, a non-banking finance company under Cyrus Poonawalla Group, has implemented AI in HR operations to reduce risks and increase hiring accuracy.





Ques : Mukhyamantri Maiya Samman Yojana Launched by which government ?

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Jharkhand
- (c) Assam
- (d) Bihar
- (e) Meghalaya

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Mukhyamantri Maiya Samman Yojana Launched by Jharkhand government.
- Initially it was launched in August 2024 by Chief Minister Hemant Soren.
- Its aim is to enhance the financial security of women by providing direct cash transfers.
- Initial Benefit was Rs.1,000 per month per beneficiary and now it has been Increased to Rs.2,500 per month
- Women aged 21 to 49 years get the benefit of the yojana.
- Till date the amount Transferred is Rs.1,415.44 crore to 56.61 lakh women beneficiaries.

About Jharkhand :

- Capital : Ranchi
- CM : Hemant Soren
- Governor : Santosh Kumar Gangwar

EXAM
Genius





Ques : At 116 years old, Sister Inah Canabarro Lucas has been confirmed as the world's oldest living person by LongeviQuest. She is from which Country ?

- (a) Spain
- (b) Italy
- (c) Brazil
- (d) UK
- (e) None of these

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Sister Inah Canabarro Lucas, 116, is the world's oldest living person, according to LongeviQuest. She lives in Rio Grande do Sul, Brazil.
- Her confirmation follows the death of Tomiko Itooka of Japan on December 29, 2024.
- A longtime nun, teacher, and soccer enthusiast, Lucas has made history as the 20th oldest person ever recorded and the second-oldest nun in documented history

Ques : Which country has launched its first certificate course in Hindi on the occasion of the World Hindi Day in 2025?

- (a) Sri Lanka
- (b) Nepal
- (c) Bhutan
- (d) India
- (e) Bangladesh

Answer : Option A





Explanation :

- On the occasion of Hindi Diwas, the Indian High Commission in Sri Lanka established the country's first Hindi Certificate Course through open and distant learning.
- The certificate course was inaugurated during the Bharat-Sri Lanka Hindi Sammelan in Colombo on January 10, 2025, to commemorate World Hindi Day.
- The establishment of the Hindi course in Sri Lanka was part of the Ministry of External Affairs' efforts to promote the Hindi language worldwide.
- The Open University of Sri Lanka is launching a Hindi certificate course in partnership with the Swami Vivekananda Cultural Centre (SVCC), the cultural arm of India's High Commission in Colombo, Sri Lanka.

About Sri Lanka :

- Legislative capital – Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte
- Executive and Judicial capital – Colombo
- Currency – Sri Lankan rupee
- President – Anura Kumara Dissanayake;9th (replace Ranil Wickremesinghe)
- Prime Minister – Harini Amarasuriya

Ques : Which edition of Indusfood 2025 Held at Greater Noida,Uttar Pradesh ?

- (a) 4th
- (b) 6th
- (c) 8th
- (d) 10th
- (e) 12th

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Indusfood 2025 8th Edition Held at Greater Noida,Uttar Pradesh.
- It is Inaugurated by Union Minister for Food Processing Industries Chirag Paswan and Organised by Trade Promotion Council of India (TPCI),under the Market Access Initiative (MAI) scheme of the Union Ministry of Commerce.
- Exhibitors from around 30 countries Participates in this event.
- 1st edition of Indusfood held in 2017.



Ques : Which state government partnered with Google Cloud launch AI-powered Agriculture network?

- (a) Maharashtra
- (b) Assam
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Uttar pradesh
- (e) Rajasthan

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Uttar Pradesh government has signed a Memorandum of Understanding with Google Cloud (India) to develop the Gemini-powered and Beacon-enabled Uttar Pradesh Open Network for Agriculture.
- The effort aims to provide millions of farmers with one-stop access to consulting services, loans, mechanization, and market connectivity so they can sell their produce.
- Farmers will also receive real-time, accurate information on microclimates and market pricing, which is a key step toward the state government's goal of tripling farmers' revenue.
- The open and decentralized network allows many service providers to participate, such as input suppliers, financial institutions, and government organizations, while entrepreneurs can curate and supply specialized solutions to farmers.

Genius





Recent News Headlines Related to MoU and agreement :

- Coal India Limited (CIL) and Indian Rare Earths Limited (IREL) Partner to collaborate on the development of critical minerals. Coal India Limited (CIL) Established in 1975 and headquarter is in Kolkata, West Bengal.
- Union Ministry of Cooperation and Indonesia's Ministry of Trade signed an MOU valid for four years. India will provide Indonesia with one million metric tonnes of non-basmati white rice per year at the current international pricing.
- Uttarakhand government and Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) signed an MOU to promote tourism in the border areas of the state.
- The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) has partnered with Stride Ventures, a venture debt firm, to catalyse the growth of Indian startups and widen their global footprint.
- Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) & boAt Signs MoU to nurture DPIIT-recognized startups, particularly in the Direct-to-Consumer (D2C) and manufacturing sectors.
- Swiggy Limited & National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) Partners to provide financial literacy to its delivery partners.
- The All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE) and the National Quantum Mission (NQM) have jointly launched India's first Undergraduate (UG) Minor Programme in Quantum Technologies, which will begin in the upcoming academic session.
- Uttar Pradesh and Japan's Yamanashi Prefecture signs MOU to improve economic and cultural cooperation between UP and Yamanashi, representing a growing partnership between the two nations.
- Uttar Pradesh and Manipur governments signed an MOU To implement the 'Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat' program in Lucknow, UP. Manipur is the third state to sign a MoU with Uttar Pradesh (UP) under the Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat programme after Arunachal Pradesh (AR) and Meghalaya.
- West Bengal(WB) Government and United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) signed an MOU To enhance the treatment of children affected by NonCommunicable Diseases (NCD), including juvenile diabetes.
- The National e-Governance Division (NeGD) and the Indian Ports Association (IPA) have signed a historic MoU in New Delhi to foster digital transformation in India's marine sector.





Ques : Who has been appointed as the chairperson of Equal's newly formed Advisory Board?

- (a) Justice B. N. Srikrishna
- (b) Justice Dipak Misra
- (c) Justice R. F. Nariman
- (d) Justice Arun Mishra
- (e) Justice Kurian Joseph

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- B. N. Srikrishna, a retired Supreme Court justice, will lead the newly formed Advisory Board of Equal, an ID verification and data sharing platform.
- Equal offers identity authentication services to large businesses, with digital integrations with several ID providers.
- The appointment comes as the government finalizes the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025, which will implement the DPDP Act, 2023.
- Justice Srikrishna chaired the first committee constituted by the Union Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology to develop a data protection law. The committee's report, which was submitted in 2018, was eventually rejected.
- He also led the Expert Committee on Arbitration Law, which proposed changes to the Arbitration & Conciliation Act of 1996.





Ques : Bureau of Indian Standards established in which year ?

- (a) 1956
- (b) 1965
- (c) 1977
- (d) 1987
- (e) 1985

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- On January 6, 2025, the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) celebrated its 78th Foundation Day, demonstrating its commitment to quality and innovation.
- Established on January 6, 1947, as the Indian Standards Institution (ISI), BIS was restructured under the Bureau of Indian Standards Act, 1986, to expand its statutory powers and scope.
- In 2014, there were 14 QCOs covering 106 products. Today, there are 186 covering 760 products, indicating a strong commitment to quality standards.
- Over 44.28 crore gold objects have been hallmarked, and there is increasing consumer demand for silver hallmarking, encouraging the BIS to examine its implementation.

About the Bureau of Indian Standards :

- Established : 1 April 1987
- HQ : New Delhi
- Director-General : Pramod Kumar Tiwari





Ques : What was the score achieved by SECI under the MoU with MNRE for FY 2023-24?

- (a) 85 out of 100
- (b) 90 out of 100
- (c) 96 out of 100
- (d) 80 out of 100
- (e) 98 out of 100

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Solar Energy Corporation of India Ltd (SECI) has received a "Excellent" grade for its performance under the MoU with the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) for fiscal year 2023-24, with a score of 96 out of 100.
- This achievement demonstrates SECI's unwavering commitment to operational excellence and sustaining the highest levels of corporate governance.
- SECI is critical to the development and extension of renewable energy (RE) capacity in India, with a total allocated generation capacity of more than 73 GW as of December 31, 2024.
- SECI is the country's main Renewable Energy Implementing Agency (REIA), dedicated to meeting climate targets and driving sustainable development.
- On August 30, 2024, SECI was accorded Navratna status by the Ministry of Finance.





Ques : What is the record-breaking number of participants expected for the Tata Mumbai Marathon 2025?

- (a) 30,000 runners
- (b) 40,000 runners
- (c) 50,000 runners
- (d) 60,000 runners
- (e) 70,000 runners

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The 20th edition of the Tata Mumbai Marathon, on January 19, 2025, is expected to attract a record-breaking 60,000 competitors.
- Sir Mo Farah, a well-known British long distance runner, has been named as the International Event Ambassador.
- He competed in the 5,000m and 10,000m races at the Olympics in 2012 and 2016, as well as the World Championships in 2013 and 2015.
- First man to win both the 5,000m and 10,000m titles at the Olympics and World Championships.

EXAM
Genius





Recent Headlines Related to Brand Ambassador :

- Sachin Tendulkar : Kissht, a leading digital lending platform operated by OnEMI Technology Solutions Private Limited
- Salman Khan and Tiger Shroff : Inaugural Kho Kho World Cup
- Indian Chess Prodigy D Gukesh : RBL Bank Limited
- Indian cricketer Rohit Sharma : ixigo's Trains app
- Mahendra Singh Dhoni : Eurogrip Tyres
- Mary Kom : Brand ambassador for the "Assam Rifles Half-Marathon (ARHM) 2024" in Shillong
- Rashmika Mandanna : DRA, a Chennai-based real estate developer
- Pankaj Tripathi : Festival ambassador for the Arunachal Rang Mahotsav 2024
- Abhishek Bachchan : Ramraj Cotton, a prominent traditional and ethnic wear brand
- Bollywood actor Jackie Shroff : All Living Things Environmental Film Festival (ALT EFF)
- Harbhajan Singh and Sania Mirza : Sports Ambassador by Dubai Sports Council
- Mahendra Singh Dhoni : Jharkhand Assembly Election
- Pankaj Tripathi : brand ambassador of Madhya Pradesh Tourism Department
- Sonu Sood : Brand Ambassador and Honorary Tourism Advisor for Thailand
- Rashmika Mandanna : Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre
- Manu Bhaker : Golden Bullet, a tools company
- Rahul Dravid : Shriram Finance Ltd
- Manu Bhaker : Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW)
- Sharath Kamal : first Indian ambassador for the International Table Tennis Federation (ITTF) Foundation

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Piyush Goyal, Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, has started which edition of the National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP) at the Bharat Ratna C. Subramaniam Auditorium (NASC Complex), Pusa in New Delhi ?

- (a) 5th
- (b) 6th
- (c) 7th
- (d) 8th
- (e) 9th

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Piyush Goyal, Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, has started the 8th edition of the National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP) at the Bharat Ratna C. Subramaniam Auditorium (NASC Complex), Pusa in New Delhi.
- The Agricultural & Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) hosted the event in partnership with the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI).

Details of portals revealed at the event :

- TraceNet 2.0 : It is an updated online Organic traceability solution that allows for more efficient operations and better regulatory oversight. It will assure the transparency, traceability, and conformity of organic agricultural and processed food products from farm to market.
- AgriXchange portal : The redesigned and renovated AgriXchange portal allows for more user-friendly data analysis and the development of reports and data on agricultural exports, making it available to the general public.
- Organic Promotion Portal : Farmers, FPOs, and exporters can promote their certified organic products, create trade leads, and connect with worldwide buyers.
- APEDA portal : The APEDA portal has been redesigned and refurbished to provide better user experience and information to stakeholders in agriculture and processed foods.
- NPOP site : The dedicated portal for the National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP) will improve visibility and operational efficiency for organic stakeholders.



Ques : Joseph Aoun elected as the new President of which country after a two-year-long presidential vacuum?

- (a) Namibia
- (b) Lebanon
- (c) Uruguay
- (d) Chad
- (e) Haiti

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Lebanon's parliament voted to elect Joseph Aoun, the country's army chief, as president, ending a more than two-year presidential vacuum.
- The session marked the legislature's 13th attempt to pick a successor to outgoing President Michel Aoun, whose mandate expired in October 2022.
- The president's influence in Lebanon is constrained by the power-sharing system, which requires that the president be a Maronite Christian, the prime minister be a Sunni Muslim, and the speaker of parliament be a Shiite.

About Lebanon :

- Capital : Beirut
- Currency : Lebanese pound

EXAM
Genius





Newly Appointed Prime Minister & President :

- Prime Minister of Iceland : Kristrun Frostadottir (Replaced Bjarni Benediktsson)
- President of Moldova : Ms Maia Sandu
- President of Tonga : Aisake Valu Eke
- President of Georgia : Mikheil Kavelashvili
- Prime Minister of France : Francois Bayrou
- Interim Prime Minister of Syria : Mohammad al-Bashir
- President of Ghana : John Dramani Mahama
- Prime minister of Burkina Faso : Rimalba Jean Emmanuel Ouedraogo
- President of Namibia : Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah (Replaced Nangolo Mbumba)
- Prime Minister (PM) of Lithuania : Gintautas Paluckas (Replaced Ingrida Simonyte)
- Prime Minister of Uzbekistan (3rd time) : Abdulla Nigmatovich Aripov
- President of Uruguay : Yamandu Orsi
- Prime Minister of Mali : Abdoulaye Maiga (Replaced Choguel Maiga)
- President of Somalia : Abdirahman Mohamed Abdullahi (Waddani Party) (Replaced Muse Bihi Abdi)
- Prime Minister of Haiti : Alix Didier Fils-Aime (Replaced Garry Conille)
- Prime Minister of Mauritius : Navin Ramgoolam
- 103rd Prime Minister of Japan : Leader of the Liberal Democratic Party (LDP) Shigeru Ishiba
- President of Moldova (2nd term) : Maia Sandu
- 47th president of America : Donald Trump (Republican party) (Replaced Joe Biden)
- 50th Vice president of USA : JD Vance
- President of Botswana : Duma Boko
- President of Vietnam : Luong Cuong

Genius





Ques : Which company has launched two indigenously designed and constructed Fast Patrol Vessels (FPVs) for the Indian Coast Guard ?

- (a) Cochin Shipyard Limited
- (b) Hindustan Shipyard
- (c) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (d) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders
- (e) Goa Shipyard Limited

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) successfully launched two indigenously designed Fast Patrol Vessels (FPVs) for the Indian Coast Guard.
- In an official event, Vandana Agrawal, wife of Defence manufacturing Secretary Sanjeev Kumar, unveiled the fast patrol vessels Amulya and Akshay, developed under the vision of 'Atmanirbha Bharat' in defense manufacturing.
- These 52-meter-long, 8-meter-wide vessels, with a displacement of 320 tonnes, are ideal for defending offshore assets, islands, and conducting surveillance operations.

About Goa Shipyard Limited :

- Established : 1957
- HQ : Vasco da Gama, Goa
- CMD : Brajesh Kumar Upadhyay

EXAM
Genius





Recent News Headlines related to Defence

- India and the US have partnered to co-produce US sonobuoys for the Indian Navy's underwater domain awareness (UDA).
- People's Liberation Army Navy (PLAN) officially launched its latest amphibious assault ship (AAS) from Shanghai, named 'Sichuan' after a province in southwestern China.
- India has designated 2025 to be the 'year of changes' in the defence sector, promising "unprecedented" progress in strengthening India's security and sovereignty in the face of 21st-century challenges.
- Pakistan's atomic energy regulatory agency has approved the construction of the country's largest nuclear reactor for electricity generating.
- The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has signed a contract to Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL) in Mumbai for air independent propulsion (AIP) plugs valued roughly Rs 1,990 crore.
- India marked a significant milestone in its self-reliance by delivering two warships to the Indian Navy: the destroyer Surat and the frigate Nilgiri.
- China successfully launched four Earth-observation radar satellites called 'PIESAT-2' using a Long March-2D rocket from the Taiyuan Satellite Launch Center in Shanxi Province.
- Space entrepreneurs in Japan and India had agreed to collaborate on a study of utilizing laser-equipped spacecraft to remove garbage from orbit, as an experimental answer to the increasingly pressing problem of orbital congestion.
- China's space program reached a milestone when two of its astronauts performed a nine-hour spacewalk. Shenzhou-19 crew members Cai Xuzhe and Song Lingdong completed a nine-hour extravehicular exercise (EVA), breaking a 22-year-old US record.
- Defence PSU BEML Limited has secured Rs.136 crore contract to supply indigenously designed High Mobility Vehicles (HMs) 8x8.
- Starting in 2025, India's Aditya L1 and the European Space Agency's (ESA) Proba-3 missions will collaborate to further solar research.
- INS Tushil, a Russian-built guided missile frigate, was commissioned into the Indian Navy in Kaliningrad, Russia, in front of Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Chief of Naval Staff Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi, and other senior officials.
- Adani Defence has delivered the second Drishti-10 Starliner surveillance drone to the Indian Navy, improving the country's marine capability.





Ques : Groww Asset Management Limited established in which year ?

- (a) 2006
- (b) 2008
- (c) 2010
- (d) 2012
- (e) 2015

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Groww Mutual Fund, an asset management company, introduced the Groww Nifty India Railways PSU Index Fund and ETF.
- The Groww Nifty India Railways (IR) PSU ETF will be the first of its type in India.
- The Groww Nifty India Railways PSU ETF is an open-ended plan that tracks the Nifty India Railways PSU Index (TRI) (Total Return Index).

About Groww Asset Management Limited :

- Established : 2008
- HQ : Mumbai
- CEO : Varun Gupta

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which platform has been exclusively mandated by IBBI for asset sales under the liquidation process?

- (a) GEM (Government e-Marketplace)
- (b) eBKray auction platform
- (c) MCA21 portal
- (d) NCLT auction system
- (e) SEBI e-Auction portal

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Beginning April 1, the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI) will exclusively use the eBKray auction platform to sell assets throughout the liquidation process.
- The eBKray (now Bank Asset Auction Network) is a property listing and e-auction network for banks and lending institutions to efficiently recover non-performing assets (NPAs).
- IBBI has urged insolvency professionals to offer unsold assets from ongoing liquidation cases for sale on the eBKray platform by March 31.
- The IBBI reports that 210 assets have been posted on the site, with 25 auctions currently scheduled.

About IBBI :

- Established : 2016
- HQ : New Delhi
- Chairperson : Ravi Mittal

EXAM
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Ques : Securities and Exchange Board of India Chairperson Madhabi Puri Buch Predicts how much percent Increase in Capital Market Fundraising ?

- (a) 15%
- (b) 18%
- (c) 21%
- (d) 25%
- (e) 28%

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- According to SEBI Chairperson Madhabi Puri Buch, total capital market fundraising in FY2025 is likely to increase by 21% to Rs.14.7 lakh crore from Rs.11.8 lakh crore in FY2024.
- During the first nine months of FY2024 (April-December), Rs.10.7 lakh crore was raised from the domestic capital market.
- SEBI has cut the processing period for rights issues from 317 days to 26 days, promoting increased funding through this route.

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Recent News Headlines Related to SEBI

- Cosmea Financial Holdings (CFH) Private Limited, led by Sam Ghosh, was granted approval by the SEBI to sponsor a Mutual Fund (MF). CFH plans to invest Rs 200 crore (USD 23.3 million) in its Asset Management Company (AMC).
- SEBI, the market regulator, slapped a Rs 54 lakh penalty on Jaiprakash Power Ventures, its MD and CEO Suren Jain, and other key personnel for falsifying the company's financial statements.
- SEBI has extended the prohibition on future trade of seven agricultural commodities until January 2025: soybeans and their derivatives, crude palm oil, wheat, rice (non-basmati), moong, chana, and mustard seeds.
- SEBI has urged stock exchanges, clearing organizations, and depositories to implement a common strategy for sharing data used in research and research publications conducted by approved academic institutions.
- The SEBI has mandated all Mutual Fund (MF) companies to reduce the processing time for cancelling their Systematic Investment Plans (SIPs) to 2 working days from the previous 10 working days.
- SEBI, the market regulator, has expanded the list of equities eligible for the optional T+0 mode of trading and settlement to 500 starting January 31
- The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) published a circular under Section (11) of the SEBI Act, 1992, to safeguard investor interests, regulate the securities market, and promote its growth.
- SEBI has slapped a Rs.9 lakh fine on Reliance Securities for "flouting market norms" and stock broker regulations.
- Angel One Asset Management Company has received SEBI's approval to act as the asset management company for Angel One Mutual Fund which will focus exclusively on passive investment solutions.
- The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has scrapped the requirement for corporations to deposit 1% of the issue size with stock exchanges before making a public offering
- Unifi Asset Management Pvt Ltd, a wholly owned subsidiary of Unifi Capital, has received final approval from the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) to launch its mutual fund operations.
- SEBI may soon expand angel funds' investor base to include Hindu undivided families (HUFs), family trusts, and single proprietorships.





Ques : What amount given by World Bank to Meghalaya Multisectoral Project for Adolescent Wellbeing, Empowerment and Resilience (MPOWER) ?

- (a) USD 15 million
- (b) USD 25 million
- (c) USD 30 million
- (d) USD 35 million
- (e) USD 40 million

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- USD 35 million Given to Meghalaya Multisectoral Project for Adolescent Wellbeing, Empowerment and Resilience (MPOWER) by World Bank
- Maturity period for Loan Amount is 15 years, including a grace period of 5 years
- The aim of the loan to better empower 5,00,000 adolescents to make the transition from school to work by lowering dropouts, improving learning outcomes and providing assistance for accessing jobs and starting businesses
- MPOWER will strengthen academic results for adolescents in grades 6-12 and close gaps in students' reading and math skills.
- Total cost of the project is USD 45 million (Rest will be given by GoI).

About World Bank :

- Established : 1944
- HQ : Washington DC
- Members : 189
- President : Ajay banga
- MD & CFO : Anshula Kant
- Chief Economist : Indermit Gill

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RECENT LOANS AND AGREEMENTS :

- The Export-Import Bank of India (EXIM Bank) successfully raised \$1 billion (Rs. 8,570 crore) in overseas bond issuance at competitive rates, a notable achievement for Indian issuers in global capital markets.
- The Government of India (GoI) and the Asian Development Bank (ADB) agreed to a \$42 million loan for the Maharashtra Sustainable Climate-Resilient Coastal Protection and Management Project.
- The World Bank has approved the Uttar Pradesh Agriculture Growth and Rural Enterprise Ecosystem Strengthening (UP-AGREES) Project, a \$325.10 million initiative aimed at increasing farmers' incomes in Uttar Pradesh by improving crop productivity, implementing digital and climate-resilient practices, and improving market access.
- The Asian Development Bank (ADB) has approved a \$500 million loan to support India's economic growth by promoting environmentally sustainable infrastructure
- World Bank give \$200 million loan to help Kerala farmers to adapt to climate change and to boost agri entrepreneurship.
- Varthana has successfully secured \$15 million (Rs.120 crores) from the BlueOrchard Microfinance Fund, managed by global impact investor BlueOrchard, through the External Commercial Borrowings (ECB) framework.
- The Asian construction Bank (ADB) has approved a USD 788.8 million (more than Rs 6,600 crore) results-based loan to Andhra Pradesh for the construction of Amaravati as a green and smart capital city with world-class infrastructure.
- Deutsche Bank AG, India, has provided a €91 million (about Rs.814 crore) sustainability-linked loan to SMFG India Credit (SMICC). The loan was facilitated via the Bank's Gift City Branch
- ADB approves USD 350 Million Loan to Boost India's Logistics Sector and Export Competitiveness.
- The World Bank has approved a \$188.28-million loan to stimulate economic growth in Maharashtra, especially in the lagging districts. The \$188.28-million loan from the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) has a final maturity of 15 years, including a grace period of 5 years
- India and the Asian Development Bank (ADB) have inked a loan deal worth \$98 million to boost horticulture crop yield in the country.
- World Bank approves USD 225.5mn for ELEMENT Project in Tripura, Nagaland



Ques : Suryoday Small Finance Bank established in which year ?

- (a) 2015
- (b) 2017
- (c) 2019
- (d) 2020
- (e) 2021

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Suryoday Small Finance Bank (SSFB) has partnered with Tata Digital to expand its FD products.
- SSFB will benefit from Tata Neu's reach and offer deposit schemes to retail clients through this relationship.
- SSFB's fixed deposit (FD) offering will be available on the Tata Neu platform, allowing customers to earn up to 9.1% interest without requiring a savings account.
- Customers can start investing with as little as Rs. 1,000 and the onboarding process is quick.

About Suryoday Small Finance Bank :

- Established : 2017
- HQ : Navi Mumbai
- Tagline : A bank of smiles
- MD & CEO : Baskar Babu Ramachandran

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Recently signed banking agreements

- PhonePe has partnered with ICICI Lombard General Insurance to provide insurance coverage for travelers visiting the Maha Kumbh Mela.
- Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND) and the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) have signed a MoU for sharing of intelligence and information to check money laundering.
- The National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC) has teamed with pollster Axis My India to help bridge India's skills gaps and satisfy the predicted demand for millions of jobs in developed economies over the next five years.
- Bajaj brokerage, the brokerage arm of Bajaj Finance Ltd., has teamed up with Tamilnad Mercantile Bank (TMB) to launch a comprehensive 3-in-1 account solution that combines banking, broking, and investing services on a single platform
- The Assam government has inked a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with SBI and UBI to provide insurance coverage to state government employees.
- The Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH) has teamed with Vivifi Finance to start a pilot operation offering unsecured loans to gig workers.
- Mizoram government entered into a Memorandum of Agreement (MoA) with its partner banks – State Bank of India (SBI), Mizoram Rural Bank (MRB), and Mizoram Cooperative Apex Bank Limited (MCAB) for the disbursement of loans under the Bana Kaih (handholding) Scheme.
- Punjab National Bank (PNB) and Federation of Cold Storage Associations of India (FCAOI) have signed an MoU to improve agricultural infrastructure and cold chain development in India
- Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) partnered with Bank of Bhutan, Bhutan's largest commercial bank, to modernize its digital core and improve customer experience.
- Magma HDI General Insurance has partnered with IndoStar Capital Finance Limited (ICFL), a prominent NBFC to enhance the availability of motor, health, and commercial insurance solutions for customers.
- M2P Fintech has partnered with the State Bank of India (SBI) to provide smooth and safe payment experiences.
- Tata Power Renewable Energy, a unit of Tata Power, has partnered with Canara Bank to offer cheap financing for rooftop solar installations.





Ques : Which bank Offer AI-Driven Support and Digital Payment Solutions for Maha Kumbh 2025 ?

- (a) HDFC Bank
- (b) Karnataka Bank
- (c) Bank of baroda
- (d) Canara Bank
- (e) None of these

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Bank of Baroda (BoB) will open AI-powered customer service and full-fledged branches in Prayagraj, including forex transaction facilities, to better serve visitors.
- BoB is opening two full-fledged branches with FX transaction services.
- The Bank created Aditi, a GenAI-powered Virtual Relationship Manager, to improve customer service and solve banking-related issues.
- The bank is pushing its new UPI payment app, BoB e-Pay, which provides comprehensive payment options.

About Bank of Baroda :

- Established : 1908
- HQ : Vadodara, Gujarat
- Tagline : India's International Bank
- MD & CEO : Debadatta Chand

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Ques : Where was the Inland Waterways Development Council (IWDC) meeting held?

- (a) Guwahati
- (b) New Delhi
- (c) Kaziranga
- (d) Kolkata
- (e) Varanasi

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Over the next five years, a total of Rs 50,000 crore would be invested in infrastructure along national waterways. According to the announcement, the investment ideas were announced during the Inland Waterways Development Council (IWDC) meeting in Kohora, Kaziranga.
- The Inland Waterways Authority of India (IWAI), the focal body for waterway development under the Ministry of Ports, Shipping, and Waterways (MoPSW), organised the IWDC.
- The IWDC meeting discussed a major policy program called the Riverine Community Development Scheme, which aims to improve the socioeconomic well-being of coastal communities by improving infrastructure.
- The IWDC, established in 2023, is an exercise to maximize the economic potential of inland water bodies. It necessitates unusually coordinated inter-state ties, collaborations, and cooperation in the spirit of cooperative federalism.





Ques : Who Inaugurate Z-Morh Tunnel for Boosting Kashmir-Ladakh Connectivity ?

- (a) Draupadi Murmu
- (b) Narendra Modi
- (c) Om Birla
- (d) S Jaishankar
- (e) None of the above

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Z-Morh tunnel Inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
- It marks a significant step in creating a year-round strategic corridor between Kashmir and Ladakh

About Z-Morh tunnel :

- Located between Gagangir and Sonamarg in Ganderbal district, under the Thajiwas Glacier. Length is 6.5-km two-lane.
- Main tunnel is 10.8 meters wide, with an escape tunnel of 7.5 meters, and ventilation tunnels of 8.3 meters. It Costs Rs.2,680 crore
- The Z-Morh tunnel will connect to the Zojila tunnel, making it Asia's longest tunnel once completed.

After Zojila Tunnel Connection :

- It Will be Asia's longest tunnel, improving travel between Ganderbal (Kashmir) and Kargil (Ladakh). Length is 13.14-km Zojila tunnel
- It Reduces travel time from 3 hours to just 20 minutes.
- t Built at Rs.6,800 crore, the Zojila tunnel will provide reliable access to Ladakh during winter





Ques : What is the name of Swiggy's new standalone food delivery app?

- (a) Swiggy Express
- (b) Snacc by Swiggy
- (c) Swiggy QuickBite
- (d) SnackTime
- (e) Swiggy Lite

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Swiggy has introduced a new standalone food delivery app called 'Snacc by Swiggy'. Snacc is a 15-minute food delivery app that serves short snacks and meals, comparable to Zepto's Zepto Cafe.
- Snacc is currently being tested in very specific pin codes in Bengaluru. Tea, coffee, breakfast, short lunches, and desserts are among the choices.
- Most recently, Zomato added a 15-minute food delivery option to its main app, bringing quick-to-prepare and ready-to-eat options from restaurants within a 2-kilometre radius.
- Ola, too, debuted Ola Dash, a 10-minute food delivery service, in Bengaluru, and is gradually expanding statewide.
- Another company in this market is magicpin, which recently launched its 15-minute meal delivery service magicNOW in six major Indian cities, with deliveries within a 1.5-2 km radius.





Recent News Headlines Related to launched Apps/portals

- NITI Aayog's Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP) has developed EmpowHER Biz - Sapno Ki Udaan in collaboration with New Shop, India's largest 24/7 convenience shop chain, as part of its Award to Reward (ATR) program.
- The e-Shram portal has been improved and will now be available in all 22 scheduled languages. Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya, Union Minister of Labour and Employment, has launched the multilingual e-Shram portal, which aims to be a 'One-Stop-Solution' website for all unorganised registered workers.
- M Nagaraju, the Financial Services Secretary, has unveiled the revised 'Baanknet' portal for e-auctioning items like as commercial buildings, industrial land, stores, automobiles, and agricultural and non-agricultural property.
- Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel has unveiled a new citizen-centric project known as the SWAR (Speech and Written Analysis Resource) platform.
- On the occasion of 'Good Governance Day', which commemorates the birth anniversary of former Prime Minister Shri Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh unveiled the Rashtraparv Website and Mobile App on December 25, 2024.
- On National Consumers Day 2024, the Department of Consumer Affairs will make the "Jago Grahak Jago App" and "Jagriti App" available to the public
- Gujarat's Chief Minister, Bhupendra Patel, launched the 'Prakrutik Krushi Portal (Natural Agriculture Portal)' to encourage organic farming
- “Amrit Gyaan Kosh” Portal Launched by Union Minister of State(MoS), Dr. Jitendra Singh, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions to build a comprehensive knowledge base by curating best practices from across India, with a focus on aligning these practices with 15 of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)
- Pralhad Joshi, Minister of Food and Consumer Affairs, has presented 'Anna Chakra', a game-changing supply chain optimization tool for the Public Distribution System





Ques : The Centre released how much tax devolution to the state governments to accelerate capital expenditure and finance welfare activities ?

- (a) Rs 1.7 lakh crore
- (b) Rs 1.53 lakh crore
- (c) Rs 1.63 lakh crore
- (d) Rs 1.73 lakh crore
- (e) Rs 1.13 lakh crore

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Centre has granted Rs 1.73 lakh crore in tax devolution to state governments in order to accelerate capital investment and fund welfare programs.
- The Union government has released tax devolution of Rs 1,73,030 crore to state governments, compared to Rs 89,086 crore in December 2024.
- Currently, 41% of taxes collected by the Centre are distributed in instalments to states within a fiscal year.
- Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and Bihar received the highest allocations of funding, with Rs.31,039.84 crore, Rs.17,403.36 crore, and Rs.13,017.06 crore, respectively.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which state offered a \$1 million prize for deciphering the Indus Valley script, which has been an unsolved mystery for almost a century ?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) Telangana

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Tamil Nadu Chief Minister MK Stalin offered a \$1 million prize for deciphering the Indus Valley script, which has been an unsolved mystery for almost a century.
- Stalin regarded Sir John Marshall's discovery of the Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) in 1924 as a watershed moment in Indian history, altering perceptions of the country's past.
- Tamil linguists and researchers worldwide are still working to solve the Indus conundrum, which has been unsolved for almost a century.
- The CM has announced a Rs.2 crore funding to establish a research chair named after distinguished scholar Iravatham Mahadevan at the Roja Muthiah Research Library.

Genius





Ques : Tamim Iqbal has recently announced his retirement from international cricket. He is from which country?

- (a) Sri Lanka
- (b) Nepal
- (c) Bhutan
- (d) India
- (e) Bangladesh

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Tamim Iqbal declared his retirement from international cricket.
- This is his second retirement announcement, having previously retired in July 2023 in an emotionally heated news conference, only to reverse his decision within 24 hours after intervention from Bangladesh's then-prime minister Sheikh Hasina.
- Tamim finished his career with 15,192 runs for Bangladesh, the second most in the country's history behind Mushfiquir Rahim.
- The 35-year-old amassed 5134 runs in 70 Tests, 8357 in 243 One-Day Internationals, and 1758 in 78 Twenty20 Internationals.

EXAM
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Recently Retired Players :

- Martin Guptill (New Zealand) : Retirement from international cricket
- Rishi Dhawan : Retirement from Indian limited overs cricket
- Ravichandran Ashwin (Indian) : International cricket
- Imad Wasim (Pakistan) : International cricket
- Siddarth Kaul (Indian) : cricket
- Emma McKeon (Australia): professional swimming
- Rafael Nadal (Spain) : professional tennis
- Tim Southee (New Zealand) : international cricket
- Mohammad Nabi (Afghanistan) : Retire from ODI Cricket
- Wriddhiman Saha (India) : retired from all cricket formats
- Rani Rampal : Retirement from Hockey
- Wicketkeeper-Batter Matthew Wade : Retires from International Cricket
- Andres Iniesta (Spain) : Retirement from professional football
- Rafael Nadal (from Spain) : Retirement from professional tennis
- Dipa Karmakar : Retirement from gymnastics
- Dwayne Bravo : All forms of cricket
- Luis Suarez (Uruguay) : National football team
- Moeen Ali (England) : Retirement from international cricket
- Shannon Gabriel (West Indies) : Retirement from international cricket
- Dawid Malan (England) : Retirement from international cricket

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which edition of “Future of Jobs Report 2025 – Insights Report January 2025” Published by World Economic Forum (WEF) ?

- (a) 3rd
- (b) 4th
- (c) 5th
- (d) 6th
- (e) 7th

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Future of Jobs Report 2025 – Insights Report January 2025 5th Edition Published by World Economic Forum (WEF).
- By 2030, employment disruption is expected to affect 22% of the worldwide workforce.
- The analysis predicts the creation of 170 million new employment and the displacement of 92 million, resulting in a net increase of 78 million jobs.
- By 2030, approximately 40% of current skills are predicted to become outdated.
- The report estimates that 59 out of 100 persons in the global workforce will require training by 2030.
- By 2030, 60% of employers expect increased digital access to transform their firm.
- 86% of employers expect AI and information processing to have a significant impact, while 58% anticipate the influence of robotics and automation.

About World Economic Forum (WEF) :

- Established : 1971
- HQ : Cologny, Geneva, Switzerland
- President and CEO : Borge Brende





India's Rankings in Different Indices

- Henley Passport Index 2025 Published by Henley : India (85th), Singapore (top)
- ThreatLandscape Report 2024 Published by CloudSEK : India (2nd), United States (top)
- Global Aging Index Published by National University of Singapore (NUS) & Columbia University : India (123rd), Switzerland (top)
- Hurun India Top 200 Self-Made Entrepreneurs of the Millennia 2024 Published by Hurun India & IDFC FIRST Private Banking : Kaivalya Vohra (Zepto) (Youngest), Ashok Soota (Happiest Minds Technologies) (Oldest)
- Travel and Tourism Development Index (TTDI) 2024 Published by World Economic Forum (WEF) : India (39th), United States (Top)
- 2025 QS Sustainability Rankings Published by QS Rankings : IIT Delhi (171), University of Toronto (Canada) (top)
- SBTi commitments by Indian companies Published by ICRA ESG Ratings Limited : India (6th), United Kingdom (UK) (top)
- "world's worst airlines" in the 2024 AirHelp Score survey : IndiGo (103rd), Brussels Airlines (top)
- Interdisciplinary Science Rankings (ISR) 2025 Published by Times Higher Education (THE) : Anna University in Chennai (Tamil Nadu, TN) (42nd), Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) (USA) (top)
- 2024 Network Readiness Index (NRI) Published by Portulans Institute and Saïd Business School : India (49th), United States of America (top)
- Sustainable Trade Index 2024 Published by Hinrich Foundation and IMD : India (23rd), New Zealand (top)
- Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) 2025 : India (10th), Denmark (last)
- Brand Finance's Global City Index Published by Brand Finance : London (top), New Delhi (77), Mumbai (78)
- WJP Rule of Law Index 2024 Published by World Justice Project (WJP) : India (79th), Denmark (top)
- World Intellectual Property Indicators Report 2024 : India (6th), China (top)
- EdelGive-Hurun India Philanthropy List 2024 : Shiv Nadar & Family (top)
- AI Preparedness Index (API) Published by IMF : India (72nd), Singapore (top)





Ques : Varun Aaron has announced his retirement at the age of 35. He is from which sports ?

- (a) Cricket
- (b) Football
- (c) Shooting
- (d) Badminton
- (e) tennis

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Varun Aaron announced his retirement from all kinds of cricket at the age of 35.
- After retiring from red-ball cricket at the end of the 2023-24 Indian domestic season, Aaron officially resigned from representative cricket following Jharkhand's elimination from the Vijay Hazare Trophy, where he appeared in four matches and took three wickets at an average of 53.3.
- Aaron's rise to prominence came at the age of 21 during the 2010-11 Vijay Hazare Trophy, when his raw pace wowed spectators, most notably with a blistering 153kph delivery against Gujarat in the final.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which state government has signed an agreement with software giant Infosys to provide technical help for the state's expected first-ever skill census initiative in the country ?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) Telangana

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- To increase job possibilities for young people, the Andhra Pradesh government has signed an agreement with software giant Infosys to provide technical help for the state's expected first-ever skill census initiative in the country.
- As part of the talent census program, Infosys would provide a generative AI-powered digital platform for pre-validating candidate skills, with no financial participation.
- As part of the agreement, Infosys would create a digital platform for pre-validating the skills of Andhra Pradesh's 3.59 million people aged 15 to 59.
- The program would enable transparent data-driven evaluations to measure progress and outcomes, while also aligning with the State's goal of creating 20 lakh employment over the next five years.





Ques : Which ministry Launched Bharat Cleantech Manufacturing Platform at Bharat Climate Forum 2025 in New Delhi ?

- (a) Union Ministry of Home Affairs
- (b) Union Ministry of Education
- (c) Union Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship
- (d) Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- (e) Union Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Piyush Goyal, Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, presented the 'Bharat Cleantech Manufacturing Platform', which the Centre described as a "initiative designed to enhance India's cleantech value chains in the solar, wind, hydrogen, and battery storage sectors".
- The unveiling took place during the Bharat Climate Forum 2025, which was held in New Delhi.
- The introduction of the Bharat Cleantech Manufacturing Platform would enable Indian enterprises to collaborate and co-innovate, as well as providing a platform for funding and sharing ideas, technology, and resources.
- This will help India become an appealing business case and a global leader in the sustainability and cleantech sectors.





News Headlines Related to Ministry :

- Piyush Goyal, Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, has started the 8th edition of the National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP) at the Bharat Ratna C. Subramaniam Auditorium (NASC Complex), Pusa in New Delhi.
- The Animal Welfare Board of India (AWBI), a statutory agency under the Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying of the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry, and Dairying, has signed a MOU with NALSAR University of Law in Hyderabad.
- Dr. Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology, revealed that the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) has created technology to synthesize Paracetamol in-house.
- Nitin Gadkari, Union Minister of traffic Transport and Highways, has announced a new plan that will provide cashless treatment to traffic accident victims. the policy will immediately cover the victim's treatment costs for 7 days, up to a maximum of Rs 1.5 lakh.
- Rajiv Ranjan Singh, Union Minister of Animal Husbandry and Fisheries, has opened the country's first organic fisheries cluster in Sikkim.
- First phase of the 'One Nation, One Subscription (ONOS)' Launched by Ministry of Education(MoE). An Outlay of Rs 6,000 crore released for three years, from 1st January 2025 to 31st December 2027.
- Mission MAUSAM Approved in September 2024. It is Led by Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) with the Aim to make India "Weather Ready" and "Climate Smart", complying with the international standards by 2026. It has an Outlay of Rs 2,000 crore for 2 years.
- The Ministry of Consumer Affairs has partnered with messaging platform Gupshup to introduce a web-based AI virtual assistant, Jagriti, to simplify the process of filing consumer complaints.
- Starting June 2026, solar enterprises must utilize only India-made solar photovoltaic (PV) cells for government procurement programs, according to the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE)





Ques : What is the name of the rocket by Blue Origin set to make its inaugural launch?

- (a) Falcon Heavy
- (b) New Glenn
- (c) Atlas V
- (d) Vulcan Centaur
- (e) Starship

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Blue Origin's New Glenn rocket will launch at 1 a.m. ET Monday from the Cape Canaveral Space Force Station in Florida.
- The New Glenn rocket, measuring around 320 feet (98 meters), is the first Blue Origin rocket designed to transport satellites to space and one of the most powerful in the world.
- It is named after John Glenn, the first American astronaut to orbit Earth in 1962.

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Recent News Headlines related to Defence

- Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) successfully launched two indigenously designed Fast Patrol Vessels (FPVs) for the Indian Coast Guard.
- India and the US have partnered to co-produce US sonobuoys for the Indian Navy's underwater domain awareness (UDA).
- People's Liberation Army Navy (PLAN) officially launched its latest amphibious assault ship (AAS) from Shanghai, named 'Sichuan' after a province in southwestern China.
- India has designated 2025 to be the 'year of changes' in the defence sector, promising "unprecedented" progress in strengthening India's security and sovereignty in the face of 21st-century challenges.
- Pakistan's atomic energy regulatory agency has approved the construction of the country's largest nuclear reactor for electricity generating.
- The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has signed a contract to Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL) in Mumbai for air independent propulsion (AIP) plugs valued roughly Rs 1,990 crore.
- India marked a significant milestone in its self-reliance by delivering two warships to the Indian Navy: the destroyer Surat and the frigate Nilgiri.
- China successfully launched four Earth-observation radar satellites called 'PIESAT-2' using a Long March-2D rocket from the Taiyuan Satellite Launch Center in Shanxi Province.
- Space entrepreneurs in Japan and India had agreed to collaborate on a study of utilizing laser-equipped spacecraft to remove garbage from orbit, as an experimental answer to the increasingly pressing problem of orbital congestion.
- China's space program reached a milestone when two of its astronauts performed a nine-hour spacewalk. Shenzhou-19 crew members Cai Xuzhe and Song Lingdong completed a nine-hour extravehicular exercise (EVA), breaking a 22-year-old US record





Ques : Which country will host the 28th Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of Parliaments of Commonwealth Countries (CSPOC) in 2026 ?

- (a) Sri Lanka
- (b) Nepal
- (c) Bhutan
- (d) India
- (e) Bangladesh

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- India will host the 28th Commonwealth Speakers and Presiding Officers Conference (CSPOC) in 2026.
- The seminar will center on the application of artificial intelligence and social media in parliamentary processes.
- The CSPOC platform was defined as a space for member countries to strengthen their collaboration and exchange parliamentary practices.
- India has already hosted the conference in 1970-71, 1986, and 2010, and has asked Commonwealth presiding officials to attend the 2026 session in New Delhi.

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Ques : Who announced a USD 3 billion investment in India over the next two years to enhance AI and cloud infrastructure ?

- (a) Microsoft
- (b) Google
- (c) Tally solutions
- (d) IBM
- (e) WIPRO

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Microsoft plans to invest USD 3 billion in India over two years to improve AI and cloud infrastructure, as well as skilling efforts.
- Microsoft's ADVANTA(I)GE INDIA Initiative, part of its Global Skills for Social Impact charter, intends to teach 10 million Indians in vital AI skills by 2030. The company also made various collaborations to meet this objective :
 - Partner with Apollo Hospitals On AI-driven research in genomics, disease progression, and multimodal AI models
 - Partner with Mahindra Group to Set up an AI Division to involve innovation across its automotive, farming, and finance sectors
 - Partner with RailTel to Establish an AI Center of Excellence through which Microsoft will train employees in AI and cloud technologies
 - Partner with Bajaj Finserv to Leverage Microsoft Azure OpenAI services to improve customer experiences, boost productivity, and reduce operational costs
 - Partner with upGrad To train 1 million learners in foundational and advanced AI skills by 2025 through the use of tools like GitHub Copilot and Azure OpenAI Service





Ques : National Youth Day is celebrated annually on which day ?

- (a) 12 January
- (b) 13 January
- (c) 14 January
- (d) 15 January
- (e) 16 January

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- National Youth Day is observed annually on January 12th in India to commemorate the birth anniversary of Swami Vivekananda, a spiritual leader and philosopher.
- This year Swami Vivekananda's 162nd birth anniversary.
- The primary goal of this day's observance is to inspire and educate young people about their responsibilities.
- Theme 2025: Youth for a Sustainable Future: Shaping the Nation with Resilience and Responsibility.
- The Indian government initiated the festival on 1985.

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Important days :

- 24 December : National Consumer Rights Day
- 25 December : Good Governance Day
- 26 December : Boxing Day
- 26 December : Computer Operators' Day
- 26 December : Veer Bal Divas A Day of Valor And Righteousness
- 27 December : International Day of Epidemic Preparedness
- 29 December : International Cello Day
- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 2 January : 67th Foundation Day of Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day
- 4 January : World Braille Day
- 5 January : National Bird Day (Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future)
- 6 January : World Day of War Orphans
- 6 January : Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) celebrated its 78th Foundation Day
- 8 January : Earth's Rotation Day
- 9 January : NRI or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- 10 January : World Hindi Day, also known as 'Vishwa Hindi Diwas' (Theme 2025: A Global Voice of Unity and Cultural Pride)

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IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Bangalore Medical College and Research Institute (BMCRI) has been chosen by the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) to establish South India's first Infectious Disease Research and Diagnostic Laboratory (IRDL).

The respected American publication Track and Fields News has selected India's Neeraj Chopra, a gold medalist at the Tokyo Olympics, the best javelin thrower of 2024. Anderson Peters from Grenada was ranked second by the magazine.

Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro was sworn in for a new term amidst continued demonstrations and rebukes from the United States and others who feel he stole last year's election.

President Droupadi Murmu presented the Pravasi Bharatiya Samman Award to the honoree during the 18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD) Convention in Bhubaneswar, Odisha.

Since 2003, the ninth of January has been marked as Pravasi Divas in India to commemorate Mahatma Gandhi's return to India from South Africa on this date in 1915. It is organised by the Ministry of External Affairs and has taken place every two years since 2015.

Brijendra Pratap Singh Appointed as Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of National Aluminium Company (NALCO)

Prime Minister Narendra Modi will participate in the Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Summit in France. The event will focus on five key themes: public interest in AI, the future of work, innovation and culture, trust in AI, and global AI governance.





Ques : Which bank is marketing its first dollar syndicated loan since 2012 of as much as \$400 million ?

- (a) Canara Bank
- (b) Bank of India
- (c) HDFC Bank
- (d) UCO Bank
- (e) Axis Bank

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- According to sources, Bank of India is offering its first syndicated loan of up to \$400 million since 2012, coinciding with an increase in Indian debtors seeking worldwide credit.
- The Indian lender is raising the loan in three and five-year tranches through its Gujarat International Finance TecCity division.
- According to Bloomberg data, Bank of India last used offshore credit markets in 2012 to raise a \$200 million facility for two years.

About Bank of India :

- Established : 7 September 1906
- HQ : Mumbai, Maharashtra
- MD & CEO : Rajneesh Karnatak
- Tagline : Relationship Beyond Banking





Ques : How many persons can an investor declare as nominees under the revised SEBI rules for demat accounts or mutual fund folios?

- (a) 8
- (b) 10
- (c) 12
- (d) 15
- (e) 16

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Sebi has made significant modifications to the nomination requirements for mutual funds and demat accounts to reduce unclaimed assets.
- Sebi updated mutual fund nomination regulations, effective March 1, 2025.
- According to Sebi, investors can designate up to 10 candidates for their demat or mutual fund accounts. However, the investor must declare the nominee.
- New rules require investors to declare nominees themselves, as Power of Attorney (PoA) holders are not authorized to do so.

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Recent News Headlines Related to SEBI

- According to SEBI Chairperson Madhabi Puri Buch, total capital market fundraising in FY2025 is likely to increase by 21% to Rs.14.7 lakh crore from Rs.11.8 lakh crore in FY2024.
- Cosmea Financial Holdings (CFH) Private Limited, led by Sam Ghosh, was granted approval by the SEBI to sponsor a Mutual Fund (MF). CFH plans to invest Rs 200 crore (USD 23.3 million) in its Asset Management Company (AMC).
- SEBI, the market regulator, slapped a Rs 54 lakh penalty on Jaiprakash Power Ventures, its MD and CEO Suren Jain, and other key personnel for falsifying the company's financial statements.
- SEBI has extended the prohibition on future trade of seven agricultural commodities until January 2025: soybeans and their derivatives, crude palm oil, wheat, rice (non-basmati), moong, chana, and mustard seeds.
- SEBI has urged stock exchanges, clearing organizations, and depositories to implement a common strategy for sharing data used in research and research publications conducted by approved academic institutions.
- The SEBI has mandated all Mutual Fund (MF) companies to reduce the processing time for cancelling their Systematic Investment Plans (SIPs) to 2 working days from the previous 10 working days.
- SEBI, the market regulator, has expanded the list of equities eligible for the optional T+0 mode of trading and settlement to 500 starting January 31
- The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) published a circular under Section (11) of the SEBI Act, 1992, to safeguard investor interests, regulate the securities market, and promote its growth.
- SEBI has slapped a Rs.9 lakh fine on Reliance Securities for "flouting market norms" and stock broker regulations.
- Angel One Asset Management Company has received SEBI's approval to act as the asset management company for Angel One Mutual Fund which will focus exclusively on passive investment solutions.





Ques : What was the Consumer Price Index (CPI)-based retail inflation in December 2024 as reported by MoSPI?

- (a) 5%
- (b) 5.22%
- (c) 6%
- (d) 5.7%
- (e) 6.5%

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- In December, India's retail inflation reached a four-month low of 5.22 percent, down from 5.48 percent the previous month.
- December is the fourth consecutive month of over 5% inflation.
- In October, India's retail inflation reached a 14-month high of 6.21%, while food inflation rose to a 15-month high of 10.9%.

Month-wise list of retail inflation :

- July 2024 : 3.54%
- August 2024 : 3.65%
- September 2024 : 5.49%
- October 2024 : 6.21%
- November 2024 : 5.48%

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Ques : Who has been appointed as the new secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)?

- (a) Jay Shah
- (b) Devajit Saikia
- (c) Sourav Ganguly
- (d) Rahul Dravid
- (e) Anurag Thakur

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Former first-class cricketer Devajit Saikia has been named as the new secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI), succeeding Jay Shah, who became the ICC Chairman last year.
- Prabhtej Singh Bhatia was chosen Treasurer of the Indian Cricket Board.
- Saikia, who represented Assam in the 1990-91 first-class cricket season, scored 53 runs in four games.
- He also has extensive cricket administrative expertise, having previously served as the BCCI joint secretary and the secretary of the Assam Cricket Association.

About Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) :

- Founded : 1928
- HQ : Mumbai
- President : Roger Binny
- Secretary : Devajit Saikia
- Treasurer : Prabhtej Singh Bhatia





Ques : Why is India's inclusion in the UN Committee of Experts on Big Data significant?

- (a) It enhances India's role in climate policy formulation
- (b) It recognizes India as a global leader in data science and statistical innovation
- (c) It helps India influence global trade policies
- (d) It promotes India's interests in artificial intelligence research
- (e) It aids in India's sustainable development goals

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- India has joined the UN's Committee of Experts on Big Data and Data Science for Official Statistics.
- The UN Committee of Experts on Big Data and Data Science for Official Statistics (UN-CEBD) was established to explore the potential benefits and challenges of Big Data.
- This development aligns with India's efforts to modernize its statistical processes by integrating non-traditional data sources such as satellite imagery, IoT, and machine learning to provide accurate and real-time insights for governance.

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Ques : How much total investment has the Adani Group committed in Chhattisgarh for energy and cement projects?

- (a) Rs 40,000 crore
- (b) Rs 45,000 crore
- (c) Rs 50,000 crore
- (d) Rs 60,000 crore
- (e) Rs 65,000 crore

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- The Adani Group plans to invest Rs 65,000 crore in energy and cement projects in Chhattisgarh.
- Gautam Adani, chairman of Adani Group, met with Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai and announced an investment of Rs 60,000 crore to expand the group's power plants in Raipur, Korba, and Raigarh in the state. The development will increase Chhattisgarh's power producing capacity by 6,120 megawatts.
- According to the announcement, the Adani Group has invested Rs 5,000 crore to the construction and expansion of its cement factories in Chhattisgarh. Adani Cement operates two integrated operations in the state, in Bhatapara and Jamul, and has already announced growth at the Bhatapara facility.
- Adani Power is India's leading private thermal power producer. It plans to increase its thermal power capacity to 30.67 GW by 2029-30 from 15 GW currently.
- The company announced last month that it was considering investing Rs 20,000 crore to build a coal-fired ultra-supercritical thermal power plant in Bihar.
- Adani has committed to investing Rs 10,000 crore in the state over the next four years to support CSR activities in education, healthcare, skill development, and tourism.



Ques : What is the Outlay of the project INROAD (Indian Natural Rubber Operations for Assisted Development) ?

- (a) Rs.50 crore
- (b) Rs.100 crore
- (c) Rs.150 crore
- (d) Rs.200 crore
- (e) Rs.250 crore

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- INROAD (Indian Natural Rubber Operations for Assisted Development) started in the North-East India and parts of West Bengal with an Outlay of Rs.100 crore
- The initiative is financially backed by four large corporations: Apollo, Ceat, JK, and MRF. The Rubber Board of India is in charge of its implementation.
- In its first four years, the project has successfully established 1,25,272 hectares of new natural rubber plantations.
- These plantations span across 94 districts in the North East and parts of West Bengal.
- A model smokehouse has been inaugurated for the Bhaishkhuli Pragatishil Mohila Samittee, a cooperative of 65 female rubber growers in Goalpara, Assam to enhance the quality of natural rubber produced in India's North-East.





Ques : Which state government launched the Swami Vivekanand Yuva Shakti Mission on the occasion of the National Youth day?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) Madhya Pradesh

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- On the occasion of the National Youth Day in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav officially launched the Swami Vivekanand Yuva Shakti Mission.
- Chief Minister Mohan Yadav also unveiled the world's largest 3-D rangoli, depicting Swami Vivekananda, at the Shaurya Smarak in Bhopal.
- The Swami Vivekananda Yuva Shakti Mission was launched by the state government in accordance with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's guiding principle of GYAN (Focus on the Poor, Youth, Farmers, and Women) and inspired by Swami Vivekanand's ideas.
- The Chief Minister also introduced the Swami Vivekananda Yuva Shakti Mission Portal and theme song. The Portal will provide information on the mission to the broader public.
- The state government intends to employ more than 70% of the young by 2028. By 2030, all of the state's youth will have completed their education through the 12th grade.





Ques : Which state became the 34th state to implement the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY) ?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) Telangana

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Odisha became the 34th state to implement the Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY), a substantial improvement in the state's healthcare system.
- The National Health Authority (NHA) of the Union Ministry of Health and Odisha's Department of Health and Family Welfare signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to formalize their merger.
- The AB PM-JAY would work with Odisha's existing Gopabandhu Jan Arogya Yojana (GJAY).
- The unified system provides annual health coverage of ₹5 lakh per family, with an additional Rs.5 lakh for female members.

About Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY) :

- Launched : 23 September, 2018
- Nodal agency National Health Authority
- It provides a health coverage of Rs.5 lakh per family annually, with an additional Rs.5 lakh specifically for women members
- AB PM-JAY has recorded 8.19 crore hospital admissions across India, with Rs.1.13 lakh crore allocated towards healthcare for marginalized communities





Ques : Kappad beach and Chal beach wins Blue Flag certification. It is in which state ?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) Telangana

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Foundation for Environmental Education (FEE), based in Denmark, has given Kerala's renowned Kappad beach in Kozhikode and Chal beach in Kannur the prestigious Blue Flag designation.
- This designation acknowledges beaches that adhere to high environmental, safety, and sustainability criteria.
- The Blue Flag designation raises Kerala's profile as a sustainable tourism destination and serves as a global benchmark for environmentally friendly tourism activities.
- Kappad Beach has earned the Blue Flag certification for the 4th consecutive year. As of November 2024, India has 13 Blue Flag beaches.
- Award given to Beaches and marinas that meet 33 criteria, focusing on environmental education, water quality, safety, services, and waste management
- It is Launched under the Integrated Coastal Zone Management Project (ICZMP) by the Ministry of Environment, Forest, and Climate Change.

13 Blue Flag beaches in India are :

- Shivrajpur Beach : Dwarka, Gujarat (2020)
- Golden Beach : Puri, Odisha (2020)
- Ghoghla Beach : Diu, Gujarat (2020)
- Kasarkod Beach : Uttara Kannada, Karnataka (2020)
- Padubidri Beach : Udupi, Karnataka (2020)
- Rushikonda Beach : Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh (2020)
- Radhanagar Beach : Havelock Island, Andaman & Nicobar Islands (2020)
- Kovalam Beach : Chennai, Tamil Nadu (2020)
- Eden Beach : Puducherry (2020)
- Minicoy Thundi Beach : Lakshadweep (2022)
- Kadmat Beach : Lakshadweep (2022)
- Kappad Beach : Kozhikode, Kerala (2025)
- Chal Beach : Kannur, Kerala (2025)





Ques : Which organization has launched a dedicated Post-Retirement Benefit (PRB) Cell to enhance the welfare and convenience of its retired employees?

- (a) Solar Energy Corporation of India Ltd
- (b) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited
- (c) South Eastern Coalfields Limited (SECL)
- (d) Steel Authority of India Limited
- (e) Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- South Eastern Coalfields Limited (SECL), a subsidiary of Coal India Limited (CIL) headquartered in Chhattisgarh, has established a dedicated Post-Retirement Benefit (PRB) Cell to improve the welfare and convenience of its retired personnel.
- The PRB Cell will function as a single-window system, integrating post-retirement services traditionally overseen by multiple departments such as Personnel, Finance, and Medical.
- The effort also compliments 'Mission Sambandh,' an SECL program that aims to improve stakeholder communication and collaboration.
- This centralized approach attempts to avoid delays and confusion, giving retirees easier access to pensions, provident funds, medical facilities, and other benefits.





Ques : Where is the headquarter of International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) ?

- (a) Singapore
- (b) Germany
- (c) Switzerland
- (d) Denmark
- (e) Cambodia

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The IUCN Red List of Threatened Species has recognized India's Western Ghats as a global hotspot for threatened freshwater species. This is the first-ever multi-taxon assessment of freshwater fauna worldwide.
- The evaluation evaluates the extinction risk and significant threats to 23,496 freshwater species, including crustaceans, fishes, and odonates.
- The study found 89 confirmed and 187 suspected extinctions of freshwater species since 1500 AD.
- The Western Ghats is home to about 300 freshwater fish species, making it one of the richest places for freshwater biodiversity.
- Kerala has the highest number of vulnerable freshwater fishes in India, with 74 out of 188 species categorized as such.

About IUCN :

- Established : 1948
- HQ : Gland, Switzerland
- Director : General Grethel Aguilar





Ques : Who has successfully completed user trials of HIMKAVACH multi-layer clothing system in extreme cold weather conditions ?

- (a) DRDO
- (b) ISRO
- (c) HAL
- (d) NASA
- (e) None of these

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) has completed user trials for its HIMKAVACH multi-layer apparel system in extreme cold temperatures.
- The system is meant to protect personnel in temperatures ranging from +20°C to -60°C, making it excellent for high-altitude military operations, especially in the Himalayan region.
- Previously, the Indian Army (IA) utilized the Extreme Cold Weather Clothing System (ECWCS), a 3-layered suit created by DRDO's Defence Institute of Physiology and Allied Sciences (DIPAS).

About DRDO :

- Established : 1958
- HQ : New Delhi
- Chairman : Sameer V. Kamat

EXAM
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Ques : Which institutions are collaborating with C-DOT for the development of the Wideband Spectrum-Sensor ASIC-Chip?

- (a) IIT Delhi and IIT Bombay
- (b) IIT Kanpur and IIT Hyderabad
- (c) IIT Madras and IISc Bengaluru
- (d) IIT Mandi and IIT Jammu
- (e) IIT Roorkee and IIT Guwahati

Answer : option D

Explanation :

- The Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT), the premier Telecom R&D centre of the Department of Telecommunications (DoT), GoI, has signed an agreement with IIT Mandi, in collaboration with IIT Jammu, for the development of "Wideband Spectrum-Sensor ASIC-Chip, for Enhancing Spectrum Utilization".
- The agreement was struck under the Telecom Technology Development Fund (TTDF) initiative of India's Department of Telecommunications.
- This program, which aims to support Indian entrepreneurs, academia, and R&D institutions, is a critical enabler for creating, developing, and commercializing telecommunications technologies and solutions.
- The project's goal is to create a dependable and easy-to-implement wideband spectrum sensing (WSS) algorithm that would enhance spectrum efficiency by using spectrum holes to provide broadband services in rural India.
- Spectrum sensing allows cognitive radio users to adapt to their surroundings by recognizing spectrum voids while avoiding interference with the core network.





Recent News Headlines Related to IITs

- IIT-Madras has successfully commissioned Asia's largest shallow wave basin at its Discovery campus at Thaiyur.
- IIT Madras, has worked with the Union Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare on a project to increase the efficiency and efficacy of the agricultural extension system through digitization.
- IIT Madras has completed a 410-meter Hyperloop test track, marking a big step forward in India's pursuit of futuristic transportation solutions.
- Hyundai Motor Group has partnered with three IITs to build a joint research system in the domains of batteries and electrification, involving a USD 7 million investment over five years.
- IIT Guwahati will host the 10th India International Science Festival (IISF) 2024 from November 30 to December 3.
- Samsung R&D Institute, Noida (SRI-Noida) has signed a MOU with the famed Indian Institute of Technology Bombay (IIT Bombay).
- IIT Madras and ISRO Collaborate to create a Centre of Excellence focused on research in 'Fluid and Thermal Sciences'. ISRO will provide seed funding of Rs 1.84 Crore to establish this center.
- The IIT Madras aims to establish a worldwide flagship center in Dubai to promote research, innovation, and entrepreneurship.
- IIT Delhi and the International Energy Agency (IEA) have signed a Memorandum of Understanding on clean energy transition.
- IIT Indore has developed a new technology for early detection of breast cancer that is specifically geared to assist women in rural and remote places.
- IIT Delhi and the Indian Air Force's Headquarters Maintenance (HQ) Command in Nagpur have signed a MOU to collaborate on the development of novel technologies for aviation textiles, with an emphasis on parachutes and other safety equipment.
- US Government Partner with IIT Madras Research Park in Chennai to work in 4 broad areas namely, Solar energy (SE), Green Hydrogen (GH), Electric Vehicles (EVs), and Batteries, and Green Buildings (GBs).
- The National Health Authority (NHA) and IIT Kanpur inked an MoU in the presence of Union Health Secretary Apurva Chandra.





Ques : Who was recently honored with the 'Satyajit Ray Lifetime Achievement Award' for contributions to Indian cinema?

- (a) Aparna Sen
- (b) Sharmila Tagore
- (c) Satyajit Ray
- (d) Rituparno Ghosh
- (e) Soumitra Chatterjee

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Eminent director Aparna Sen was honoured with the 'Satyajit Ray Lifetime Achievement Award' at the annual award ceremony of West Bengal Film Journalists Association (WBFJA) for her contributions to Indian cinema.

Winners List of West Bengal Film Journalists Association (WBFJA) :

- Best Bengali Film : Manik Babur Megh
- Best Actor (Male) : Chandan Sen
- Best Director : Srijit Mukherji ('Badami Haynar Kabale') and Debaloy Bhattacharya ('Padatik')
- Best Screenplay : Anjan Dutt (For 'Chalchitra Ekhon')
- Best Music Director : Amit Chatterjee
- Most Popular Film Award : Khadaan
- Best Actor (Female) : Rituparna Sengupta (for 'Ajogya')
- Most Promising Director : Abhinandan Banerjee (For 'Manik Babur Megh')
- Best Background Score : Rathijit Bhattacharya (for 'Khadaan')
- Playback singer awards : Timir Biswas (Tekka), Rathijit Bhattacharya (Khadaan), and Antara Mitra (Khadaan)
- Best Lyricist : Kaushik Ganguly (for 'Ajogya')
- Special Recognition for Technical Innovation : Srijit Mukherji's 'Oti Uttam'





Recent News Headlines Related to Awards & Winners :

- Best javelin thrower of 2024 by American publication Track and Fields News : India's Neeraj Chopra
- India's 1st and world's 3rd airport to receive the prestigious Level 5 Accreditation : Mumbai (Maharashtra)-based Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport (CSMIA)
- Padmapani Lifetime Achievement Award : Sai Paranjpye for her contributions to both Indian cinema and Marathi literature
- Gangadhar National Award for Poetry 2023 : Odia poet Prativa Satpathy
- Bahrain's prestigious 'Medal of Efficiency' (First Class) by King Hamad bin Isa Al Khalifa : Dr. Ravi Pillai
- "Great Place to Work" certification for January 2025–2026 : Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL)
- SKOCH Award : Maharashtra government's initiative 'Shasan Aplya Dari' ('Government at Your Doorstep')
- 34th Vyas Samman for 2024 : Hindi writer Suryabala for Her novel "Kaun Des Ko Vasi: Venu Ki Diary" which was published in 2018
- Prestigious "Gold Award" in the State Energy Conservation Award 2024 : RINL, the corporate entity of the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant
- Royal honors 'knighthood' and 'damehood' by King Charles III : Oscar award winning filmmaker Christopher Nolan and his wife, Emma Thomas
- Pandit Swapan Chaudhuri : Rashtriya Tansen Samman 2023
- Sanand Nyas Sanstha from Indore : Raja Mansingh Tomar Samman 2023
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi : Kuwait's highest civilian honour, the Order of Mubarak Al Kabeer
- Mrs. India USA 2024 : Caitlin Sandra Neil, a 19-year-old Indian-American teenager born in Chennai, India
- Miss Teen India USA 2024 : Sanskriti Sharma from Illinois
- 14th PSE Excellence Awards in 3 Category : "Corporate Governance" and "Corporate Social Responsibility & Sustainability" and "Operational Performance Excellence" : Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA)





Ques : Which state University was recognized by the University Grants Commission (UGC) under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act, 1956, enabling it to offer academic courses in physical education and sports sciences ?

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Jharkhand
- (c) Assam
- (d) Bihar
- (e) Meghalaya

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Bihar Sports University, based in Rajgir, Bihar, is accredited by the University Grants Commission (UGC) under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act, 1956, allowing it to provide academic degrees in physical education and sports sciences.
- The Bihar government has nominated Shishir Sinha, a retired IAS officer, as the university's first Vice-Chancellor (VC).
- The university's academic programs will begin in the 2025-2026 session.

These programs will include :

- A four-year Bachelor of Physical Education (B.P.Ed.) program (subject to approval from the National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE))
- Diplomas and PG diplomas in yoga.
- Diplomas and PG diplomas in sports coaching, focusing on two or three sports

About University Grants Commission :

- Established : 28 December 1956
- HQ : New Delhi
- Chairman : Mamidala Jagadesh Kumar





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) and JK Cement Signed an MOU to foster innovation, empower entrepreneurs, and strengthen India's manufacturing ecosystem.

Bollywood actor Akshay Kumar Appointed as Brand ambassador for POCO India.

India and Mumbai batter Shreyas Iyer, the second-most expensive player in the player auction, has been appointed captain by Punjab Kings for IPL 2025. The 2024 IPL winning captain has previously led Delhi Capitals (DC) and Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) in the IPL.

Mongolia & India Signed an Mining Partnership. In the areas of geology and exploration, aiming to enhance resource security and diversify supply chains.

Mount Ibu in North Maluku, Indonesia, erupted, producing ash clouds up to 4,000 meters and ejecting hot lava up to two kilometers from its crater. The volcano is located on Halmahera Island.

Zoran Milanović, political leader of the Social Democratic Party (SDP) Appointed as 5th President of Croatia for the 2nd consecutive term. He served as the President of Croatia for the 1st time in January 2020 by defeating former president Kolinda GrabarKitarovic.

India achieved a record renewable energy capacity addition of 30 GW in 2024, according to data from the Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (MNRE). India targets 500 GW of renewable energy capacity by 2030.





Ques : Which bank has introduced the 'Chiranjeevi-Super Senior Citizen FD' scheme?

- (a) HDFC bank
- (b) ICICI bank
- (c) RBL bank
- (d) Bandhan bank
- (e) IDBI bank

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- IDBI Bank has launched a new fixed deposit scheme, 'IDBI Chiranjeevi-Super Senior Citizen FD,' for customers aged 80 and above.
- The scheme offers higher interest rates, with an additional 65 basis points over standard fixed deposit rates and 15 basis points over existing senior citizen rates.
- The 555-day tenure offers an annual interest rate of 8.05 percent, making it a highly competitive option.
- The bank has also created tempting rates for various term alternatives, such as 7.90% per annum for 375 days, 8.0% per annum for 444 days, and 7.85% per annum for 700 days.

About IDBI Bank :

- Established : 1 July 1964
- HQ : Mumbai
- MD & CEO : Rakesh Sharma
- Tagline : Bank Aisa Dost Jaisa

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which Bank has introduced two new slabs for savings bank (SB) deposit holders ?

- (a) AU Small Finance Bank Limited
- (b) Capital Small Finance Bank Limited
- (c) Jana Small Finance Bank
- (d) Shivalik Small Finance Bank
- (e) Equitas Small Finance Bank Limited

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Equitas Small Finance Bank has added two new slabs for savings bank (SB) deposit holders.
- Balances exceeding Rs.10 lakhs, up to Rs.25 lakhs, and from Rs.25 lakhs to Rs.1 crore yield 7% and 7.25% interest, respectively.
- Interest rates for balances up to Rs.1 lakh will remain at 3.00%, while the expanded slab for balances between Rs.1 lakh and Rs.10 lakhs would be 5%.
- Balances ranging from Rs.1 crore to Rs.25 crore will earn 7.50 percent. For balances above Rs.25 crore, the current rate of 7.80% remains constant.

About Equitas Small Finance Bank :

- Headquarters- Chennai
- MD & CEO – P.N. Vasudevan
- Tagline – It's fun banking

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Who has been appointed as the Group Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Angel One?

- (a) Sundar Pichai
- (b) Ambarish Kenghe
- (c) Satya Nadella
- (d) Rajesh Gopinathan
- (e) Nandan Nilekani

Answer : option B

Explanation :

- Angel One has named Ambarish Kenghe as its group CEO. Kenghe will inherit the position in March 2025.
- Kenghe has previously served as vice president and general manager, Google Pay APAC, where he was instrumental in increasing the platform's reach and supporting the UPI ecosystem in India.
- His previous positions were chief product officer for Myntra, consultant for Bain & Company, and engineer at Cisco Systems.

About Angel One :

- Established : 1996
- HQ : Mumbai, Maharashtra
- CMD : Dinesh Thakkar

EXAM
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Recent Appointment in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- Baldev Prakash : deputy managing director and group chief risk officer of State Bank of India
- Amit Ganorkar : Managing Director(MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of TATA AIG General Insurance Company (Replaced Neelesh Garg)
- Jatinder Pal Singh : CEO of ITI Asset Management (ITI AML) (succeeding Hitesh Thakkar)
- Rajat Verma : CEO of DBS Bank India (succeeding Surojit Shome)
- Anup Kumar Sinha : Reappointment as Bandhan Bank's non-executive chairman
- Amitava Chatterjee : Managing director (MD) and CEO J&K Bank
- Alok Aggarwal : Managing Director and CEO of Brookfield India Real Estate Trust
- R Subramaniakumar : MD & CEO of RBL Bank
- Ram Mohan Rao Amara : Managing Director of State Bank of India (SBI)
- George Heber Joseph : Chief investment officer (CIO) of the newly- incorporated joint venture firm Jio BlackRock Asset Management Company (AMC)
- Manish Jain : Executive Director of YES Bank
- R Ramaseshan : Part-time Chairman' (independent director) of Jana Small Finance Bank (JSFB) Limited (Replaced Subhash Khuntia)
- Bhavesh Jain : Managing Director and CEO of TransUnion CIBIL
- Sanjay Malhotra : 26th Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for three years
- Vaibhav Chaturvedi : ex-officio member of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI)
- Vijay Chandok : MD & CEO of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) (Replaced Padmaja Chunduru)

EXAM
Genius





Ques : What is the India's wholesale price inflation in December ?

- (a) 2.37%
- (b) 4.27%
- (c) 2.15%
- (d) 1.54%
- (e) 3.45%

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- India's wholesale price inflation rose to 2.37% in December 2024, up from 1.89% in November, driven by higher prices in manufactured products, non-food articles, and fuel and power
- It was 0.86 per cent in December 2023.

Recent WPI-based Retail inflation in India :

- November 2024 : 1.89%
- October 2024 : 2.36%
- September 2024 : 1.84%
- August 2024 : 1.31%
- July 2024 : 2.04%

EXAM
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Ques : Where did the first edition of the Kho Kho World Cup take place?

- (a) Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium, New Delhi
- (b) Kalinga Stadium, Bhubaneswar
- (c) Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, New Delhi
- (d) Salt Lake Stadium, Kolkata
- (e) M. Chinnaswamy Stadium, Bengaluru

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The first Kho Kho World Cup kicked off on January 13, 2025, at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium in New Delhi. Sudhanshu Mittal, President of the Indian Kho Kho Federation, officially opened the World Cup.
- The Kho Kho Federation of India, with the Indian Olympic Association's cooperation, will host the Kho Kho World Cup in New Delhi from January 13 to 19, 2025.
- During the World Cup, each team will have 12 players, but during a match, only 9 players from each team will take the field.
- The first Kho Kho World Cup will feature 20 men's and 19 women's teams from throughout the world. The male and female kho kho teams have been separated into four divisions.
- Pratik Waikar leads the Indian men's team of 15 members, while Priyanka Ingle leads the women's team.





Ques : The Gaan Ngai festival commemorates the end of the harvest season and is celebrated in which state ?

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Mizoram
- (c) Assam
- (d) Manipur
- (e) Meghalaya

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Gaan Ngai celebration, honoring the conclusion of the harvest season for the Kabui/Rongmei Naga group, is being held in Manipur.
- Gaan-ngai is a festival of lights and victory, namely victory against evil.
- Gaan-ngai is often referred to as the winter celebration. Chakaan means season, Gaan means winter, and Ngai means festival. This celebration is also known as a New Year's festival because it celebrates the conclusion of the year and the start of the New Year.

About Manipur :

- Capital – Imphal
- Chief Minister – Biren Singh
- Governor – Ajay Bhalla

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Recent News Headlines Related to Festivals & Fairs :

- Elephant and Tourism Festival 18th Edition : Held at Baghmara Intermediate Community Forest near the renowned Chitwan National Park, Sauraha, Chitwan, Nepal
- Kagyad Dance event : Sikkim at Gangtok's Tsuklakhang Palace
- Ladakhi Losar : Celebrated in Ladakh to mark the New Year according to the Tibetan calendar
- Viraasat Sari Festival 2024 : 3rd Edition Hosted by Ministry of Textiles at Handloom Haat, Janpath, New Delhi
- Eaglenest Bird Festival : Arunachal Pradesh in Kellong and Thongre village, West Kameng District
- International Gita Mahotsav : Kurukshetra, Haryana
- Asthalakshmi Mahotsav : New Delhi, It will focus on India's eight north-eastern states
- Cherry Blossom Festival : Shillong, Meghalaya
- Hornbill Festival : Nagaland
- Bodoland Mohotsav : celebration of the Bodo language in Delhi (theme is 'Peace and Harmony for Prosperous Bharat')
- Jauljibi Mela : Pithoragarh, Uttarakhand
- Igas Bagwal (also known as Budhi Diwali or Harbodhni Ekadashi) : Uttarakhand
- Bali Padyami festival (Bali Pratipada) : Karnataka
- Ningol Chakkouba : Meitei community in Manipur
- 20th Divya Kala Mela : goal is to help Divyang craftsmen market and promote their products
- 8th Bhartiya Kala Mahotsav : President Droupadi Murmu has inaugurated in Secunderabad, Telangana. focuses on the North-Eastern states.
- Jivitputrika or Jitiya Vrat : Hindu festival celebrated by mothers in northern and eastern India, including Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand, and Nepal.
- Naga King Chilli festival : Seiyhama village in Nagaland celebrated 3rd edition belongs to the genus Capsicum
- harvest festival of Karma or Karam Parv : Tribal populations of many states
- 9th Ladakh Zaskar Festival 2024 : Celebrated in Zaskar, situated in the Ladakh





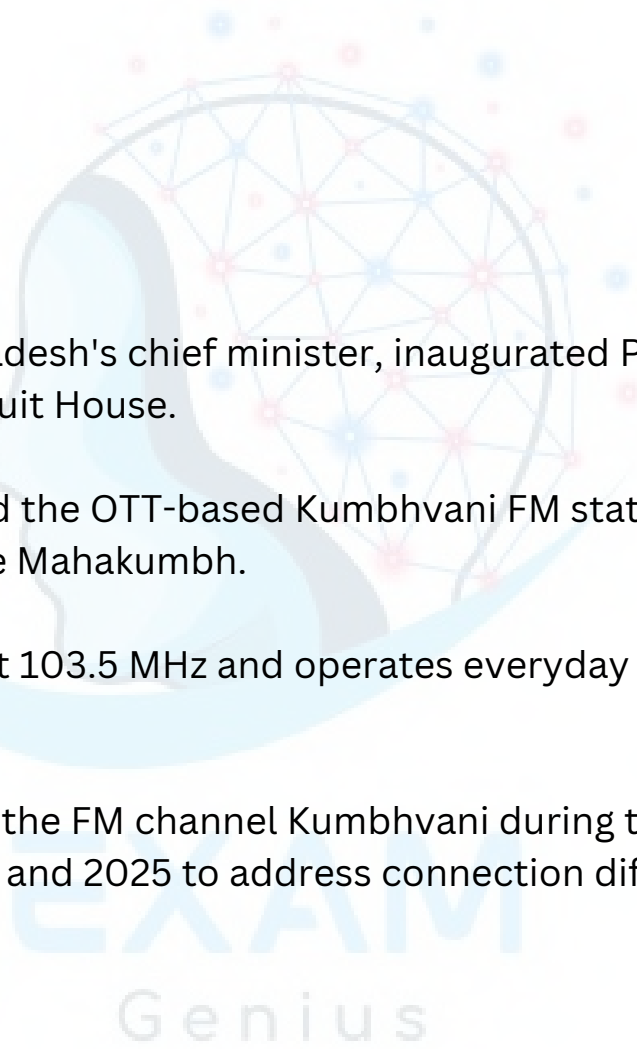
Ques : Which state inaugurated Prasar Bharati's FM channel 'Kumbhvani' at the Circuit House ?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) Madhya Pradesh

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Yogi Adityanath, Uttar Pradesh's chief minister, inaugurated Prasar Bharati's FM station 'Kumbhvani' at Circuit House.
- Prasar Bharati has created the OTT-based Kumbhvani FM station to provide detailed information on the Mahakumbh.
- The channel broadcasts at 103.5 MHz and operates everyday from 5:55 am to 10:05 pm.
- Prasar Bharati developed the FM channel Kumbhvani during the Kumbh celebrations in 2013, 2019, and 2025 to address connection difficulties in remote locations.





Ques : Union Minister of Commerce & Industry, Piyush Goyal has inaugurated the National Turmeric Board in which city ?

- (a) Guwahati
- (b) New Delhi
- (c) Kaziranga
- (d) Kolkata
- (e) Varanasi

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Piyush Goyal, Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, has launched the National Turmeric Board at Vanijya Bhawan in New Delhi, which will benefit cultivators in 20 states.
- The government has named Palle Ganga Reddy as its first chairwoman. The Board's headquarters are in Nizamabad, Telangana.
- Representatives from other ministries will join the National Turmeric Board in the coming days. Representatives from exporter and producer organizations will also serve on the Board.
- The Board will ensure the quality and safety of turmeric production and exports. Last year, 2023-24, India cultivated 3.05 lakh hectares of turmeric, producing 10.74 lakh tonnes.
- Turmeric, often referred to as the “Golden Spice,” holds immense economic potential for Indian farmers, particularly those in 20 states including Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Madhya Pradesh, and Meghalaya.
- India is the world's top producer, consumer, and exporter of turmeric. India accounts for more than 70% of global turmeric production, with 30 types grown in the country.
- During 2023-24, 1.62 lakh tonnes of turmeric and turmeric products worth 226.5 million USD were exported.
- The government of India has set a target of Rs8000 crore of turmeric by 2030.





News Headlines Related to Ministry :

- Piyush Goyal, Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, presented the 'Bharat Cleantech Manufacturing Platform', which the Centre described as a "initiative designed to enhance India's cleantech value chains in the solar, wind, hydrogen, and battery storage sectors".
- Piyush Goyal, Union Minister of Commerce and Industry, has started the 8th edition of the National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP) at the Bharat Ratna C. Subramaniam Auditorium (NASC Complex), Pusa in New Delhi.
- The Animal Welfare Board of India (AWBI), a statutory agency under the Department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying of the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry, and Dairying, has signed a MOU with NALSAR University of Law in Hyderabad.
- Dr. Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology, revealed that the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) has created technology to synthesize Paracetamol in-house.
- Nitin Gadkari, Union Minister of traffic Transport and Highways, has announced a new plan that will provide cashless treatment to traffic accident victims. the policy will immediately cover the victim's treatment costs for 7 days, up to a maximum of Rs 1.5 lakh.
- Rajiv Ranjan Singh, Union Minister of Animal Husbandry and Fisheries, has opened the country's first organic fisheries cluster in Sikkim.
- First phase of the 'One Nation, One Subscription (ONOS)' Launched by Ministry of Education(MoE). An Outlay of Rs 6,000 crore released for three years, from 1st January 2025 to 31st December 2027.
- Mission MAUSAM Approved in September 2024. It is Led by Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) with the Aim to make India "Weather Ready" and "Climate Smart", complying with the international standards by 2026. It has an Outlay of Rs 2,000 crore for 2 years.
- The Ministry of Consumer Affairs has partnered with messaging platform Gupshup to introduce a web-based AI virtual assistant, Jagriti, to simplify the process of filing consumer complaints.





Ques : Who is the author of the book Middle Class India: Driving Change in the 21st Century?

- (a) Arundhati Roy
- (b) P. Sainath
- (c) Shashi Tharoor
- (d) Chetan Bhagat
- (e) Manisha Pande

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Manisha Pande, a journalist, has released the book Middle Class India: Driving Change in the 21st Century.

It's divided into three parts :

- Part I examines the middle class in pre-Independence India, namely from 1757 to 1947.
- Part II focuses on the period between 1947, when India gained independence from British colonial control, and 1991, when economic reform began.
- Part III discusses the post-liberalisation scenario from 1991 to the present day.

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Recent News Headlines Related to Books :

- “Chhaunk: On Food, Economics and Society (Juggernaut)” : Abhijit Vinayak Banerjee and Cheyenne Olivier
- 'Jammu Kashmir & Ladakh Through the Ages: A Visual Narrative of Continuities and Linkages' : Professor Raghuvendra Tanwar
- In Pursuit of Democracy : Najma Heptulla
- The Nehru Development Model : Arvind Panagariya
- Living with Birds : Asad Rahamani
- BRING IT ON: The Incredible Story of My Life : Dr. Deepa Malik
- New Bharat – Modi’s Vision and Development 2019-2024 : Ravi Prashar and Released by Union Minister of Culture and Tourism Gajendra Singh Shekhawat
- 3 Books - Hindu Rashtra Hai Kya , The Fight for the Republic and Reflections on Culture, Media, and Science : Published by Safdar Hashmi Memorial Trust (SAHMAT) based in New Delhi and Tulika Books
- Tipu Sultan-The Saga of the Mysore Interregnum : Vikram Sampath
- Loh Purush Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel Ka Jeevanvrit : Rakesh Kumar Sharma
- "Why the Heck Not?" - a blueprint for success from the man behind DLF : KP Singh and Aparna Jain
- Beyond the Higgs Boson: The W Boson : Manik Kotwal
- My Beloved Life tells the story of Jadunath : Amitava Kumar
- Ratan Tata: A Life : Thomas Mathew
- Why Bharat Matters : External Affairs Minister Dr S. Jaishankar

EXAM
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Ques : Annabel Sutherland selected as the ICC Women's player of the month for December 2024. She is from which country ?

- (a) England
- (b) New Zealand
- (c) Australia
- (d) South Africa
- (e) Ireland

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The International Cricket Council (ICC) has named Jasprit Bumrah of India and Annabel Sutherland of Australia as the ICC Men's and Women's Players of the Month for December 2024, respectively.
- Top-ranked Test bowler Bumrah provided stern resistance to Australia's resurgence in a compelling Border-Gavaskar Trophy series with destructive bowling spells.
- Sutherland was in sparkling form during Australia's ODI matches against India and New Zealand, winning Player of the Series twice for her all-round contributions.
- Both players were crowned after a vote by global fans registered on ICC-cricket.com and an expert panel of ICC Hall of Famers, former international players, and media representatives.

Recent ICC players of the month :

- November 2024 : Haris Rauf (Pakistan) (Men) and Danni Wyatt-Hodge (England) (women)
- October 2024 : Amelia Kerr (New Zealand) (Men) and Noman Ali (Pakistan) (women)
- September 2024 : Kamindu Mendis (Sri Lanka) (Men) and Tammy Beaumont (England) (women)
- August 2024 : Dunith Wellalage (Sri Lanka) (Men) and Harshitha Samarawickrama (Sri Lanka) (women)





Ques : Who is the Chairman of the reconstituted Atomic Energy Commission (AEC)?

- (a) Manoj Govil
- (b) Pankaj Kumar Mishra
- (c) Suresh Kumar
- (d) Ajit Kumar Mohanty
- (e) Anamika sen

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The government has reconstituted the Atomic Energy Commission (AEC), which now includes T V Somanathan and Manoj Govil, who have taken over as Cabinet Secretary and Expenditure Secretary, respectively.
- The AEC also includes Pankaj Kumar Mishra, who was appointed as Member (Finance) last year, according to a notification made on October 21 and published in the Gazette on January 9.
- Ajit Kumar Mohanty, Secretary of the Department of Atomic Energy, serves as Chairman of the reformed AEC.
- The AEC is responsible for developing policy for the Department of Atomic Energy.

About The Atomic Energy Commission :

- The Atomic Energy Commission was founded in August 1948 as a division of the Department of Scientific Research.
- The Department of Atomic Energy was established later, on August 3, 1954, with direct supervision from the Prime Minister.
- The AEC was officially established in March 1958, following a government resolution. This historical framework laid the groundwork for India's nuclear policy evolution.





Recent Appointment in different departments :

- Devajit Saikia : New secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)
- Prabhtej Singh Bhatia : Treasurer of the Indian Cricket Board
- Brijendra Pratap Singh : Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of National Aluminium Company (NALCO)
- B. N. Srikrishna : Chairperson of Equal's newly formed Advisory Board
- Tuhin Kanta Pandey : Secretary, Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance
- Dr. V Narayanan : chairman of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- Bahadur Singh Sagoo : President of the Athletics Federation of India (AFI) (Replaced Adille Sumariwalla)
- Mike Johnson, a Republican from Louisiana : Speaker of the U.S. House of Representatives
- Devajit Saikia : Chief Secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)
- Prabhtej Singh Bhatia : Treasurer of BCCI
- Sanjiv Ranjan : Secretary General of the Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA) Secretariat in Ebene, Mauritius (Replaced Salman Al-Farisi of Indonesia)
- Senior bureaucrat Akash Tripathi : Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Power
- Ashutosh Agnihotri : Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of the Food Corporation of India (FCI)
- Jyoti Sharma : Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Nasscom Foundation
- Kamal Kishore Soan : Additional Secretary and Mission Director of the Jal Jeevan Mission, which is part of the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation
- Shubha Thakur : Inter State Council Secretariat of the Home Ministry

EXAM
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Ques : What type of missile is the Nag Mk 2?

- (a) Surface-to-Air Missile
- (b) Air-to-Air Missile
- (c) Cruise Missile
- (d) Ballistic Missile
- (e) Anti-Tank Guided Missile

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- India successfully evaluated its indigenously built third-generation Anti-Tank Fire-and-Forget Guided Missile (Nag Mk 2) at Rajasthan's Pokhran Field Firing Range.
- The missile travels at 230 m/s and can kill enemy tanks up to 4 km away in 17-18 seconds.
- The rocket, weighing around 45 kilos and measuring 6 feet 1 inch, can quickly destroy enemy tanks and armored vehicles.
- The DRDO developed the missile at a cost of Rs.300 crore.
- The missile's first successful test occurred in 1990. Trials in 2017, 2018, and 2019 included technological improvements.

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Recent News Headlines related to Defence

- Blue Origin's New Glenn rocket will launch at 1 a.m. ET Monday from the Cape Canaveral Space Force Station in Florida.
- Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) successfully launched two indigenously designed Fast Patrol Vessels (FPVs) for the Indian Coast Guard.
- India and the US have partnered to co-produce US sonobuoys for the Indian Navy's underwater domain awareness (UDA).
- People's Liberation Army Navy (PLAN) officially launched its latest amphibious assault ship (AAS) from Shanghai, named 'Sichuan' after a province in southwestern China.
- India has designated 2025 to be the 'year of changes' in the defence sector, promising "unprecedented" progress in strengthening India's security and sovereignty in the face of 21st-century challenges.
- Pakistan's atomic energy regulatory agency has approved the construction of the country's largest nuclear reactor for electricity generating.
- The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has signed a contract to Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL) in Mumbai for air independent propulsion (AIP) plugs valued roughly Rs 1,990 crore.
- India marked a significant milestone in its self-reliance by delivering two warships to the Indian Navy: the destroyer Surat and the frigate Nilgiri.
- China successfully launched four Earth-observation radar satellites called 'PIESAT-2' using a Long March-2D rocket from the Taiyuan Satellite Launch Center in Shanxi Province.
- Space entrepreneurs in Japan and India had agreed to collaborate on a study of utilizing laser-equipped spacecraft to remove garbage from orbit, as an experimental answer to the increasingly pressing problem of orbital congestion.
- China's space program reached a milestone when two of its astronauts performed a nine-hour spacewalk. Shenzhou-19 crew members Cai Xuzhe and Song Lingdong completed a nine-hour extravehicular exercise (EVA), breaking a 22-year-old US record.
- Defence PSU BEML Limited has secured Rs.136 crore contract to supply indigenously designed High Mobility Vehicles (HMs) 8x8.
- Starting in 2025, India's Aditya L1 and the European Space Agency's (ESA) Proba-3 missions will collaborate to further solar research.
- INS Tushil, a Russian-built guided missile frigate, was commissioned into the Indian Navy in Kaliningrad, Russia, in front of Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Chief of Naval Staff Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi, and other senior officials.





Ques : What monthly pension has the Odisha government announced for people jailed during the Emergency?

- (a) Rs.5000
- (b) Rs.10000
- (c) Rs.15000
- (d) Rs.20000
- (e) Rs.25000

Answer : Option D

Expanation :

- Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi announced the establishment of a monthly stipend for individuals detained and imprisoned during the Emergency under the Maintenance of Internal Security Act, Defence of India Rule, or Defence and Internal Security of India Rules.
- The Odisha government has granted a monthly stipend of Rs 20,000 and other perks for those imprisoned during the Emergency.
- Along with the pension, the state government will cover the medical expenditures of all those imprisoned during the Emergency. Everyone who is still living on January 1, 2025, will be eligible for a pension and medical care.
- From June 25, 1975 to March 21, 1977, hundreds were imprisoned in various jails across the country for protesting the Emergency.





Ques : Which high court did K. Vinod Chandran serve as the Chief Justice before being elevated to the Supreme Court?

- (a) Delhi High Court
- (b) Patna High Court
- (c) Kerala High Court
- (d) Bombay High Court
- (e) Madras High Court

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- K Vinod Chandran, Chief Justice of the Patna High Court, was elevated to the Supreme Court. The Supreme Court Collegium approved Justice Chandran's name.
- Justice Chandran was appointed as a judge of the Kerala High Court on November 8, 2011. On March 29, 2023, he was appointed Chief Justice of the Patna High Court.
- Once he takes his oath as a Supreme Court judge, the court's working strength will increase to 33. It has a sanctioned strength of 34, including the Chief Justice of India.
- The appointment was made by the President in exercise of his duties under Article 124 (2) of the Constitution.

EXAM
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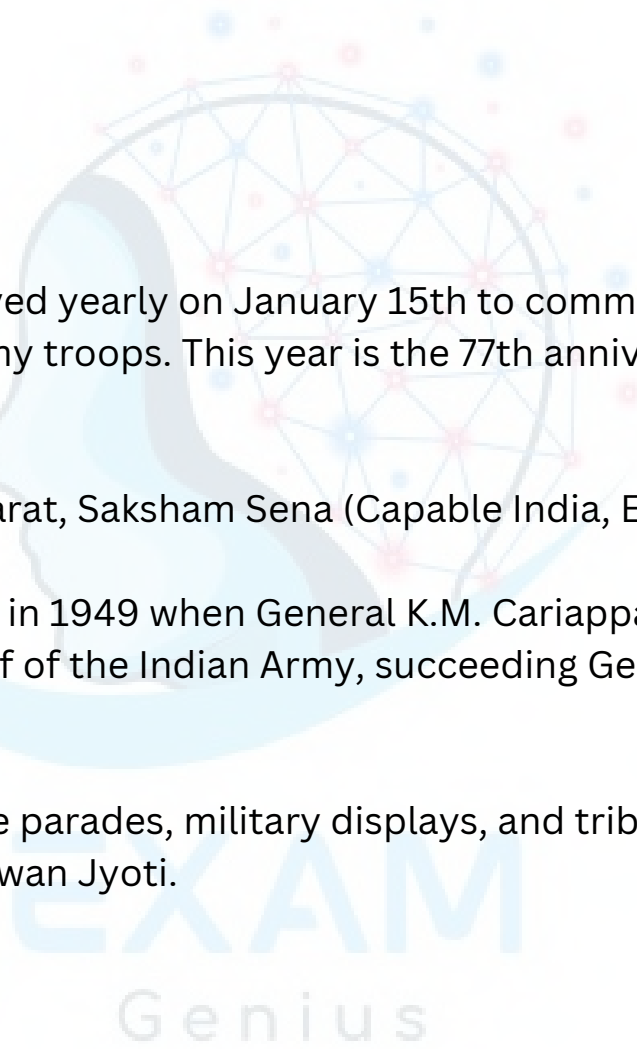
Ques : Indian Army Day is celebrated annually on which day ?

- (a) 15 January
- (b) 16 January
- (c) 17 January
- (d) 18 January
- (e) 19 January

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Indian Army Day is observed yearly on January 15th to commemorate the bravery and sacrifices of Indian Army troops. This year is the 77th anniversary of Indian Army Day.
- Theme 2025: Samarth Bharat, Saksham Sena (Capable India, Empowered Army).
- It commemorates the day in 1949 when General K.M. Cariappa became the first Indian Commander-in-Chief of the Indian Army, succeeding General Sir Francis Roy Bucher.
- The day is marked by huge parades, military displays, and tributes at the National War Memorial and Amar Jawan Jyoti.





Ques : When is National Startup Day celebrated in India?

- (a) 15 January
- (b) 16 January
- (c) 17 January
- (d) 18 January
- (e) 19 January

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- National Startup Day is held yearly on January 16th to acknowledge and promote India's entrepreneurial spirit.
- It was initially declared by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2022 to commemorate startups' contributions to the Indian economy.
- The day emphasizes startups' role in fostering innovation, job development, and economic growth across multiple sectors.

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Important days :

- 24 December : National Consumer Rights Day
- 25 December : Good Governance Day
- 26 December : Boxing Day
- 26 December : Computer Operators' Day
- 26 December : Veer Bal Divas A Day of Valor And Righteousness
- 27 December : International Day of Epidemic Preparedness
- 29 December : International Cello Day
- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 2 January : 67th Foundation Day of Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day
- 4 January : World Braille Day
- 5 January : National Bird Day (Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future)
- 6 January : World Day of War Orphans
- 6 January : Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) celebrated its 78th Foundation Day
- 8 January : Earth's Rotation Day
- 9 January : NRI or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- 10 January : World Hindi Day, also known as 'Vishwa Hindi Diwas' (Theme 2025: A Global Voice of Unity and Cultural Pride)
- 12 January : National Youth Day (Theme 2025: Youth for a Sustainable Future: Shaping the Nation with Resilience and Responsibility)





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Uttar Pradesh is considering the privatization of two of its four power distribution companies—Dakshinanchal Vidyut Vitran Nigam and Purvanchal Vidyut Vitran Nigam.

PV Sindhu, two-time Olympic medallist and one of India's greatest sporting trailblazers, has joined forces with sports brand PUMA India in a multi-year partnership as brand ambassador.

Thalai Pongal, the first day of the Tamil month, is a significant harvest festival celebrated with fervor across Tamil Nadu. The Tamil Nadu Tourism Development Corporation (TNTDC) organized a grand celebration in Nanjikottai village near Thanjavur.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has launched “Mission Mausam”, which aims to make the country a “weather-ready” and “climate-smart” nation, in New Delhi as part of the events marking the 150th foundation day of the India Meteorological Department.

India has signed an agreement with Saudi Arabia for Hajj 2025, finalising a quota of 1,75,025 pilgrims. Union Minister for Minority Affairs Kiren Rijiju signed the deal in Jeddah with Saudi Minister for Hajj and Umrah Tawfiq Bin Fawzan Al Rabiah.

Avaniyapuram Jallikattu Festival Held at Avaniyapuram village, near the Sri Bathrakaliamman Temple, Madurai, Tamil Nadu. 1,100 bulls and 900 bull-tamers participate and The best bull is awarded a tractor valued at Rs.11 lakh, while the top bull-tamer receives a car worth Rs.8 lakh.

Genius





Ques : Who has been appointed as the Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Punjab National Bank (PNB)?

- (a) Rajnish Kumar
- (b) S. S. Mallikarjuna Rao
- (c) Atanu Kumar Das
- (d) Ashok Chandra
- (e) Shyam Srinivasan

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Punjab National Bank (PNB) has selected Ashok Chandra as its Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO).
- Before these positions, Chandra was an executive director at Canara Bank. He replaced Atul Kumar Goel.
- Chandra, who joined Canara Bank as an executive director in November 2022, was in charge of a variety of verticals, including digital banking and information technology, strategy and planning, marketing and public relations, financial inclusion, micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSME), retail assets, agriculture, and priority sectors.
- Chandra began his banking career as a probationary officer at what was then known as Corporation Bank in September 1991.

About Punjab National Bank :

- Established : 19 May 1894
- HQ : New Delhi
- MD & CEO : Ashok Chandra
- Tagline : The Name You Can Bank Upon





Ques : Which Indian organization has partnered with UAE-based Magnati to advance QR-based UPI payments in the Middle East?

- (a) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- (b) State Bank of India (SBI)
- (c) NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)
- (d) Paytm
- (e) HDFC Bank

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL) has teamed with Magnati, a UAE-based payment solution provider, to promote QR-based Unified Payments Interface (UPI) merchant payments using point-of-sale (POS) terminals across the Middle East.
- The collaboration intends to expand the QR-based merchant payment network in the UAE by allowing more businesses to accept UPI as a payment method from Indian travelers, according to NIPL, the international branch of the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI).
- UPI is regarded as one of the world's most successful real-time payment systems, handling over 16 billion transactions by December 2024.
- The agreement will first provide UPI acceptance throughout Dubai Duty Free, improving the shopping and payment experience for Indian tourists.

About NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL) :

- Established : 2020
- HQ : Mumbai
- CEO : Ritesh Shukla





Ques : Tata Capital raises how much through maiden international bond ?

- (a) \$100 million
- (b) \$200 million
- (c) \$300 million
- (d) \$400 million
- (e) \$500 million

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Tata Capital Ltd, the Tata group's financial services arm, raised \$400 million through a maiden international bond with a 5.38 percent interest rate.
- The senior unsecured bond has a 3.5-year tenor and will be used to fund corporate operations, including lending.
- Tata Capital initiated the deal with an initial price guidance of US Treasury + 125 basis points (bps) in response to considerable investor demand.

About Tata Capital Ltd :

- Established : 2007
- HQ : Mumbai
- MD & CEO : Rajiv Sabharwal

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Ques : Who has been appointed as the MD & CEO of Institutional Equities at JM Financial Institutional Securities?

- (a) Ramesh Gupta
- (b) Alok Sharma
- (c) Ankur Jhaveri
- (d) Ravi Iyer
- (e) Prashant Mehta

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- JM Financial has named Ankur Jhaveri MD & CEO of Institutional Equities at JM Financial Institutional Securities. He will be in charge of improving the sales, trading, research, and derivatives sectors.
- Ankur has approximately 20 years of expertise in institutional stocks and derivatives. Before to JM Financial, he was Managing Director at Axis Capital.
- He earned an MBA in Finance and Financial Management Services from the NL Dalmia Institute of Management Studies and Research, as well as a Master's degree in Finance (International Finance) from ICFAI University.

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Ques : What is the GDP growth forecast for India by FICCI for the financial year 2024-25?

- (a) 6.4%
- (b) 5.6%
- (c) 6.8%
- (d) 5.2%
- (e) 6.7%

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The FICCI expects India's GDP to rise by 6.4% in fiscal year 2024-25.
- This is a decrease from the 7.0% prediction issued in September 2024 and represents a significant deceleration from the 8.2% growth observed in 2023-24.
- The agricultural industry, including allied activities, is predicted to rise 3.6% in 2024-25, according to the FICCI Survey.

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Ques : Where were the three naval combatants commissioned?

- (a) Kochi Naval Base
- (b) Naval Dockyard, Mumbai
- (c) Visakhapatnam Naval Dockyard
- (d) Chennai Port
- (e) Goa Naval Base

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- On Indian Army Day, Prime Minister Narendra Modi dedicated three frontline naval combatants to the nation: INS Surat, INS Nilgiri, and INS Vaghsheer, which were commissioned at the Naval Dockyard in Mumbai, Maharashtra.
- The Prime Minister also introduced new platforms, such as the INS Nilgiri, which honors the Chola dynasty's nautical strength, and the Surat battleship.
- INS Surat, the fourth and last ship of the P15B Guided Missile Destroyer Project, is one of the world's largest and most advanced destroyers.
- INS Nilgiri, the first ship in the P17A Stealth Frigate Project, was designed by the Indian Navy's Warship Design Bureau and has sophisticated features for increased survivability, seakeeping, and stealth.
- INS Vaghsheer is the sixth and final submarine of the P75 Scorpene Project.





Recent News Headlines related to Defence

- India successfully evaluated its indigenously built third-generation Anti-Tank Fire-and-Forget Guided Missile (Nag Mk 2) at Rajasthan's Pokhran Field Firing Range.
- Blue Origin's New Glenn rocket will launch at 1 a.m. ET Monday from the Cape Canaveral Space Force Station in Florida.
- Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) successfully launched two indigenously designed Fast Patrol Vessels (FPVs) for the Indian Coast Guard.
- India and the US have partnered to co-produce US sonobuoys for the Indian Navy's underwater domain awareness (UDA).
- People's Liberation Army Navy (PLAN) officially launched its latest amphibious assault ship (AAS) from Shanghai, named 'Sichuan' after a province in southwestern China.
- India has designated 2025 to be the 'year of changes' in the defence sector, promising "unprecedented" progress in strengthening India's security and sovereignty in the face of 21st-century challenges.
- Pakistan's atomic energy regulatory agency has approved the construction of the country's largest nuclear reactor for electricity generating.
- The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has signed a contract to Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL) in Mumbai for air independent propulsion (AIP) plugs valued roughly Rs 1,990 crore.
- India marked a significant milestone in its self-reliance by delivering two warships to the Indian Navy: the destroyer Surat and the frigate Nilgiri.
- China successfully launched four Earth-observation radar satellites called 'PIESAT-2' using a Long March-2D rocket from the Taiyuan Satellite Launch Center in Shanxi Province.
- Space entrepreneurs in Japan and India had agreed to collaborate on a study of utilizing laser-equipped spacecraft to remove garbage from orbit, as an experimental answer to the increasingly pressing problem of orbital congestion.
- China's space program reached a milestone when two of its astronauts performed a nine-hour spacewalk. Shenzhou-19 crew members Cai Xuzhe and Song Lingdong completed a nine-hour extravehicular exercise (EVA), breaking a 22-year-old US record.
- Defence PSU BEML Limited has secured Rs.136 crore contract to supply indigenously designed High Mobility Vehicles (HMs) 8x8.
- Starting in 2025, India's Aditya L1 and the European Space Agency's (ESA) Proba-3 missions will collaborate to further solar research.
- INS Tushil, a Russian-built guided missile frigate, was commissioned into the Indian Navy in Kaliningrad, Russia, in front of Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Chief of Naval Staff Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi, and other senior officials.





Ques : What is the rank of India in Annual India Fintech Report 2024 ?

- (a) 1st
- (b) 2nd
- (c) 3rd
- (d) 4th
- (e) 5th

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Annual India Fintech Report 2024 Published by Tracxn Technologies Limited
- India placed third globally in fintech funding, despite a 33% year-over-year fall to USD 1.9 billion from USD 2.8 billion in 2023.
- The fintech sector received USD 805 million in funding in Q3 2024, a 61% increase over the previous year.
- According to the research, early-stage fundraising rounds decreased by 16% year on year, from USD 667 million in 2023 to USD 562 million in 2024, and by 70% from USD 1.9 billion in 2022.
- Seed-stage funding decreased by 19% year on year, from USD 219 million in 2023 to USD 178 million in 2024, and by 66% from USD 529 million in 2022.

Top 3 in Tracxn's Annual India Fintech Report 2024 :

- Country : 1. United States of America (USA) 2. United Kingdom (UK) 3. India
- Top 3 Indian cities which emerged as hub for fintech funding in 2024 : 1. Bengaluru 2. Mumbai 3. Delhi
- Top 3 Investing Companies : 1. XV Partners 2. LetsVenture Technologies Private Limited 3. Y Combinator
- Top 3 companies in Seed Investments : 1. Catalysts Private Limited 2. Y Combinator LLC 3. Antler



Ques : What is the primary aim of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023?

- (a) To reduce the tenure of election commissioners
- (b) To centralize the election process
- (c) To widen the scope of selection of election commissioners
- (d) To introduce electronic voting machines
- (e) To limit the powers of the Election Commission

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service, and Term of Office) Act of 2023 establishes new processes to broaden the scope of selection.

Background to the New Law for Appointing CECs and ECs :

- Article 324 of the Indian Constitution states that the President will nominate the CEC and ECs, however this is subject to Parliamentary law (if such law exists).
- While this provision requires Parliament to propose a corresponding law, it has not done so (until now).
- In the lack of such a law, the President has made selections based on the Prime Minister's recommendations.
- In 2023, the Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court (in the Anoop Baranwal v. Union of India case) agreed to modify the process for Election Commission selections in order to ensure their independence.
- The Bench formed a committee that included the Prime Minister, the Leader of the Opposition in Parliament, and the Chief Justice of India (CJI).
- This committee will provide recommendations to the President on Election Commission appointments until Parliament passes a separate statute on the subject.





New Appointment Process Under the Act :

- The Election Commission is made up of the Chief Election Commissioner and two Election Commissioners, who are currently Gyanesh Kumar and Sukhbir Singh Sandhu.
- Section 5 limits eligibility to current or past Secretary-level officers.
- Previously, the senior-most Election Commissioner succeeded the outgoing CEC. The Act provides for the selection of candidates outside of the Election Commission, which broadens the pool.
- Section 6 of the Act establishes a Search Committee chaired by the Minister of Law and Justice and two senior officials to select a panel of five candidates.
- Selection committee composition : The Prime Minister, a Cabinet minister, and the Lok Sabha's Leader of the Opposition make up the Selection Committee. This committee has the option of selecting a candidate within the panel or nominating someone from outside.

Ques : Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan has inaugurated the registration page for the third edition of Kashi Tamil Sangamam, a 10-day festival taking place in which city ?

- (a) Guwahati
- (b) New Delhi
- (c) Kaziranga
- (d) Kolkata
- (e) Varanasi

Answer : Option E





Explanation :

- Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan has inaugurated the registration page for the third edition of Kashi Tamil Sangamam, a 10-day festival taking place in Varanasi. The event will be held from February 15 to 24, 2025.
- The portal, kashitamil.iitm.ac.in, administered by the Indian Institute of Technology Madras, will take registrations till February 1.
- The event, organized by the Ministry of Education in partnership with the Uttar Pradesh government, will commemorate the long-standing ties between Tamil Nadu and Kashi. This year's event will be dedicated to Maharishi Agasthyar.
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi launched KTS 2.0 in Varanasi on December 17, 2023.

This year, the government has decided to bring around 1000 delegates from Tamil Nadu under five categories/groups :

- (i) Students, Teachers, and Writers
- (ii) Farmers and Artisans (Vishwakarma Categories)
- (iii) Professionals and Small Entrepreneurs
- (iv) Women (SHG, Mudra Loan beneficiaries, DBHPS Pracharaks)
- (v) Start-up, Innovation, Edu-Tech, Research.

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Ques : Who has been appointed as the Secretary of the Department of Higher Education under the Ministry of Education?

- (a) Alok Kumar
- (b) Ramesh Pokhriyal
- (c) Anurag Sharma
- (d) Amit Khare
- (e) Vineet Joshi

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Vineet Joshi, a seasoned Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer from the Manipur cadre in the 1992 batch, has been appointed Secretary of the Department of Higher Education under the Ministry of Education.
- Prior to this assignment, Joshi was Manipur's Chief Secretary, a position he took in May 2023 amidst growing ethnic tensions.
- Vineet Joshi previously served as the Director-General of the National Testing Agency (NTA), where he oversaw important entrance exams such as the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) and the Joint Entrance Examination (JEE) Main.
- He has also served as Chairman of the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE), where he was influential in implementing the Continuous and Comprehensive Evaluation (CCE) system.





Recent Appointment in different departments :

- K Vinod Chandran : Chief Justice of Supreme Court
- Ajit Kumar Mohanty : Chairman of the reformed Atomic Energy Commission (AEC)
- Devajit Saikia : New secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)
- Prabhtej Singh Bhatia : Treasurer of the Indian Cricket Board
- Brijendra Pratap Singh : Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of National Aluminium Company (NALCO)
- B. N. Srikrishna : Chairperson of Equal's newly formed Advisory Board
- Tuhin Kanta Pandey : Secretary, Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance
- Dr. V Narayanan : chairman of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- Bahadur Singh Sagoo : President of the Athletics Federation of India (AFI) (Replaced Adille Sumariwalla)
- Mike Johnson, a Republican from Louisiana : Speaker of the U.S. House of Representatives
- Devajit Saikia : Chief Secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)
- Prabhtej Singh Bhatia : Treasurer of BCCI
- Sanjiv Ranjan : Secretary General of the Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA) Secretariat in Ebene, Mauritius (Replaced Salman Al-Farisi of Indonesia)
- Senior bureaucrat Akash Tripathi : Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Power
- Ashutosh Agnihotri : Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of the Food Corporation of India (FCI)
- Jyoti Sharma : Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Nasscom Foundation
- Kamal Kishore Soan : Additional Secretary and Mission Director of the Jal Jeevan Mission, which is part of the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation
- Shubha Thakur : Inter State Council Secretariat of the Home Ministry
- Faiz Ahmed Kidwai : chief of the Directorate General of Civil Aviation





Ques : Where has the first astronomical observatory of Eastern India been inaugurated?

- (a) West Bengal
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Haryana
- (e) Maharashtra

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Department of Science and Technology, Union Ministry of Science and Technology, has inaugurated the first astronomical observatory in Eastern India and the sixth in the country, located on Panchet Hill in the Garpanchkot area of Purulia district in West Bengal.
- It is the sixth such observatory in India, following Ladakh, Nainital (Uttarakhand), Mount Abu (Rajasthan), Girbani Hills in Pune, and Kavalur in Tamil Nadu.
- The observatory in Garpanchkot Hills is named after the eminent scientist Satyendra Nath Bose. The Satyendra Nath Bose National Centre for Basic Sciences established the observatory.
- The Satyendra Nath Bose National Centre for Basic Sciences has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Sidhu Kanu Birsa University, Purulia to operate the observatory and share resources.
- In 1986, the Government of India's Department of Science and Technology established the Satyendra Nath Bose National Centre for Basic Sciences in Kolkata, West Bengal.





Ques : On which route is the first trial run of the hydrogen-powered train in India expected to take place?

- (a) Delhi-Agra
- (b) Mumbai-Pune
- (c) Jind-Sonipat
- (d) Chennai-Bengaluru
- (e) Jaipur-Ajmer

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- At the 18th Pravasi Bharatiya Divas, India's Railway Minister, Ashwini Vaishnaw, highlighted a significant success in green energy technology.
- Indian Railways has developed the world's most powerful hydrogen-powered train engine, surpassing the 500-600 horsepower engines developed by other countries. The engine generates 1,200 horsepower.
- The first trial run is expected on the Jind-Sonipat route in Haryana soon.

About Indian Railway :

- Established : 16 April 1853
- HQ : New Delhi
- Chairman & CEO : Satish Kumar

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Ques : Which Indian grandmaster defeated World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen and World No. 2 Fabiano Caruana in an online chess competition?

- (a) Praggnanandhaa R
- (b) Nihal Sarin
- (c) Gukesh D
- (d) Arjun Erigaisi
- (e) Viswanathan Anand

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Arjun Erigaisi, an Indian grandmaster, stunned the internet chess community by defeating World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen and World No. 2 Fabiano Caruana in Chess.com's Titled Tuesday weekly blitz competition.
- His Only loss in the tournament occurred in the seventh round to the American grandmaster Hikaru Nakamura. Nakamura also finished with 10 points, but the Indian grandmaster had a higher tiebreak record.
- He overcame Magnus Carlsen with black pieces in round 10, and then defeated Fabiano Caruana in the 11th and final round.
- Titled Tuesday is an online competition for titled chess players with legitimate Chess.com accounts. To ensure fair play, players are asked to be accessible on Zoom calls.





Ques : Who broke multiple records in the 3rd ODI against Ireland Women at the Niranjan Shah Stadium, Rajkot ?

- (a) Smriti Mandhana
- (b) Harmanpreet Kaur
- (c) Mithali Raj
- (d) Shafali Verma
- (e) Deepti Sharma

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Smriti Mandhana set many records in the third ODI against Ireland Women at the Niranjan Shah Stadium in Rajkot.
- Scored a century in just 70 balls, beating Harmanpreet Kaur's 87-ball record.
- Mandhana became the first Indian woman to score 10 ODI century.
- Mandhana's triple-figure total is the joint-seventh quickest in the format, matching former England cricketer Charlotte Edwards' feat in 2012.
- She now ranks third on the all-time list, alongside Australia's Tammy Beaumont, who has 10 centuries.

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Recent records in Cricket :

- Jasprit Bumrah : the bowler with the highest average among those with 200 or more Test wickets
- Richa Ghosh : India's wicket keeper-batter, made history by hitting the joint-fastest fifty in women's T20Is
- Nat SciverBrunt : Fastest Test Century in just 96 balls
- Shaheen Afridi (Pakistani) : country's first bowler to take 100 wickets in all formats of international cricket
- Virat Kohli : became the fastest cricketer to amass 27000 international runs, breaking Sachin Tendulkar's previous record.
- Ravindra Jadeja : became the first Indian left arm spinner to reach 300 test wickets
- Jasprit Bumrah : 10th Indian bowler to reach the illustrious milestone of 400 international wickets
- Kagiso Rabada : Fastest bowler to reach 300 Test wickets based on balls bowled, achieving the milestone in just 11,817 deliveries
- Harmanpreet Kaur : top run-scorer in women's T20I cricket for India
- Ravindra Jadeja : Climbs to 5th Spot in India's Test Wicket List
- Rohit Sharma : First cricketer in the world to hit 600 sixes in international cricket
- Smriti Mandhana : First Indian Woman Cricketer To Score Consecutive Centuries in ODIs
- Kagiso Rabada : Fastest bowler to reach 300 Test wickets based on balls bowled, achieving the milestone in just 11,817 deliveries
- Rohit Sharma 2nd player after MS Dhoni to play 250 matches in IPL
- Shafali Verma : Fastest double century in women's Test cricket
- Jos Buttler : Becomes first Englishman to make 3,000 T20I runs
- Sophie Ecclestone : Fastest woman to reach 100 wickets in One Day International (ODI) cricket
- Yuzvendra Chahal : first bowler to pick up 200 wickets in the history of the Indian Premier League (IPL)
- Dipendra Singh Airee, Nepal : Third man to hit six sixes in an over in an international T20 game





Ques : Who has inaugurated the 'Bharat Mobility Global Expo 2025', the largest mobility expo in the country, at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi ?

- (a) Draupadi Murmu
- (b) Narendra Modi
- (c) Om Birla
- (d) S Jaishankar
- (e) None of the above

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the 'Bharat Mobility Global Expo 2025,' the country's largest mobility expo, at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.
- The Expo, which will be hosted from January 17 to 22 at three different venues — Bharat Mandapam and Yashobhoomi in Delhi, and India Expo Center and Mart in Greater Noida — will feature over nine concurrent events, as well as over 20 seminars and pavilions.
- Furthermore, the Expo will include state sessions to highlight mobility-related regulations and initiatives, allowing for collaboration at the industry and regional level.
- It is an industry-led and government-supported project coordinated by India's Engineering Export Promotion Council (EEPC), with the cooperation of several industry associations and partner organizations.



Ques : The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has inked a Rs. 2,960 crore contract with which company to provide Medium-Range Surface-to-Air Missiles (MRSAM) to the Indian Navy ?

- (a) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited
- (b) Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited
- (c) Bharat Dynamic Limited
- (d) Tata Advanced Systems
- (e) Bharat Electronics Limited

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has inked a Rs. 2,960 crore contract with Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL) to provide Medium-Range Surface-to-Air Missiles (MRSAM) to the Indian Navy.
- The MRSAM system will be installed on several Indian military ships and is intended to be integrated into future naval platforms.
- This contract accords with the government's objective of 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat,' as the missiles are supplied under the 'Buy (Indian)' category, which includes primarily local content.
- The initiative is intended to provide approximately 3.5 lakh mandays of employment in the defence sector, including contributions from other MSMEs, hence strengthening India's defence manufacturing capabilities.





Ques : Under which ministry does the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) operate?

- (a) Union Ministry of Home Affairs
- (b) Union Ministry of Education
- (c) Union Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship
- (d) Union Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment
- (e) Union Ministry of Commerce and Industry

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry, has formed a strategic collaboration with ITC Limited, one of India's largest diversified conglomerates.
- This alliance establishes a shared goal to enhance startup growth and technology advancement while also creating sustainable market prospects for businesses across the country.
- Under this agreement, ITC intends to deploy startup solutions in important areas such as digital platforms for Manufacturing Execution Systems (MES), integrating renewable energy alternatives for manufacturing locations, energy storage systems, and so on.

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IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Cybersecurity Hackathon 2024-25 1st Edition Launched by Punjab National Bank (PNB). The Theme is “Code Against Malware”. Winners will receive prizes worth up to Rs 11 lakhs and have the opportunity to implement their solutions in live environments with PNB.

Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL) and Oil & Natural Gas Corporation Limited (ONGC) Signed MoU to explore collaboration in the area of New and Renewable Energy (NRE) sector.

Bank of Baroda has launched "bob Liquid Fixed Deposits" as an alternative to regular fixed deposits (FDs). The bob Liquid FD allows you flexible deposit amounts starting at Rs.5,000 (with no maximum deposit amount), duration options ranging from 12 to 60 months, and partial withdrawals in multiples of Rs.1,000.

India and Spain have signed two Memorandums of Understanding to promote and expand their bilateral relations. These agreements prioritized sports collaboration and sustainable urban development. both countries agreed to mark 2026 as the "Year of Culture, Tourism, and Artificial Intelligence (AI)".

According to Swiss Re's most recent insurance market outlook report, India's insurance industry is primed for strong growth, with the country expected to lead the G20 in premium expansion at an average rate of 7.3% per year between 2025 and 2029. Swiss Re also predicts that India will overtake Germany and Japan to become the world's third-largest economy by the end of the decade.

India is considering reducing its ownership in 5 state-run banks, including UCO Bank, Central Bank of India, Indian Overseas Bank, Bank of Maharashtra, and Punjab and Sind Bank. The goal is to bring down the government's stake in these banks below 75% to meet regulatory norms





Ques : How many Indian banks were ranked in the top 25 global banks by market capitalization in Q4 2024?

- (a) 1
- (b) 2
- (c) 3
- (d) 4
- (e) 5

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- GlobalData reports that three Indian banks, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank, and State Bank of India (SBI), are among the top 25 worldwide banks by market value in Q4 2024.
- ICICI Bank's market valuation increased by 25.8% to \$105.7 billion, reflecting India's increasing digital banking and credit ecosystem.
- In Q4 2024, the top 25 global banks' aggregate market value increased by 27.1% year on year to \$4.6 trillion.

Top 3 Indian banks :

- 13th HDFC Bank (Market Cap : \$158.5 billion)
- 19th ICICI Bank (Market Cap : \$105.7 billion)
- 24th State Bank of India (SBI) (Market Cap : \$82.9 billion)

Genius





Ques : Which insurance company has recently partnered with Saraswat Co-operative Bank Ltd for a strategic bancassurance collaboration in January 2025?

- (a) Bajaj Allianz General Insurance
- (b) ICICI Prudential Life Insurance
- (c) Kotak Mahindra Life Insurance
- (d) Reliance Nippon Life Insurance
- (e) PNB MetLife India Insurance

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- PNB MetLife India Insurance Company Ltd (PNB MetLife) has entered into a strategic bancassurance agreement with Saraswat Co-operative Bank Ltd, one of India's leading urban co-operative banks.
- This agreement intends to improve financial inclusion by providing a full suite of life insurance solutions, such as savings, protection, retirement, and group plans, to Saraswat Bank's enormous customer base of nearly 30 lakh people via 302 locations nationally.
- Bancassurance is an insurance distribution model in which corporations work with banks to market insurance policies or products.
- This arrangement benefits both banks and insurance companies. The bank obtains a commission from the insurance firm, while the insurer benefits from the bank's distribution network.
- Sameer Bansal is the MD and CEO of PNB MetLife.





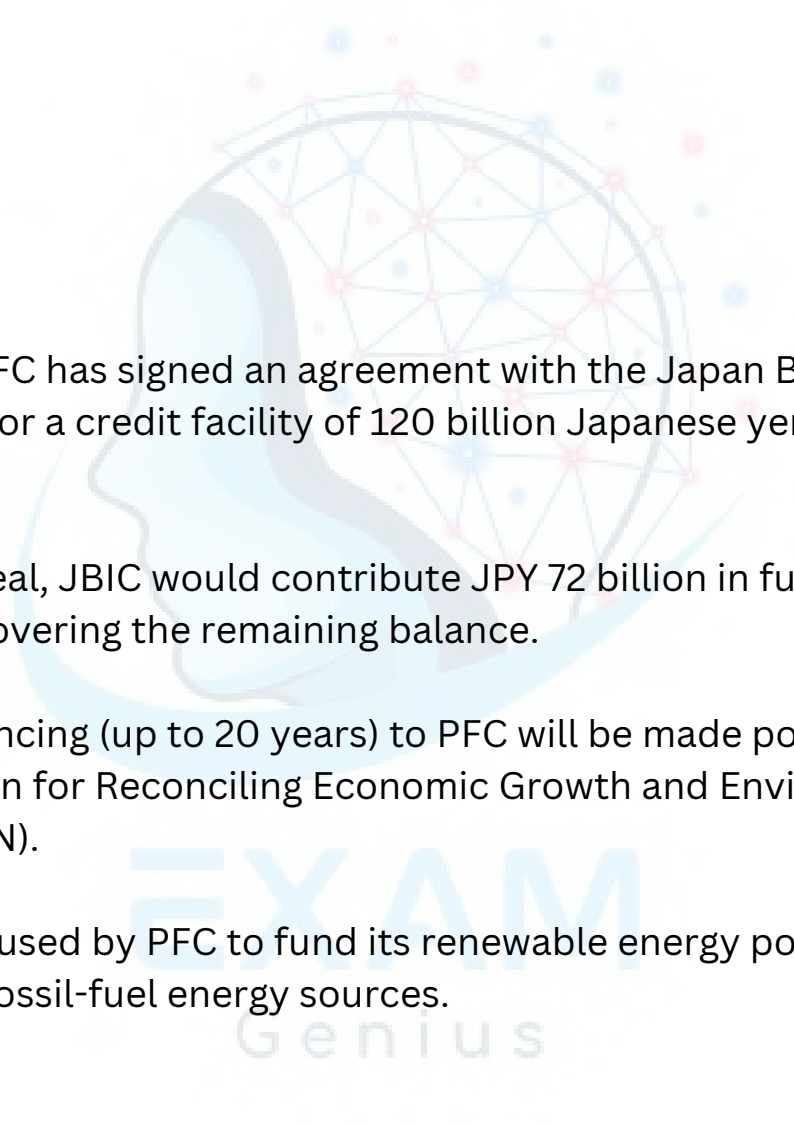
Ques : Which state-owned Indian entity signed an agreement with Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC) for a loan facility?

- (a) Power Grid Corporation of India
- (b) Power Finance Corporation (PFC)
- (c) Rural Electrification Corporation (REC)
- (d) NTPC Limited
- (e) NHPC Limited

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The state-owned PFC has signed an agreement with the Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC) for a credit facility of 120 billion Japanese yen (about Rs 6,600 crore).
- According to the deal, JBIC would contribute JPY 72 billion in funding, with commercial banks covering the remaining balance.
- This long-term financing (up to 20 years) to PFC will be made possible by JBIC's project 'Global Action for Reconciling Economic Growth and Environmental Preservation' (GREEN).
- The cash would be used by PFC to fund its renewable energy portfolio, accelerating India's shift to non-fossil-fuel energy sources.





Ques : Which company has launched the Sunishchit Laabh savings plan?

- (a) HDFC Life Insurance
- (b) ICICI Prudential Life Insurance
- (c) LIC of India
- (d) SBI Life Insurance
- (e) Shriram Life Insurance

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Shriram Life Insurance has established Shriram Life Sunishchit Laabh, a non-participating individual savings plan that offers guaranteed returns of up to 668% of the total premium paid.
- The plan is designed for individuals aged 30 days to 60 years, with a minimum annual premium starting at Rs.30,000. Payment options include Rs.15,500 half-yearly, Rs.8,000 quarterly, and Rs.3,000 monthly.
- The plan provides tax-free maturity income distributions for up to 40 years and a maximum age of 101 years, assuring long-term financial security, including beyond retirement.
- It also offers death benefits of up to 160 times the annualised premium and flexible maturity income payment types, allowing consumers to adjust to changing financial circumstances.





Ques : Which state launches 'Garudakshi' portal for Forest Protection ?

- (a) West Bengal
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Haryana
- (e) Maharashtra

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Karnataka Forest Department plans to implement the "Garudakshi" online FIR system to tackle forest and wildlife crimes.
- The new digital system, unveiled by Forest, Biology, and Environment Minister Ishwara B Khandre at Vidhana Soudha, aims to streamline the process of filing First Information Reports (FIRs) for forest crimes.
- Developed in conjunction with the Wild Life Trust of India (WTI), the Garudakshi program allows for online handling of forest crime cases under the Forest and Wildlife Protection Acts.

About Karnataka :

- Capital : Bangalore
- CM : Siddaramaiah
- Governor : Thawar Chand Gehlot

EXAM
Genius





Ques : India Meteorological Department (IMD) under the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) celebrated its _ Foundation Day.

- (a) 140th
- (b) 142nd
- (c) 148th
- (d) 150th
- (e) 152nd

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The India Meteorological Department (IMD) under the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) commemorated its 150th foundation day.
- During the ceremony, PM unveiled 'Mission Mausam', a project to transform India into a 'Weather-Ready' and 'Climate-smart' country using advanced weather surveillance technologies.
- The Government of India (GoI) approved Mission Mausam in September 2024, with a budget of 2,000 crores for two years.
- In celebration of IMD's 150th anniversary, he issued commemorative postal stamps and coins.
- The coin is round and has a denomination of Rs 150. The coin is made of 99.99% silver and has a weight of 40 grams.
- On the obverse side of the coin, 'satyamev jayate' is written in Hindi underneath the Lion Capital of Ashoka Pillar in the center.
- The coin is imprinted with 'Bharat' in Hindi on the left and 'India' on the right.

About India Meteorological Department :

- Established : January 15, 1875
- HQ : New Delhi
- Director General : Dr. Mrutyunjay Mohapatra



Ques : Who has been reappointed as the Chairperson of the Executive Council of the Prime Ministers Museum and Library Society?

- (a) Amit Shah
- (b) Nripendra Mishra
- (c) Rajnath Singh
- (d) Piyush Goyal
- (e) Nitin Gadkari

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Government of India has reorganized the Prime Ministers Museum and Library Society's Executive Council and reappointed Nripendra Mishra as Chairperson.
- Former Union Minister Smriti Irani, ex-NITI Aayog Vice-Chairman Rajiv Kumar, former Army General Syed Ata Hasnain, acclaimed filmmaker Shekhar Kapur, and Sanskar Bharati's Vasudev Kamath are among the distinguished new members of the PMML society.
- The Prime Ministers Museum and Library Society's Executive Council is its highest-level decision-making body.
- The important decision-making council, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi as president and Defence Minister Rajnath Singh as vice president, has also grown. The executive council has expanded from 29 to 34 members.
- The Prime Minister Museum and Library Society was established by the Indian government on April 1, 1966, to oversee the Nehru Memorial Museum and Library, currently known as the Prime Minister Museum and Library.





Recent Appointment in different departments :

- Vineet Joshi : Secretary of the Department of Higher Education under the Ministry of Education
- K Vinod Chandran : Chief Justice of Supreme Court
- Ajit Kumar Mohanty : Chairman of the reformed Atomic Energy Commission (AEC)
- Devajit Saikia : New secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)
- Prabhtej Singh Bhatia : Treasurer of the Indian Cricket Board
- Brijendra Pratap Singh : Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of National Aluminium Company (NALCO)
- B. N. Srikrishna : Chairperson of Equal's newly formed Advisory Board
- Tuhin Kanta Pandey : Secretary, Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance
- Dr. V Narayanan : chairman of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- Bahadur Singh Sagoo : President of the Athletics Federation of India (AFI) (Replaced Adille Sumariwalla)
- Mike Johnson, a Republican from Louisiana : Speaker of the U.S. House of Representatives
- Devajit Saikia : Chief Secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)
- Prabhtej Singh Bhatia : Treasurer of BCCI
- Sanjiv Ranjan : Secretary General of the Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA) Secretariat in Ebene, Mauritius (Replaced Salman Al-Farisi of Indonesia)
- Senior bureaucrat Akash Tripathi : Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Power
- Ashutosh Agnihotri : Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of the Food Corporation of India (FCI)
- Jyoti Sharma : Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Nasscom Foundation
- Kamal Kishore Soan : Additional Secretary and Mission Director of the Jal Jeevan Mission, which is part of the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation
- Shubha Thakur : Inter State Council Secretariat of the Home Ministry





Ques : India Unveils 'Utkash' as Second Multi-Purpose Vessel. It is built by which company ?

- (a) Cochin Shipyard Limited
- (b) Hindustan Shipyard
- (c) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (d) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders
- (e) L&T Shipyard

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- M/s L&T Shipyard's second Multi-Purpose Vessel (MPV) for the Indian Navy was launched at its Kattupalli, Chennai, facility.
- The occasion was attended by Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, as well as senior officials from the Indian Navy and L&T Shipyard.
- The vessel, named 'Utkarsh', represents a major forward in India's indigenous shipbuilding skills.
- Its Dimension is 107 meters long and 18.6 meters wide.
- Maximum speed of 15 knots and Displacement Over 3,750 tonnes.
- The contract for the two Multi-Purpose Vessels was signed on March 25, 2022, between the Ministry of Defence and M/s L&T Shipyard .
- The First MPV launched earlier is INS Samarthak.





Ques : Where was the Bhargavastra micro missile system successfully tested?

- (a) Chandipur Firing Range, Odisha
- (b) Gopalpur Seaward Firing Range, Odisha
- (c) Pokhran Test Range, Rajasthan
- (d) Wheeler Island, Odisha
- (e) Kalaikunda Air Base, West Bengal

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The indigenously built micro missile system Bhargavastra was successfully tested at the Gopalpur Seaward firing range in Odisha.
- The micro missile system was designed to counter the threat of swarm drone attacks.
- Economic Explosives Ltd (EEL), a part of the Solar Group based in Nagpur, designed the Bhargavastra. It was created and developed in-house and is regarded as an efficient low-cost weapon system against swarm drone attacks.

About Swarm Drone Attack :

- Unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs), sometimes known as drones, are remotely controlled airborne objects that can be employed for a variety of purposes.
- The Americans initially employed drones on the battlefield to murder top commanders of Al-Qaeda and Talibans in Afghanistan.
- Iranians have employed swarm drones to successfully penetrate Israel's vaunted Iron Dome anti-missile system.





Ques : The ____ Foundation Day of Startup India, celebrated in New Delhi.

- (a) 4th
- (b) 6th
- (c) 7th
- (d) 9th
- (e) 11th

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The 9th Foundation Day of Startup India in New Delhi marked a critical milestone in India's progress towards becoming a global leader in innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Shri Piyush Goyal, Union Minister of Commerce & Industry, launched the Prabhaav Factbook and Bharat Startup Challenge to highlight the impact of startups on India's economy and society.
- This thorough overview covers India's startup ecosystem achievements from 2016 to 2024.
- India has experienced 76 Initial Public Offerings (IPOs) in the calendar year 2024.
- India now has the world's third largest startup ecosystem, with 1,59,157 registered startups as of January 15, up from approximately 500 in 2016. This has created 17.2 lakh direct jobs.
- The ministry has introduced the Bharat Startup Challenge, which would include 75 tasks in diverse sectors.





Ques : Which e-commerce giant has signed an agreement to acquire fintech lending start-up Axio?

- (a) Amazon
- (b) Flipkart
- (c) Google
- (d) Messho
- (e) Swiggy

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Amazon has inked a deal to acquire fintech loan start-up Axio, formerly Capital Float, for around \$190-200 million.
- Axio has filed an application with the regulator (RBI) for a change of control to Amazon, which is pending clearance. Following approval, Amazon's intended acquisition of Axio would be completed.
- Axio manages Rs 2,200 crore in assets, with 3% of them being gross non-performing assets. It has served almost ten million clients.
- In August of last year, it raised \$20 million in equity capital from the Amazon Smbhav Venture Fund to extend loan offerings.
- Amazon has purchased nine Indian startups since 2016.





Ques : The Union Cabinet approved establishing a third launchpad at Isro's Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota at a cost of ____.

- (a) Rs.3,985 crore
- (b) Rs.3,455 crore
- (c) Rs.2,745 crore
- (d) Rs.3,967 crore
- (e) Rs.3,650 crore

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Union Cabinet approved establishing a third launchpad at Isro's Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota at a cost of Rs.3,985 crore.
- The project is planned to be finished in 48 months (4 years).
- The Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota will build a third launchpad capable of launching 30,000-tonne spacecraft into low-earth orbit.
- The Indian Space Research Organisation is designing the Next Generation Launch Vehicle (NGLV), which will be 91m tall.
- The first launch pad was erected in the early 1990s, and the first launch occurred on September 20, 1993.
- The second launch pad began functioning in 2005.





Recent News Headlines Related to ISRO

- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has successfully launched the Space Docking Experiment (SpaDeX) mission. ISRO's PSLV-C60 rocket, carrying two spacecraft for space docking demonstrations, launched from Sriharikota's Satish Dhawan Space Centre
- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) successfully launched the European Space Agency (ESA) Probe 3 spacecraft from the First Launch Pad at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC-SHAR) in Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh.
- Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has signed an Implementation Agreement (IA) with the Australian Space Agency (ASA) for further strengthening of cooperation in space activities between the two countries
- ISRO has launched its analogue space mission in Leh, Ladakh.
- Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and the Department of Biotechnology (DBT) Objective To develop and conduct biological and environmental experiments for the planned Bharatiya Antariksh Station (BAS), expected to be operational by 2028-2035
- ISRO has launched India's first analog space mission from Leh, Ladakh. The mission involves ISRO, the University of Ladakh, IIT Bombay, AAKA Space Studio, and the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council.
- EOS-06, commonly known as Oceansat-3, is an Earth observation spacecraft created by ISRO. It was successfully launched on November 26, 2022, using ISRO's Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (PSLV-C54).
- ISRO has acquired two 400kg satellites for the next Space Docking Experiment (SPADEX)
- ISRO has received a budget of Rs 2104.06 crore for the Chandrayaan-4 mission, which would be completed in 36 months.
- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) aims to launch the first base module of the Bharatiya Antariksh Station (BAS), India's first space station, in 2028. The BAS will contain five modules.
- ISRO's Earth Perception Satellite-8 (EOS-8) is supposed to be sent off by the Small Satellite Launch Vehicle (SSLV)-D3 on August 16 from Sriharikota in Andhra Pradesh.
- The Air Breathing Propulsion Technology demonstration flight was successfully completed by the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) on its second trial flight.
- GSAT 20 is a 4,700 kg heavy-weight, high-tech satellite. New Delhi: Using SpaceX's Falcon 9 rocket, the Indian space agency ISRO will launch its latest big satellite in a

first.



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IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Bank of Baroda (BoB) raised Rs 5,000 crore through tenyear infrastructure bonds at a coupon rate of 7.23%. BoB's infrastructure bond, rated AAA by CRISIL and India Ratings, had a base issue of Rs 2,000 crore and a green shoe option of Rs 3,000 crore.

Binod Kumar has assumed office as the Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Indian Bank. Prior to this, he was serving as Executive Director of Punjab National Bank (PNB).

Shriram Housing Finance (SHF) has rebranded itself as Truhome Finance following its acquisition by Warburg Pincus and its co-investors, including QIA (Qatar's sovereign wealth fund), from Shriram Finance.

Google-backed Indian space start-up company Pixxel has become the first Indian private company to launch its commercial satellite constellation named Firefly on board a Space X rocket.

The SpaceX rocket also carried the world's first commercial satellite for surveillance of space objects orbiting the earth, made by an Indian space company, Digantara.

Exercise 'Devil Strike' Held at Northern Borders of India between Indian Army, Indian Air Force, and Special Forces

Asia's second-largest International Society for Krishna Consciousness's (ISKCON's) temple Inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi at Kharghar, Navi Mumbai. Its Cost is Rs.170 crore. Asia's largest ISKCON temple Mayapur Chandrodaya Mandir Temple of the Vedic Planetarium is in West Bengal.





Ques : Who Decided to Conduct Daily Variable-Rate Repo (VRR) Operations to Boost Banking Liquidity amid Deficit ?

- (a) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- (b) State Bank of India (SBI)
- (c) NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)
- (d) Paytm
- (e) HDFC Bank

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) will conduct daily Variable-Rate Repo (VRR) auctions until further notice. This measure will increase banking liquidity amid the deficit.
- The first VRR worth Rs 50,000 crore was held on January 16, 2025, with solo primary dealers participating alongside other eligible bidders.
- To control liquidity deficits, the RBI has reduced all banks' Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) to 4% of deposits in two equal tranches of 25 basis points (bps) each beginning December 14, 2024 and December 28, 2024.
- On January 15, 2025, RBI held a 5-day VRR auction with a stated sum of Rs 75,000 crore. Banks submitted bids totaling Rs 3,980 crore.





Recent News Headlines Related to RBI

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has implemented new credit reporting rules. Lenders are now required to update credit bureau information every 15 days, rather than monthly. This directive went into force on January 1, 2025.
- The Reserve Bank Innovation Hub and IIMA Ventures have launched Swanari TechSprint 3.0, a program targeted at fostering women-centric financial firms in India.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) lifted the supervisory restrictions imposed on two non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) – Asirvad Micro Finance Limited and DMI Finance Private Limited.
- The Reserve Bank announced the winners of its 3rd Global Hackathon, themed 'Zero Financial Frauds' and 'Being Divyang Friendly'.
- The RBI has declared that the interest rate for RBI Floating Rate Savings Bonds (Taxable) FRSB 2020 (T) will stay at 8.05% from January 1 to June 30, 2025
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) lifted business restrictions on Arohan Financial Services Limited, a microfinance institution situated in Kolkata (West Bengal), after the lender implemented remedial steps and committed to fair loan pricing.
- HDFC Bank, India's largest private sector lender, has received the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) approval to acquire up to a 9.5% stake in Kotak Mahindra Bank, AU Small Finance Bank, and Capital Small Finance Bank.
- The Reserve Bank of India has approved a voluntary merger between The National Co-operative Bank Ltd., Bangalore (Karnataka) and Cosmos Co-operative Bank Limited (Maharashtra).
- As of December 31, 2024, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced that 98.12% of the Rs.2,000 denomination banknotes have been returned to the banking system, with Rs.6,691 crore still held by the public.
- To combat fraud, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) proposed adding a lookup tool for beneficiary accounts to the Real-Time Gross Settlement (RTGS) and National Electronic Funds Transfer (NEFT) systems.
- The RBI's "Report on Trend and Progress of Banking in India 2023-24" provides a detailed study of the banking sector's performance for fiscal year 2023-24.





Ques : Who has partnered with the National Institute of Securities Markets (NISM) to launch an e-learning course on municipal bonds ?

- (a) NABARD
- (b) RBI
- (c) EPFO
- (d) SEBI
- (e) NPCI

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- SEBI has collaborated with the National Institute of Securities Markets (NISM) to offer an e-learning course on municipal bonds.
- The course's goal is to help municipal corporations, urban local authorities, and other stakeholders better understand municipal bonds in order to utilize them for urban infrastructure development
- Municipal bonds (muni bonds) are debt securities issued by metropolitan municipal governments and organizations. They are used to pay for day-to-day expenses as well as capital projects like highways, roads, and schools.
- The course is 10 hours long and can be taken at one's own pace. The course is available for free until March 31, 2025. After this date, a nominal fee will be charged.

About NISM :

- NISM is an Indian public trust, established in 2006 by SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India).
- HQ : Mumbai, Maharashtra
- NISM is also the central training institute for SEBI's civil service staff.
- NISM provides certification and training programs to enhance knowledge and skills in the securities market.



Ques : What is the primary focus of the collaboration between FIU-IND and NHB?

- (a) Promoting housing development schemes
- (b) Enhancing digital payment systems
- (c) Facilitating rural credit availability
- (d) Monitoring foreign exchange transactions
- (e) Intelligence sharing, capacity building, and risk assessment

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- The Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND) has signed an MoU with National Housing Bank (NHB) to engage in crucial areas such as intelligence sharing, capacity building, and risk assessment.
- The goal is to improve the execution of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002 (PMLA) and related laws as part of continuous efforts.

About Financial Intelligence Unit (India) :

- Established : 2004
- Act : Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002
- HQ : New Delhi
- Director : Vivek Aggarwal

About National Housing Bank :

- Established : 9 July 1988
- HQ : New Delhi
- MD & CEO : Sanjay Shukla

EXAM
Genius





Ques : RBI has instructed banks and other regulated entities (REs) to use the which phone numbering series exclusively for making transactional calls to customers ?

- (a) 1200xx
- (b) 1400xx
- (c) 1500xx
- (d) 1600xx
- (e) 1800xx

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- RBI has instructed banks and other regulated entities (REs) to use the '1600xx' phone numbering series exclusively for making transactional calls to customers.
- The RBI has instructed that banks and REs use the '140xx' series for promotional calls in order to avoid confusion with transactional calls and limit the risk of fraud.
- Mobile numbers have become an important identifier in the account authentication and verification process since they get sensitive information such as OTPs, transaction alerts, and account updates.
- The RBI has recommended regulated firms to check and clean up their client datasets using the Mobile Number Revocation List (MNRL), which is available on the Digital Intelligence Platform (DIP) maintained by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT).
- All regulated entities must comply with the RBI's guidelines by March 31, 2025.

According to the DoT's notification, the phone number format for the '1600xx' series is 1600ABCXXX, where:

- XXX represents any number between 000-999.
- AB represents the telecom circle (e.g., Kolkata).
- C represents the service provider (e.g., Bharti Airtel).



Ques : Which financial institution has received RBI approval to open 20 branches across 20 cities in India?

- (a) Citibank
- (b) Standard Chartered Bank
- (c) Barclays Bank
- (d) HSBC India
- (e) Deutsche Bank

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- HSBC India, the Indian arm of London-based HSBC, has received approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to open 20 branches in 20 cities.
- The opening of 20 branches brings HSBC India's total number of branches in the country to 46. In 2016, HSBC operated 50 branches in the country before deciding to close 26. Opening branches represents a significant shift in approach.
- HSBC India will open branches in the following cities: Amritsar, Bhopal, Bhubaneswar, Dehradun, Faridabad, Indore, Jalandhar, Kanpur, Ludhiana, Lucknow, Mysuru, Nagpur, Nashik, Navi Mumbai, Patna, Rajkot, Surat, Thiruvananthapuram, Vadodara, and Vishakhapatnam.
- These regions were chosen because of their rising wealth pools, which cater to affluent, high-net-worth, and ultra-high-net-worth individuals with domestic and international banking and asset management requirements.

Genius





Ques : What was the total loan disbursement amount under PMMY in the third quarter of the financial year ending December 2024?

- (a) Rs.3.39 lakh crore
- (b) Rs.3 lakh crore
- (c) Rs.2.25 lakh crore
- (d) Rs.3.75 lakh crore
- (e) Rs.2.45 lakh crore

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- In the third quarter of the current fiscal year, small business loans disbursed under the Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY) hit an all-time high of Rs.3.39 lakh crore (December 2024).
- In the first half of FY25, PMMY loans totaled Rs.1.86 lakh crore, a modest reduction from Rs.1.91 lakh crore in the same period last year.
- The fiscal year 2023-24 saw record disbursements of Rs.5.20 lakh crore, surpassing the Rs.4.40 lakh crore disbursed in FY23.
- On October 24, 2024, the government increased the maximum loan amount for PMMY from Rs.10 lakh to Rs.20 lakh.
- The Union Budget 2024-25 added the 'Tarun Plus' category, which allows successful borrowers to obtain larger loan limits.

Types of loans under Mudra Yojana :

- Shishu : Loan up to Rs.50,000.
- Kishor : Loan above Rs.50,000 and less than Rs.5 lakh.
- Tarun : Rs. 5 lakhs and less than Rs.10 lakh.
- Tarun Plus : Rs. 10 lakhs and less than Rs.20 lakh

About Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana :

- Launched : 8 April 2015
- Maximum loan : 10 lakhs



Ques : What is the projected growth rate of India for FY26 and FY27 as per the IMF?

- (a) 4.5%
- (b) 5.5%
- (c) 5.8%
- (d) 6.5%
- (e) 6.8%

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The International Monetary Fund (IMF) has kept India's growth rate at 6.5 percent for the next two fiscal years, 2025-26 or FY26 and 2026-27 or FY27, as forecast in October's World Economic Outlook report.
- Meanwhile, the IMF forecasts global growth of 3.3% in both 2025 and 2026, which is lower than the historical average of 3.7%.
- The 2025 prediction is substantially unchanged from the October 2024 World Economic Outlook, with an upward revision for the US offsetting losses in other major economies.

About International Monetary Fund :

- Established : 1 July 1944
- HQ : Washington, D.C., U.S.
- Member : 191 countries (190 UN countries and Kosovo)
- Managing Director : Kristalina Georgieva
- Chief Economist : Pierre-Olivier Gourinchas





Ques : Novak Djokovic broke a tie with which player for the most Grand Slam matches in tennis history ?

- (a) Carlos Alcaraz
- (b) Rafael Nadal
- (c) Roger Federer
- (d) Jannik Sinner
- (e) None of these

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Novak Djokovic broke a tie with Roger Federer for the most Grand Slam matches in tennis history.
- Djokovic overtook Roger Federer's record of 429 Grand Slam matches with his second-round match at the Australian Open.

Top 5 most Grand Slam Matches :

- 1) Novak Djokovic : 430
- 2) Roger Federer : 429
- 3) Rafael Nadal : 358
- 4) Jimmy Connors : 282
- 5) Andre Agassi : 277

EXAM
Genius





Recent News headlines related to Sports

- Arjun Erigaisi, an Indian grandmaster, stunned the internet chess community by defeating World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen and World No. 2 Fabiano Caruana in Chess.com's Titled Tuesday weekly blitz competition.
- The International Cricket Council (ICC) has named Jasprit Bumrah of India and Annabel Sutherland of Australia as the ICC Men's and Women's Players of the Month for December 2024, respectively.
- The first Kho Kho World Cup kicked off on January 13, 2025, at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium in New Delhi. Sudhanshu Mittal, President of the Indian Kho Kho Federation, officially opened the World Cup.
- India and Mumbai batter Shreyas Iyer, the second-most expensive player in the player auction, has been appointed captain by Punjab Kings for IPL 2025. The 2024 IPL winning captain has previously led Delhi Capitals (DC) and Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) in the IPL.
- In squash, India's Anahat Singh won the Under 17 Girl's Singles title at the British Junior Open in Birmingham, England.
- Varun Tomar of the Indian Army has won the Men's 10-meter Air Pistol finals of the 67th National Shooting Championship 2024, which took place at Dr Karni Singh Shooting Range in New Delhi.
- Haryana Steelers reached a historic milestone by winning their first Pro Kabaddi League (PKL) title. In a thrilling final at the Shree Shiv Chhatrapati Sports Complex in Pune, the Steelers overcame the Patna Pirates by 32-23.
- West Bengal, the most successful team in the Santosh Trophy's history, added to its trophy collection by defeating Kerala in the final of the 78th edition. This was the Bengal team's 33rd Santosh Trophy.
- Hemanth Muddappa, known as the "Drag King," achieved a remarkable triple crown victory in the final round of the MMSC FMSCI Indian National Motorcycle Drag Racing Championship held at the Madras International Circuit (MIC).
- Kerala won the Senior National Men's Handball Championship for the first time, defeating Chandigarh 34-31. The event final was held in Changanassery, Kerala.
- Punjab's Vijayveer Sidhu defeated fellow Olympian Gurpreet Singh of the Army Marksmanship Unit to win his first men's 25m rapid-fire pistol (RFP) title at the 67th National Shooting Championship Competitions (NSCC) for pistol events





Ques : Who has been appointed as the Director General of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF)?

- (a) Kuldiep Singh
- (b) Rakesh Asthana
- (c) Gyanendra Pratap Singh
- (d) Anil Chauhan
- (e) Sudeep Lakhtakia

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Gyanendra Pratap Singh, the Assam police chief, has been named Director General of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF).
- Singh is a 1991 batch Indian Police Service officer from the Assam-Meghalaya cadre.
- Senior IPS officer Vitul Kumar has been in command of the force after Anish Dayal Singh's retirement on December 31, 2024.
- Singh, who previously worked for the National Investigation Agency (NIA), was transferred to Assam as the additional DGP in 2019 in response to the anti-Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) protests. He later took over as the DGP.

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Recent Defence related appointments :

- Air Commodore Debakinandan Sahu : Command of the Base Repair Depot (BRD) at Tughlakabad (Air Commodore Rishi Seth)
- Air Marshal Jeetendra Mishra : Chief of the Indian Air Force's Western Air Command (Replaced Air Marshal Pankaj Mohan Sinha)
- Vitul Kumar : Director General of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) (Replaced Anish Dayal Singh)
- Jared Isaacman : NASA Chief to Oversee Moon Missions
- Valdecy Urquiza (Brazil) : Secretary-General of the International Criminal Police Organisation INTERPOL
- Rajesh Kumar Singh : Defence Secretary at South Block
- Surgeon Vice Admiral Kavita Sahai : Director General Medical Services (Navy)
- Paramesh Sivamani : 26th Director General of the Indian Coast Guard (ICG)
- Air Marshal SP Dharkar : Vice Chief of Air Staff
- IPS Nalin Prabhat : Director General of Police (DGP) of Jammu and Kashmir (Replaced R.R. Swain)
- Surgeon Vice Admiral Arti Sarin : first female officer as Director General of Armed Forces Medical Services (DGAfms)
- Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh : Vice Chief of the Indian Air Force (IAF) (succeed Air Chief Marshal V.R. Chaudhari)
- Nikhat Zareen (boxer) : Telangana Police as a Deputy Superintendent of Police (Special Police)
- Amrit Mohan Prasad : Director General of Sashastra Seema Bal
- Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit : Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief (AOC-in-C) of Central Air Command
- Air Marshal Tejinder Singh : Deputy Chief of the Indian Air Force
- Vice Admiral Rajesh Dhankhar : Director General of Project Seabird
- Rajwinder Singh Bhatti : Director General of the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF)
- B Srinivasan : Director General (DG) of National Security Guard
- Sanjeev Raina : ITBP Additional Director General





Ques : What is the name of the app launched under the Defence Ministry's "battle tourism" plan?

- (a) Bharat Sainik Darshan
- (b) Bharat Yodha App
- (c) Bharat Ranbhoomi Darshan App
- (d) Veer Bharat App
- (e) Battlefields of India App

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Bharat Ranbhoomi Darshan Launched by Union Minister Rajnath Singh, Ministry of Defense (MoD)
- It is Developed by MoD, Ministry of Tourism, and the Indian Army
- This app includes detailed information of 77 battlefield sites and provides visitors an in-depth overview of some of the major military events
- To promote tourism and highlight India's military heritage, the government has opened significant battlefields to visitors.
- These include sites from the 1962 India-China war, offering a deeper connection to the nation's wartime history.

The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has granted civilians access to the following battlefields:

- Kibithoo and Bum La Pass in Arunachal Pradesh
- Rezang La and Pangong Tso in Ladakh
- Doklam, the site of the 2017 conflict
- The Army is exploring the possibility of opening additional significant battlefields, including Galwan Valley, Siachen, Kargil, Lipulekh Pass





Recent News Headlines Related to launched Apps/portals

- The Karnataka Forest Department plans to implement the "Garudakshi" online FIR system to tackle forest and wildlife crimes.
- Swiggy has introduced a new standalone food delivery app called 'Snacc by Swiggy'. Snacc is a 15-minute food delivery app that serves short snacks and meals, comparable to Zepto's Zepto Café.
- NITI Aayog's Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP) has developed EmpowHER Biz - Sapno Ki Udaan in collaboration with New Shop, India's largest 24/7 convenience shop chain, as part of its Award to Reward (ATR) program.
- The e-Shram portal has been improved and will now be available in all 22 scheduled languages. Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya, Union Minister of Labour and Employment, has launched the multilingual e-Shram portal, which aims to be a 'One-Stop-Solution' website for all unorganised registered workers.
- M Nagaraju, the Financial Services Secretary, has unveiled the revised 'Baanknet' portal for e-auctioning items like as commercial buildings, industrial land, stores, automobiles, and agricultural and non-agricultural property.
- Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel has unveiled a new citizen-centric project known as the SWAR (Speech and Written Analysis Resource) platform.
- On the occasion of 'Good Governance Day', which commemorates the birth anniversary of former Prime Minister Shri Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh unveiled the Rashtraparv Website and Mobile App on December 25, 2024.
- On National Consumers Day 2024, the Department of Consumer Affairs will make the "Jago Grahak Jago App" and "Jagriti App" available to the public
- Gujarat's Chief Minister, Bhupendra Patel, launched the 'Prakrutik Krushi Portal (Natural Agriculture Portal)' to encourage organic farming
- “Amrit Gyaan Kosh” Portal Launched by Union Minister of State(MoS), Dr. Jitendra Singh, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions to build a comprehensive knowledge base by curating best practices from across India, with a focus on aligning these practices with 15 of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)





Ques : Which edition of the multinational naval exercise La Perouse held in the eastern Indian Ocean ?

- (a) 1st
- (b) 2nd
- (c) 3rd
- (d) 4th
- (e) 5th

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The indigenously designed and built guided missile destroyer Indian Naval Ship (INS) Mumbai is taking part in the fourth edition of the multinational naval exercise La Perouse in the eastern Indian Ocean.
- France will lead the 2025 La Perouse exercise, which will also include eight other countries: India, the United States, Canada, Malaysia, Indonesia, Australia, the United Kingdom, and Singapore.
- The exercise seeks to improve common situational awareness by improving collaboration in maritime surveillance, maritime interdiction operations, and aviation operations, as well as conducting progressive training and information exchange.
- This visit is consistent with India's SAGAR (Security and Growth for All in the Region) agenda of strengthening maritime cooperation and partnership for a safer and more secure Indo-Pacific region.





Recent News Headlines Related to Defence Exercise :

- Exercise 'Devil Strike' Held at Northern Borders of India between Indian Army, Indian Air Force, and Special Forces
- Indian and Nepalese Army contingents are taking part in the 18th round of Exercise Surya Kiran.
- Exercise Sahayog-Hop Tac 2nd Edition Held at off the coast of Kochi, Kerala between India & Vietnam (Coast guard).
- Exercise Desert Knight 2025 Held at Arabian Sea between India, France, and the UAE (Air force). From India Sukhoi-30MKI, Jaguars, IL-78 mid-air refuellers, and AEW&C (Airborne Early Warning and Control) systems participate in Exercise.
- The Eastern Naval Command will host the bilateral naval exercise SLINEX 2024 (Sri Lanka-India Exercise) at Visakhapatnam from December 17 to 20, 24.
- India and Cambodia's first joint tabletop exercise, dubbed 'CINBAX,' began at the Foreign Training Node in Pune, Maharashtra
- On December 2, 2024, India and Malaysia began the bilateral Joint Military Exercise "Harimau Shakti" at the Bentong camp in Pahang district, Malaysia
- The Indian Coast Guard (ICG) held the 11th National Maritime Search and Rescue Exercise (SAREX-2024) off the Kochi coast.
- The 13th edition of Joint Military Exercise AGNI WARRIOR (XAW-2024), a bilateral exercise between the Indian Army and the Singapore Armed Forces, ended at Field Firing Ranges in Devlali (Maharashtra).
- The 11th edition of the Indian Coast Guard's National Maritime Search and Rescue Exercise and Workshop (SAREX-24) starts in Kochi, Kerala.
- The Indian Army successfully completed the Multilateral Annual Joint Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR) Exercise 'Sanyukt Vimochan 2024', which took place in Ahmedabad and Porbandar, Gujarat
- India Launches First Space Defense Exercise Antariksha Abhyas – 2024 To simulate and address threats to and from space-based assets, integrating space capabilities into military operations
- Exercise AUSTRALIND 3rd Edition Held at Foreign Training Node, Pune, Maharashtra between India & Australia (Army)
- The Indian Army, Indian Air Force, and Indian Navy will launch a command-level tri-service theatre exercise called 'Poorvi Prahar' along the India-China border.





Ques : Archaeological Experiential Museum Inaugurated by Union Ministry of Culture and the Gujarat State Government in which state ?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) Madhya Pradesh

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Archaeological Experiential Museum Inaugurated by Union Ministry of Culture and the Gujarat State Government at Vadnagar, Gujarat
- Inauguration ceremony was presided over by Union Home Minister Shri Amit Shah and attended by Gujarat Chief Minister Shri Bhupendrabhai Patel, Union Minister of Education Shri Dharmendra Pradhan
- 12,500 sq. m. area covered with nine thematic galleries
- 4,000 sq. m. excavation site, with visible archaeological remains up to 16-18 meters deep
- Its costs is Rs.298 Crore, including five years of operational maintenance
- Over 5,000 artifacts including ceramics, coins, sculptures, organic materials (food grains, DNA, skeletal remains)





Recent Headlines Related to Inauguration :

- Asia's second-largest International Society for Krishna Consciousness's (ISKCON's) temple Inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi at Kharghar, Navi Mumbai.
- Yogi Adityanath, Uttar Pradesh's chief minister, inaugurated Prasar Bharati's FM station 'Kumbhvani' at Circuit House.
- Z-Morh tunnel Inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. It marks a significant step in creating a year-round strategic corridor between Kashmir and Ladakh.
- National Commission for Women (NCW), in collaboration with the Lok Sabha Secretariat and the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, inaugurated 'Panchayat Se Parliament 2.0' at the Central Hall of Samvidhan Sadan.
- Om Birla, Lok Sabha Speaker, launched the Gandhi Darshan Art Gallery at Rajghat in New Delhi.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi has inaugurated the 13-kilometer extension of the Delhi-Ghaziabad-Meerut Namo Bharat route. The corridor, worth Rs 4.600 crore.
- Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurated the BHARATPOL platform, designed by the Central Bureau of Investigation, in New Delhi. The BHARATPOL platform will make it easier to process all requests for international assistance through INTERPOL.
- The Indian Army recently inaugurated a statue of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj at Pangong Tso in Ladakh, near the India-China border.
- Two UK universities, Queen's University Belfast and Coventry University, have applied to open international campuses in Gujarat's GIFT City, following the lead of Australian institutions.

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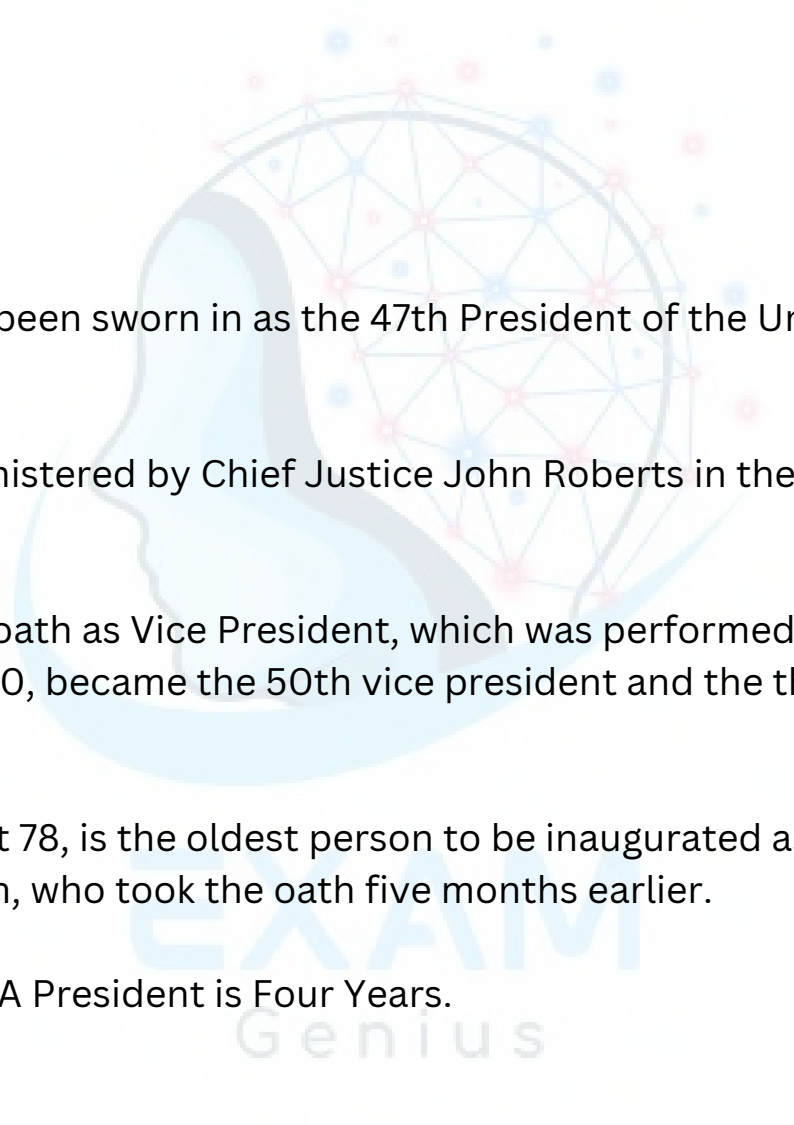
Ques : Donald Trump was sworn in as which President of the United States?

- (a) 45th
- (b) 46th
- (c) 47th
- (d) 48th
- (e) 49th

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Donald Trump has been sworn in as the 47th President of the United States, for his second term.
- The oath was administered by Chief Justice John Roberts in the Capitol Rotunda in Washington, DC.
- JD Vance took the oath as Vice President, which was performed by Justice Brett Kavanaugh. Vance, 40, became the 50th vice president and the third youngest in US history.
- President Trump, at 78, is the oldest person to be inaugurated as president, surpassing Joe Biden, who took the oath five months earlier.
- The Term of the USA President is Four Years.





Ques : Global Lighthouse Network (GLN) launched in which year ?

- (a) 2015
- (b) 2017
- (c) 2018
- (d) 2019
- (e) 2020

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The World Economic Forum (WEF) has welcomed CEAT Limited and Hindustan Unilever Limited's Tinsukia (Assam) plant to its Global Lighthouse Network (GLN) to promote manufacturing transformation via innovation.
- 15 new members from UAE, China, Germany, Malaysia, Saudi Arabia, UK, USA, and Morocco (home to the first Lighthouse site in Africa).
- The WEF has added 17 innovative industrial sites to the GLN, bringing the total to 189 facilities. 25 of them are Sustainability Lighthouses, utilizing sophisticated 4IR/Industry 4.0 production technology.

About Global Lighthouse Network (GLN) :

- It is an initiative by the World Economic Forum (WEF) and cofounded with McKinsey & Company
- Launched : 2018
- Total facilities : 189
- Indian facilities : 16
- Objective : to enhance the performance of manufacturing and supply chains by adopting 4IR technologies

About World Economic Forum :

- Established : 24 January 1971
- HQ : Cologny, Switzerland
- Executive Chairman : Klaus Schwab
- President : Borge Brende





Ques : Which northeastern state is the first to distribute property cards under the Centre's village survey scheme 'SVAMITVA'?

- (a) Meghalaya
- (b) Arunachal Pradesh
- (c) Assam
- (d) Mizoram
- (e) Nagaland

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Mizoram, the "first among the northeastern states," has handed property cards to 2,909 recipients through the Centre's village survey plan since April 2023.
- 1,754 property cardholders from 18 villages in the state were among the 65 lakh beneficiaries spread across ten states and two Union Territories.
- The Survey of Villages Abadi and Mapping with Improvised Technology in Village Areas (SVAMITVA), a Ministry of Panchayati Raj scheme, provides a 'Record of Rights' to village household owners and issues legal ownership cards to property owners by mapping land parcels using drone technology.
- The Prime Minister announced the SVAMITVA plan on April 24, 2020. The plan used drone and GIS technology to create rights records in revenue documents for inhabited settlements.





Ques : Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) established in which year ?

- (a) 1945
- (b) 1954
- (c) 1964
- (d) 1969
- (e) 1972

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- ISRO successfully grew black-eyed pea seeds in orbit using its Compact Research Module for Orbital Plant Studies (CROPS). The CROPS project studies plant growth in space.
- The first mission, CROPS-1, demonstrated seed germination and plant growth in a controlled environment aboard a spacecraft.
- CROPS-1 is a tiny greenhouse that uses porous clay pellets as a soil media.

About ISRO :

- Established : 15 August 1969
- HQ : Antariksh Bhavan in Bangalore
- Chairman : Dr. S. Somanath

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Recent News Headlines Related to ISRO

- The Union Cabinet approved establishing a third launchpad at Isro's Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota at a cost of Rs.3,985 crore.
- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has successfully launched the Space Docking Experiment (SpaDeX) mission. ISRO's PSLV-C60 rocket, carrying two spacecraft for space docking demonstrations, launched from Sriharikota's Satish Dhawan Space Centre
- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) successfully launched the European Space Agency (ESA) Probe 3 spacecraft from the First Launch Pad at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC-SHAR) in Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh.
- Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has signed an Implementation Agreement (IA) with the Australian Space Agency (ASA) for further strengthening of cooperation in space activities between the two countries
- ISRO has launched its analogue space mission in Leh, Ladakh.
- Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and the Department of Biotechnology (DBT) Objective To develop and conduct biological and environmental experiments for the planned Bharatiya Antariksh Station (BAS), expected to be operational by 2028-2035
- ISRO has launched India's first analog space mission from Leh, Ladakh. The mission involves ISRO, the University of Ladakh, IIT Bombay, AAKA Space Studio, and the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council.
- EOS-06, commonly known as Oceansat-3, is an Earth observation spacecraft created by ISRO. It was successfully launched on November 26, 2022, using ISRO's Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (PSLV-C54).
- ISRO has acquired two 400kg satellites for the next Space Docking Experiment (SPADEX)
- ISRO has received a budget of Rs 2104.06 crore for the Chandrayaan-4 mission, which would be completed in 36 months.
- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) aims to launch the first base module of the Bharatiya Antariksh Station (BAS), India's first space station, in 2028. The BAS will contain five modules.
- ISRO's Earth Perception Satellite-8 (EOS-8) is supposed to be sent off by the Small Satellite Launch Vehicle (SSLV)-D3 on August 16 from Sriharikota in Andhra Pradesh.
- The Air Breathing Propulsion Technology demonstration flight was successfully completed by the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) on its second trial flight.
- GSAT 20 is a 4,700 kg heavy-weight, high-tech satellite. New Delhi: Using SpaceX's Falcon 9 rocket, the Indian space agency ISRO will launch its latest big satellite in a first.



Ques : Who inaugurated the 85th All India Presiding Officers' Conference (AIPOC) in Patna?

- (a) Draupadi Murmu
- (b) Narendra Modi
- (c) Om Birla
- (d) S Jaishankar
- (e) None of the above

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Om Birla, Speaker of the Lok Sabha, has opened the 85th All India Presiding Officers' Conference (AIPOC) in Patna.
- The two-day conference is titled '75th Anniversary of Constitution: Contribution of Parliament and State Legislative Bodies to Strengthening Constitutional Values'.
- Following a 43-year pause, the state hosted the programme for the third time.

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Ques : National Penguin Awareness Day celebrated annually on which day ?

- (a) 19 January
- (b) 20 January
- (c) 21 January
- (d) 22 January
- (e) 23 January

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- National Penguin Awareness Day is commemorated annually on January 20 to raise awareness of penguins, their natural habitats, and the threats they face as a result of climate change, habitat destruction, and pollution.
- The day emphasizes the significance of safeguarding penguin species, many of which are endangered or under threat owing to melting ice caps, overfishing, and ocean pollution.

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Important days :

- 24 December : National Consumer Rights Day
- 25 December : Good Governance Day
- 26 December : Boxing Day
- 26 December : Computer Operators' Day
- 26 December : Veer Bal Divas A Day of Valor And Righteousness
- 27 December : International Day of Epidemic Preparedness
- 29 December : International Cello Day
- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 2 January : 67th Foundation Day of Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day
- 4 January : World Braille Day
- 5 January : National Bird Day (Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future)
- 6 January : World Day of War Orphans
- 6 January : Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) celebrated its 78th Foundation Day
- 8 January : Earth's Rotation Day
- 9 January : NRI or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- 10 January : World Hindi Day, also known as 'Vishwa Hindi Diwas' (Theme 2025: A Global Voice of Unity and Cultural Pride)
- 12 January : National Youth Day (Theme 2025: Youth for a Sustainable Future: Shaping the Nation with Resilience and Responsibility)
- 14 January : 9th Armed Forces Veterans' Day 2025 (Celebrates to Commemorates The retirement of Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa on January 14, 1953)
- 15 January : Indian Army Day (Theme 2025: Samarth Bharat, Saksham Sena (Capable India, Empowered Army))
- 16 January : National Startup Day
- 11 to 17 January : National Road Safety Week 2025
- January 18 to February 17 : National Road Safety Month 2025 (Theme 2025 Sadak Suraksha Jeevan Raksha)





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Singapore's highest honor for non-citizens, the Honorary Citizen Award Given to Tarun Das, former Director General of the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) by President Tharman Shanmugaratnam. He received the Singapore Public Service Medal in 2004.

During the first-ever corporate round-table conference in New Delhi, Union Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya invited corporations to adopt one sport with the goal of boosting the Indian sports ecosystem in preparation for the 2036 Olympic Games.

State Bank of India (SBI) Given Loan of Rs.31,802 crore to Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL) to finance the expansion of its refinery to 11 Million tonnes per annum (MMTPA) from 7.8 MMTPA and setting up of a petrochemical complex in Bina, Madhya Pradesh.

The US Senate has confirmed the appointment of Marco Rubio as the 72nd US Secretary of State in the Trump Administration. Rubio won the vote by 99-0 during the 1st session of the 119th Congress.

Dr. Mandaviya stressed India's goal of ranking among the top five world sports performers by 2047, when the country will celebrate its 100th anniversary of independence.

Book Parliament: Powers, Functions & Privileges; A Comparative Constitutional Perspective Authored by Dr. K.S. Chauhan and Released by Vice President Jagdeep Dhankhar.

Dr. Jitendra Singh, India's Science and Technology Minister, dedicated India's first-ever CSIR Innovation Complex in Mumbai via virtual mode.





Ques : What changes have been made by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) under the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA)?

- (a) Promoting digital payments across India
- (b) Allowing cross-border transactions in Indian Rupee (INR) and local/national currencies
- (c) Imposing restrictions on foreign direct investments
- (d) Enhancing cash withdrawal limits for NRIs
- (e) Introducing stricter regulations for forex trading

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- RBI in cooperation with the government, has proposed amendments to the existing Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA) regulations to encourage cross-border transactions in the Indian rupee (INR) and local / national currencies.
- This action comes against the backdrop of the rupee being under pressure from a surging dollar, weakening the Chinese currency.
- According to the revisions in FEMA, overseas branches of banks that are authorized to deal in foreign exchange (Authorised Dealers) would be able to create INR accounts for a resident outside India for the settlement of all permissible current account and capital account transactions with a resident in India.
- According to the FEMA revisions, persons located outside India will be able to use their balances in repatriable INR accounts for overseas investment, including FDI, in non-debt securities.
- Indian exporters would be able to open foreign currency accounts overseas to settle trade transactions, such as receiving export revenues and using them to pay for imports.





Ques : Who has been appointed as the Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of Zurich Kotak General Insurance?

- (a) Sanjay Mehrotra
- (b) Vikram Singh Mehta
- (c) Alok Kumar Agarwal
- (d) Ajay Bansal
- (e) Ramesh Chandran

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Zurich Kotak General Insurance has appointed Alok Kumar Agarwal as its Managing Director and CEO. He succeeds Suresh Agarwal.
- Agarwal has over two decades of experience with ICICI Lombard General Insurance Company, where he held several executive positions in the corporate, SME, crop, and retail business segments during his 22-year career.
- The development comes after Zurich Insurance Group's strategic acquisition of a majority stake in Kotak Mahindra General Insurance Company in June 2024.

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Recent Appointment in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- Binod Kumar : MD and CEO of Indian Bank
- Ashok Chandra : MD and CEO of Punjab National Bank (PNB)
- Ankur Jhaveri : MD and CEO of Institutional Equities at JM Financial Institutional Securities
- Ambarish Kenghe : CEO of Angel One
- Baldev Prakash : deputy managing director and group chief risk officer of State Bank of India
- Amit Ganorkar : Managing Director(MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of TATA AIG General Insurance Company (Replaced Neelesh Garg)
- Jatinder Pal Singh : CEO of ITI Asset Management (ITI AML) (succeeding Hitesh Thakkar)
- Rajat Verma : CEO of DBS Bank India (succeeding Surojit Shome)
- Anup Kumar Sinha : Reappointment as Bandhan Bank's non-executive chairman
- Amitava Chatterjee : Managing director (MD) and CEO J&K Bank
- Alok Aggarwal : Managing Director and CEO of Brookfield India Real Estate Trust
- R Subramaniakumar : MD & CEO of RBL Bank
- Ram Mohan Rao Amara : Managing Director of State Bank of India (SBI)
- George Heber Joseph : Chief investment officer (CIO) of the newly- incorporated joint venture firm Jio BlackRock Asset Management Company (AMC)
- Manish Jain : Executive Director of YES Bank
- R Ramaseshan : Part-time Chairman' (independent director) of Jana Small Finance Bank (JSFB) Limited (Replaced Subhash Khuntia)
- Bhavesh Jain : Managing Director and CEO of TransUnion CIBIL
- Sanjay Malhotra : 26th Governor of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for three years

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Ques : In which country Policybazaar launched the PB Advantage initiative?

- (a) Netherland
- (b) Mauritius
- (c) Moldova
- (d) Singapore
- (e) UAE

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Policybazaar.ae, the UAE's premier online insurance marketplace, has launched PB Advantage, a game-changing project that aims to reinvent the health insurance experience in the UAE.
- PB Advantage delivers cutting-edge services to simplify and improve the health insurance procedure.
- 30-Minute Claims Assistance: Dedicated claims desks enable faster outcomes.
- Auto Recharge of Sum Insured: Following the initial claim, the full coverage amount is automatically restored, giving additional coverage for unrelated illnesses or conditions. For example, an AED 1 million policy utilized for surgery is increased by additional AED 1 million for future claims.
- The No Claim Bonus adds 10% to the total insured for each claim-free year, up to a maximum of five years.





Recent Facilities Launched in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- Shriram Life Insurance has established Shriram Life Sunishchit Laabh, a non-participating individual savings plan that offers guaranteed returns of up to 668% of the total premium paid.
- Cybersecurity Hackathon 2024-25 1st Edition Launched by Punjab National Bank (PNB). The Theme is "Code Against Malware". Winners will receive prizes worth up to Rs 11 lakhs and have the opportunity to implement their solutions in live environments with PNB.
- Bank of Baroda has launched "bob Liquid Fixed Deposits" as an alternative to regular fixed deposits (FDs). The bob Liquid FD allows you flexible deposit amounts starting at Rs.5,000 (with no maximum deposit amount), duration options ranging from 12 to 60 months, and partial withdrawals in multiples of Rs.1,000
- IDBI Bank has launched a new fixed deposit scheme, 'IDBI Chiranjeevi-Super Senior Citizen FD,' for customers aged 80 and above.
- Bank of Baroda (BoB) will open AI-powered customer service and full-fledged branches in Prayagraj, including forex transaction facilities, to better serve visitors.
- Groww Mutual Fund, an asset management company, introduced the Groww Nifty India Railways PSU Index Fund and ETF.
- RenewBuy, an online insurance company, has launched the RenewBuy Smart Term Plan under its RB Proprietary line.
- Mirae Asset Investment Managers (India) Pvt. Ltd. has established the Mirae Asset Smallcap Fund, an open-ended equity plan that focuses primarily on smallcap stocks.
- Go Digit-Life Insurance Limited (Digit-Life), a major new-age digital insurer, has introduced its first individual pure-term life insurance policy, "Digit Glow Term Life Insurance."
- IndiaBonds.com, a SEBI-registered Stock Broker (Debt Segment) and licensed Online Bond website Provider (OBPP), now offers Digital Fixed Deposits (FDs) on its website.
- Punjab & Sind Bank, a state-owned bank, will launch a quick loan scheme for the MSME sector of up to Rs 25 lakh this month as part of its initiative to expand lending through its digital platform.





Ques : Who inaugurated the two-day international seminar on “Formalization and Social Security Coverage for Workers in the Informal Sector”?

- (a) Amit Shah
- (b) Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya
- (c) Rajnath Singh
- (d) Piyush Goyal
- (e) Nitin Gadkari

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya, Union Minister of Labour and Employment, Youth Affairs, and Sports, has opened a two-day international symposium on "Formalization and Social Security Coverage for Workers in the Informal Sector: Challenges and Innovations" in New Delhi.
- He also released the coffee table book "Social Protection in India," which chronicles India's effort to provide social protection to its population through various social welfare measures.
- The Indian Ministry of Labour and Employment, in partnership with the Employees' State Insurance Corporation (ESIC) and the worldwide Social Security Association (ISSA), convened this worldwide conversation at the Yashobhoomi - India International Convention & Expo Center.





Ques : What is the total amount agreed by the Union Cabinet to revive Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited (RINL)?

- (a) Rs.11,440 crore
- (b) Rs.10,240 crore
- (c) Rs.12,650 crore
- (d) Rs.9,440 crore
- (e) Rs.11,120 crore

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Union Cabinet approved a Rs.11,440 crore revival plan for Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited (RINL), the state-owned entity that runs the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant.
- Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw outlined the strategy, which involves a Rs.10,300 crore equity infusion and the conversion of Rs.1,140 crore in working capital loans to preferred share capital.
- RINL will benefit from a Rs.10,300 crore equity investment to address operational challenges in raising working capital and maximizing productivity in blast furnace operations. The recovery plan anticipates that RINL would begin full production with two blast furnaces in January 2025 and three blast furnaces in August 2025.

Genius





Ques : Which organization launched the Internet Governance Internship and Capacity Building Scheme?

- (a) Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)
- (b) National Informatics Centre (NIC)
- (c) National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI)
- (d) Indian Institute of Technology (IIT)
- (e) Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI)

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI) has introduced the Internet Governance Internship and Capacity Building Scheme. The initiative aims to increase awareness and skills in internet governance (IG) among Indian citizens.
- The program's goal is to provide participants with the knowledge they need to effectively participate in global internet governance processes with I-Star organizations such as the Internet Corporation for Assigned Names and Numbers (ICANN), the Internet Society or Information Security Operations Center (ISOC), the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE), and the Internet Engineering Task Force (IETF), as well as collaborate closely with leading industry experts.
- The program provides a bi-annual internship with two concurrent tracks: a six-month programme and a three-month programme.
- Interns will get a fixed monthly salary of Rs. 20,000/-, as well as assistance in carrying out necessary outreach projects.
- The National Internet Exchange of India, established on June 19, 2003, is a non-profit business under the aegis of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, Government of India.





Ques : MEITY in association with Data Security Council of India (DSCI) Launches which edition of Cyber Security Grand Challenge for Advancing Cyber security Innovations ?

- (a) 1st
- (b) 2nd
- (c) 3rd
- (d) 4th
- (e) 5th

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Cyber Security Grand Challenge 2nd Edition launched by S. Krishnan, Secretary of the Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology (MEITY).
- It is Implemented by Data Security Council of India (DSCI) based on Noida, Uttar Pradesh.
- Total Prize money is Rs.6.85 crores, compared to Rs.3.2 crores in its first edition
- Participants will develop innovative solutions in six key areas : Application Programming Interface (API) Security • Data Security • Wearable Device Security and Privacy • Clone and Fake Application (App) Mitigation • Artificial Intelligence (AI) for Threat Detection and Incident Response • Securing Next-Generation Biometric Systems

The challenge is divided into four stages :

- Idea Stage : A total of 36 startups (6 per problem area) will be selected, each receiving INR 5 lakh
- Minimum Viable Product (MVP) Stage : 18 startups will be chosen and awarded INR 10 lakh each
- Final Product Stage : Winners for each problem area will receive INR 25 lakh
- Go-to-Market Stage : At this final stage, three top winners will be announced

Final stage, three top winners :

- Platinum winner : Rs 1 crore
- Gold Winner : Rs 50 lakh
- Silver Winner : Rs 25 lakh





Ques : National broadband mission (NBM) launched in which year ?

- (a) 2015
- (b) 2017
- (c) 2019
- (d) 2021
- (e) 2023

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Union Minister of Communications Jyotiraditya M. Scindia has announced a number of projects, including the Sanchar Saathi Mobile App, the National Broadband Mission (NBM) 2.0, and the launch of the Intra Circle Roaming (ICR) capability at DBN-funded 4G mobile sites.
- NBM 2.0 seeks to connect the remaining 170,000 settlements in the country.
- Launched in 2019, the NBM aimed to provide internet access to all villages by 2022 by installing an additional 30 lakh km of optical fibre cable and increasing tower density from 0.42 to 1.0 tower per thousand inhabitants by 2024.

EXAM
Genius





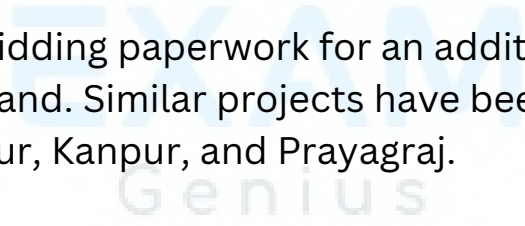
Ques : Which state has approved solar power projects worth over Rs 10,000 crore to meet the state's renewable energy capacity of 22,000 megawatts (MW) ?

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Rajasthan
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) Madhya Pradesh

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Uttar Pradesh has approved solar power projects worth over Rs 10,000 crore to meet the state's renewable energy capacity of 22,000 megawatts (MW).
- The roadmap calls for the construction of three 2,000 Mw solar power facilities in the Bundelkhand region's Jhansi, Lalitpur, and Chitrakoot districts.
- While NTPC Green Energy will build 800 Mw and 600 Mw solar power plants in Chitrakoot and Lalitpur, respectively, Hinduja Group has been selected to build a 600 Mw unit in Jhansi.
- The UPNEDA has issued bidding paperwork for an additional 1,200 Mw solar power facility in Jalaun, Bundelkhand. Similar projects have been suggested in various locations, including Mirzapur, Kanpur, and Prayagraj.





Ques : What is the name of the air taxi prototype unveiled by Sarala Aviation?

- (a) SkyGlide
- (b) SwiftAir
- (c) Nimbus
- (d) AeroOne
- (e) Shunya

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Sarala Aviation, a Bengaluru-based startup, showcased its prototype air taxi, Shunya, at the Bharat Mobility Global Expo.
- The startup plans to launch electric flying taxis in Bengaluru by 2028, becoming the first to introduce urban air transport in India.
- The Shunya prototype is designed for short travels of 20-30 kilometers and can attain speeds of up to 250 kilometers per hour.
- The vehicle can carry up to six passengers and a maximum weight of 680 kg, making it the biggest payload eVTOL (electric vertical take-off and landing) vehicle on the market today.
- Adrian Schmidt, Rakesh Gaonkar, and Shivam Chauhan co-founded Sarla Aviation in October 2023. Adrian Schmidt is the co-founder and CEO of Sarla Aviation.
- The business just acquired \$10 million in Series A funding, led by Accel and including Flipkart co-founder Binny Bansal and Zerodha co-founder Nikhil Kamath.





Ques : India clinches historic double victory in men's and women's titles in Kho Kho World Cup by defeating which country ?

- (a) Sri Lanka
- (b) Nepal
- (c) Bhutan
- (d) Bangladesh
- (e) None of these

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The inaugural Kho Kho World Cup in New Delhi concluded on a historic note, with India winning both the men's and women's titles in dramatic manner.
- The Indian women's kho kho team defeated Nepal 78-40 at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium to win the 2025 title. Meanwhile, the men's team defeated Nepal 54-36 in the final.
- India's Women Team Captain is Priyanka Ingle and India's Men's Team Captain is Pratik Waikar

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which country has recently been admitted as a “partner country” of the BRICS bloc?

- (a) Sweden
- (b) Spain
- (c) Gabon
- (d) Comoros
- (e) Nigeria

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Nigeria has been welcomed as a "partner country" of the BRICS bloc of developing countries, according to Brazil, the group's chairman.
- Iran, Egypt, Ethiopia, and the United Arab Emirates will join the group in 2023, and Saudi Arabia has been invited.
- Turkey, Azerbaijan, and Malaysia have formally sought to join BRICS, with a few more expressing interest.
- Nigeria is the eighth BRICS member country, joining Belarus, Bolivia, Cuba, Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Thailand, Uganda, and Uzbekistan.
- Brazil, Russia, India, and China founded BRICS in 2009, with South Africa joining in 2010 as a counterweight to the Group of Seven (G-7) main industrialised nations.

About Nigeria :

- Capital- Abuja
- Currency- Nigerian naira
- Continent- Africa
- President- Bola Tinubu





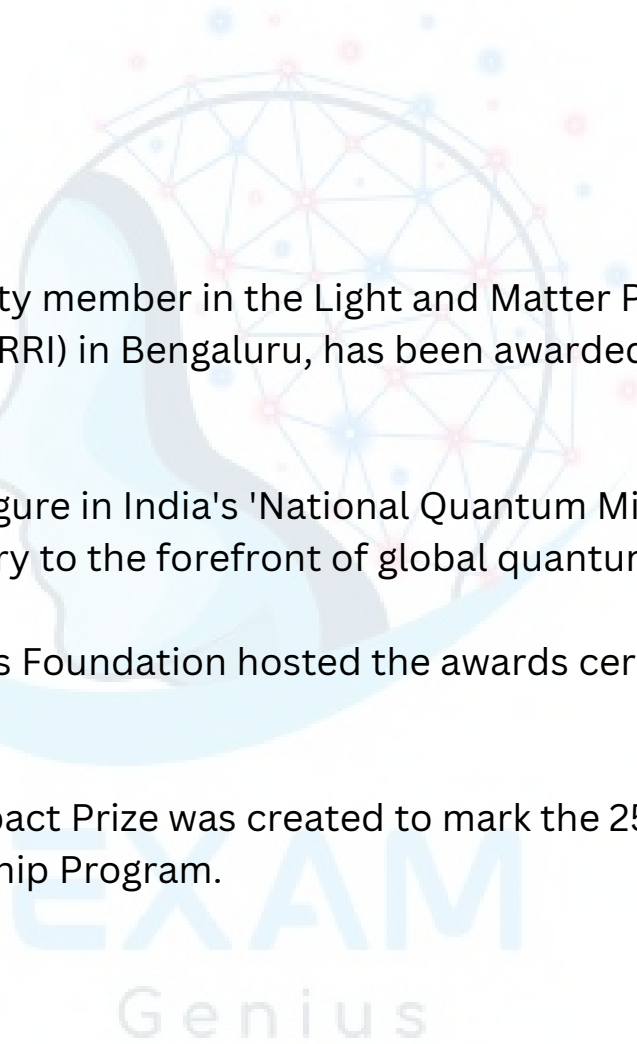
Ques : Who was awarded the Gates-Cambridge Impact Prize 2025?

- (a) Dr. Ramesh Kulkarni
- (b) Prof. Urbasi Sinha
- (c) Prof. Sudha Murthy
- (d) Dr. Vandana Sharma
- (e) Prof. Anil K. Gupta

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Prof. Urbasi Sinha, a faculty member in the Light and Matter Physics team of the Raman Research Institute (RRI) in Bengaluru, has been awarded the Gates-Cambridge Impact Prize 2025.
- Professor Sinha is a key figure in India's 'National Quantum Mission,' a program aimed at moving the country to the forefront of global quantum innovation.
- The Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation hosted the awards ceremony in Cambridge, UK.
- The Gates-Cambridge Impact Prize was created to mark the 25th anniversary of the Gates-Cambridge Scholarship Program.





Recent News Headlines Related to Awards & Winners :

- Singapore's highest honor for non-citizens, the Honorary Citizen Award : Tarun Das, former Director General of the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII)
- 'Satyajit Ray Lifetime Achievement Award' : Eminent director Aparna Sen
- Blue Flag certification : Kappad beach in Kozhikode and Chal beach in Kannur in Kerala
- Best javelin thrower of 2024 by American publication Track and Fields News : India's Neeraj Chopra
- India's 1st and world's 3rd airport to receive the prestigious Level 5 Accreditation : Mumbai (Maharashtra)-based Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport (CSMIA)
- Padmapani Lifetime Achievement Award : Sai Paranjpye for her contributions to both Indian cinema and Marathi literature
- Gangadhar National Award for Poetry 2023 : Odia poet Prativa Satpathy
- Bahrain's prestigious 'Medal of Efficiency' (First Class) by King Hamad bin Isa Al Khalifa : Dr. Ravi Pillai
- "Great Place to Work" certification for January 2025-2026 : Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL)
- SKOCH Award : Maharashtra government's initiative 'Shasan Aplya Dari' ('Government at Your Doorstep')
- 34th Vyas Samman for 2024 : Hindi writer Suryabala for Her novel "Kaun Des Ko Vasi: Venu Ki Diary" which was published in 2018
- Prestigious "Gold Award" in the State Energy Conservation Award 2024 : RINL, the corporate entity of the Visakhapatnam Steel Plant
- Royal honors 'knighthood' and 'damehood' by King Charles III : Oscar award winning filmmaker Christopher Nolan and his wife, Emma Thomas
- Pandit Swapan Chaudhuri : Rashtriya Tansen Samman 2023
- Sanand Nyas Sanstha from Indore : Raja Mansingh Tomar Samman 2023
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi : Kuwait's highest civilian honour, the Order of Mubarak Al Kabeer
- Mrs. India USA 2024 : Caitlin Sandra Neil, a 19-year-old Indian-American teenager born in Chennai, India





Ques : David Lynch, who recently passed away, was renowned for his work in which field?

- (a) Literature
- (b) Filmmaking
- (c) Painting
- (d) Music
- (e) Theatre

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- David Lynch, an American filmmaker known for his surrealist films Mulholland Drive and Twin Peaks, passed away at the age of 78.
- He received an honorary Academy Award in 2019 for his lifetime contributions to cinema.
- He received two Primetime Emmy Awards and a Peabody Award for Twin Peaks in 1991.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which team did Karnataka defeat in the Vijay Hazare Trophy 2024-25 final?

- (a) Punjab
- (b) Uttar Pradesh
- (c) Vidarbha
- (d) Gujarat
- (e) Hyderabad

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Karnataka defeated Vidarbha by 36 runs in the Vijay Hazare Trophy (VHT) 2024-25 final at the Kotambi Stadium in Vadodara. This is Karnataka's fifth Vijay Hazare Trophy title win.
- Karnataka first won the event in 2013-14, and they successfully defended it the following year. Their third title came in 2017-18, with Agarwal leading the batting rankings, while Padikkal was the leading run-scorer in Karnataka's fourth victory in 2019-20, over Tamil Nadu.
- Along with Karnataka, only Tamil Nadu (3), Mumbai (2), and Saurashtra (2) have won several titles during this time span.
- Captain of Karnataka Team is Mayank Agarwal and Captain of Vidarbha Team is Karun Nair.

EXAM
Genius





Recent News headlines related to Sports

- Novak Djokovic broke a tie with Roger Federer for the most Grand Slam matches in tennis history.
- Arjun Erigaisi, an Indian grandmaster, stunned the internet chess community by defeating World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen and World No. 2 Fabiano Caruana in Chess.com's Titled Tuesday weekly blitz competition.
- The International Cricket Council (ICC) has named Jasprit Bumrah of India and Annabel Sutherland of Australia as the ICC Men's and Women's Players of the Month for December 2024, respectively.
- The first Kho Kho World Cup kicked off on January 13, 2025, at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium in New Delhi. Sudhanshu Mittal, President of the Indian Kho Kho Federation, officially opened the World Cup.
- India and Mumbai batter Shreyas Iyer, the second-most expensive player in the player auction, has been appointed captain by Punjab Kings for IPL 2025. The 2024 IPL winning captain has previously led Delhi Capitals (DC) and Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) in the IPL.
- In squash, India's Anahat Singh won the Under 17 Girl's Singles title at the British Junior Open in Birmingham, England.
- Varun Tomar of the Indian Army has won the Men's 10-meter Air Pistol finals of the 67th National Shooting Championship 2024, which took place at Dr Karni Singh Shooting Range in New Delhi.
- Haryana Steelers reached a historic milestone by winning their first Pro Kabaddi League (PKL) title. In a thrilling final at the Shree Shiv Chhatrapati Sports Complex in Pune, the Steelers overcame the Patna Pirates by 32-23.
- West Bengal, the most successful team in the Santosh Trophy's history, added to its trophy collection by defeating Kerala in the final of the 78th edition. This was the Bengal team's 33rd Santosh Trophy.
- Hemanth Muddappa, known as the "Drag King," achieved a remarkable triple crown victory in the final round of the MMSC FMSCI Indian National Motorcycle Drag Racing Championship held at the Madras International Circuit (MIC).
- Kerala won the Senior National Men's Handball Championship for the first time, defeating Chandigarh 34-31. The event final was held in Changanassery, Kerala.
- Punjab's Vijayveer Sidhu defeated fellow Olympian Gurpreet Singh of the Army Marksmanship Unit to win his first men's 25m rapid-fire pistol (RFP) title at the 67th National Shooting Championship Competitions (NSCC) for pistol events





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Robert Jerard Ravi Appointed as Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL)

The 7th India Boat & Marine Show (IBMS) was held at the Bolgatty Palace Event Centre in Kochi. K-BIP of the Kerala government, NSIC, Kochi Water Metro, Kerala Tourism, Indian Coast Guard, Southern Naval Command, Kerala Maritime Board, CIFT, and the Fisheries Department have all supported and promoted the event.

Olympic champions Viktor Axelsen and An Se-young won the men's and women's singles titles, respectively, with lopsided victories in the India Open Super 750 badminton tournament in New Delhi.

Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya Appointed as Chief Justice of the Delhi High Court. He Replaced Justice Vibhu Bakhru.

Government of Uttarakhand and Icelandic company Verkis Consulting Engineers (Verkis) signed an MOU for geothermal exploration and development in Uttarakhand. Under the agreement, feasibility studies for these projects will be funded by the Government of Iceland.

Justice Alok Aradhe Appointed as Chief Justice of the Bombay High Court. He Replaced Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya.

EXAM
Genius



Ques : The Reserve Bank of India has revealed the names of the members of the Standing External Advisory Committee (SEAC), which will evaluate applications for Universal Banks and Small Finance Banks. What is the tenure of SEAC committee ?

- (a) 1 years
- (b) 2 years
- (c) 3 Years
- (d) 4 Years
- (e) 5 Years

Answer : Option C

Explanation

- The Reserve Bank of India has revealed the names of the members of the Standing External Advisory Committee (SEAC), which will evaluate applications for Universal Banks and Small Finance Banks. The SEAC's tenure will be three years.
- K. Jain, former Deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India, will chair the committee.
- The SEAC will be led by Revathy Iyer, Director of the Central Board of the RBI; Parvathy V. Sundaram, former Executive Director of the RBI; Hemant G. Contractor, former MD of SBI and former Chairman of the PFRDA; and N. S. Kannan, former MD and CEO of ICICI Prudential Life Insurance Company Ltd.
- The Reserve Bank of India's Department of Regulation will offer secretarial support to the committee.
- According to licensing requirements, applications for Universal Banks and Small Finance Banks will be initially examined by the Reserve Bank to ensure that the applicants are eligible.
- The applications will next be evaluated by a Standing External Advisory Committee (SEAC) made up of distinguished individuals with experience in banking, the financial sector, and other relevant fields.





Recent News Headlines Related to RBI

- RBI in cooperation with the government, has proposed amendments to the existing Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA) regulations to encourage cross-border transactions in the Indian rupee (INR) and local / national currencies.
- RBI has instructed banks and other regulated entities (REs) to use the '1600xx' phone numbering series exclusively for making transactional calls to customers.
- HSBC India, the Indian arm of London-based HSBC, has received approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to open 20 branches in 20 cities.
- The RBI will conduct daily Variable-Rate Repo (VRR) auctions until further notice. This measure will increase banking liquidity amid the deficit.
- The RBI has implemented new credit reporting rules. Lenders are now required to update credit bureau information every 15 days, rather than monthly. This directive went into force on January 1, 2025.
- The Reserve Bank Innovation Hub and IIMA Ventures have launched Swanari TechSprint 3.0, a program targeted at fostering women-centric financial firms in India.
- The RBI lifted the supervisory restrictions imposed on two non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) – Asirvad Micro Finance Limited and DMI Finance Private Limited.
- The Reserve Bank announced the winners of its 3rd Global Hackathon, themed 'Zero Financial Frauds' and 'Being Divyang Friendly'.
- The RBI has declared that the interest rate for RBI Floating Rate Savings Bonds (Taxable) FRSB 2020 (T) will stay at 8.05% from January 1 to June 30, 2025
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) lifted business restrictions on Arohan Financial Services Limited, a microfinance institution situated in Kolkata (West Bengal), after the lender implemented remedial steps and committed to fair loan pricing.
- HDFC Bank, India's largest private sector lender, has received the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) approval to acquire up to a 9.5% stake in Kotak Mahindra Bank, AU Small Finance Bank, and Capital Small Finance Bank.
- The Reserve Bank of India has approved a voluntary merger between The National Co-operative Bank Ltd., Bangalore (Karnataka) and Cosmos Co-operative Bank Limited (Maharashtra).
- As of December 31, 2024, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced that 98.12% of the Rs.2,000 denomination banknotes have been returned to the banking system, with Rs.6,691 crore still held by the public.





Ques : Who released the list of Non-Banking Finance Companies (NBFCs) in the Upper Layer (UL) segment under the Scale Based Regulation (SBR) for NBFCs for the financial year 2024-25(FY25) ?

- (a) NABARD
- (b) RBI
- (c) EPFO
- (d) SEBI
- (e) NPCI

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has published the list of Non-Banking Finance Companies (NBFCs) in the Upper Layer (UL) category under Scale-Based Regulation (SBR) for FY24-25.
- The RBI has kept Tata Sons Private Limited on the NBFC UL list despite their request to de-register, which is currently being reviewed.
- The latest list includes 15 organizations, including Life Insurance Corporation of India, Housing Finance Limited, Bajaj Finance Limited, and Shriram Finance Limited (SFL), among others.

Different types of NBFCs :

- NBFC-TL (Top Layer) : NBFC-UL will be moved to TL if RBI recog
- NBFC-UL (Upper Layer) : This layer are subjected to enhanced regulatory requirements for at least 5 years, even if they fail to meet the criteria in subsequent reviews
- NBFC-ML (Middle Layer) : All-deposit taking NBFCs and non-deposit taking NBFCs with assets more than Rs 1,000 crore.
- NBFC-BL (Base Layer) : Non-deposit taking NBFCs with assets less than Rs 1,000 crore



Ques : What is the GDP growth projection for India in the current fiscal by Deloitte India?

- (a) 6.5-6.8%
- (b) 5.5-5.8%
- (c) 7.0-7.3%
- (d) 6.0-6.3%
- (e) 7.5-7.8%

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Deloitte India expects India's GDP to increase at 6.5-6.8 percent in the current fiscal year, stating that India will need to adapt to the changing global landscape and leverage its internal assets to drive long-term prosperity.
- Deloitte India's Economic Outlook study also stated that the country must decouple from global uncertainty and maximize its own potential.

Updated GDP List :

- Deloitte – 6.5-6.8 (FY25)
- FICCI – 6.4% (FY25)
- UN – 6.6% (CY25); 6.7% (CY26)
- SBI – 6.3% (FY25)
- NSO – 6.4% (FY25)
- RBI – 6.6% (FY24)

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which insurance company has entered into a partnership with Bharti Airtel to create a digital platform for financial services ?

- (a) Go Digit General Insurance
- (b) Universal Sompo General Insurance
- (c) Kotak Mahindra Life Insurance
- (d) Bajaj Finance
- (e) None of these

Answer : option D

Explanation :

- Bajaj Finance has partnered with Bharti Airtel to develop a digital platform for financial services.
- With this agreement, the telecom operator will gradually provide the majority of the non-banking financial company's (NBFC) retail financial solutions to all of its 370 million consumers.
- The platform will serve 375 million customers and Airtel's over 1.2 million strong distribution network via Bajaj Finance's diverse range of 27 product lines. It will use the distribution power of over 5,000 branches and 70,000 field agents.
- Airtel will initially provide Bajaj Finance's retail banking products through its Airtel Thanks app. This is to ensure a seamless and secure consumer experience, which will be extended across its nationwide network of retailers.





Recently signed banking agreements

- The Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND) has signed an MoU with National Housing Bank (NHB) to engage in crucial areas such as intelligence sharing, capacity building, and risk assessment.
- PNB MetLife India Insurance Company Ltd (PNB MetLife) has entered into a strategic bancassurance agreement with Saraswat Co-operative Bank Ltd, one of India's leading urban co-operative banks.
- The state-owned PFC has signed an agreement with the Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC) for a credit facility of 120 billion Japanese yen (about Rs 6,600 crore)
- NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL) has teamed with Magnati, a UAE-based payment solution provider, to promote QR-based Unified Payments Interface (UPI) merchant payments using point-of-sale (POS) terminals across the Middle East.
- Suryoday Small Finance Bank (SSFB) has partnered with Tata Digital to expand its FD products.
- PhonePe has partnered with ICICI Lombard General Insurance to provide insurance coverage for travelers visiting the Maha Kumbh Mela.
- Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND) and the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) have signed a MoU for sharing of intelligence and information to check money laundering.
- The National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC) has teamed with pollster Axis My India to help bridge India's skills gaps and satisfy the predicted demand for millions of jobs in developed economies over the next five years.
- Bajaj brokerage, the brokerage arm of Bajaj Finance Ltd., has teamed up with Tamilnad Mercantile Bank (TMB) to launch a comprehensive 3-in-1 account solution that combines banking, broking, and investing services on a single platform
- The Assam government has inked a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with SBI and UBI to provide insurance coverage to state government employees.
- The Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH) has teamed with Vivifi Finance to start a pilot operation offering unsecured loans to gig workers.





Ques : Which organization developed the 'Entity Locker' platform?

- (a) National Informatics Centre (NIC)
- (b) Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)
- (c) National eGovernance Division (NeGD)
- (d) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- (e) Central Bureau of Digital Infrastructure (CBDI)

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Building on DigiLocker's success, the government has launched 'Entity Locker,' a new digital platform designed to simplify the management and verification of corporate and organizational records.
- This secure, cloud-based platform, developed by the National eGovernance Division (NeGD) of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), serves a wide range of entities, including corporations, micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs), trusts, startup companies, and societies.
- Entity Locker uses cutting-edge technology to easily interface with multiple government and regulatory systems. Key characteristics include real-time access to government databases, consent-based mechanisms for safe information sharing, Aadhaar-authenticated role-based access, and legally binding digital signatures.
- Users are also given 10 GB of encrypted cloud storage for secure document management.
- The platform, which is part of India's Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI), corresponds with the Union Budget 2024-25 goals of enhancing digital governance and making it easier to conduct business.
- The platform serves a variety of applications, including vendor verification on procurement portals, expediting MSME loan approvals, enabling FSSAI compliance, and streamlining GSTN, MCA, and bidding processes.





Recent News Headlines Related to launched Apps/portals

- Bharat Ranbhoomi Darshan app Launched by Union Minister Rajnath Singh, Ministry of Defense (MoD). This app includes detailed information of 77 battlefield sites.
- The Karnataka Forest Department plans to implement the "Garudakshi" online FIR system to tackle forest and wildlife crimes.
- Swiggy has introduced a new standalone food delivery app called 'Snacc by Swiggy'. Snacc is a 15-minute food delivery app that serves short snacks and meals, comparable to Zepto's Zepto Café.
- NITI Aayog's Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP) has developed EmpowHER Biz - Sapno Ki Udaan in collaboration with New Shop, India's largest 24/7 convenience shop chain, as part of its Award to Reward (ATR) program.
- The e-Shram portal has been improved and will now be available in all 22 scheduled languages. Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya, Union Minister of Labour and Employment, has launched the multilingual e-Shram portal, which aims to be a 'One-Stop-Solution' website for all unorganised registered workers.
- M Nagaraju, the Financial Services Secretary, has unveiled the revised 'Baanknet' portal for e-auctioning items like as commercial buildings, industrial land, stores, automobiles, and agricultural and non-agricultural property.
- Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel has unveiled a new citizen-centric project known as the SWAR (Speech and Written Analysis Resource) platform.
- On the occasion of 'Good Governance Day', which commemorates the birth anniversary of former Prime Minister Shri Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh unveiled the Rashtraparv Website and Mobile App on December 25, 2024.
- On National Consumers Day 2024, the Department of Consumer Affairs will make the "Jago Grahak Jago App" and "Jagriti App" available to the public
- Gujarat's Chief Minister, Bhupendra Patel, launched the 'Prakrutik Krushi Portal (Natural Agriculture Portal)' to encourage organic farming
- "Amrit Gyaan Kosh" Portal Launched by Union Minister of State(MoS), Dr. Jitendra Singh, Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions to build a comprehensive knowledge base by curating best practices from across India, with a focus on aligning these practices with 15 of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)





Ques : Who has claimed the top spot in the inaugural HSBC Hurun Global Indians List 2024 ?

- (a) Microsoft Chairman and CEO Satya Nadella
- (b) Alphabet CEO Sundar Pichai
- (c) YouTube CEO Neal Mohan
- (d) Google cloud CEO Thomas Kurian
- (e) Adobe CEO Shantanu Narayan

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- HSBC Hurun Global Indians List 2024 Published by Hurun.
- Satya Nadella, CEO of Microsoft, is ranked first in the inaugural HSBC Hurun Global Indians List 2024, which includes 226 CEOs of Indian descent who lead the world's most valuable organizations.
- Alphabet CEO Sundar Pichai and YouTube CEO Neal Mohan were second and third, respectively.
- Hurun compiled the list after surveying 400 respondents, including wealth creators.
- The survey shows that Indian-origin leaders have a major worldwide influence, with 79% of entrants residing in the US, 5% in the UK, and 4% in the UAE.
- San Francisco had the most entries (37), followed by New York and Palo Alto in California.

Ranking of top 5 in the HSBC Hurun Global Indians List 2024 :

- 1 Satya Nadella Microsoft CEO
- 2 Sundar Pichai Alphabet CEO
- 3 Neal Mohan YouTube CEO
- 4 Thomas Kurian Google cloud CEO
- 5 Shantanu Narayan Adobe CEO





India's Rankings in Different Indices

- Annual India Fintech Report 2024 Published by Tracxn Technologies Limited : India (3rd), United States of America (USA) (1st)
- Henley Passport Index 2025 Published by Henley : India (85th), Singapore (top)
- ThreatLandscape Report 2024 Published by CloudSEK : India (2nd), United States (top)
- Global Aging Index Published by National University of Singapore (NUS) & Columbia University : India (123rd), Switzerland (top)
- Hurun India Top 200 Self-Made Entrepreneurs of the Millennia 2024 Published by Hurun India & IDFC FIRST Private Banking : Kaivalya Vohra (Zepto) (Youngest), Ashok Soota (Happiest Minds Technologies) (Oldest)
- Travel and Tourism Development Index (TTDI) 2024 Published by World Economic Forum (WEF) : India (39th), United States (Top)
- 2025 QS Sustainability Rankings Published by QS Rankings : IIT Delhi (171), University of Toronto (Canada) (top)
- SBTi commitments by Indian companies Published by ICRA ESG Ratings Limited : India (6th), United Kingdom (UK) (top)
- "world's worst airlines" in the 2024 AirHelp Score survey : IndiGo (103rd), Brussels Airlines (top)
- Interdisciplinary Science Rankings (ISR) 2025 Published by Times Higher Education (THE) : Anna University in Chennai (Tamil Nadu, TN) (42nd), Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) (USA) (top)
- 2024 Network Readiness Index (NRI) Published by Portulans Institute and Saïd Business School : India (49th), United States of America (top)
- Sustainable Trade Index 2024 Published by Hinrich Foundation and IMD : India (23rd), New Zealand (top)
- Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) 2025 : India (10th), Denmark (last)
- Brand Finance's Global City Index Published by Brand Finance : London (top), New Delhi (77), Mumbai (78)
- WJP Rule of Law Index 2024 Published by World Justice Project (WJP) : India (79th), Denmark (top)
- World Intellectual Property Indicators Report 2024 : India (6th), China (top)





Ques : Singapore's Global Finance & Technology Network (GFTN) signed an MoU with which state to establish the Global Competency Centre ?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) Telangana

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Government of Odisha's Electronics and IT Department and Singapore's Global Finance & Technology Network (GFTN) have signed a MOU to establish a Global Competency Centre in Bhubaneswar to foster FinTech collaboration, with a focus on developing inclusive and sustainable InsureTech and related areas.
- The effort is another positive step towards honoring the 60th anniversary of India-Singapore diplomatic relations in 2025.
- Odisha intends to use global skills and resources to spur innovation and develop bespoke Fintech solutions. It is developing incubator hubs, encouraging relationships between academia and industry, and improving financing access.

About Odisha :

- Capital – Bhubaneswar
- Chief Minister – Mohan Charan Majhi (replace Naveen Patnaik)
- Deputy CM – KV Singhdeo and Pravati Parida
- Governor – Dr. Hari Babu Kambhampati





Recent News Headlines Related to MoU and agreement :

- Government of Uttarakhand and Icelandic company Verkis Consulting Engineers (Verkis) signed an MOU for geothermal exploration and development in Uttarakhand. Under the agreement, feasibility studies for these projects will be funded by the Government of Iceland
- Amazon has inked a deal to acquire fintech loan start-up Axio, formerly Capital Float, for around \$190-200 million.
- Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) and ITC Limited signed MOU to accelerate startup growth and technological advancement besides creation of viable market opportunities for startups across the country.
- India and Spain have signed two MOU to promote and expand their bilateral relations. These agreements prioritized sports collaboration and sustainable urban development. both countries agreed to mark 2026 as the "Year of Culture, Tourism, and Artificial Intelligence (AI)"
- Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL) and Oil & Natural Gas Corporation Limited (ONGC) Signed MoU to explore collaboration in the area of New and Renewable Energy (NRE) sector
- India has signed an agreement with Saudi Arabia for Hajj 2025, finalising a quota of 1,75,025 pilgrims. Union Minister for Minority Affairs Kiren Rijiju signed the deal in Jeddah with Saudi Minister for Hajj and Umrah Tawfiq Bin Fawzan Al Rabiah.
- Mongolia & India Signed an Mining Partnership. In the areas of geology and exploration, aiming to enhance resource security and diversify supply chains.
- Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) and JK Cement Signed an MOU to foster innovation, empower entrepreneurs, and strengthen India's manufacturing ecosystem.
- To increase job possibilities for young people, the Andhra Pradesh government has signed an agreement with software giant Infosys to provide technical help for the state's expected first-ever skill census initiative in the country.
- The Uttar Pradesh government has signed a MOU with Google Cloud (India) to develop the Gemini-powered and Beacon-enabled Uttar Pradesh Open Network for Agriculture.
- Coal India Limited (CIL) and Indian Rare Earths Limited (IREL) Partner to collaborate on the development of critical minerals. Coal India Limited (CIL) Established in 1975 and headquarter is in Kolkata, West Bengal.
- Union Ministry of Cooperation and Indonesia's Ministry of Trade signed an MOU valid for four years. India will provide Indonesia with one million metric tonnes of non-basmati white rice per year at the current international pricing.





Ques : Which state recently approved the rules and regulations for the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) ?

- (a) West Bengal
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Haryana
- (e) Maharashtra

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Uttarakhand cabinet has cleared the norms and regulations for the Uniform Civil Code (UCC), which would be implemented within the next 10 days.
- Uttarakhand would be the first state to adopt UCC since independence.
- UCC law covers fundamental problems like marriage, divorce, inheritance, and live-in relationships, with 7 schedules and 392 provisions.
- A nine-member team led by former chief secretary Shatrughan Singh was tasked with creating guidelines for implementing the Act.

About Uttarakhand :

- Capital : Gairsain (summer) Dehradun (winter)
- CM : Pushkar Singh Dhami
- Governor : Gurmit Singh





Recent News Headlines Related to First in india and world :

- Dr. Jitendra Singh, India's Science and Technology Minister, dedicated India's first-ever CSIR Innovation Complex in Mumbai via virtual mode.
- Google-backed Indian space start-up company Pixxel has become the first Indian private company to launch its commercial satellite constellation named Firefly on board a Space X rocket.
- The SpaceX rocket also carried the world's first commercial satellite for surveillance of space objects orbiting the earth, made by an Indian space company, Digantara.
- The Department of Science and Technology, Union Ministry of Science and Technology, has inaugurated the first astronomical observatory in Eastern India and the sixth in the country, located on Panchet Hill in the Garpanchkot area of Purulia district in West Bengal.
- On the occasion of Hindi Diwas, the Indian High Commission in Sri Lanka established the country's first Hindi Certificate Course through open and distant learning.
- On New Year's Day, January 1, 2025, India welcomed its first 'Generation Beta' baby in Aizawl, Mizoram.
- Noble Hospitals and Research Centre in Pune, Maharashtra has installed the first made-in-India surgical robot, the SSI Mantra (Multi-Arm Novel Tele Robotic Assistance).
- 'Nadi Tarangini', an indigenously designed pulse diagnostic instrument, has been India's first Ayurvedic medical device to be approved for use by the Central Drugs Standard Control Organization (CDSCO).
- The Gujarat government will conduct the country's first census of coastal and wader birds in the Marine National Park and Sanctuary in Jamnagar.
- In a first, Chhattisgarh state has devised an innovative concept that combines forest ecosystem services with Green Gross Domestic Product (Green GDP).
- Kanyakumari, Tamil Nadu's famed tourist resort, has added another pearl to its crown. India's first glass bridge across the sea was inaugurated.
- Devi Ahilyabai Holkar Airport in Indore has been officially declared India's first Zero-Waste Airport.
- Uttarakhand has recently inaugurated its first wine production unit in Kotdwar, which is part of the government's new excise policy aimed at promoting wine tourism





Ques : United States President Donald Trump signed an executive order to withdraw from which Organisation on his very first day in office ?

- (a) WHO
- (b) WTO
- (c) IMF
- (d) ADB
- (e) None of these

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- On his first day in office, US President Donald Trump signed an executive order withdrawing from the World Health Organization (WHO).
- The order stated that the reasons for withdrawal were WHO's "mishandling of the COVID-19 pandemic," "failure to adopt urgently needed reforms," "inability to demonstrate independence from the inappropriate political influence of WHO member states," and the continued demand of "unfairly onerous payments from the United States."
- According to the WHO, US contributions were \$662 million for the 2024-25 budget cycle, accounting for 19% of the agency's overall revenue.
- The WHO is a United Nations organization that works on global health issues. It collaborates with governments to improve primary health care, develops government policies, and coordinates programs to combat certain diseases.





Ques : On which day Lokpal of India celebrated its inaugural Foundation Day at the Manekshaw Centre in New Delhi ?

- (a) January 16, 2025
- (b) January 17, 2025
- (c) January 18, 2025
- (d) January 19, 2025
- (e) January 20, 2025

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- On January 16, 2025, the Lokpal of India held its maiden Foundation Day at the Manekshaw Centre in New Delhi.
- The day commemorated the establishment of an anti-corruption body under Section 3 of the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013, which took effect on January 16, 2014.
- The occasion included Chief Justice of India, Justice Sanjiv Khanna, as the Chief Guest.
- The Lokpal, chaired by Justice A.M. Khanwilkar, traces its origins to a civil society movement that advocated for an ombudsman to combat corruption.

About Lokpal :

- Concept originated from Administrative Reforms Commission (ARC) report (1966)
- Concept of ombudsman originated in Sweden in 19th century. Term coined by Dr. L.M.Singhvi in 1963.
- Selection Committee includes PM (Chairman), Lok Sabha Speaker, Opposition Leader, CJI/ Judge of the Supreme Court, and an eminent jurist
- The Tenure is 5 years or until 70 years of age
- Appointed made by President of India
- Timeline for cases are for Preliminary inquiry 90 days and for Investigation it is 6 months (extendable)
- 1st chairperson was Pinaki Chandra Ghose and Recent Chairperson is Ajay Manikrao Khanwilkar
- Composition : • Chairperson (Chief Justice of India or a Supreme Court judge, or an eminent person) • Up to 8 members (50% judicial; 50% from SC/ST/OBC/minorities/women)





Ques : The United States of America (USA)'s Bureau of Industry & Security (BIS) has removed how many Indian nuclear entities from its restrictive Entity List ?

- (a) 2
- (b) 3
- (c) 4
- (d) 5
- (e) 6

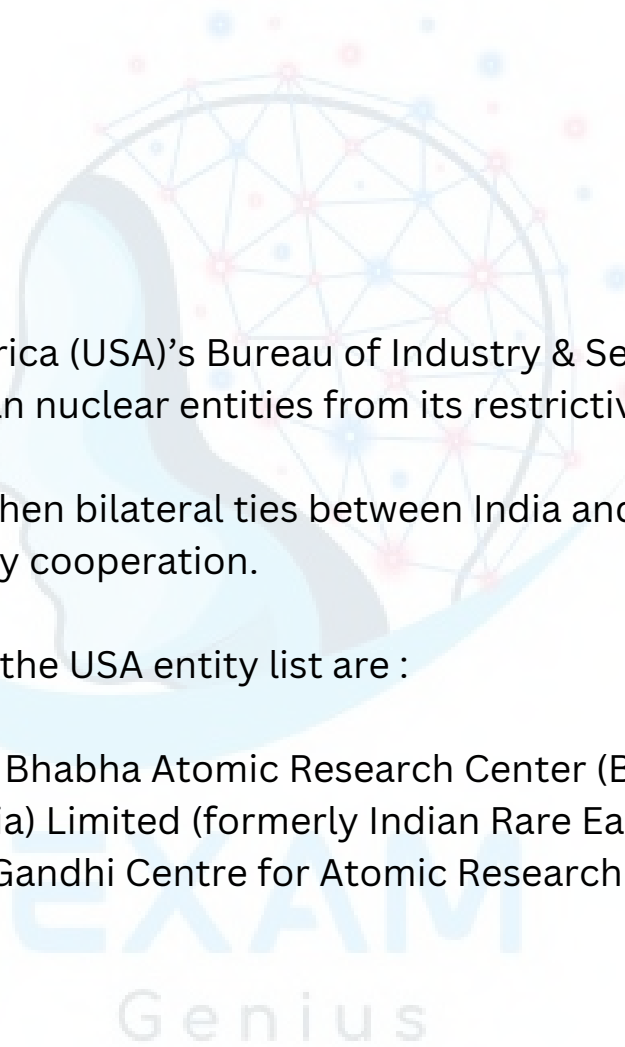
Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The United States of America (USA)'s Bureau of Industry & Security (BIS) has removed 3 prominent Indian nuclear entities from its restrictive Entity List .
- This move aims to strengthen bilateral ties between India and USA and also focus on promoting advanced energy cooperation.

The entities removed from the USA entity list are :

1. Trombay, Mumbai based Bhabha Atomic Research Center (BARC)
2. Mumbai based IREL (India) Limited (formerly Indian Rare Earths Ltd)
3. Kalpakkam based Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research (IGCAR)





Ques : Which state government has launched 'Deendayal Upadhyay Bhoomiheen Krishi Majdoor Kalyana Yojana' to provide Rs 10,000 annual aid to labourers?

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Jammu and Kashmir
- (c) Nagaland
- (d) Bihar
- (e) Chhattisgarh

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai has launched the 'Deendayal Upadhyay Bhoomiheen Krishi Majdoor Kalyana Yojana' in Raipur.
- Under this initiative, more than 5.62 lakh landless agricultural workers, Baigas, and Gunias in the state will receive Rs 10,000 each year.
- The scheme's beneficiaries received more than Rs 562 crores as a result.
- The Chief Minister also took part in the 'Nagar Vikas Ke Sopan' event in Raipur, where he lay the groundwork for 813 projects totaling Rs 155.38 million.

About Chhattisgarh :

- Capital – Raipur
- Chief Minister – Vishnu Deo Sai (replace Bhupesh Baghel)
- Deputy CM – Arun Sao & Vijay Sharma
- Governor – Biswabhusan Harichandan





Recent News Headlines Related to Schemes

- PARTH Yojana (Police Army Recruitment Training & Hunar) Launched by Madhya Pradesh To prepare youth for recruitment into Indian Army, Police, ParaMilitary forces, and related services.
- Mohan Charan Majhi, Chief Minister of Odisha announced Shahid Madho Singh Haath Kharcha Scheme with a budget of Rs 156 crore to support tribal students. Its aims is to reduce dropout rates and increase students' interest in education.
- PLI scheme for Specialty Steel, termed as PLI Scheme 1.1 Launched by Union Minister of Steel and Heavy Industries, Shri H. D. Kumaraswamy at Vigyan Bhavan New Delhi. It is launched for the Period of FY 2025-26 to FY 2029-30.
- The Mira Bhayandar Municipal Corporation (MBMC) has developed a flagship initiative named 'Faral Sakhi' to encourage women entrepreneurs in the city of Mira Bhayandar, Maharashtra.
- The Union Cabinet, led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the extension of the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana and Restructured Weather Based Crop Insurance Scheme until 2025-26, with a total budget of Rs.69,515.71 crore from 2021-22 to 2025-26.
- The Income Tax Department has extended the deadline for the Vivad Se Vishwas Scheme 2024, offering taxpayers another chance to resolve disputes at lower tax rates. The extended new date is January 31, 2025.
- The Haryana government has agreed to enhance the maximum amount of Death-cum-Retirement Gratuity for state government employees by 25%.
- Government of India(GoI) sanctioned Rs. 4388 crore under the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahabhiyan (PM-KUSUM) Scheme to solarize agriculture for states across India.
- Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) chief Arvind Kejriwal has launched a new scholarship programme aimed at Dalit students in Delhi. The scheme, named the Dr Ambedkar Samman Scholarship, will cover all expenses for Dalit students wishing to pursue higher education abroad.
- Delhi Chief Minister Atishi has introduced the Mukhyamantri Mahila Samman Yojana, which would pay a monthly stipend of Rs 1,000 to women residents with annual household incomes of up to Rs 3 lakh
- Gujarat, Maharashtra, and Uttar Pradesh have emerged as the top three states for rooftop solar installations under the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana plan. It is launched on February 15, 2024.





Ques : Which region's women entrepreneurs were highlighted in the 118th episode of "Mann Ki Baat"?

- (a) Lakshadweep
- (b) Andaman and Nicobar Islands
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Goa
- (e) Tamil Nadu

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- In the 118th episode of "Mann Ki Baat," Prime Minister Narendra Modi emphasized the empowerment of women who produce Virgin Coconut Oil (VCO) in the Andaman & Nicobar Islands.
- This initiative intends to economically empower tribal people by establishing self-help groups (SHGs) and providing marketing and branding training.
- The Nicobar district's Virgin Coconut Oil (VCO) has earned the Geographical Indication (GI) badge.

About Andaman and Nicobar Islands :

- Capital : Port Blair
- Lt : Governor Admiral Devendra Kumar Joshi

EXAM
Genius





Ques : The third National Mining Ministers Conference concluded in which state ?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) Telangana

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The third National Mining Ministers Conference concluded in Konark, Odisha, with an emphasis on vital minerals mining. Rajasthan received the prize for excellent contribution to organizing the most auctions in 2023-24.
- The first National Mining Ministers Conference took place in Hyderabad, Telangana, in September 2022, followed by the second in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, in January 2024.
- The Union Ministry of Mines organized the National Mining Ministers Conference in conjunction with the Odisha government.
- G. Kishan Reddy, Union Minister of Coal and Mines, opened the third National Mining Ministers' Conference. Mohan Charan Majhi, the Chief Minister of Odisha, was the Conference's Chief Guest.

Genius





Recent News Headlines Related to Summits / conference

- Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya, Union Minister of Labour and Employment, Youth Affairs, and Sports, has opened a two-day international symposium on "Formalization and Social Security Coverage for Workers in the Informal Sector: Challenges and Innovations" in New Delhi.
- During the first-ever corporate round-table conference in New Delhi, Union Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya invited corporations to adopt one sport with the goal of boosting the Indian sports ecosystem in preparation for the 2036 Olympic Games.
- Om Birla, Speaker of the Lok Sabha, has opened the 85th All India Presiding Officers' Conference (AIPOC) in Patna.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi launched the 'Bharat Mobility Global Expo 2025,' the country's largest mobility expo, at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi will participate in the Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Summit in France. The event will focus on five key themes: public interest in AI, the future of work, innovation and culture, trust in AI, and global AI governance.
- India will host the 28th Commonwealth Speakers and Presiding Officers Conference (CSPOC) in 2026. The seminar will center on the application of artificial intelligence and social media in parliamentary processes.
- Over the next five years, a total of Rs 50,000 crore would be invested in infrastructure along national waterways. According to the announcement, the investment ideas were announced during the Inland Waterways Development Council (IWDC) meeting in Kohora, Kaziranga.





Ques : The northeastern states of Manipur, Meghalaya, and Tripura celebrate their Statehood Day on which day ?

- (a) 20 January
- (b) 21 January
- (c) 22 January
- (d) 23 January
- (e) 24 January

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Every year on January 21, the northeastern states of Manipur, Meghalaya, and Tripura celebrate Statehood Day, commemorating the momentous moment when they achieved full statehood under the North Eastern Region (Reorganization) Act of 1971.
- Manipur, dubbed the "Jewel of India," has a rich past that includes traditional art, dance, and literature. Manipur's sovereignty in 1972 enabled it to thrive while maintaining its distinct identity.
- Meghalaya, often known as the "Abode of Clouds," became a full-fledged state to preserve its own cultural and linguistic identity. In 1947, the rulers of the Garo and Khasi regions joined India.
- Meghalaya, located in the country's northeastern area, was established as an autonomous state inside the state of Assam on April 2, 1970, including the districts of United Khasi and Jaintia Hills, as well as the Garo Hills.
- Tripura was a princely state till it merged with India on November 15, 1949. Bir Bikram was the last monarch to reign before India gained freedom. After his death on May 17, 1947, his minor son Kirri Bikram Mannikya ascended to the throne of Tripura kingdom.





Important days :

- 26 December : Boxing Day
- 26 December : Computer Operators' Day
- 26 December : Veer Bal Divas A Day of Valor And Righteousness
- 27 December : International Day of Epidemic Preparedness
- 29 December : International Cello Day
- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 2 January : 67th Foundation Day of Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day
- 4 January : World Braille Day
- 5 January : National Bird Day (Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future)
- 6 January : World Day of War Orphans
- 6 January : Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) celebrated its 78th Foundation Day
- 8 January : Earth's Rotation Day
- 9 January : NRI or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- 10 January : World Hindi Day, also known as 'Vishwa Hindi Diwas' (Theme 2025: A Global Voice of Unity and Cultural Pride)
- 12 January : National Youth Day (Theme 2025: Youth for a Sustainable Future: Shaping the Nation with Resilience and Responsibility)
- 14 January : 9th Armed Forces Veterans' Day 2025 (Celebrates to Commemorates The retirement of Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa on January 14, 1953)
- 15 January : Indian Army Day (Theme 2025: Samarth Bharat, Saksham Sena (Capable India, Empowered Army))
- 16 January : National Startup Day
- 11 to 17 January : National Road Safety Week 2025
- January 18 to February 17 : National Road Safety Month 2025 (Theme 2025 Sadak Suraksha Jeevan Raksha)
- 20 January : National Penguin Awareness Day





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Eritrea's Berhane Tesfay and Kenya's Joyce Chepkemoi Tele won the men's and women's elite races, respectively, at the Mumbai Marathon 2025.

International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON) and the Adani Group Collaborate to ensure that nearly one lakh people are provided with nutritious meals daily during the 45-day spiritual gathering at Maha Kumbh Mela. SKCON has set up a large-scale kitchen at Harshvardhan Marg.

Russian President Vladimir Putin and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian signed a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership Treaty for 20 years at Moscow. The agreement seeks to enhance trade and economic ties, with bilateral trade having risen by 15.5% to \$3.77 billion between January and October 2024.

The National Broadband Mission (NBM) 2.0 aims to expand "operational" fiber connectivity to 2.7 lakh villages by 2030, from 50,000 now. The share of rural Indians who are subscribers should also grow from 45% to 60% by then.

India has ascended to the position of the world's seventh-largest coffee producer, with exports reaching \$1.29 billion in the fiscal year 2023-24, nearly doubling from \$719.42 million in 2020-21.

The introduction of coffee to India traces back to the 1600s when Sufi saint Baba Budan brought seven Mocha seeds to the hills of Karnataka.

Book The World After Gaza Authored by Pankaj Mishra.





Ques : Which act provides the legislative framework for Asset Reconstruction Companies in India?

- (a) Banking Regulation Act, 1949
- (b) SARFAESI Act, 2002
- (c) Companies Act, 2013
- (d) RBI Act, 1934
- (e) Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- RBI has updated instructions for settling dues owed by borrowers to Asset Reconstruction Companies (ARCs) under the Master Direction- Reserve Bank of India (Asset Reconstruction Companies), 2024.
- The amended instructions were published through a circular under Sections 9 and 12 of the SARFAESI Act, 2002 (54 of 2002).
- Borrowers with more than 1 crore outstanding dues would have their proposal reviewed by an Independent Advisory Committee (IAC) before settlement.
- Borrowers with outstanding dues of Rs 1 crore or less might get settlement approval from a non-acquisition officer.

EXAM
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Ques : Which General Insurance Company Launches CyberEdge a Comprehensive Cyber Insurance Solution for Indian Businesses ?

- (a) Bajaj Allianz General Insurance
- (b) ICICI Prudential Life Insurance
- (c) Kotak Mahindra Life Insurance
- (d) TATA AIG General Insurance Company
- (e) PNB MetLife India Insurance

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- TATA AIG General Insurance Company has launched CyberEdge, a cutting-edge cyber insurance product aimed at protecting Indian enterprises from the growing threat of cyberattacks.
- The policy caters to organizations of all sizes, providing financial and operational support in areas such as forensic investigations, legal fees, data recovery, extortion payments, and business interruption losses.
- With the cyber insurance business quickly developing, TATA AIG hopes to gain a 25% market share within five years.
- The announcement comes in reaction to the worrisome rise in cyber events; a Prahar analysis found 79 million cyberattacks in India in 2023, with a projected increase to 1 trillion every year by 2033.

About Tata AIG General Insurance Company :

- Established : 2001
- HQ : Mumbai
- MD & CEO : Neelesh Garg





Ques : What type of service will Skydo Technologies provide under the RBI authorization?

- (a) Domestic fund transfers
- (b) International credit ratings
- (c) Cross-border payment aggregation
- (d) Cryptocurrency trading
- (e) Digital wallet services

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Skydo Technologies, a cross-border payments startup, has been granted in-principle authorization from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to function as a Payment Aggregator-Cross Border entity.
- Skydo presently handles over 12,000 exporters in India and processes over \$250 million in annual export payments.
- Skydo has received Payment Service Provider (PSP) clearance from Amazon, allowing it to process payments for exporters participating in the Global Selling program.

Criteria for payment aggregator-cross border (PA-CB) licence :

- In October 2023, the RBI released a circular mandating minimum net worth standards for non-banks operating as PA-CBs.
- Applicants must have a net worth of Rs 15 crore at the time of application and Rs 25 crore by March 31, 2026, as per the regulations.
- New non-banks must have a net value of Rs 25 crore by the end of the third financial year after authorization.



Ques : When was the Paris Agreement on climate change originally adopted?

- (a) 2012
- (b) 2013
- (c) 2014
- (d) 2015
- (e) 2016

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Following Donald Trump's inauguration for his second term as President, the United States will withdraw from the 2015 Paris Climate Agreement.
- Trump had already withdrawn the United States out of the Paris Agreement during his first term, but his successor, Joe Biden, rejoined four years later.
- The Paris Agreement, signed in 2015, is a global agreement aimed at keeping global warming to far below 2°C above pre-industrial levels, with efforts to restrict the increase to 1.5°C.
- The pact encourages countries to establish and meet their own emission-reduction objectives, known as Nationally Determined Contributions.
- The United States is the second-largest source of greenhouse gas emissions. Its decision to extract, consume, and export additional fossil fuels may nullify even this 2% reduction.





Ques : Which Edition of World Future Skills Index 2025 Published by Quacquarelli Symonds (QS) ?

- (a) 1st
- (b) 2nd
- (c) 3rd
- (d) 4th
- (e) 5th

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- World Future Skills Index 2025 Edition 1st Edition Published by Quacquarelli Symonds (QS).
- It use 4 Indicators : Skills fit, Academic readiness, Future of work and Economic transformation
- India ranked 25th globally with a score of 76.6, indicating it as a "future skills contender."
- The USA ranks first with a score of 97.6, followed by the UK (97.1) and Germany (94.6).
- G7 countries scored 68.3, highlighting India's need for further investment and innovation in sustainable practices.

Ranking of top 5 countries :

- 1 USA
- 2 UK
- 3 Germany
- 4 Australia
- 5 Canada
- 25 India

EXAM
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India's Rankings in Different Indices

- HSBC Hurun Global Indians List 2024 Published by Hurun : Satya Nadella, CEO of Microsoft (Top)
- Annual India Fintech Report 2024 Published by Tracxn Technologies Limited : India (3rd), United States of America (USA) (1st)
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- "world's worst airlines" in the 2024 AirHelp Score survey : IndiGo (103rd), Brussels Airlines (top)
- Interdisciplinary Science Rankings (ISR) 2025 Published by Times Higher Education (THE) : Anna University in Chennai (Tamil Nadu, TN) (42nd), Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) (USA) (top)

Genius





Ques : Which edition of Jaipur Literature Festival to begin from January 30 ?

- (a) 12th
- (b) 14th
- (c) 16th
- (d) 18th
- (e) 20th

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The 18th edition of the Jaipur Literature Festival, the world's largest literary event, will take place from January 30 to February 3, 2025.
- The coveted Kanhaiya Lal Sethia Award for Poetry, which will be presented to eminent Hindi poet Badri Narayan, is one of the festival's highlights. He received the Sahitya Akademi Award in 2022 for his collection Tumdi ke Shabd.
- The 2025 edition will also focus on the theme "Fractured World," featuring sessions on current geopolitics, war, and conflict, as well as topics such as theater, dance, music, cinema, sports, food, and climate change.

EXAM
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Ques : Which government department has entered into an alliance with Apna for a talent hunt to equip startups with skilled manpower?

- (a) Department of Higher Education
- (b) Department of Official Language
- (c) Department of Fertilizers
- (d) Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
- (e) Department of Consumer Affairs

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) and Apna, the country's jobs and professional networking platform, have formed an alliance to conduct a talent search to provide DPIIT-registered startups with highly skilled personnel, thereby creating new job opportunities for unemployed youth.
- The agreement, which was formalized through MoU, provides a monetary value of Rs 2000 per entity registered on the Bharat Startup Registry (Bhaskar) platform in recruiting credits on Apna's platform for each of the 7,000,000 entities. This is now scheduled to be worth Rs 140 crore.
- India presently has approximately 1.59 lakh firms recognized by the DPIIT, and by January 15, 2025, it will have firmly established itself as the world's third-largest startup ecosystem.
- According to official data, this thriving ecosystem, led by over 100 unicorns, is continuing to reinvent innovation and entrepreneurship on a global scale.





Ques : Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar started in which year ?

- (a) 2015
- (b) 2016
- (c) 2018
- (d) 2019
- (e) 2020

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS) Honored with Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar 2025 under Institutional Category.
- Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar Started in 2019 and Sponsored by Government of India
- It is Awarded on January 23, the birth anniversary of freedom fighter Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose.
- Prize under Institution Category is Cash prize of Rs.51 lakh (US\$59,000) and a certificate
- Prize under Individual Category is Cash prize of ₹5 lakh (US\$5,800) and a certificate
- 2024 winner is 60 Parachute Field Hospital, Uttar Pradesh (Institutional)

About INCOIS :

- Established : 1999
- HQ : Hyderabad, Telangana
- Chairman : Dr. M. Ravichandran





Ques : Who has been elected as the president of the Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI) for 2025?

- (a) Rajesh Verma
- (b) Dhananjay Shukla
- (c) Meena Gupta
- (d) Ankit Srivastava
- (e) Piyush Sharma

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI) has elected Dhananjay Shukla as its president for 2025. Dhananjay Shukla was the vice-president of the ICSI for 2024 .
- He is a commerce and law graduate, a fellow of ICSI, and a practicing company secretary in Gurugram.
- Pawan G Chandak, on the other hand, has been appointed as the vice president, with a background in labor laws and welfare.

About Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI) :

- Established : 1968
- Act : Company Secretaries Act 1980
- HQ : New Delhi
- Administered by : Union Ministry of Corporate Affairs





Recent Appointment in different departments :

- Robert Jerard Ravi : Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of Bharat Sanchar Nigam Limited (BSNL)
- Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya : Chief Justice of the Delhi High Court (Replaced Justice Vibhu Bakhru)
- Justice Alok Aradhe : Chief Justice of the Bombay High Court (Replaced Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyaya)
- Marco Rubio : 72nd US Secretary of State
- Nripendra Mishra : Chairperson of Executive Council of the Prime Ministers Museum and Library Society
- Vineet Joshi : Secretary of the Department of Higher Education under the Ministry of Education
- K Vinod Chandran : Chief Justice of Supreme Court
- Ajit Kumar Mohanty : Chairman of the reformed Atomic Energy Commission (AEC)
- Devajit Saikia : New secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)
- Prabhtej Singh Bhatia : Treasurer of the Indian Cricket Board
- Brijendra Pratap Singh : Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) of National Aluminium Company (NALCO)
- B. N. Srikrishna : Chairperson of Equal's newly formed Advisory Board
- Tuhin Kanta Pandey : Secretary, Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance
- Dr. V Narayanan : chairman of the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- Bahadur Singh Sagoo : President of the Athletics Federation of India (AFI) (Replaced Adille Sumariwalla)
- Mike Johnson, a Republican from Louisiana : Speaker of the U.S. House of Representatives
- Devajit Saikia : Chief Secretary of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)





Ques : What is the approved Minimum Support Price (MSP) of Raw Jute (TD-3 grade) for the 2025-26 marketing season?

- (a) Rs. 5,450 per quintal
- (b) Rs. 5,650 per quintal
- (c) Rs. 5,000 per quintal
- (d) Rs. 5,750 per quintal
- (e) Rs. 5,450 per quintal

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA), chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for Raw Jute for the marketing season 2025-26.
- The MSP for raw jute (TD-3 grade) has been set at Rs.5,650/- per quintal for the 2025-26 season. This would result in a return of 66.8% over the all-India weighted average cost of production.
- The authorized MSP for raw jute for the marketing season 2025-26 is consistent with the premise of setting MSP at at least 1.5 times the all-India weighted average cost of production, as announced by the government in the Budget 2018-19.
- The MSP of raw jute for the marketing season 2025-26 has increased by Rs.315/- per quintal over the previous marketing season 2024-25.
- The Government of India increased the MSP of raw jute from Rs.2400/- per quintal in 2014-15 to Rs.5,650/- per quintal in 2025-26, representing a 2.35-fold increase.





Ques : The 1st International Olympic Research Conference is set to be hosted in which state ?

- (a) Punjab
- (b) Uttar Pradesh
- (c) Vidarbha
- (d) Gujarat
- (e) Hyderabad

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- India's bid to host the 2036 Olympics has taken a crucial step ahead, with officials from the Indian Olympic Association (IOA) and experts from various sectors gathering in Gujarat for a critical four-day event.
- The event will take conducted at Gandhinagar's Rashtriya Raksha University (RRU) campus.
- This seminar, conducted in partnership with the Union Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, focuses on establishing strategies and new business models to build long-term sports infrastructure, which is critical for presenting India as a strong contender to host the famous global event.

Themes :

1. 2036 Vision: Pathway to Become an Olympic Host
2. Global Best Practices in Olympic City Selection and Urban Legacy
3. Financing the Future: Economic Models for Hosting Olympics
4. Greening the Games: Sustainability in Indian Olympic Plan
5. Gender Equity and Inclusion in Sports



Ques : Who has been given the additional charge of Director General, Bureau of Civil Aviation Security (BCAS)?

- (a) Kuldeep Singh
- (b) Amrit Mohan Prasad
- (c) Rakesh Asthana
- (d) Sujoy Lal Thaosen
- (e) Sanjay Arora

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Central government has assigned Amrit Mohan Prasad, Director General of Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB), the additional responsibility of Director General, Bureau of Civil Aviation Security (BCAS).
- Prasad was given the job months after BCAS DG Zulfiqar Hasan departed on October 31, last year.
- Prasad, a 1989-batch IPS officer from the Odisha cadre, has been assigned the extra charge for six months from November 1, 2024, or until the regular incumbent joins or further directives are issued, whichever comes first.
- BCAS is India's regulating authority for civil aviation security, having been reorganised as an autonomous department within the Ministry of Civil Aviation on April 1, 1987.





Ques : Who has been appointed as the Director General of the Border Security Force (BSF)?

- (a) Rakesh Sharma
- (b) Anil Deshmukh
- (c) Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal
- (d) Rajendra Prasad Singh
- (e) Deepak Verma

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal has been named Director General of the Border Security Force (BSF).
- The 1994-Batch IPS officer from the Tamil Nadu cadre would serve as Additional Director-General of Police, BSF, for four years.
- Mr Aggarwal formerly served as Commissioner of Police in Chennai, where he oversaw the Operations, Enforcement Bureau, and Armed Police divisions, launching a number of initiatives such as Drive Against Drugs and Kaaval Karangal. He has also created a number of police welfare projects.

About BSF :

- Established : 1st December 1965
- HQ : New Delhi
- Director : Daljit Singh Chaudhary





Ques : Discovery of a Rare Umamaheshwara Sculpture is in which state ?

- (a) West Bengal
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Haryana
- (e) Maharashtra

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- A historical item, an Umamaheshwara metal sculpture, has been discovered in Taggunje, Ajri village, Kundapura taluk, Udupi district, Karnataka.
- This sculpture, produced in the 17th century with a 12th-century style, combines Shaiva Shaktha and Naga worship traditions.

About the sculpture :

- Panchaloha, a five-metal sculpture, is a masterwork of religious art and culture.
- The image represents Lord Shiva sitting on a lotus platform with Parvati (Uma) on his lap, surrounded by Ganesha, Shanmukha, and Nandi.
- The sculpture's base contained two lines in Kannada writing from the 17th century.

About Karnataka :

- Capital : Bangalore
- CM : Siddaramaiah
- Governor : Thawar Chand Gehlot



Ques : Which state government has signed 54 MoUs worth 15.70 lakh crore rupees during the World Economic Forum (WEF) Annual Meeting 2025 in Davos ?

- (a) West Bengal
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Haryana
- (e) Maharashtra

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- During the World Economic Forum (WEF) Annual Meeting 2025 in Davos, the Maharashtra government signed 54 MOU totaling 15.70 lakh crore rupees.
- These agreements are estimated to create around 16 lakh jobs across a variety of sectors. One of the important agreements is with MSN Holdings Ltd, which intends to develop an advanced lithium battery and cell manufacturing facility under the state's 'Ultra Mega facility' initiative.
- The project, which will cost 14,652 crore rupees, seeks to create 8,760 direct and indirect jobs, with a focus on developing the Vidarbha region.
- The largest MoU was signed with Reliance Group, which has committed 3.05 lakh crore rupees to investments in petrochemicals, polyester, renewable energy, bioenergy, green hydrogen, retail, telecommunications, data centers, hospitality, and real estate.
- The WEF Annual Meeting 2025, scheduled from January 20 to 24 in Davos, Switzerland, is themed "Collaboration for the Intelligent Age."





Ques : Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Jayanti, also known as 'Parakram Diwas' or Courage Day, is celebrated annually on which day ?

- (a) 20 January
- (b) 21 January
- (c) 22 January
- (d) 23 January
- (e) 24 January

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Jayanti, also known as 'Parakram Diwas' or Courage Day, is observed annually on January 23 to commemorate one of India's most notable liberation fighters, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose. Subhas Chandra Bose was born 128 years ago this year.
- Theme 2025 Netaji: Courage, Determination and Patriotism
- From creating and directing the Indian National Army to forming alliances against the British during World War II, Netaji was a pivotal role in laying the groundwork for the contemporary Indian state.
- Subhas Chandra Bose was born on January 23, 1897, in Cuttack, Odisha, as the ninth child of Janakinath Bose and Prabhavati Devi. Growing up, he was an excellent student who earned his BA in Philosophy from Presidency College in Calcutta (now Kolkata).





Important days :

- 27 December : International Day of Epidemic Preparedness
- 29 December : International Cello Day
- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 2 January : 67th Foundation Day of Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day
- 4 January : World Braille Day
- 5 January : National Bird Day (Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future)
- 6 January : World Day of War Orphans
- 6 January : Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) celebrated its 78th Foundation Day
- 8 January : Earth's Rotation Day
- 9 January : NRI or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- 10 January : World Hindi Day, also known as 'Vishwa Hindi Diwas' (Theme 2025: A Global Voice of Unity and Cultural Pride)
- 12 January : National Youth Day (Theme 2025: Youth for a Sustainable Future: Shaping the Nation with Resilience and Responsibility)
- 14 January : 9th Armed Forces Veterans' Day 2025 (Celebrates to Commemorates The retirement of Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa on January 14, 1953)
- 15 January : Indian Army Day (Theme 2025: Samarth Bharat, Saksham Sena (Capable India, Empowered Army))
- 16 January : National Startup Day
- 11 to 17 January : National Road Safety Week 2025
- January 18 to February 17 : National Road Safety Month 2025 (Theme 2025 Sadak Suraksha Jeevan Raksha)
- 20 January : National Penguin Awareness Day
- 21 January : Northeastern states of Manipur, Meghalaya, and Tripura celebrate Statehood Day



IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Flamingo Festival 2025 Held at Andhra Pradesh. It calls to protect the rich biodiversity of the region, specifically in Pulicat Lake and Nelapattu Bird Sanctuary.

JSW Group and Maharashtra government Signed MOU to invest Rs.3 lakh crore across various sectors in Maharashtra, including in the naxal-infested Gadchiroli. The commitment aligns with Maharashtra's 'Green Maharashtra' mission.

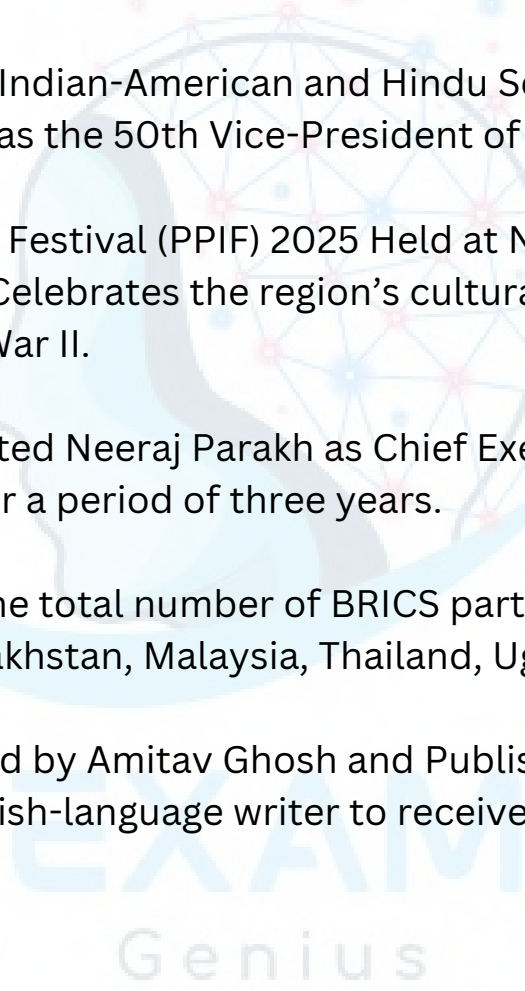
Ms. Usha, became the first Indian-American and Hindu Second Lady after her husband J.D. was sworn in as the 50th Vice-President of the U.S.

Pangsau Pass International Festival (PPIF) 2025 Held at Nampong, Arunachal Pradesh on 3rd week of January. It Celebrates the region's cultural heritage and its historical significance during World War II.

Reliance Power has appointed Neeraj Parakh as Chief Executive Officer. His appointment is effective for a period of three years.

Nigeria's inclusion brings the total number of BRICS partner countries to nine, joining Belarus, Bolivia, Cuba, Kazakhstan, Malaysia, Thailand, Uganda, and Uzbekistan.

Book Wild Fictions Authored by Amitav Ghosh and Published by Fourth Estate India. In 2019 he was the 1st English-language writer to receive the '54th Jnanpith Award'.





Ques : Which insurance company has launched 'Shubh Muhurat,' a life insurance solution designed to help families prepare financially for weddings ?

- (a) Kotak Mahindra Life Insurance
- (b) Tata AIA Life Insurance
- (c) Bajaj Allianz General Insurance
- (d) Bharti AXA General Insurance
- (e) Life Insurance Corporation of India

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Tata AIA Life Insurance has created 'Shubh Muhurat,' a life insurance solution aimed to assist families in financially preparing for weddings, which are a significant life milestone in India.
- The approach intends to handle escalating wedding costs through disciplined savings, wealth growth, and financial security.
- According to a Jefferies estimate, India's wedding market, the world's second largest, would hold over 80 lakh weddings in 2024, costing over Rs.10.7 lakh crore. The typical wedding costs Rs.12.5 lakh, which often exceeds education fees.
- Recognising this financial load, Tata AIA's new service is aimed at parents aged 31-50 with children aged 1-20, encouraging long-term financial preparation.





Ques : How long ago did the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) impose the restrictions on monthly and daily transfers?

- (a) 5 years ago
- (b) 10 years ago
- (c) 14 years ago
- (d) 20 years ago
- (e) 25 years ago

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Business correspondents (BCs), who process millions of crores of rupees daily in domestic remittances, have urged the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to ease the 14-year-old restrictions on monthly and daily transactions.
- They have asked the RBI to increase the monthly transfer limit to Rs.50,000 and decrease the need for two-factor authentication (2FA) to once a month, rather than every transaction.
- Effective November 1, 2024, new domestic money transfer (DMT) laws will restrict misuse of banking systems.

Limitations to Business Correspondent :

- Daily Transaction Limit : Rs.10000 per Customer per Day
- Monthly Transaction Limit : Rs.25000 per Customer per Month (Recently requested to be increased to Rs.50000)





Recent News Headlines Related to RBI

- RBI has updated instructions for settling dues owed by borrowers to Asset Reconstruction Companies (ARCs) under the Master Direction- Reserve Bank of India (Asset Reconstruction Companies), 2024.
- Skydo Technologies, a cross-border payments startup, has been granted in-principle authorization from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to function as a Payment Aggregator-Cross Border entity.
- The RBI has revealed the names of the members of the Standing External Advisory Committee (SEAC), which will evaluate applications for Universal Banks and Small Finance Banks. The SEAC's tenure will be three years.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has published the list of Non-Banking Finance Companies (NBFCs) in the Upper Layer (UL) category under Scale-Based Regulation (SBR) for FY24-25.
- RBI in cooperation with the government, has proposed amendments to the existing Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA) regulations to encourage cross-border transactions in the Indian rupee (INR) and local / national currencies.
- RBI has instructed banks and other regulated entities (REs) to use the '1600xx' phone numbering series exclusively for making transactional calls to customers.
- HSBC India, the Indian arm of London-based HSBC, has received approval from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to open 20 branches in 20 cities.
- The RBI will conduct daily Variable-Rate Repo (VRR) auctions until further notice. This measure will increase banking liquidity amid the deficit.
- The RBI has implemented new credit reporting rules. Lenders are now required to update credit bureau information every 15 days, rather than monthly. This directive went into force on January 1, 2025.
- The Reserve Bank Innovation Hub and IIMA Ventures have launched Swanari TechSprint 3.0, a program targeted at fostering women-centric financial firms in India.
- The RBI lifted the supervisory restrictions imposed on two non-banking financial companies (NBFCs) – Asirvad Micro Finance Limited and DMI Finance Private Limited.





Ques : Which bank has purchased a personal loan portfolio from Standard Chartered Bank in January 2025?

- (a) Federal Bank
- (b) Axis Bank
- (c) IndusInd Bank
- (d) HDFC Bank
- (e) Kotak Mahindra Bank

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Kotak Mahindra Bank (KMB) has agreed to buy a personal loan portfolio from Standard Chartered Bank for Rs 3,330 crore, which is less than the Rs 4,100 crore announced at the time of the transaction announcement in October 2024 due to many clients paying off loans in the meantime.
- Personal loans are part of the unsecured retail advances. Unsecured retail loans, including retail microcredit, were for 10.5 percent of KMB's net advances at the end of December 2024.

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Ques : Which Bank in partnership with RuPay, a global card payment network from India, has launched the UPI enabled RuPay Credit Card called – FIRST EARN ?

- (a) HDFC Bank
- (b) IDFC First Bank
- (c) South Indian Bank
- (d) RBL Bank
- (e) Yes Bank

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- IDFC FIRST Bank, in collaboration with RuPay, India's global card payment network, has launched the FIRST EARN RuPay Credit Card, which supports UPI.
- This credit card is backed by a fixed deposit, so anyone may apply for it online right away. It also provides cashback on UPI payments, making the product worthwhile for customers.
- This UPI-enabled virtual credit card is intended to make transactions more convenient and rewarding for cardholders.

About IDFC First Bank :

- Established : 2015
- HQ : Mumbai, Maharashtra
- MD & CEO : V. Vaidyanathan
- Tagline : Always You First

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Ques : Who has been reappointed as the Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer (MD & CEO) of IDBI Bank?

- (a) Amitabh Chaudhry
- (b) Rakesh Sharma
- (c) Sandeep Bakhshi
- (d) Uday Kotak
- (e) Shyam Srinivasan

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- IDBI Bank's Board of Directors has approved Rakesh Sharma's reappointment as Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer (MD & CEO) for three years, effective March 19, 2025.
- Sharma has led IDBI Bank since October 10, 2018. Before joining IDBI Bank, he was MD & CEO of Canara Bank from September 11, 2015, until his superannuation on July 31, 2018.

About IDBI Bank :

- Established : 1 July 1964
- HQ : Mumbai
- MD & CEO : Rakesh Sharma
- Tagline : Bank Aisa Dost Jaisa

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Ques : Which is the world's most valuable brand according to Global 500, 2025 report Published by Brand Finance ?

- (a) Apple
- (b) Google
- (c) Amazon
- (d) Microsoft
- (e) Walmart

Answer : option A

Explanation :

- Global 500 2025 report 19th Edition Published by Brand Finance.
- Apple remains the world's most valuable brand, worth USD 574.5 billion. Since 2021, Apple has remained the world's most valuable brand, with the exception of 2023.
- Tata Group (USD 28.6 billion) remains the most valuable Indian brand for the 15th consecutive year, ranking 60th in the list.
- WeChat (95.2) remains the world's strongest brand for the second year in a row, followed by Nike (94.7) and Google (94.3).
- India ranks second with 36% of the total brand value, while the US leads with 40% for IT services.
- The banking sector has the greatest number of brands on the lists (78) followed by retail (45) on 2nd and Media(24) on 3rd.

Ranking of Top 5 Globally Valuable Brands :

- 1 Apple (USA) USD 574.5
- 2 Microsoft (USA) USD 461.1
- 3 Google (USA) USD 413.0
- 4 Amazon (USA) USD 356.4
- 5 Walmart (USA) USD 137.2



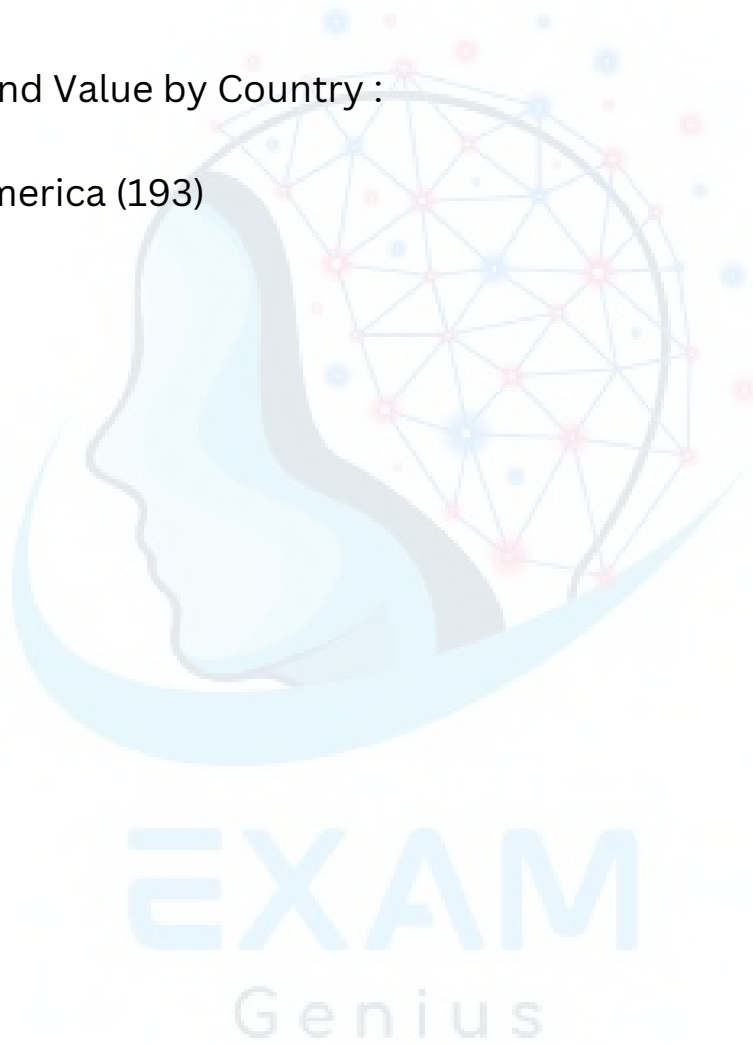


Ranking of Top 5 Valuable Indian Brands :

- 60 Tata Group USD 28.6
- 132 Infosys USD 16.3
- 164 HDFC Group USD 14.2
- 177 Life Insurance Corporation USD 13.3
- 237 Reliance Group USD 9.8

Ranking of Top 3 Brand Value by Country :

- 1 United States of America (193)
- 2 China (69)
- 3 Germany (27)
- 8 India (15)





India's Rankings in Different Indices

- World Future Skills Index 2025 Published by Quacquarelli Symonds (QS) : India (25th), USA (top)
- HSBC Hurun Global Indians List 2024 Published by Hurun : Satya Nadella, CEO of Microsoft (Top)
- Annual India Fintech Report 2024 Published by Tracxn Technologies Limited : India (3rd), United States of America (USA) (1st)
- Henley Passport Index 2025 Published by Henley : India (85th), Singapore (top)
- ThreatLandscape Report 2024 Published by CloudSEK : India (2nd), United States (top)
- Global Aging Index Published by National University of Singapore (NUS) & Columbia University : India (123rd), Switzerland (top)
- Hurun India Top 200 Self-Made Entrepreneurs of the Millennia 2024 Published by Hurun India & IDFC FIRST Private Banking : Kaivalya Vohra (Zepto) (Youngest), Ashok Soota (Happiest Minds Technologies) (Oldest)
- Travel and Tourism Development Index (TTDI) 2024 Published by World Economic Forum (WEF) : India (39th), United States (Top)
- 2025 QS Sustainability Rankings Published by QS Rankings : IIT Delhi (171), University of Toronto (Canada) (top)
- SBTi commitments by Indian companies Published by ICRA ESG Ratings Limited : India (6th), United Kingdom (UK) (top)
- "world's worst airlines" in the 2024 AirHelp Score survey : IndiGo (103rd), Brussels Airlines (top)
- Interdisciplinary Science Rankings (ISR) 2025 Published by Times Higher Education (THE) : Anna University in Chennai (Tamil Nadu, TN) (42nd), Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) (USA) (top)
- 2024 Network Readiness Index (NRI) Published by Portulans Institute and Saïd Business School : India (49th), United States of America (top)
- Sustainable Trade Index 2024 Published by Hinrich Foundation and IMD : India (23rd), New Zealand (top)
- Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) 2025 : India (10th), Denmark (last)





Ques : Which company has acquired the packaged foods brand SIL Food India?

- (a) ITC Limited
- (b) Tata Consumer Products
- (c) Nestle India
- (d) Reliance Consumer Products
- (e) Hindustan Unilever Limited

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Reliance Consumer Products has bought the packaged goods brand SIL Food India, which produces cooking pastes, jams, mayonnaise, baked beans, and Chinese sauces.
- SIL Food India, situated in Pune, largely serves the Western and Southern regions, whereas Reliance Consumer Products Ltd (RCPL) intends to increase its distribution countrywide to compete with FMCG companies such as HUL, Tata Consumer, and Cremica.
- Reliance Consumer aims to attain ₹10,000 crore in revenue, with acquisitions as part of its plan.
- Marico Industries first bought SIL Food India, formerly James Smith & Co, in 1993. Marico eventually sold the company to Scandic Food India, a division of Denmark's Good Food Group.
- Food Service India, a supplier of seasonings, spices, and condiments to the hospitality industry, will buy SIL Foods in 2021.

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Ques : Which major event is set to take place in New Delhi in 2025?

- a) New Delhi International Film Festival
- b) New Delhi World Trade Fair
- c) New Delhi World Book Fair
- d) International Literary Fest
- e) New Delhi Publishers' Summit

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The upcoming New Delhi World Book Fair 2025 will bring together readers, authors, and publishers.
- The event, scheduled for February 1-9, 2025, will take place in the Bharat Mandapam in Pragati Maidan.
- The event, organized by the National Book Trust (NBT) under the Ministry of Education and co-hosted by the Indian Trade Promotion Organization (ITPO), is a significant highlight in the global publishing calendar.
- This year's book fair focuses on 'Republic@75', commemorating the 75th anniversary of the Indian Constitution.
- The YUVA Corner will feature novels by 75 young authors selected under the Prime Minister's Mentoring Scheme for Young Authors.
- The National Institute of Design (NID) in Ahmedabad created the Theme Pavilion, which would be the highlight of the book show.
- Guest of Honour is France.





Ques : What is the rank of India in Global Firepower Index 2025 ?

- (a) 1st
- (b) 2nd
- (c) 3rd
- (d) 4th
- (e) 5th

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Global Firepower Index 2025 Started in 2006 Published by Globalfirepower.com
- According to the Global Firepower Index 2025, India is the world's fourth most powerful military, trailing only the US, Russia, and China.
- The Global Firepower Index assesses the military capabilities of 145 countries across land, sea, and air.
- India was ranked fourth with a score of 0.1184. A score of 0.0000 represents flawless military strength, which no government possesses.

About Global Firepower Index :

- The Global Firepower Index analyzes 145 countries' military power based on their war-making capabilities on land, sea, and air.
- It excludes a country's nuclear weapons capability and solely includes conventional military capabilities.
- The military strength of 145 countries is assessed using more than 60 characteristics, including personnel, natural resources, finance, and geography.





Ranking of top 5 & last countries in the Global Firepower Index 2025 :

- 1 United States of America
- 2 Russia
- 3 China
- 4 India
- 5 South Korea
- 145 Bhutan

Ranking of India and its neighboring countries :

- 3 China
- 12 Pakistan
- 35 Bangladesh
- 37 Myanmar
- 69 Sri Lanka
- 118 Afghanistan
- 126 Nepal



EXAM
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Ques : Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY) Launched in which year ?

- (a) 2012
- (b) 2014
- (c) 2015
- (d) 2017
- (e) 2019

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY), launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on January 22, 2015, has been providing financial security to India's girl children for ten years.
- Over 4.2 crore accounts would be opened by November 2024 under the SSY initiative, which started with a 9.1% interest rate and climbed to 9.2% in fiscal year 2015-2016.

About Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY) :

- Launched : January 22, 2015
- Eligibility : The girl child has to be below the age of 10 at the time of account opening
- Investment : Minimum value is Rs.250 and Maximum value is Rs.1.5 lakh per annum
- Tenure : 21 years from the date of opening, or until the girl child marries after the age of 18





Ques : Which international chess tournament will India host in 2025?

- a) World Rapid Chess Championship
- b) Chess Olympiad
- c) Chess Grand Prix
- d) Asian Chess Championship
- e) FIDE Chess World Cup

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- India will host the FIDE Chess World Cup 2025, its first big international tournament since the 2022 Chennai Chess Olympiad. This marks a significant milestone for the country.
- The FIDE Chess World Cup 2025 will take place from October 31 to November 27, 2025.
- This competition is significant due to its knockout style and participation from over 200 players worldwide.
- In 2023, R. Praggnanandhaa earned the silver medal following a tight loss to Magnus Carlsen in the final.
- Viswanathan Anand, one of India's most prominent chess players, is the only Indian to have won the FIDE World Championship.
- India last hosting the FIDE World Cup in 2002 in Hyderabad.

About FIDE :

- Established : 1924
- HQ : Lausanne, Switzerland
- President : Arkady Dvorkovich





Recent News headlines related to Sports

- Eritrea's Berhane Tesfay and Kenya's Joyce Chepkemai Tele won the men's and women's elite races, respectively, at the Mumbai Marathon 2025.
- Olympic champions Viktor Axelsen and An Se-young won the men's and women's singles titles, respectively, with lopsided victories in the India Open Super 750 badminton tournament in New Delhi.
- The inaugural Kho Kho World Cup in New Delhi concluded on a historic note, with India winning both the men's and women's titles in dramatic manner.
- Karnataka defeated Vidarbha by 36 runs in the Vijay Hazare Trophy (VHT) 2024-25 final at the Kotambi Stadium in Vadodara. This is Karnataka's fifth Vijay Hazare Trophy title win
- Novak Djokovic broke a tie with Roger Federer for the most Grand Slam matches in tennis history.
- Arjun Erigaisi, an Indian grandmaster, stunned the internet chess community by defeating World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen and World No. 2 Fabiano Caruana in Chess.com's Titled Tuesday weekly blitz competition.
- The International Cricket Council (ICC) has named Jasprit Bumrah of India and Annabel Sutherland of Australia as the ICC Men's and Women's Players of the Month for December 2024, respectively.
- The first Kho Kho World Cup kicked off on January 13, 2025, at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium in New Delhi. Sudhanshu Mittal, President of the Indian Kho Kho Federation, officially opened the World Cup.
- India and Mumbai batter Shreyas Iyer, the second-most expensive player in the player auction, has been appointed captain by Punjab Kings for IPL 2025. The 2024 IPL winning captain has previously led Delhi Capitals (DC) and Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) in the IPL.
- In squash, India's Anahat Singh won the Under 17 Girl's Singles title at the British Junior Open in Birmingham, England.
- Varun Tomar of the Indian Army has won the Men's 10-meter Air Pistol finals of the 67th National Shooting Championship 2024, which took place at Dr Karni Singh Shooting Range in New Delhi.





Ques : The Khelo India Winter Games (KIWG) 2025 were inaugurated amidst great enthusiasm at the iconic NDS Stadium in Leh, Ladakh, marking the commencement of which edition this year ?

- (a) 2nd
- (b) 3rd
- (c) 4th
- (d) 5th
- (e) 6th

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The fifth edition of the Khelo India Winter Games (KIWG) 2025 kicked off at the renowned NDS Stadium in Leh, Ladakh, with much excitement.
- The first part, hosted by the Union Territory of Ladakh, will take place from January 23 to January 27, 2025. The second phase, focused on snow games, will take place in the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir from February 22 to February 25, 2025.
- The KIWG 2025 kicked off with ice hockey matches at the NDS Stadium and Ladakh Scouts Regimental Centre.
- The Ladakh leg of the Games involves 594 participants, including 428 athletes.
- This is the second year running that Ladakh will host a portion of the Khelo India Winter Games (KIWG). Prior to the 2024 edition, Jammu & Kashmir hosted all the events.

About Khelo India Winter Games :

- Started : 2020
- 2024 held : Leh & Gulmarg





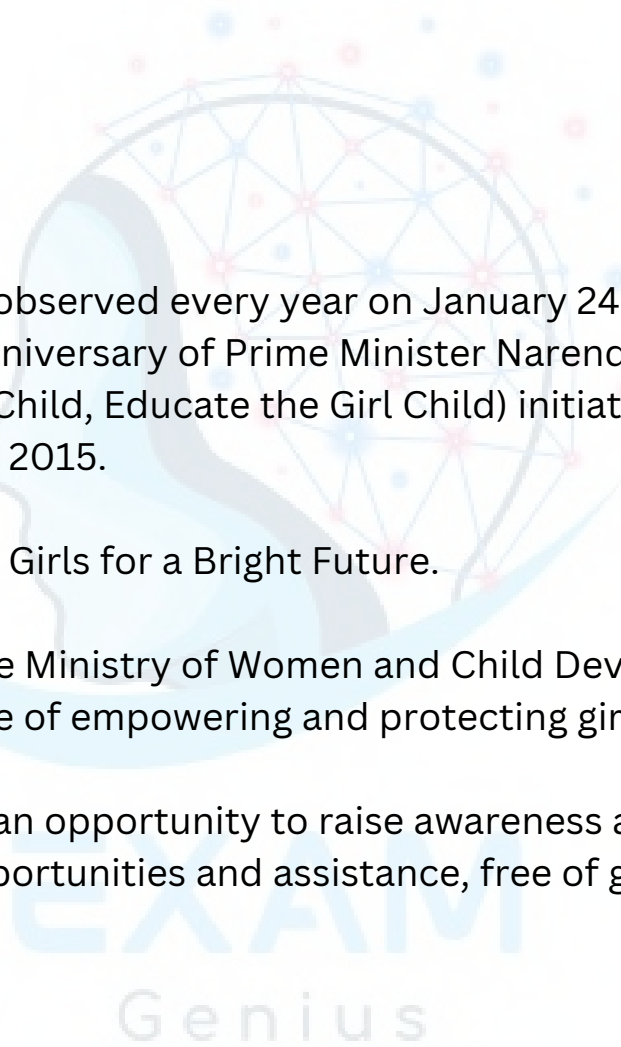
Ques : National Girl Child Day is celebrated every year on which day annually ?

- (a) 20 January
- (b) 21 January
- (c) 22 January
- (d) 23 January
- (e) 24 January

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- National Girl Child Day is observed every year on January 24. The day also commemorates the first anniversary of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao (Save the Girl Child, Educate the Girl Child) initiative, which was inaugurated on January 22, 2015.
- Theme 2025: Empowering Girls for a Bright Future.
- Established in 2008 by the Ministry of Women and Child Development, this day emphasizes the significance of empowering and protecting girl children.
- National Girl Child Day is an opportunity to raise awareness about girls' rights and ensure they have equal opportunities and assistance, free of gender biases.





Important days :

- 27 December : International Day of Epidemic Preparedness
- 29 December : International Cello Day
- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 2 January : 67th Foundation Day of Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day
- 4 January : World Braille Day
- 5 January : National Bird Day (Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future)
- 6 January : World Day of War Orphans
- 6 January : Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) celebrated its 78th Foundation Day
- 8 January : Earth's Rotation Day
- 9 January : NRI or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- 10 January : World Hindi Day, also known as 'Vishwa Hindi Diwas' (Theme 2025: A Global Voice of Unity and Cultural Pride)
- 12 January : National Youth Day (Theme 2025: Youth for a Sustainable Future: Shaping the Nation with Resilience and Responsibility)
- 14 January : 9th Armed Forces Veterans' Day 2025 (Celebrates to Commemorates The retirement of Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa on January 14, 1953)
- 15 January : Indian Army Day (Theme 2025: Samarth Bharat, Saksham Sena (Capable India, Empowered Army))
- 16 January : National Startup Day
- 11 to 17 January : National Road Safety Week 2025
- January 18 to February 17 : National Road Safety Month 2025 (Theme 2025 Sadak Suraksha Jeevan Raksha)
- 20 January : National Penguin Awareness Day
- 21 January : Northeastern states of Manipur, Meghalaya, and Tripura celebrate Statehood Day
- 23 January : Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Jayanti, also known as 'Parakram Diwas' or Courage Day
- 24 January : International Day of Education 2025 (Theme 2025 AI and Education: Preserving Human Agency in a World of Automation)





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Punjab & Sind Bank plans to raise Rs.2,000 crore through Qualified Institutional Placement (QIP) during the current quarter. Post-QIP, the government's stake in the bank is expected to decrease by 3-4%.

Quad foreign ministers meeting 9th Edition Held at Washington D.C, the United States of America by US Secretary of State Marco Rubio. Quad group consisting of India, Japan, Australia, and the United States of America.

India will host the 7th Quad Leader Summit meeting in 2025.

Micheal Martin Appointed as Republic of Ireland's prime minister for Second Term. The 64-year-old Martin previously served as prime minister from 2020 to 2022.

NTPC Limited and Ceylon Electricity Board of Sri Lanka signed MoU to develop a 50 Megawatt (MW) (extendable to 120 MW) solar project in Sampoor, Trincomalee, Sri Lanka.

NTPC Limited Established in 1975 and Headquartered in New Delhi. Gurdeep Singh is CMD of NTPC Limited.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which insurance company Tie-Up with CARS24 Financial Services for Life Insurance Distribution ?

- (a) HDFC Life Insurance
- (b) ICICI Prudential Life Insurance
- (c) LIC of India
- (d) SBI Life Insurance
- (e) Shriram Life Insurance

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- HDFC Life Insurance Company Limited has formed a corporate agency partnership with CARS24 Financial Services Private Limited, an NBFC registered with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI).
- This partnership will enable CARS24 Financial Services to offer HDFC Life products to current and new customers.
- This project will help achieve the objective of 'Insurance for All by 2047.'
- INSURE24, a significant milestone for CARS24, is poised to transform the digital insurance landscape for India's rapidly expanding online consumer base.

About HDFC Life Insurance Company Limited :

- Established : 2000
- HQ : Mumbai
- MD & CEO : Vibha Padalkar





Recently signed banking agreements

- Bajaj Finance has partnered with Bharti Airtel to develop a digital platform for financial services.
- The Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND) has signed an MoU with National Housing Bank (NHB) to engage in crucial areas such as intelligence sharing, capacity building, and risk assessment.
- PNB MetLife India Insurance Company Ltd (PNB MetLife) has entered into a strategic bancassurance agreement with Saraswat Co-operative Bank Ltd, one of India's leading urban co-operative banks.
- The state-owned PFC has signed an agreement with the Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC) for a credit facility of 120 billion Japanese yen (about Rs 6,600 crore)
- NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL) has teamed with Magnati, a UAE-based payment solution provider, to promote QR-based Unified Payments Interface (UPI) merchant payments using point-of-sale (POS) terminals across the Middle East.
- Suryoday Small Finance Bank (SSFB) has partnered with Tata Digital to expand its FD products.
- PhonePe has partnered with ICICI Lombard General Insurance to provide insurance coverage for travelers visiting the Maha Kumbh Mela.
- Financial Intelligence Unit-India (FIU-IND) and the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) have signed a MoU for sharing of intelligence and information to check money laundering.
- The National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC) has teamed with pollster Axis My India to help bridge India's skills gaps and satisfy the predicted demand for millions of jobs in developed economies over the next five years.
- Bajaj brokerage, the brokerage arm of Bajaj Finance Ltd., has teamed up with Tamilnad Mercantile Bank (TMB) to launch a comprehensive 3-in-1 account solution that combines banking, broking, and investing services on a single platform
- The Assam government has inked a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with SBI and UBI to provide insurance coverage to state government employees.





Ques : Which bank has become the first Indian bank to implement Clari5's National Cybercrime Reporting Portal (NCRP) ?

- (a) South Indian Bank
- (b) Axis Bank
- (c) Indian Bank
- (d) Punjab National Bank
- (e) Karur Vyasya Bank

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Punjab National Bank (PNB) is the first Indian bank to use Clari5's National Cybercrime Reporting Portal (NCRP) Integration Solution, advancing fraud prevention and complaint handling.
- This cutting-edge system was created in partnership with the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C).
- The system offers configurable whitelisting to shield legitimate consumer transactions from fraud protection efforts.

About Punjab National Bank :

- Established : 19 May 1894
- HQ : New Delhi
- MD & CEO : Ashok Chandra
- Tagline : The Name You Can Bank Upon

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which insurance company Partners with Truhome Finance to Offer Group Credit Life Insurance ?

- (a) Bajaj Allianz General Insurance
- (b) ICICI Prudential Life Insurance
- (c) Kotak Mahindra Life Insurance
- (d) TATA AIG General Insurance Company
- (e) PNB MetLife India Insurance

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- PNB MetLife India Insurance Company Limited (PNB MetLife) has teamed with Chennai-based Truhome Finance (previously Shriram Housing Finance Limited) to provide Group Credit Life insurance to their home loan customers.
- This collaboration helps achieve the objective of 'Insurance for All by 2047' by making financial security more accessible to individuals and families.

About PNB MetLife :

- Established : 2001
- HQ : Mumbai
- MD & CEO : Sameer Bansal

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which organization cancelled the registration of X10 Financial Services Ltd?

- (a) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- (b) State Bank of India (SBI)
- (c) NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)
- (d) Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)
- (e) National Housing Bank (NHB)

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- RBI has terminated the registration of X10 Financial Services Ltd, a non-banking financial company (NBFC), citing irregularities in its digital lending operations.
- The Certificate of Registration (CoR) was cancelled because the company violated the code of conduct guidelines for outsourcing financial services in its digital lending operations by outsourcing core decision-making functions such as credit appraisal, rate fixing, and Know Your Customer verification to the Service Provider (SP) and failing to conduct due diligence on the SPs.
- The CoR was granted to X10 Financial Services Ltd, formerly known as Abhishek Securities Ltd, in June 2015.

EXAM
Genius





Recent Penalties imposed on Banks by RBI :

- IndusInd Bank Limited was fined Rs.27.30 lakh by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for not following the 'Reserve Bank of India (Interest Rate on Deposits) Directions, 2016'.
- The Reserve Bank of India issued a monetary penalty of Rs.5 lakh on The Panchkula Central Co-operative Bank Limited, Haryana.
- Penalty of Rs 59.20 lakh Imposed on South Indian Bank by RBI Due to non-compliance with directives on interest rate on deposits and customer service standards.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) issued a penalty of Rs 28.30 lakh on SG Finserve Limited (previously Moongipa Securities).
- Arunachal Pradesh Rural Bank received a Rs 14 lakh penalty for failing to comply with Prudential Norms (Provisioning, Asset Classification, and Exposure Limit).
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) imposed a monetary penalty of Rs.61.60 lakh on The Surat People's Co-operative Bank Limited, Surat, for non-compliance with certain directions issued by RBI.
- The RBI imposed a monetary penalty of Rs.1.50 lakh on The Bihar Awami Co-operative Bank Ltd., Patna for violating section 26A and section 56 of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949 (BR Act) and failing to comply with RBI's 'Know Your Customer (KYC)' directions.
- Penalty on Hewlett Packard Financial Services (India) Private Limited is Amount to Rs.10.4 lakh and on Muthoot Vehicle & Asset Finance Limited is Amount to Rs.7.9 lakh
- The Reserve Bank of India has imposed a penalty of Rs 31.8 lakh on BNP Paribas for failing to comply with specific RBI guidelines on 'Interest Rate on Advances'.
- The RBI levied a monetary penalty of Rs.1.91 crore on Axis Bank Limited and Rs.1 crore on HDFC Bank Limited for non-compliance with certain directions issued by RBI.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has imposed a monetary penalty of Rs.2.68 crore on UCO Bank.





Ques : SBI Payments is a joint venture between the State Bank of India and which other entity?

- (a) Visa
- (b) Hitachi Payment Services
- (c) Mastercard
- (d) Amazon Pay
- (e) BharatPe

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- SBI Payments has teamed with Pine Labs to improve India's digital payments ecosystem, combining the expertise of SBI Payments, a joint venture between the State Bank of India and Hitachi Payment Services, and Pine Labs.
- The alliance, which already powers over 200,000 digital checkout terminals in India, aims to expedite the nationwide adoption of digital payments and commerce solutions.
- MD & CEO of SBI Payments : Sujay Kumar Yadav

EXAM
Genius





Ques : What is the primary goal of the collaboration between NITI Aayog and NASSCOM Foundation?

- (a) Boosting employment in the IT sector
- (b) Enhancing access to higher education
- (c) Reducing the digital divide
- (d) Promoting entrepreneurship among youth
- (e) Establishing digital infrastructure in rural areas

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- National Institution for Transforming India (NITI Aayog) and the National Association of Software and Service Companies (NASSCOM) Foundation Signed MoU to provide digital skills to one lakh individuals with an aim to reduce the issue of digital divide.
- It Comes under Aspirational Blocks Programme(ABP), and is aligned with the Pradhan Mantri Gramin Digital Saksharta Abhiyaan (PMGDISHA).
- It will initially target 60 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) blocks in its first phase
- The program focuses on training individuals between 12- 60 years in essential computer skills, cybersecurity, and internet usage

About NASSCOM :

- Established : 1 March 1988
- HQ : New Delhi
- Chairman : Sindhu Gangadharan
- President : Rajesh Nambiar

About NITI Aayog :

- Established : 1 January 2015
- HQ : New Delhi
- Chairman : Narendra Modi
- CEO : B V R Subrahmanyam





Recent News Headlines Related to MoU and agreement :

- NTPC Limited and Ceylon Electricity Board of Sri Lanka signed MoU to develop a 50 Megawatt (MW) (extendable to 120 MW) solar project in Sampoor, Trincomalee, Sri Lanka.
- JSW Group and Maharashtra government Signed MOU to invest Rs.3 lakh crore across various sectors in Maharashtra, including in the naxal-infested Gadchiroli. The commitment aligns with Maharashtra's 'Green Maharashtra' mission.
- DPIIT and Apna platform have formed an alliance to conduct a talent search to provide DPIIT-registered startups with highly skilled personnel, thereby creating new job opportunities for unemployed youth.
- The Government of Odisha's Electronics and IT Department and Singapore's Global Finance & Technology Network (GFTN) have signed a MOU to establish a Global Competency Centre in Bhubaneswar to foster FinTech collaboration, with a focus on developing inclusive and sustainable InsureTech and related areas.
- International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON) and the Adani Group Collaborate to ensure that nearly one lakh people are provided with nutritious meals daily during the 45-day spiritual gathering at Maha Kumbh Mela. ISKCON has set up a large-scale kitchen at Harshvardhan Marg.
- Russian President Vladimir Putin and Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian signed a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership Treaty for 20 years at Moscow. The agreement seeks to enhance trade and economic ties, with bilateral trade having risen by 15.5% to \$3.77 billion between January and October 2024
- Government of Uttarakhand and Icelandic company Verkis Consulting Engineers (Verkis) signed an MOU for geothermal exploration and development in Uttarakhand. Under the agreement, feasibility studies for these projects will be funded by the Government of Iceland
- Amazon has inked a deal to acquire fintech loan start-up Axio, formerly Capital Float, for around \$190-200 million.
- Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) and ITC Limited signed MOU to accelerate startup growth and technological advancement besides creation of viable market opportunities for startups across the country.
- India and Spain have signed two MOU to promote and expand their bilateral relations. These agreements prioritized sports collaboration and sustainable urban development. both countries agreed to mark 2026 as the "Year of Culture, Tourism, and Artificial Intelligence (AI)"





Ques : Which organization has signed an MoU with the Bhaane Group?

- (a) Department of Higher Education
- (b) Department of Official Language
- (c) Department of Fertilizers
- (d) Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade
- (e) Department of Consumer Affairs

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) with the Bhaane Group, a subsidiary of Shahi Exports Pvt Ltd, the largest garment producer.
- This alliance will develop incubation programs for manufacturing and other production-related firms, as well as foster relationships with foreign startup ecosystems.
- The private firm will help new entrepreneurs by giving market knowledge. The firm will help them develop a comprehensive understanding of how overseas markets work, as well as operational knowledge throughout the startup lifecycle.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : The Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (BBBP) scheme has completed how many years ?

- (a) 6
- (b) 8
- (c) 10
- (d) 12
- (e) 14

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The Government of India (GoI) has successfully implemented the Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (BBBP) project, which aims to protect, educate, and empower girls in India, for the past decade.
- The GoI plans to commemorate the 10th anniversary of BBBP from January 22 to March 8, 2025, culminating on International Women's Day.
- The BBBP is now merged with Mission Shakti, a women's safety and empowerment program, to be implemented throughout the 15th Finance Commission (FC) period from 2021-22 to 2025-26.

About Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (BBBP) scheme :

- Launched : January 22, 2015
- Launched : Panipat, Haryana
- Objective : address the declining Child Sex Ratio (CSR), prevent gender-biased sex-selective elimination and promote the survival, protection and education of the girl child
- Implemented by : Ministry of Women and Child Development with Ministry of Health & Family Welfare and Ministry of Education
- 100% funding by the Central Government





Recent News Headlines Related to Schemes

- The Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY), launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on January 22, 2015, has been providing financial security to India's girl children for ten years.
- Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai has launched the 'Deendayal Upadhyay Bhoomiheen Krishi Majdoor Kalyana Yojana' in Raipur. Under this initiative, more than 5.62 lakh landless agricultural workers, Baigas, and Gunias in the state will receive Rs 10,000 each year.
- PARTH Yojana (Police Army Recruitment Training & Hunar) Launched by Madhya Pradesh To prepare youth for recruitment into Indian Army, Police, ParaMilitary forces, and related services.
- Mohan Charan Majhi, Chief Minister of Odisha announced Shahid Madho Singh Haath Kharcha Scheme with a budget of Rs 156 crore to support tribal students. Its aims is to reduce dropout rates and increase students' interest in education.
- PLI scheme for Specialty Steel, termed as PLI Scheme 1.1 Launched by Union Minister of Steel and Heavy Industries, Shri H. D. Kumaraswamy at Vigyan Bhavan New Delhi. It is launched for the Period of FY 2025-26 to FY 2029-30.
- The Mira Bhayandar Municipal Corporation (MBMC) has developed a flagship initiative named 'Faral Sakhi' to encourage women entrepreneurs in the city of Mira Bhayandar, Maharashtra.
- The Union Cabinet, led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, has approved the extension of the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana and Restructured Weather Based Crop Insurance Scheme until 2025-26, with a total budget of Rs.69,515.71 crore from 2021-22 to 2025-26.
- The Income Tax Department has extended the deadline for the Vivad Se Vishwas Scheme 2024, offering taxpayers another chance to resolve disputes at lower tax rates. The extended new date is January 31, 2025.
- The Haryana government has agreed to enhance the maximum amount of Death-cum-Retirement Gratuity for state government employees by 25%.
- Government of India(GoI) sanctioned Rs. 4388 crore under the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Urja Suraksha evam Utthaan Mahabhiyan (PM-KUSUM) Scheme to solarize agriculture for states across India.
- Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) chief Arvind Kejriwal has launched a new scholarship programme aimed at Dalit students in Delhi. The scheme, named the Dr Ambedkar Samman Scholarship, will cover all expenses for Dalit students wishing to pursue higher education abroad.
- Delhi Chief Minister Atishi has introduced the Mukhyamantri Mahila Samman Yojana, which would pay a monthly stipend of Rs 1,000 to women residents with annual household incomes of up to Rs 3 lakh



Ques : On the eve of Republic Day 2025, President Droupadi Murmu approved gallantry awards for how many personnel from the Armed Forces and Central Armed Police Forces ?

- (a) 74
- (b) 78
- (c) 83
- (d) 88
- (e) 93

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- On Republic Day 2025, President Droupadi Murmu awarded heroism medals for 93 Armed Forces and Central Armed Police Force troops.
- Honors include two Kirti Chakras, 14 Shaurya Chakras, one Bar to Sena Medal (Gallantry), 66 Sena Medals, two Nao Sena Medals, and eight Vayu Sena Medals.

Kirti Chakra :

- Major Manjit
- Naik Dilwar Khan

Shaurya Chakra Recipients :

- Major Ashish Dahiya
- Major Kunal
- Major Satender Dhankar
- Captain Deepak Singh
- Assistant Commandant Eshenthung Kikon
- Subedar Vikas Tomar
- Subedar Mohan Ram



- Havildar Rohit Kumar
- Havildar Prakash Tamang
- Flight Lieutenant Aman Singh Hans
- Corporal Dabhi Sanjay Hiffabai Essa
- Vijayan Kutty G
- Vikrant Kumar
- Jeffrey Hmingchullo

Bar to Sena Medal (Gallantry) :

- Lieutenant Colonel KH Shem

Nao Sena Medal (Gallantry) :

- Lieutenant Commander Sourabh Malik
- Lieutenant Commander Satyam Singh

Vayu Sena Medal (Gallantry) :

- Group Captain Ankit Raj Singh
- Wing Commander Akshay Saxena
- Wing Commander Ankit Sood
- Wing Commander Dushyant Singh Rathore
- Wing Commander Jude Joseph Pereira
- Squadron Leader Prathamesh D Dongre
- Flight Lieutenant Tarun Nair
- Corporal Vikky Pahade





Ques : National Mission on Edible Oils-Oilseeds (NMEO-Oilseeds) Launched in which year ?

- (a) 2021
- (b) 2022
- (c) 2023
- (d) 2024
- (e) 2025

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare (MoA&FW) has launched the first edible oil consumption survey on the "My Gov" site to examine consumption patterns in India.
- This project intends to effectively implement the National Mission on Edible Oils-Oilseeds (NMEO-Oilseeds).
- The 45-day questionnaire-based survey, begun on January 9, 2025, will run until February 23, 2025.
- India currently imports 55-60% of its edible oil from nations like Indonesia, Malaysia, Argentina, Brazil, Russia, and Ukraine.
- In the 2023-24 marketing year, India imported around 15.96 million tonnes of edible oil (MT).

About National Mission on Edible Oils-Oilseeds (NMEO-Oilseeds) :

- Launched : October 2024
- Launched by : Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare (DA&FW)
- Period : Seven years, from 2024-25 to 2030-31
- Outlay : Rs.10,103 crores
- Objective : to increase primary oilseed production from 39 MT (2022-23) to 69.7 MT by 2030-31





Ques : Who flagged-off 'SANJAY – The Battlefield Surveillance System (BSS)' from South Block, New Delhi ?

- (a) Amit Shah
- (b) Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya
- (c) Rajnath Singh
- (d) Piyush Goyal
- (e) Nitin Gadkari

Answer : Option C

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh launched 'SANJAY - The Battlefield Surveillance System (BSS)' from South Block in New Delhi.
- SANJAY is an automated system that integrates inputs from all ground and aerial battlefield sensors, processes them to confirm their veracity, prevents duplication, and fuses them to create a Common Surveillance Picture of the battlefield via a secure Army Data Network and Satellite Communication Network.
- SANJAY was developed indigenously and cooperatively by the Indian Army and Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL), resulting in a suitable ecology for achieving 'Aatmanirbharta' as a follow-up to the Indian Army's 'Year of Technology Absorption'.
- These systems will be incorporated into all operational Brigades, Divisions, and Corps of the Indian Army in three phases between March and October 2025, which has been designated as the 'Year of Reforms' by the Ministry of Defence. This system was designed for the Buy (Indian) category at a cost of Rs 2,402 crore.





Recent News Headlines related to Defence

- M/s L&T Shipyard's second Multi-Purpose Vessel (MPV) for the Indian Navy was launched at its Kattupalli, Chennai, facility. The vessel, named 'Utkarsh'.
- The indigenously built micro missile system Bhargavastra was successfully tested at the Gopalpur Seaward firing range in Odisha.
- The Ministry of Defence (MoD) has inked a Rs. 2,960 crore contract with Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL) to provide Medium-Range Surface-to-Air Missiles (MRSAM) to the Indian Navy.
- On Indian Army Day, Prime Minister Narendra Modi dedicated three frontline naval combatants to the nation: INS Surat, INS Nilgiri, and INS Vaghsheer, which were commissioned at the Naval Dockyard in Mumbai, Maharashtra.
- India successfully evaluated its indigenously built third-generation Anti-Tank Fire-and-Forget Guided Missile (Nag Mk 2) at Rajasthan's Pokhran Field Firing Range.
- Blue Origin's New Glenn rocket will launch at 1 a.m. ET Monday from the Cape Canaveral Space Force Station in Florida.
- Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) successfully launched two indigenously designed Fast Patrol Vessels (FPVs) for the Indian Coast Guard.
- India and the US have partnered to co-produce US sonobuoys for the Indian Navy's underwater domain awareness (UDA).
- People's Liberation Army Navy (PLAN) officially launched its latest amphibious assault ship (AAS) from Shanghai, named 'Sichuan' after a province in southwestern China.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which state inaugurated India's first fully integrated disaster warning system KaWaCHaM (Kerala Warnings, a Crisis and Hazard Management System) ?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) Telangana

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan has launched India's first fully integrated disaster warning system, KaWaCHaM (Kerala Warnings, Crisis and Hazard Management System).
- The KaWaCHaM system was developed as part of the National Cyclone Risk Mitigation Project.
- The KaWaCHaM system is regarded as one of the fastest weather alarm systems in the world, and it will aid rescue and rehabilitation operations during extreme weather events caused by climate change.
- The KaWaCHaM system was created by the Kerala State Disaster Management Authority (KSDMA) with funding from the National Disaster Management Authority, the Indian government, and the World Bank. It's part of the National Cyclone Risk Mitigation Project.





Ques : For the year 2025, the President has approved conferment of how many Padma Awards ?

- (a) 124
- (b) 128
- (c) 134
- (d) 139
- (e) 142

Answer : Option D

- The Padma Awards are India's highest civilian honors, announced annually on the eve of Republic Day.
- The Padma awards, the country's highest civilian honors, are divided into three categories: Padma Shri, Padma Bhushan, and Padma Vibhushan.
- The President has approved the conferment of 139 Padma Awards for 2025, including one dual instance (each award counts as one). See the list below.
- The list includes 7 Padma Vibhushan, 19 Padma Bhushan, and 113 Padma Shri Awards.
- The list includes 23 female honorees, 10 foreigners/NRI/PIO/OCI, and 13 posthumous awardees.

Padma Vibhushan (7) :

- Shri Duvvur Nageshwar Reddy (Medicine) Telangana
- Justice (Retd.) Shri Jagdish Singh Khehar (Public Affairs) Chandigarh
- Smt. Kumudini Rajnikant Lakhia (Art) Gujarat
- Shri Lakshminarayana Subramaniam (Art) Karnataka
- Shri M. T. Vasudevan Nair (Posthumous) (Literature and Education) Kerala
- Shri Osamu Suzuki (Posthumous) (Trade and Industry) Japan
- Smt. Sharda Sinha (Posthumous) (Art) Bihar



Padma Bhushan (19) :

- Shri A Surya Prakash (Literature and Education Journalism) Karnataka
- Shri Anant Nag (Art) Karnataka
- Shri Bibek Debroy (Posthumous) (Literature and Education) NCT Delhi
- Shri Jatin Goswami (Art) Assam
- Shri Jose Chacko Periappuram (Medicine) Kerala
- Shri Kailash Nath Dikshit (Others-Archaeology) NCT Delhi
- Shri Manohar Joshi (Posthumous) (Public Affairs) Maharashtra
- Shri Nalli Kuppuswami Chetti (Trade and Industry) Tamil Nadu
- Shri Nandamuri Balakrishna (Art) Andhra Pradesh
- Shri P R Sreejesh (Sports) Kerala
- Shri Pankaj Patel (Trade and Industry) Gujarat
- Shri Pankaj Udhas (Posthumous) (Art) Maharashtra
- Shri Rambahadur Rai (Literature and Education Journalism) Uttar Pradesh
- Sadhvi Ritambhara (Social Work) Uttar Pradesh
- Shri S Ajith Kumar (Art) Tamil Nadu
- Shri Shekhar Kapur (Art) Maharashtra
- Ms. Shobana Chandrakumar (Art) Tamil Nadu
- Shri Sushil Kumar Modi (Posthumous) (Public Affairs) Bihar
- Shri Vinod Dham (Science and Engineering) USA

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Yala Glacier is Set to Vanish by 2040s Due to Climate Change. It is in which country ?

- (a) Sri Lanka
- (b) Nepal
- (c) Bhutan
- (d) Bangladesh
- (e) None of these

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Yala Glacier in Nepal's Langtang National Park has been a focus of glaciological research due to its considerable retreat in recent decades.
- Recent assessments suggest that this glacier could disappear by the 2040s, highlighting the significant influence of climate change on the Himalayan cryosphere.
- Between 1974 and 2021, Yala Glacier receded by 680 meters, resulting in a 36% drop in area.
- Yala Glacier is the only Himalayan glacier listed on the Global Glacier Casualty List, indicating its critical status. This list was launched in 2024.

About Nepal :

- Capital : Kathmandu
- Currency : Nepalese rupee
- President : Ram Chandra Paudel
- Prime minister : KP Sharma Oli





Ques : National Tourism Day is celebrated annually on which day ?

- (a) 22 January
- (b) 23 January
- (c) 24 January
- (d) 25 January
- (e) 26 January

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- National Tourism Day is observed annually on January 25 to highlight the importance of tourism in India and its potential as a vital economic driver.
- The day's goal is to boost tourism in India, create knowledge of the country's varied culture, tradition, and natural beauty, and promote responsible and sustainable tourist practices.
- Theme 2025: Tourism for Inclusive Growth.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : International Customs Day is observed annually on which day ?

- (a) 22 January
- (b) 23 January
- (c) 24 January
- (d) 25 January
- (e) 26 January

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- International Customs Day is commemorated annually on 26th January to recognize the contribution of customs personnel and agencies in the global commerce system.
- Theme 2025: Customs Delivers on its Commitment to Efficiency, Security, and Prosperity.
- International Customs Day originated with the creation of the Customs Cooperation Council (CCC), today known as the World Customs Organisation (WCO).
- The CCC was created in 1952 as an intergovernmental organization to promote the efficiency of customs administrations worldwide.

EXAM
Genius





Important days :

- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 2 January : 67th Foundation Day of Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day
- 4 January : World Braille Day
- 5 January : National Bird Day (Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future)
- 6 January : World Day of War Orphans
- 6 January : Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) celebrated its 78th Foundation Day
- 8 January : Earth's Rotation Day
- 9 January : NRI or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- 10 January : World Hindi Day, also known as 'Vishwa Hindi Diwas' (Theme 2025: A Global Voice of Unity and Cultural Pride)
- 12 January : National Youth Day (Theme 2025: Youth for a Sustainable Future: Shaping the Nation with Resilience and Responsibility)
- 14 January : 9th Armed Forces Veterans' Day 2025 (Celebrates to Commemorates The retirement of Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa on January 14, 1953)
- 15 January : Indian Army Day (Theme 2025: Samarth Bharat, Saksham Sena (Capable India, Empowered Army))
- 16 January : National Startup Day
- 11 to 17 January : National Road Safety Week 2025
- January 18 to February 17 : National Road Safety Month 2025 (Theme 2025 Sadak Suraksha Jeevan Raksha)
- 20 January : National Penguin Awareness Day
- 21 January : Northeastern states of Manipur, Meghalaya, and Tripura celebrate Statehood Day
- 23 January : Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Jayanti, also known as 'Parakram Diwas' or Courage Day
- 24 January : International Day of Education 2025 (Theme 2025 AI and Education: Preserving Human Agency in a World of Automation)
- 24 January : National Girl Child Day (Theme 2025: Empowering Girls for a Bright Future)
- 25 January : National Voters' Day 2025 (Theme 2025 Nothing Like Voting, I Vote for Sure)
- 26 January : 76th Republic Day 2025 (Theme 2025 "Swarnim Bharat: Virasat aur Vikas" (Golden India: Heritage and Development))



IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Former Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) secretary and current International Cricket Council (ICC) chairman Jay Shah Appointed as Board member of the Marylebone Cricket Club (MCC) Advisory Board

Hitachi Payment Services has teamed with IvyCamp, IvyCap Ventures' worldwide alumni-based engagement effort, to drive fintech innovation through the Hitachi Payments Accelerator (HPX) program.

Bollywood actor Ayushmann Khurrana Appointed as Brand ambassador for this year's edition of FICCI Frames

The 25th anniversary edition of FICCI Frames will focus on the theme of “RISE: Redefining Innovation, Sustainability and Excellence”

Former Australian cricket captain Michael Clarke has been inducted into the prestigious Australian Cricket Hall of Fame, becoming the 64th cricketer to receive this remarkable honor.

Jitender Pal Singh Appointed as Ambassador to Israel of India. He Replaced Sanjeev Kumar Singla.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which bank has appointed P. Suriaraj as its Executive Director?

- (a) HDFC Bank
- (b) IDFC First Bank
- (c) Dhanlaxmi Bank
- (d) RBL Bank
- (e) Yes Bank

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Suriaraj has taken over as Executive Director of the Dhanlaxmi Bank. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) nominated him as the bank's executive director for three years.
- Mr. Suriaraj is a seasoned banker with 37 years of experience at Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Ltd.
- He has served as the General Manager of several departments, including integrated treasury, HR, recovery, establishment, planning and resource mobilization, operation and services, inspection, and accounts

EXAM
Genius





Recent Appointment in Banking & Insurance Sector :

- Rakesh Sharma : Reappointment as MD and CEO of IDBI Bank
- Alok Kumar Agarwal : Managing Director and CEO of Zurich Kotak General Insurance
- Binod Kumar : MD and CEO of Indian Bank
- Ashok Chandra : MD and CEO of Punjab National Bank (PNB)
- Ankur Jhaveri : MD and CEO of Institutional Equities at JM Financial Institutional Securities
- Ambarish Kenghe : CEO of Angel One
- Baldev Prakash : deputy managing director and group chief risk officer of State Bank of India
- Amit Ganorkar : Managing Director(MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of TATA AIG General Insurance Company (Replaced Neelesh Garg)
- Jatinder Pal Singh : CEO of ITI Asset Management (ITI AML) (succeeding Hitesh Thakkar)
- Rajat Verma : CEO of DBS Bank India (succeeding Surojit Shome)
- Anup Kumar Sinha : Reappointment as Bandhan Bank's non-executive chairman
- Amitava Chatterjee : Managing director (MD) and CEO J&K Bank
- Alok Aggarwal : Managing Director and CEO of Brookfield India Real Estate Trust
- R Subramaniakumar : MD & CEO of RBL Bank
- Ram Mohan Rao Amara : Managing Director of State Bank of India (SBI)
- George Heber Joseph : Chief investment officer (CIO) of the newly- incorporated joint venture firm Jio BlackRock Asset Management Company (AMC)
- Manish Jain : Executive Director of YES Bank

EXAM
Genius





Ques : According to the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) Payments System Report, what percentage of India's total payment volume was captured by UPI by the end of 2024?

- a) 50%
- b) 67%
- c) 34%
- d) 90%
- e) 83%

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- According to the Reserve Bank of India's Payments System Report, the United Payments Interface (UPI) would account for 83% of total payment volume by 2024, up from 34% in 2019.
- UPI transaction volume increased from 375 crore in 2018 to 17,221 crore by 2024, bringing the total digital payments volume to 20,787 crore transactions.
- UPI transaction value increased from Rs. 5.86 lakh crore (US\$ 67.71 billion) in 2018 to Rs. 246.83 lakh crore (US\$ 2,852 billion) in 2024, with a compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of 89.3% in volume and 86.5% in value over five years.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) stated in its Annual Report on Ombudsman Scheme that integrated Ombudsman Scheme saw a jump of _ on year in complaints from banking customers.

- (a) 32.81%
- (b) 23.41%
- (c) 32.60%
- (d) 35.45%
- (e) 26.72%

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- According to the Reserve Bank of India's Annual Report on Ombudsman Scheme, the integrated Ombudsman Scheme received 32.81% more complaints from banking customers in FY2024, totaling 9.34 lakh.
- Complaints were filed with 24 RBI Ombudsman offices and Centralised Receipt and Processing Centre (CRPC).
- The plan received 85,281 complaints (29.01%) about loans and advances, a 42.70% rise from last year.
- Regionally, Chandigarh, the National Capital Territory of Delhi, Rajasthan, Gujarat, and Uttarakhand ranked first through fifth in terms of complaints received at ORBIOs per lakh accounts.
- Mizoram, Nagaland, Ladakh, Manipur, and Lakshadweep recorded the fewest complaints in FY24.





Ques : What is the target set by the Government of India for Geographical Indication (GI) tags by 2030?

- (a) 5000
- (b) 8000
- (c) 10000
- (d) 12000
- (e) 14000

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Union Minister of Commerce & Industry, Shri Piyush Goyal, set an objective of achieving 10,000 Geographical Indication (GI) Tags by 2030.
- The statement was made at the GI Samagam in New Delhi, organized by DPIIT in cooperation with India Today Group.
- The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) has given GI tags to 605 Indian products as of now.
- The GI Samagam's subject was "Preserving Heritage, Fostering Innovation," with the goal of connecting culture, business, and innovation.
- Darjeeling tea was the first product to receive a GI in 2003. The geographical indication registration is valid for ten years. It can be renewed for 10 years at a time.





Ques : Which Indian cricketer became the highest wicket-taker in T20 internationals for India?

- (a) Jasprit Bumrah
- (b) Bhuvneshwar Kumar
- (c) Arshdeep Singh
- (d) Ravichandran Ashwin
- (e) Kuldeep Yadav

Answer : Option C

- Arshdeep Singh, India's left-arm pacer, was the main wicket-taker during the team's great performance in the 2024 ICC T20 World Cup, and he recently became the country's highest wicket-taker in T20 internationals.
- The ICC Men's T20I Team of the Year 2024 was captained by Rohit Sharma, and Arshdeep Singh was named the ICC Men's T20I Cricketer of the Year 2024.
- The ICC Men's T20I Team of the Year 2024 included Arshdeep Singh, Jasprit Bumrah, Hardik Pandya, and Rohit Sharma, while the ICC Women's T20I Team of the Year 2024 had Smriti Mandhana, Richa Ghosh, and Deepti Sharma.

ICC Awards 2024 winners list :

- ICC Men's T20I Cricketer of the Year- Arshdeep Singh (IND)
- ICC Women's T20I Cricketer of the Year- Amelia Kerr (NZL)
- ICC Umpire of the Year – Richard Illingworth (ENG)
- ICC Men's Associate Cricketer of the Year – Gerhard Erasmus (NAM)
- ICC Women's Associate Cricketer of the Year – Esha Oza (UAE)
- ICC Emerging Men's Cricketer of the Year – Kamindu Mendis (SRI)
- ICC Emerging Women's Cricketer of the Year – Annerie Dercksen (RSA)
- ICC Men's ODI Cricketer of the Year – Azmatullah Omarzai (AFG)
- ICC Women's ODI Cricketer of the Year – Smriti Mandhana (IND)
- ICC Men's Test Cricketer of the Year – Jasprit Bumrah (IND)



Ques : Which female player won the women's singles title at the 2025 Australian Open?

- (a) Aryna Sabalenka
- (b) Iga Świątek
- (c) Coco Gauff
- (d) Madison Keys
- (e) Naomi Osaka

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Jannik Sinner of Italy and Madison Keys of the United States won the men's and women's singles titles at the 2025 Australian Open Grand Slam Tennis Tournament, respectively.
- Jannik Sinner won his third Grand Slam championship, while Madison Keys claimed her first.
- The 120th Australian Open was contested in Melbourne Park in Melbourne City, Australia, from January 6 to 26, 2025.
- Australian Open Started in 1905. It is played on Hard Surface.

Winners of Australian Open 2025 :

- Men's singles : Winner - Jannik Sinner (Italy) Runner up - Alexander Zverev (Germany)
- Women's singles : Winner - Madison Keys (USA) Runner up - Aryna Sabalenka (Belarus)
- Women's doubles : Winner - Kateřina Siniakova (Czech Republic) & Taylor Townsend (USA) Runner up - Hsieh Su-wei (Taiwan) & Jeļena Ostapenko (Latvia)
- Men's doubles : Winner - Harri Heliövaara (Finland) & Henry Patten (UK) Runner up - Simone Bolelli (Italy) & Andrea Vavassori (Italy)
- Mix doubles : Winner - Olivia Gadecki & John Peers (Australia) Runner up - Kimberly Birrell & JohnPatrick Smith (Australia)





Ques : The Ministry of Tourism, Government of India, has participated in one of the leading travel fairs – IFEMA being held in which country ?

- (a) Spain
- (b) China
- (c) USA
- (d) France
- (e) UK

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The Ministry of Tourism, Government of India, has participated in one of the main travel fairs, IFEMA, which is being hosted in Madrid, Spain, in order to showcase India as a prospective top destination in the Spanish and Latin American source markets.
- The exhibition at FITUR, which is regarded a benchmark event in the tourist sector, took place from January 22nd to January 26th, 2025. FITUR is the major expo for inbound and outbound markets in Ibero-America, as well as a global gathering point for tourism experts.
- The Indian team at FITUR included over 23 co-exhibitors, including the state governments of Karnataka, Sikkim, Chhattisgarh, and Jharkhand, among others, who presented their distinctive tourism products and experiences under the Incredible India umbrella.
- The year 2026 will be designated as the Dual Year of Culture, Tourism, and Artificial Intelligence to commemorate India and Spain's 70th anniversary of diplomatic relations.
- The Ministry of Tourism, Government of India, has also established the 'Chalo India Initiative' to encourage Indian diaspora members to become Incredible India Ambassadors.





Ques : 4th Badminton Asia Mixed Team Championships to be played in which country ?

- (a) United States
- (b) China
- (c) India
- (d) Japan
- (e) Russia

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Badminton Association of India (BAI) has announced a 14-member India squad for the 4th Badminton Asia Mixed Team Championships, which will be held in Qingdao, China, from February 11 to February 19, 2025
- The Indian squad will be captained by two-time Olympic medalist PV Sindhu and Paris Olympics semi-finalist Lakshya Sen, two of the country's finest badminton players.
- The India team earned a bronze medal at the 3rd Badminton Asia Mixed Team Championships in Dubai, United Arab Emirates, in 2023.
- China is the most successful team in the Championship, winning two gold medals and one bronze medal. India has only won one medal, bronze, at the 2023 edition.

India's squad for the Badminton Asia Mixed Team Championships :

- Men: Lakshya Sen, HS Prannoy, Satwiksairaj Rankireddy, Chirag Shetty, Dhruv Kapila, MR Arjun, Sathish Kumar.
- Women include PV Sindhu, Malvika Bansod, Gayatri Gopichand, Treesa Jolly, Ashwini Ponnappa, Tanisha Crasto, and Adya Variyath.





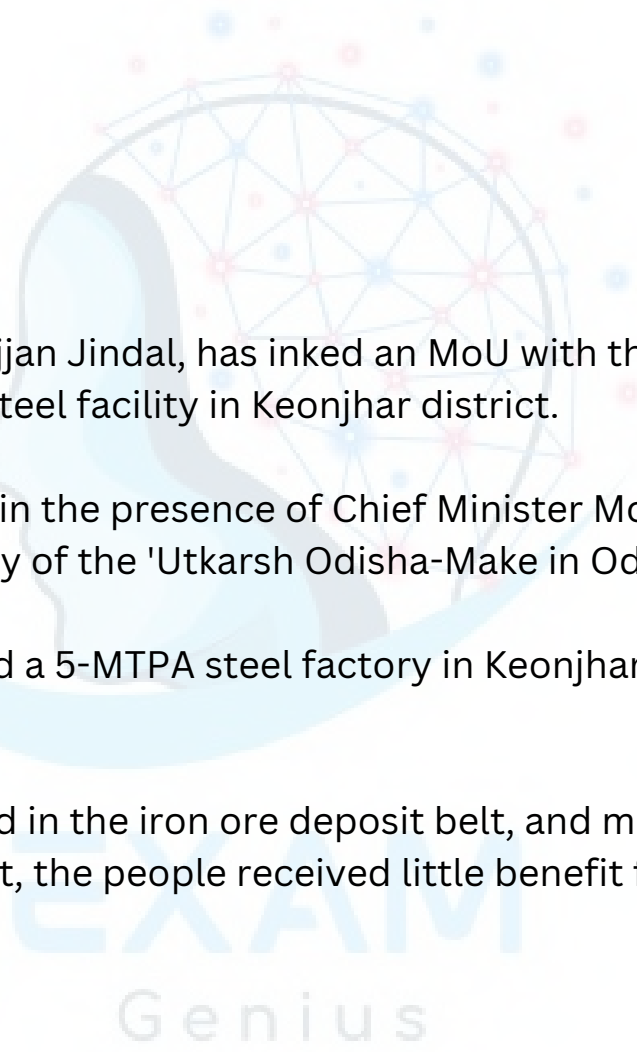
Ques : The JSW Group, led by Sajjan Jindal, has inked an MoU with which state government to build a 5-million-tonne steel facility ?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Andhra Pradesh
- (e) Telangana

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The JSW Group, led by Sajjan Jindal, has inked an MoU with the Odisha government to build a 5-million-tonne steel facility in Keonjhar district.
- The agreement was inked in the presence of Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi and Sajjan Jindal on the first day of the 'Utkarsh Odisha-Make in Odisha Conclave'.
- JSW (Group) plans to build a 5-MTPA steel factory in Keonjhar district for roughly Rs 35,000 crore.
- Keonjhar district is located in the iron ore deposit belt, and minerals were exported from the district. As a result, the people received little benefit from the mineral resources.





Ques : Alexander Lukashenko Appointed as President of which country ?

- (a) Poland
- (b) Belarus
- (c) Spain
- (d) Czech Republic
- (e) Australia

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- Longtime Belarusian leader Alexander Lukashenko has been named the winner of a contested presidential election, securing a seventh consecutive term, according to the country's electoral board.
- Belarus' incumbent President, Alexander Lukashenko, has won the presidential election. The Central Election Commission's preliminary results suggest that Lukashenko received 86.82 percent of the vote.
- According to the legislation, Belarus' president is chosen through direct elections, with a candidate earning more than 50% of the vote considered elected. The president is elected for a five-year term.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : The initial edition of the Fiscal Health Index (FHI) 2025 was unveiled in New Delhi by _ with the goal of assessing and improving Indian states' fiscal health ?

- (a) NITI Aayog
- (b) Ministry of Home affairs
- (c) RBI
- (d) SEBI
- (e) Ministry of Education

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- The initial edition of the Fiscal Health Index (FHI) 2025 was unveiled in New Delhi by NITI Aayog, with the goal of assessing and improving Indian states' fiscal health
- Dr. Arvind Panagariya, Chairman of the 16th Finance Commission, launched the report in the presence of distinguished dignitaries such as NITI Aayog Vice Chairman Suman Bery, CEO BVR Subrahmanyam, and member Dr. Arvind Virmani.
- The FHI report assesses 18 major states using five essential sub-indices: quality of expenditure, revenue mobilization, fiscal prudence, debt index, and debt sustainability.
- Odisha ranked first with a score of 67.8, followed by Chhattisgarh (55.2) and Goa (53.6).
- The rankings reveal interstate inequalities, with achiever states excelling at fiscal discipline and governments such as Karnataka struggling with expenditure management and debt sustainability.





Ques : Which Indian athlete won the gold medal in the women's 60m indoor hurdles at the Meeting de Nantes Métropole 2025?

- (a) Dutee Chand
- (b) Hima Das
- (c) Jyothi Yarraji
- (d) Annu Rani
- (e) P. U. Chitra

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Jyothi Yarraji of India smashed her own national record to win gold in the women's 60m indoor hurdles at the Meeting de Nantes Métropole 2025 in France.
- Jyothi Yarraji, who already holds the national record in the women's 100m hurdles, won the A final at the Pierre-Quinon Metropolitan Stadium in 8.04 seconds.
- Jyothi won silver in the 100m hurdles at the 2023 Asian Games with a time of 12.91 seconds. Last year, she made her Olympic debut in Paris, finishing fourth in the women's 100m hurdles repechage heat and failing to advance to the semis.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : World Leprosy Day celebrated year on which day ?

- (a) last Sunday of January
- (b) last Monday of January
- (c) last Tuesday of January
- (d) last Wednesday of January
- (e) last Thursday of January

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- Every year on the last Sunday of January, people commemorate World Leprosy Day. In 2025, World Leprosy Day will be observed on January 26.
- This international day provides an opportunity to honor those who have survived leprosy, increase awareness about the disease, and urge for an end to leprosy-related stigma and discrimination.
- Theme 2025: Unite. Act. Eliminate.

EXAM
Genius





Important days :

- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 2 January : 67th Foundation Day of Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day
- 4 January : World Braille Day
- 5 January : National Bird Day (Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future)
- 6 January : World Day of War Orphans
- 6 January : Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) celebrated its 78th Foundation Day
- 8 January : Earth's Rotation Day
- 9 January : NRI or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- 10 January : World Hindi Day, also known as 'Vishwa Hindi Diwas' (Theme 2025: A Global Voice of Unity and Cultural Pride)
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- 16 January : National Startup Day
- 11 to 17 January : National Road Safety Week 2025
- January 18 to February 17 : National Road Safety Month 2025 (Theme 2025 Sadak Suraksha Jeevan Raksha)
- 20 January : National Penguin Awareness Day
- 21 January : Northeastern states of Manipur, Meghalaya, and Tripura celebrate Statehood Day
- 23 January : Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Jayanti, also known as 'Parakram Diwas' or Courage Day



- 24 January : International Day of Education 2025 (Theme 2025 AI and Education: Preserving Human Agency in a World of Automation)
- 24 January : National Girl Child Day (Theme 2025: Empowering Girls for a Bright Future)
- 25 January : National Voters' Day 2025 (Theme 2025 Nothing Like Voting, I Vote for Sure)
- 25 January : National Tourism Day (Theme 2025: Tourism for Inclusive Growth)
- 26 January : 76th Republic Day 2025 (Theme 2025 "Swarnim Bharat: Virasat aur Vikas" (Golden India: Heritage and Development))
- 26 January : International Customs Day (Theme 2025: Customs Delivers on its Commitment to Efficiency, Security, and Prosperity)
- 26 January : International Day of Clean Energy 2025 (Theme 2025 Climate Change: The Need for a Global Energy Transition)
- 27 January : International Day of Commemoration in memory of the victims of the Holocaust (Theme 2025 Holocaust remembrance and education for dignity and human rights)

EXAM
Genius





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

RBI Fines Canara (Rs.1.63 crore), BOI (Rs.3.31 crore), and J&K Bank (Rs.1 crore) for Non-Compliance

‘Samman Sanjeevani’ app Launched by Haryana Cabinet Minister Shruti Choudhry. Its aimed at enhancing the efficiency of the ‘Mahila Evam Kishori Samman Yojana’. which is designed to provide essential services to BPL (Below Poverty Line) women and girls between the ages of 10 and 45, particularly sanitary napkins.

Indian Grandmaster Iniyar Panneerselvam showcased an exceptional performance to win the 9th Johor International Open Chess Tournament in Malaysia. Indian IM VS Raahul and Chinese IM Li Bo finished second and third respectively.

USD 30 million for JK Tyre & Industries Limited and up to USD 70 million for Cavendish Industries Limited (CIL) loan given by International Finance Corporation (IFC) to boost local supply chains, encourage the development of energy-efficient tyre production, and create employment.

The Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) has issued notices to Ola and Uber regarding claims of differential pricing based on users' mobile operating systems. According to reports, iPhone users pay greater prices than Android users for identical rides.

India & UK Renew 5-Year Partnership to strengthen collaboration and sharing knowledge in areas of mutual interest within health and life sciences during a ceremony held in New Delhi.





Ques : Department of Financial Services (DFS) has released how much capital infusion to New Delhi (Delhi) based IFCI Limited for subscribing to its share capital ?

- (a) Rs 100 crore
- (b) Rs 200 crore
- (c) Rs 300 crore
- (d) Rs 400 crore
- (e) Rs 500 crore

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- The Department of Financial Services (DFS) under the Ministry of Finance (MoF) has approved a Rs 500 crore capital infusion for New Delhi-based IFCI Limited to subscribe to its share capital in FY25 through a preferential issue (PREF).
- In January 2025, the DFS gained consent from the President of India, Droupadi Murmu, to disburse Rs. 500 crore to IFCI Ltd.
- The Government of India (GoI) plans to grow its stake in the corporation beyond its present 71.72% as of September 2024.

About IFCI Limited :

- Established : 1948
- HQ : New Delhi
- Deputy Managing Director : Rahul Bhawe

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which bank has been awarded with Indian Banks Association (IBA) Banking Technology Awards ?

- (a) City Union Bank
- (b) Indian Overseas Bank
- (c) Union Bank of India
- (d) Karnataka Bank
- (e) CSB Bank

Answer : Option A

Explanation :

- City Union Bank (CUB) win the Indian Banks Association (IBA) Banking Technology Awards in seven categories.
- It is awarded at 20th Banking Technology Conference, Expo & Citations 2023, organized by the Indian Banks Association (IBA) in Mumbai.
- Winning categories are : 1. Best AI & ML Bank 2. Best Fintech & Digital Payment Index (DPI) Adoption 3. Best Financial Inclusion 4. Best Digital Engagement 5. Best IT Risk Management 6. Best Technology Talent 7. Best Technology Bank
- The award has been Received by Dr. N. Kamakodi, Managing Director & CEO of City Union Bank
- The award is Presented by RBI Deputy Governor T. Rabi Sankar





Ques : Frictionless Finance Accelerator Programme is launched by which bank ?

- (a) HDFC Bank
- (b) IDFC First Bank
- (c) Dhanlaxmi Bank
- (d) RBL Bank
- (e) Yes Bank

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- Frictionless Finance Accelerator Programme Launched by YES Bank Limited, Reserve Bank Innovation Hub (RBIH) & S.P. Jain Institute of Management and Research (SPJIMR)
- It was Launched on National Startup Day (January 16 2025)
- Its aim is to assist fintech startups in overcoming challenges, scaling their innovations, and promoting financial inclusion in India
- The programme is in line with the growing investment in global venture capital, which reached USD 314 billion in 2024, and the projected USD 20 trillion global digital economy by 2030

About YES Bank :

- Established : 2004
- HQ : Mumbai, Maharashtra
- MD & CEO : Prashant Kumar
- Chairman : Rama Subramaniam Gandhi
- Tagline : Experience our Expertise

EXAM
Genius



Ques : RBI Announced Series of Steps to Inject how much amount into the Banking System ?

- (a) Rs 1 lakh Crore
- (b) Rs 1.50 lakh Crore
- (c) Rs 2 lakh Crore
- (d) Rs 2.50 lakh Crore
- (e) Rs 3 lakh Crore

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) plans to inject approximately Rs 1.5 lakh crore into the banking system gradually.
- The RBI plans to purchase Rs 60,000 crore of Government Securities (G-secs) through Open Market Operations (OMO) in three tranches of Rs 20,000 crore each.
- The RBI has launched a 56-day VRR auction for a stated sum of Rs 50,000 crore on February 7, 2025.
- The RBI has announced a USD/INR Buy/Sell Swap auction of USD 5 billion for a 6-month period on January 31, 2025, as part of liquidity management measures.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which organization imposed a penalty on Royal Sundaram General Insurance for violation of norms pertaining to outsourcing of activities?

- (a) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
- (b) State Bank of India (SBI)
- (c) NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL)
- (d) Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)
- (e) National Housing Bank (NHB)

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) issued a Rs.1 crore penalty on Royal Sundaram General Insurance for violating outsourcing standards.
- During an inspection, the regulator found that payments over Rs.1 crore paid to vendors in 2018-19 and 2019-20 were not mentioned in the outsourcing returns submitted to the Authority.
- The insurer also failed to provide the explanation and information requested by the inspection team throughout the examination period.

EXAM
Genius





Recent Penalties imposed on Banks by RBI :

- RBI Fines Canara (Rs.1.63 crore), BOI (Rs.1 crore), and J&K Bank (Rs.3.31 crore) for Non-Compliance
- RBI has terminated the registration of X10 Financial Services Ltd, a non-banking financial company (NBFC), citing irregularities in its digital lending operations.
- IndusInd Bank Limited was fined Rs.27.30 lakh by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for not following the 'Reserve Bank of India (Interest Rate on Deposits) Directions, 2016'.
- The Reserve Bank of India issued a monetary penalty of Rs.5 lakh on The Panchkula Central Co-operative Bank Limited, Haryana.
- Penalty of Rs 59.20 lakh Imposed on South Indian Bank by RBI Due to non-compliance with directives on interest rate on deposits and customer service standards.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) issued a penalty of Rs 28.30 lakh on SG Finserve Limited (previously Moongipa Securities).
- Arunachal Pradesh Rural Bank received a Rs 14 lakh penalty for failing to comply with Prudential Norms (Provisioning, Asset Classification, and Exposure Limit).
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) imposed a monetary penalty of Rs.61.60 lakh on The Surat People's Co-operative Bank Limited, Surat, for non-compliance with certain directions issued by RBI.
- The RBI imposed a monetary penalty of Rs.1.50 lakh on The Bihar Awami Co-operative Bank Ltd., Patna for violating section 26A and section 56 of the Banking Regulation Act, 1949 (BR Act) and failing to comply with RBI's 'Know Your Customer (KYC)' directions.
- Penalty on Hewlett Packard Financial Services (India) Private Limited is Amount to Rs.10.4 lakh and on Muthoot Vehicle & Asset Finance Limited is Amount to Rs.7.9 lakh
- The Reserve Bank of India has imposed a penalty of Rs 31.8 lakh on BNP Paribas for failing to comply with specific RBI guidelines on 'Interest Rate on Advances'.
- The RBI levied a monetary penalty of Rs.1.91 crore on Axis Bank Limited and Rs.1 crore on HDFC Bank Limited for non-compliance with certain directions issued by RBI.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has imposed a monetary penalty of Rs.2.68 crore on UCO Bank.





Ques: Who secured the top spot in World's Billionaires List 2025 Published by Forbes?

- (a) Jeff Bezos
- (b) Bernard Arnault
- (c) Elon Musk
- (d) Bill Gates
- (e) Warren Buffett

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- World's Billionaires List 2025 Published by Forbes
- Elon Musk is the richest person in the world, with a net worth of USD 433.9 billion. SpaceX is valued at USD 350 billion.
- Elon Musk is the first person in history to reach a net worth of USD 400 billion, largely due to SpaceX's valuation of USD 350 billion.
- The United States of America (USA) has the highest number of billionaires, with 813, followed by China (473), and India (200).
- As of January 1, 2025, the world's top ten individuals had a collective net worth of USD 1.9 trillion, up from USD 1.8 trillion in December 2024.

Ranking of Top 5 richest people in the world :

- 1 Elon Musk (Net Worth : USD 433.9 billion) USA
- 2 Jeff Bezos (Net Worth : USD 239.4 billion) USA
- 3 Mark Zuckerberg (Net Worth : USD 211.8 billion) USA
- 4 Larry Ellison (Net Worth : USD 204.6 billion) USA
- 5 Bernard Arnault (Net Worth : USD 181.3 billion) France

Ranking of Top 5 Indian richest people :

- 9 Mukesh Ambani (Net Worth : USD 433.9 billion)
- 17 Gautam Adani (Net Worth : USD 433.9 billion)
- 39 Shiv Nadar (Net Worth : USD 433.9 billion)
- 46 Savitri Jindal & family (Net Worth : USD 433.9 billion)
- 69 Dilip Shanghvi (Net Worth : USD 433.9 billion)





Ques : What is the rank of Indian Institute of Science (IISc) in Bengaluru, Karnataka in World University Rankings by Subject 2025 Published by Times Higher Education (THE) ?

- (a) 74th
- (b) 78th
- (c) 85th
- (d) 92nd
- (e) 96th

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- World University Rankings by Subject 2025 Published by Times Higher Education (THE). The rankings included almost 11,000 universities in 11 subjects.
- The Indian Institute of Science (IISc) in Bengaluru, Karnataka is the only Indian institution in the top 100 for computer science (CS), ranking 96th for the first time.
- The University of Oxford (UK) ranked first among all universities.
- In computer science, 53 Indian universities have made it to the global top rankings, up from 47 in 2024. IISc is rated 96th internationally.
- 14 Indian institutions maintain their position in the social sciences.

Ranking of Top 5 in World University Ranking 2025 :

- 1 University of Oxford (UK)
- 2 Massachusetts Institute of Technology (USA)
- 3 Harvard University (USA)
- 4 Princeton University (USA)
- 5 University of Cambridge (UK)





Top institutions in World University Rankings 2025 by subject :

- Arts and Humanities : Massachusetts Institute of Technology (USA)
- Business and Economics : Massachusetts Institute of Technology (USA)
- Computer Science : University of Oxford (UK)
- Education Studies : Stanford University (USA)
- Engineering : Harvard University (USA)
- Law : Stanford University(USA)
- Life Sciences : Harvard University (USA)
- Medical and Health : University of Oxford (UK)
- Physical Sciences : California Institute of Technology (USA)
- Psychology : Stanford University (USA)
- Social Sciences : Massachusetts Institute of Technology

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Georgia is the _____ country in the world to be certified malaria-free by WHO.

- (a) 42nd
- (b) 43rd
- (c) 44th
- (d) 45th
- (e) 46th

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Georgia has been officially declared malaria-free by the World Health Organization (WHO), marking a significant milestone in the country's century-long campaign against the illness.
- It is the 45th country and first in the WHO European Region to achieve malaria-free status.
- In 2005, Georgia, together with nine other countries in the WHO European Region, signed the Tashkent Declaration to reassert their commitment to eliminating malaria.
- The certification process requires a country to show that no indigenous malaria cases have been documented for at least three years in a row.
- Georgia reached this milestone in 2015 by successfully preventing the transmission of the three major malaria parasite species: *P. falciparum*, *P. malariae*, and *P. vivax*.

About Georgia :

- Capital – Tbilisi
- Currency – Georgian lari
- President – Mikheil Kavelashvili
- Prime Minister – Irakli Garibashvili





Ques : Which Indian conglomerate is associated with the acquisition of ITD Cementation India Limited (ICIL)?

- (a) Tata Group
- (b) Adani Group
- (c) Reliance Industries
- (d) Mahindra Group
- (e) Larsen & Toubro

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Competition Commission of India (CCI) has approved the proposed acquisition of a majority stake in ITD Cementation India Limited (ICIL) by Renew Exim DMCC, a Dubai-based Adani Group entity.
- Renew Exim, owned by Vinod Adani, will buy up to 72.64 % of ICIL's total issued and voting equity share capital for Rs.5,758 crore, including the principal transaction and open offer.
- Under the acquisition proposal, Renew Exim DMCC will initially purchase 46.64 percent of ITD Cementation's stock, or 8,01,13,180 shares.
- Furthermore, in accordance with SEBI's Substantial Acquisition of Shares and Takeovers Regulations, 2011, the business has launched an open offer to purchase an additional 26 percent ownership, or 4,46,64,772 shares, to strengthen its controlling position.





Ques : Which ministry has partnered with ONDC to launch the MSME Trade Enablement And Marketing (TEAM) initiative?

- (a) Union Ministry of Home Affairs
- (b) Union Ministry of Education
- (c) Union Ministry of Steel and Heavy Industries
- (d) Union Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
- (e) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Ministry of Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSME) has teamed with Open Network for Digital Commerce to launch MSME Trade Enablement And Marketing (TEAM) with an INR 277.35 Cr budget.
- This will enable over 5 lakh MSMEs, with a special focus on women-led firms, to join the ONDC network.
- ONDC will create chances for small and medium-sized enterprises to grow by leveraging digital storefronts, integrated payment systems, and logistics support.
- The MSME TEAM Initiative is more than simply a program; it is an opportunity to provide small businesses with the tools and resources they require to survive in the digital age.

Genius





Ques : How many newly accredited Wetland Cities were announced during the 64th meeting of the WCA Advisory Committee?

- a) 20
- b) 25
- c) 45
- d) 35
- e) 31

Answer : Option E

Explanation :

- The Ramsar Convention's independent Advisory Committee on Wetland City Accreditation (WCA) recognized 31 newly accredited Wetland Cities at its 64th meeting in Gland, Switzerland.
- Indore and Udaipur are the first Indian cities to earn international designation as 'Wetland Cities'. This brings the overall number of recognized wetland cities to 74.
- UNESCO provided this accreditation under the Ramsar Convention.
- Valid for 6 years, it promotes the conservation and sustainable use of urban wetlands, providing ecological and socio-economic benefits to local communities.
- Total 85 wetland sites in India that are included in the Ramsar sites
- Largest wetland site in India is Sundarbans site, West Bengal and First Ramsar site of India Chilika Lake, Odisha (1981)
- Wetland Day celebrated on 2 February.

About Wetland City Accreditation (WCA) :

- Established : 2015 by Ramsar Convention
- Established during : Conference of the Contracting Parties (COP) 12
- Aim : to recognize cities that have taken exceptional steps to safeguard their urban wetlands
- Criteria : to qualify, cities must meet six international criteria, which include measures to protect wetland ecosystems and promote their sustainable use
- China leads the global Wetland City list with 22 cities, followed by France with 9 cities





Ques : K.M. Cherian was best known for performing which of the following medical procedures for the first time in India?

- (a) Heart transplant surgery
- (b) Robotic surgery
- (c) Coronary bypass surgery
- (d) Kidney transplant
- (e) Neurosurgery

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- K.M. Cherian, India's renowned heart surgeon who performed the country's first coronary bypass operation, died in Bengaluru.
- From 1990 until 1993, he served as an honorary surgeon to the President of India.
- He earned various prizes, including the Padma Shri in 1991 and the Harvard Medical Excellence Award in 2005, as part of a panel organized by Harvard Medical School.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Who has successfully launched its new generation satellite NVS-02 from Sriharikota in Andhra Pradesh ?

- (a) DRDO
- (b) HAL
- (c) NASA
- (d) ISRO
- (e) BHEL

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) successfully launched its new generation satellite, NVS-02, from Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh. The Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle (GSLV-F15) carried the NVS-02.
- This is ISRO's 100th launch from the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota, making it a significant milestone.
- The NVS-02 is the second satellite in the NVS series and a component of India's Navigation using Indian Constellation (NavIC).
- NavIC is India's independent regional navigation satellite system, designed to provide accurate Position, Velocity, and Timing (PVT) service to customers in India and a region extending approximately 1,500 kilometers beyond the Indian subcontinent, which is its major service area.
- NavIC offers two types of services: Standard Positioning Services (SPS) and Restricted Services (RS). NavIC SPS has a position precision of more than 20 meters (2σ) and timing accuracy of more than 40 nanoseconds (2σ) in the primary service region.





Recent News Headlines Related to ISRO

- ISRO successfully grew black-eyed pea seeds in orbit using its Compact Research Module for Orbital Plant Studies (CROPS). The CROPS project studies plant growth in space.
- The Union Cabinet approved establishing a third launchpad at Isro's Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota at a cost of Rs.3,985 crore.
- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has successfully launched the Space Docking Experiment (SpaDeX) mission. ISRO's PSLV-C60 rocket, carrying two spacecraft for space docking demonstrations, launched from Sriharikota's Satish Dhawan Space Centre
- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) successfully launched the European Space Agency (ESA) Probe 3 spacecraft from the First Launch Pad at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC-SHAR) in Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh.
- Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has signed an Implementation Agreement (IA) with the Australian Space Agency (ASA) for further strengthening of cooperation in space activities between the two countries
- ISRO has launched its analogue space mission in Leh, Ladakh.
- Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and the Department of Biotechnology (DBT) Objective To develop and conduct biological and environmental experiments for the planned Bharatiya Antariksh Station (BAS), expected to be operational by 2028-2035
- ISRO has launched India's first analog space mission from Leh, Ladakh. The mission involves ISRO, the University of Ladakh, IIT Bombay, AAKA Space Studio, and the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council.
- EOS-06, commonly known as Oceansat-3, is an Earth observation spacecraft created by ISRO. It was successfully launched on November 26, 2022, using ISRO's Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (PSLV-C54).
- ISRO has acquired two 400kg satellites for the next Space Docking Experiment (SPADEX)
- ISRO has received a budget of Rs 2104.06 crore for the Chandrayaan-4 mission, which would be completed in 36 months.
- The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) aims to launch the first base module of the Bharatiya Antariksh Station (BAS), India's first space station, in 2028. The BAS will contain five modules.
- ISRO's Earth Perception Satellite-8 (EOS-8) is supposed to be sent off by the Small Satellite Launch Vehicle (SSLV)-D3 on August 16 from Sriharikota in Andhra Pradesh.
- The Air Breathing Propulsion Technology demonstration flight was successfully completed by the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) on its second trial flight.
- GSAT 20 is a 4,700 kg heavy-weight, high-tech satellite. New Delhi: Using SpaceX's Falcon 9 rocket, the Indian space agency ISRO will launch its latest big satellite in a first.





Ques : Which prestigious civilian award was conferred upon Hariman Sharma ?

- (a) Bharat Ratna
- (b) Padma Bhushan
- (c) Padma Shri
- (d) Arjuna Award
- (e) Dronacharya Award

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- Hariman Sharma, a visionary farmer from Himachal Pradesh, has received the Padma Shri, one of the highest civilian awards, for his revolutionary contribution to Indian agriculture.
- He created an innovative, self-pollinating, low chilling apple variety called HRMN - 99, which has transformed the country's apple production landscape and made a juicy, nutritious variety more accessible in terms of geography and cost.
- Unlike commercial apple cultivars that require temperate conditions and extended chilling hours, HRMN-99 thrives in tropical, subtropical, and plain regions with summer temperatures ranging from 40 to 45°C, allowing apple growing to be practiced in previously unfeasible locations.
- The story of the HRMN-99 apple variety began in 1998 when Hariman Sharma planted a few seeds from discarded apples used for household consumption in his backyard.





Ques : Which organization is providing support to Uttarakhand for hosting the 38th National Games?

- (a) Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL)
- (b) Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL)
- (c) Indian Oil Corporation (IOC)
- (d) Oil and Natural Gas Corporation Limited (ONGC)
- (e) None of These

Answer : Option C

Explanation :

- The 38th National Games will be held in Dehradun, Uttarakhand, during its Silver Jubilee year, with events taking place in 11 cities across 8 districts from January 28th to February 14th.
- 36 states and one union territory will compete in the National Games. Competitions in 35 sports disciplines will take place over the course of 17 days.
- Medals will be awarded for 33 sports, with two being exhibition sports.
- Yoga and Mallakhamb have been added to the National Games for the first time.
- This year's National Games theme is "Green Games," which emphasizes sustainability.
- A special park, known as the Sports Forest, will be built near the venue, where players and guests will plant over 10,000 seedlings.
- The medals and certificates for the athletes will be constructed of eco-friendly and biodegradable materials.





Recent News headlines related to Sports

- Indian Grandmaster Iniyen Panneerselvam showcased an exceptional performance to win the 9th Johor International Open Chess Tournament in Malaysia. Indian IM VS Raahul and Chinese IM Li Bo finished second and third respectively
- Jyothi Yarraji of India smashed her own national record to win gold in the women's 60m indoor hurdles at the Meeting de Nantes Métropole 2025 in France.
- ICC Men's T20I Cricketer of the Year is Arshdeep Singh (IND) and ICC Women's T20I Cricketer of the Year is Amelia Kerr (NZL)
- Jannik Sinner of Italy and Madison Keys of the United States won the men's and women's singles titles at the 2025 Australian Open Grand Slam Tennis Tournament, respectively.
- The Badminton Association of India (BAI) has announced a 14-member India squad for the 4th Badminton Asia Mixed Team Championships, which will be held in Qingdao, China.
- India will host the FIDE Chess World Cup 2025, its first big international tournament since the 2022 Chennai Chess Olympiad.
- The fifth edition of the Khelo India Winter Games (KIWG) 2025 kicked off at the renowned NDS Stadium in Leh, Ladakh, with much excitement
- Eritrea's Berhane Tesfay and Kenya's Joyce Chepkemoi Tele won the men's and women's elite races, respectively, at the Mumbai Marathon 2025.
- Olympic champions Viktor Axelsen and An Se-young won the men's and women's singles titles, respectively, with lopsided victories in the India Open Super 750 badminton tournament in New Delhi.
- The inaugural Kho Kho World Cup in New Delhi concluded on a historic note, with India winning both the men's and women's titles in dramatic manner.
- Karnataka defeated Vidarbha by 36 runs in the Vijay Hazare Trophy (VHT) 2024-25 final at the Kotambi Stadium in Vadodara. This is Karnataka's fifth Vijay Hazare Trophy title win
- Novak Djokovic broke a tie with Roger Federer for the most Grand Slam matches in tennis history.
- Arjun Erigaisi, an Indian grandmaster, stunned the internet chess community by defeating World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen and World No. 2 Fabiano Caruana in Chess.com's Titled Tuesday weekly blitz competition.





Ques : In which state was the International Saraswati Mahotsav 2025 held?

- (a) West Bengal
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Haryana
- (e) Maharashtra

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini has launched the seven-day "International Saraswati Mahotsav 2025" at "Adi Badri" in Haryana's Yamunagar district.
- The Haryana Sarasvati Heritage Development Board, under the Government of Haryana, is organizing the International Saraswati Mahotsav.
- The Saraswati River started in the Himalayas and flowed across the western half of the Indo-Gangetic alluvial plains, joined by various tributaries such as the Sutlej, Yamuna, Chautang, and Drishadvati.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Which state government begins process of geo-tagging Chinar trees to preserve heritage ?

- (a) Tripura
- (b) Jammu and Kashmir
- (c) Nagaland
- (d) Bihar
- (e) Chhattisgarh

Answer : Option B

Explanation :

- The Jammu and Kashmir government is using geo-tagging to preserve heritage Chinar trees.
- With advancements in technology, these trees now have 'Digital Aadhaar'. Everyone in China now has their own 'Aadhar' number.
- QR codes are now available for scanning. Each district has its own district code and number of Chinars. So far, they have identified and geo-tagged 28,560 Chinar.

EXAM
Genius





Ques : Martyrs' Day, also known as Shaheed Diwas, is observed annually on which day ?

- (a) 27 January
- (b) 28 January
- (c) 29 January
- (d) 30 January
- (e) 31 January

Answer : Option D

Explanation :

- Martyrs' Day, also known as Shaheed Diwas, is held annually on January 30 in India to commemorate the sacrifices of those who gave their lives for the nation's independence.
- This day is especially significant since it commemorates the death anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi, the leader of India's nonviolent liberation campaign.
- By commemorating this day, the nation honors its courageous martyrs and recalls their commitment to the cause of independence.
- Martyrs' Day commemorates Mahatma Gandhi, who was killed in 1948.

EXAM
Genius





Important days :

- 1 January : Global Family Day (Theme 2025: Let's Start the Year With Love, Unity, and Appreciation)
- 2 January : World Introvert Day (Theme 2025: Finding peace and calm in a noisy world)
- 2 January : 67th Foundation Day of Defence Research and Development Organization (DRDO)
- 3 January : International Mind-Body Wellness Day
- 4 January : World Braille Day
- 5 January : National Bird Day (Theme 2025: Protecting Our Birds, Protecting Our Future)
- 6 January : World Day of War Orphans
- 6 January : Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) celebrated its 78th Foundation Day
- 8 January : Earth's Rotation Day
- 9 January : NRI or Pravasi Bharatiya Divas
- 10 January : World Hindi Day, also known as 'Vishwa Hindi Diwas' (Theme 2025: A Global Voice of Unity and Cultural Pride)
- 12 January : National Youth Day (Theme 2025: Youth for a Sustainable Future: Shaping the Nation with Resilience and Responsibility)
- 14 January : 9th Armed Forces Veterans' Day 2025 (Celebrates to Commemorates The retirement of Field Marshal K.M. Cariappa on January 14, 1953)
- 15 January : Indian Army Day (Theme 2025: Samarth Bharat, Saksham Sena (Capable India, Empowered Army))
- 16 January : National Startup Day
- 11 to 17 January : National Road Safety Week 2025
- January 18 to February 17 : National Road Safety Month 2025 (Theme 2025 Sadak Suraksha Jeevan Raksha)
- 20 January : National Penguin Awareness Day
- 21 January : Northeastern states of Manipur, Meghalaya, and Tripura celebrate Statehood Day
- 23 January : Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose Jayanti, also known as 'Parakram Diwas' or Courage Day
- 24 January : International Day of Education 2025 (Theme 2025 AI and Education: Preserving Human Agency in a World of Automation)
- 24 January : National Girl Child Day (Theme 2025: Empowering Girls for a Bright Future)





- 25 January : National Voters' Day 2025 (Theme 2025 Nothing Like Voting, I Vote for Sure)
- 25 January : National Tourism Day (Theme 2025: Tourism for Inclusive Growth)
- 26 January : 76th Republic Day 2025 (Theme 2025 "Swarnim Bharat: Virasat aur Vikas" (Golden India: Heritage and Development))
- 26 January : International Customs Day (Theme 2025: Customs Delivers on its Commitment to Efficiency, Security, and Prosperity)
- 26 January : International Day of Clean Energy 2025 (Theme 2025 Climate Change: The Need for a Global Energy Transition)
- 26 January (last Sunday of January) : World Leprosy Day (Theme 2025: Unite. Act. Eliminate)
- 27 January : International Day of Commemoration in memory of the victims of the Holocaust (Theme 2025 Holocaust remembrance and education for dignity and human rights)
- 27 January : National Geographic Day 2025

EXAM
Genius





IMPORTANT ONE – LINER Current Affairs

Crystal Awards Awarded at 55th World Economic Forum (WEF) Annual Meeting commenced in Davos, Switzerland. Winners are 1. David Beckham, a UNICEF Goodwill Ambassador 2. Fashion designer and philanthropist Diane von Furstenberg 3. Architect Riken Yamamoto.

Hundreds of same-sex couples are tying the knot in Thailand as the country becomes the first in Southeast Asia to legalize marriage equality. Thailand's landmark marriage equality bill was officially written into law on September 24, 2024.

Janet Petro Appointed as 15th Acting NASA administrator. She Replaced 14th NASA administrator, Bill Nelson. This is a historic decision as Petro will be the first woman to lead Nasa since its founding in 1958.

The Board of Directors of Ujjivan Small Finance Bank (SFB) has approved to file an application with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for universal bank license.

The Directorate General of Shipping (DGS) and the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), a Scientific Society under Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) signed an umbrella MoU to advance technological innovation and excellence in India's maritime sector.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has inaugurated the 'Utkarsh Odisha, Make in Odisha Conclave' in Bhubaneswar. The two-day conclave aims to promote investment, boost industrial growth, and position Odisha as a key economic hub in Eastern India.

Birla Institute of Management Technology (BIMTECH) in Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh launched 'BIMCOIN', a blockchain-based digital currency for its ecosystem. Following the IIT Madras, BIMTECH has become the 1st business management institute in India to launch a blockchain-based digital currency.

